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Leviticus - Introduction

Leviticus

Leviticus - Introduction

Part 1: General Introduction

Outline of Leviticus

1. Instructions to the Israelites about offerings (1:1–6:7)
2. Burnt offerings (1:1–17)
3. Grain offerings (2:1–16)
4. Fellowship offerings (3:1–17)
5. Offerings for unintentional sins (4:1–5:13)
6. Guilt offerings (5:14–6:7)
7. Instructions to the priests about offerings (6:8–7:10)
8. Burnt offerings (6:8–13)
9. Grain offerings (6:14–23)
10. Purification offerings (6:24–30)
11. Guilt offerings (7:1–10)
12. Further instructions to the Israelites (7:11–7:38)
13. Peace offerings (7:11–21)
14. Eating fat and blood is forbidden (7:22–27)
15. The portion for the priests (7:28–7:38)
16. Setting apart the priests (8:1–10:20)
17. Aaron and his sons ordained (8:1–36)
18. Aaron as high priest (9:1–24)
19. Nadab and Abihu punished (10:1–20)
20. Laws about clean and unclean things (11:1–15:33)
21. Clean and unclean food (11:1–47)
22. Women are purified after giving birth (12:1–8)
23. Skin, clothing, houses (13:1–14:47)
24. Bodily fluids (15:1–33)
25. Day of Atonement; the place of the offering; the nature of blood (16:1–17:16)
26. Setting apart for worship and service; being disqualified from service (18:1–24:23)
27. The years of rest and release (25:1–55)
28. Blessing for obeying and curses for not obeying (26:1–46)
29. Gifts to God (27:1–34)

What is the book of Leviticus about?

In the book of Leviticus, Yahweh continues to give laws through Moses to the people of Israel. These laws detailed the way the people of Israel were to relate to Yahweh and one another as Yahweh's holy people who reflected Yahweh's own holiness. As such, many of the laws involve sacrifices and rituals intended to keep the people set apart from the impurity of sin and wrongdoing and keep them pure and holy to worship and serve Yahweh. The rest of the laws instruct the people and the priests about what is ritually clean and unclean and how to become clean again if one becomes unclean. In the middle of these laws is a portion of narrative (Leviticus 8–10) that details how Moses inaugurated the priesthood through Aaron and his sons, cleansed and prepared Yahweh's sacred tent to be able to receive the people's sacrifices, and began to offer sacrifices for himself and the people. It also describes the death of Aaron's two oldest sons, who fail to follow Yahweh's laws, reinforcing the vital necessity of obeying all of Yahweh's laws. Yahweh promised the people and the priests that if they would be diligent in following all of these laws, he would consider them to be faithful in honoring their covenant with him. By maintaining their status of holiness, Yahweh would be able to be Israel's God, and Israel would be able to be Yahweh's people. (See 26:3–13)

How should the title of this book be translated?

"Leviticus" means "about the Levites." The Levites were the tribe of Israel that provided priests and other workers to serve and worship Yahweh in his sacred tent. If the people in the project language do not understand the term "Levites," you can call it "The Book about the Priests" or "The Book about the Tabernacle Workers." (See: tabernacle; and How to Translate Names)

Who wrote the book of Leviticus?

The book of Leviticus claims to be the words of Yahweh passed on to the Israelites through Moses. That being said, scholarly debates continue to suggest that the compositional history of this book is long and complicated. It is likely that the source of the traditions in the book of Leviticus originated with Moses, whether in written or oral form. The community then preserved these traditions until they were written down and arranged sometime later.

What is the meaning of the words "holy" and "holiness" in the book of Leviticus?

These terms concern separating someone or something from something else. In the book of Leviticus, Yahweh declares that he is a holy God, separated from

Leviticus - Introduction

impurity, death, and sin. God does not sin. This means that any place, object, or person that is intended to be of use in the service or worship of Yahweh must be equally set apart from the impurity that comes from death, sin, and wrongdoing.

Therefore, Yahweh declares that the people of Israel are holy people in that they are separated from the people of the other nations and belong to Yahweh alone. God set the people of Israel apart so that they would belong only to him. Similarly, the people were to consider the places or objects used for worshiping Yahweh or for honoring him as separated for Yahweh's use only. The people of Israel were not to use them for anything else. God required the Israelites to live in a certain way in order to live as a nation belonging to him alone.

While certain items and people dedicated for the service and worship of Yahweh needed to be holy, ordinary people could only participate in the worship of Yahweh (usually through sacrifice) if they were clean or pure. This means that they had abstained from sin, wrongdoing, or eating or coming into physical contact with anything unclean or impure. Things or people that were unclean or impure were unacceptable to participate in the worship and service of Yahweh. In the worldview of Leviticus, impurity or uncleanness is thought of to be like a contagion with physical properties. This means that bringing something unclean into contact with something holy would cause the holy item or person to become infected (so to speak) with the uncleanness and, as a consequence, no longer fit to serve or worship Yahweh. This process was called "profaning something holy."

As a consequence, some people and some things could be made clean or cleansed, that is, made acceptable to Yahweh once again. People or things were made clean if the people performed the appropriate sacrifices and rituals. For example, some non-Israelites who wished to live among the Israelites and worship Yahweh could be made clean. However, other people and things could never be made acceptable to him and had to be destroyed.

It is important to know that not everything unclean or impure was sinful. Impurity was often associated with death or bodily discharge rather than with sin or wrongdoing. For example, after giving birth to a male child, a woman would be unclean for 33 days. Then the proper animal sacrifice would be offered for her. The monthly flow of blood made the woman unclean 12:7–13. But Leviticus never suggests that someone with a flow of blood was sinning. In the same way, Yahweh did not allow the Israelites to eat certain kinds of animals. This was one way of setting his people apart from the people who lived around them.

What are the important narrative features of Leviticus?

The entire book of Leviticus is set within the context of Yahweh speaking to Moses, Aaron, the priests, and the people of Israel. On 35 occasions, the phrase "The Lord spoke to ..." is used to begin paragraphs. God and Moses frequently spoke to others. The verb "to speak" is used 66 times. This reinforces the idea that Yahweh is telling the people how they are to live as his holy people. Neither Moses nor the people of Israel made these ideas up; they came directly from Yahweh.

Part 2: Important Religious and Cultural Concepts

What was the "tent of meeting"?

The tent of meeting (ULT; UST: sacred tent) was the physical location in which Yahweh lived among the people of Israel while they journeyed from Egypt to the land of Canaan and wandered in the wilderness. As a literal tent, the tent of meeting housed the altars, holy items, and the box of the covenant on top of which Yahweh was enthroned over the seraphs. There, Moses and Aaron would meet with Yahweh and receive his laws. (See Exodus 33:7–11) The tent itself and the items in it are described in detail in Exodus 25:1–27:20. It was here that the people of Israel were to come and present their sacrifices. This location is often described in the book of Leviticus as "to the face of Yahweh," that is, Yahweh's presence.

Why did the Israelites need so many rules about sacrificing animals?

Leviticus shows that God is holy. That means God is very different from humanity and the rest of the created world, especially concerning death, sin, and wrongdoing. God does not sin. Because of this, it is impossible to be acceptable to him without being cleansed. Because impurity (and sin) was thought of as a contagion with physical properties, blood was needed to cleanse the impurity from the people of God and, in so doing, allow Yahweh to forgive them. In this way, the various kinds of sacrifices were meant to continue the relationship between Yahweh and his people. However, because of the constant presence of the impurity caused by death, sin, and wrongdoing, the people of Israel had to continue making animal sacrifices. This was a sign that pointed to a need for a better, once-for-all sacrifice. (See the book of Hebrews.) They needed a sacrifice that would cause them to be cleansed from sin and forgiven before God forever. (See: holy, holiness, unholy, sacred; and sin, sinful, sinner, sinning)

Leviticus - Introduction

Why was the priesthood important in the book of Leviticus?
Priests were men who served and worshiped Yahweh on behalf of the people of Israel. Yahweh authorized only the priests to bring the Israelite's sacrifices to himself.

How did the Israelite's laws for worshiping God and sacrificing animals differ from rules of the other nations at that time?
It was common for other nations to sacrifice animals to their idols. However, the other nations did other things to worship their false gods. For instance, people would sleep with prostitutes at the temple of their gods or sacrifice their children to appease the gods' anger. They did this to try to persuade their gods to bless their land with the ability to grow crops. Because Yahweh is not like the gods of the other nations, he did not allow his people to do these kinds of things. Unlike the other gods who give blessing only when they are satiated with the best portions of food, Yahweh does not eat the food offered to him but rather gives it to his priests as their sacred portions of food. Yahweh's blessings of fertility, peace, and abundance were not the reward for proper sacrifices but rather the sign of the continuing covenantal relationship between Yahweh and his holy people.

What does atonement mean in the book of Leviticus?
The word translated as "atone" in the ULT is a technical term expressing the act of atonement that was carried out by the priest but always accomplished by Yahweh. Traditionally, it has been understood as a metaphor with the basic meaning of "to cover," but more recently, some scholars have understood it to express the image of "to wipe." If the former is correct, then the metaphor pictures the blood of the sacrifice as covering up the defiling impurity caused by sin. If the latter is correct, then the metaphor pictures the blood of the animal as a sort of ritual detergent that cleanses the person or object from the defiling presence of sin's impurity. Either way, the sacrifice offered by the priest on behalf of the individual or community is accepted in order to restore the relationship between the individual or community and Yahweh that has been damaged or defiled because of sin. This is why so many of the laws concerning sacrifice end with the mention of the forgiveness of sins, which was the means by which the relationship with Yahweh could be restored. (See: atonement, atone, atoned; and priest, priesthood)

Part 3: Important Translation Issues

"The sons of Aaron" and "The sons of Israel"
At the time when Yahweh spoke to Moses from the tent of meeting, the priests literally were the sons of Aaron. But the instructions in the book also applied to future generations, when the term "sons" would be a way of referring to the priests as Aaron's male descendants. If it would be clearer in your language, in your translation you could generally use that term, which would apply to both the original priests and to their successors. However, in chapters 8–10, only the literal sons of Aaron are in view, so the term "sons" would be appropriate there.

Similarly, the phrase "the sons of Israel" is a metaphor that the book of Leviticus often uses to describe the people of Israel. Although the word "sons" is masculine, it is used in these contexts in a general way that refers to both men and women. Furthermore, this expression speaks of the people of Israel in the time of Moses as if they were literally the sons of Israel. It means that they are the physical and spiritual descendants of Jacob, whose name God changed to Israel. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly.

"to the face of Yahweh"
Throughout, the book of Leviticus uses the expression "to the face of Yahweh" to refer to a location where Yahweh is present. This usually refers to a place within the tent of meeting, where Yahweh dwells. When someone or something is "to the face of Yahweh," it means that it receives Yahweh's attention, perspective, and judgment. Therefore, "to the face of" means "in the sight of" or "in the presence of," similar to the English preposition "before." In most cases, you can translate this expression as "from Yahweh's perspective," "in Yahweh's presence," or simply as "before Yahweh."

"burn in a way that makes smoke go up"
Throughout Leviticus, the language of "causing" the sacrifice "to become smoke on the altar" pictures the sacrifice as being converted to smoke by the fire of the altar and arising to Yahweh in heaven, where he would smell the pleasant aroma of the burning sacrifice. As such, the pleasant smell was either a sign that Yahweh approved the sacrifice and would atone for the individual's sins and forgive him or it functioned as a necessary requirement for the acceptance of the individual's offering. Either way, this term is common in Leviticus but difficult to translate cleanly. If your language has a verb that means to turn something into smoke through fire, especially in a religious context, consider using it here.

Leviticus - Introduction

Unblemished or perfect
When the book of Leviticus calls something perfect (in the ULT), it refers to an animal that is the best representative animal of that species. As such, the word "perfect" refers to wholeness, completeness, and the lack of any imperfection. (See the kinds of blemishes that disqualified an animal for sacrifice in 22:17–25) This is often translated with negative terms like "unblemished." If it would be more natural in your language, consider using terms that carry these same meanings.

The "gift" or "offering made by fire"
The word translated as "gift" in 1:9, 1:13, and 1:17 and throughout the book of Leviticus is variously translated in modern English versions, usually with reference to an offering made by fire, based on the word's presumed relationship with the word for fire. However, some of the sacrifices referred to by this word are not burned on the altar (like the portions of the sacrifices that belonged to the priests in 7:30 and 7:35–36) and many sacrifices, such as the purification offering, that are burned on the altar are not referred to by this term. Instead, this term simply refers to a gift offered to Yahweh that consists of food items. While you may see the phrase "fire offering" or "offering made by fire" in modern English translations, we suggest that you retain the term "gift."

"the holy thing of holy things"
Throughout the book, Yahweh reserves portions of the sacrificed animal or bread item for the priests as their food. These portions are called "the holy thing of holy things." (See e.g., Lev 2:3, 2:10; 6:17, 6:25, and 6:29; 7:1 and 7:6; 10:12 and 10:17; Lev 14:13; Lev 21:22; Lev 24:9; and Lev 27:28) All food that was offered to Yahweh was considered a holy thing (See "the holy things" and "a holy thing" in Lev 22:2–4, 22:6–7, 22:10 and 22:14–16), but certain food offerings were designated as the holy thing of holy things.

These are:

- the remainder of the regular grain offering that is not burned (2:3, 2:10, 6:17, and 10:12)
- the flesh from the sin offering (6:17, 6:25, 6:29, 10:17) and from the guilt offering (7:1, 7:6, and 14:13)
- the bread of presence that is continually in Yahweh's presence (24:9) In these verses, the expression "the holy thing of holy things" uses the possessive form to describe an offering that is exceptionally or uniquely holy. As such, the expression may be translated as "the most holy thing" or "the exceptionally holy thing."

Introducing direct quotations
The author of Leviticus uses the word "saying" to introduce his quotation of what Yahweh is telling Moses and Aaron or what they are telling the people of Israel. Consider natural ways of introducing direct quotations in your language.

"shall"
The ULT represents the Hebrew instructional verb form with the English helping verb "shall." For example, when Yahweh told the people in 1:3, "he shall present it," he was instructing them how to present their offerings. Translate this form with the most natural way in your language for giving instructions.

The expression "A man, when he ..."
The book of Leviticus uses the expression "A man, when he ..." frequently to describe various hypothetical situations related to Israel's sacrificial system and holy living. (See 13:2, 13:40, 15:16, 15:20, 22:14, and 22:21) In these contexts, although the word translated as "man" is masculine, it has a generic sense that refers to any person who approaches the tent to make a sacrifice. It may be helpful to translate this term with a generic word for a person to avoid any potential misunderstanding.

What important symbols are introduced in Leviticus?
Several physical items are used with symbolic or ritual meanings in the book of Leviticus. Olive oil was poured on someone or something when that person or object was to be set apart for the exclusive worship and service of Yahweh.

Similarly, sacrifices were routinely washed with water to cleanse them (both physically and ritually), symbolizing the removal of impurities so that God could accept the sacrifice. People and objects that were to be declared clean after having been in contact with something unclean would need to be washed to symbolize their cleansing.

Smoke is another important symbol in the book of Leviticus. While some sacrifices were to be transformed completely into smoke, as was the case with the wholly burned sacrifice (or burnt offering), all sacrifices involved burning a portion of the flesh or flour on the altar and causing it to become smoke. This smoke would go up, rising to Yahweh, who would smell the pleasing smell of the sacrifice and accept the offering on the worshiper's behalf. If your language has a verb or phrase that is used in religious contexts to refer to smoke going up to God, consider using it to translate these phrases in Leviticus.

Leviticus - Introduction

Finally, blood was considered to be akin to the ritual soap that had the power to remove the contagion that was the impurity caused by death, sin, and wrongdoing. As a consequence, blood was also used to cleanse and purify people and things.

What kind of sacrifices are described in the book of Leviticus?

Several types of sacrifices are described in the book of Leviticus, each with its own instructions and purpose. It may be helpful to refer to this list when translating the names of these sacrifices, especially if your language has a word or phrase that describes a sacrifice with a similar procedure or purpose.

1. The burnt offering (ULT; UST: wholly burned sacrifice) was a common flesh sacrifice that was to be burned completely on the altar by the priest. It belonged entirely to Yahweh, and no portion of it was retained as food for the priest or the worshiper. The burnt offering is described in detail in Leviticus 1. Individuals were allowed to offer cattle (1:1–9), sheep or goats (1:10–13), or birds (1:14–17), depending on their ability to afford such animals. As a flesh sacrifice, the blood from this sacrifice allowed Yahweh to atone for the worshiper, and so the primary purpose of the burnt offering was the removal of sin from an individual. (See the additional instructions for the priest who offers the burnt offering in 6:9–13)
2. The grain offering (ULT and UST) described in Leviticus 2 is an offering of flour to Yahweh. An individual was permitted to bring pure flour (2:1–3), onto which would be poured olive oil. Lastly, incense would be placed on top of the flour before the officiating priest scooped out one handful of the flour-oil mixture (and all the incense). This handful was designated as the memorial portion (2:2) and was the only part of the offering that was burned on the altar. The rest of the flour-oil mixture belonged to the priest as a holy thing of holy things from the gifts of Yahweh (2:3), that is, a food gift that was designated to belong to the priests for food. Individuals were also permitted to offer baked or fried goods, as long as these were made without leaven or honey (2:11) and contained salt, which symbolized the ongoing nature of God's covenant with Israel. (See 2:13) Additionally, grain offerings could be an offering of first ripe grains (2:14) in which an individual offered the first of their crop's harvest. Similarly, individuals could bring flour, grain, or baked goods as an offering of first things (2:12), or, in other words, an offering of the first and best that their crops had to offer that season. See the additional instructions for the priest who offers the grain offering in 6:14–18 as well as the special whole grain offering that was to be presented when a priest was inducted into the priesthood (6:20–23).
3. The peace offering (ULT; UST: fellowship sacrifice) is a flesh sacrifice described in detail in 3:1–17. Unlike the burnt offering, only certain internal organs and choice portions of fat were to be burned on the altar for a peace offering. (See e.g., 3:3–5, 3:9–11, and 3:14–16) By implication, the rest of the meat of the animal was to be eaten by both priest and worshiper as a kind of fellowship meal, enacting and celebrating peace between both God and humanity and between humans themselves. This is the only kind of offering in which common worshipers partook of the meat of the animal. The meat of this type of sacrifice was allowed to be eaten on the day it was offered and the following day. However, any remaining meat was considered to be defiled on the third day after it was offered to Yahweh. (See 7:15–18)

There are various sub-categories of the peace offering. Such a sacrifice could be the result of a vow, a thanksgiving offering, or a freewill offering. In the first case, an individual would promise to sacrifice an animal or food gift to Yahweh if he answered a specific prayer or delivered the individual from, for example, a challenging circumstance. (See 7:16–18 and 22:21–25) In the second case, an individual would offer a sacrifice as a way of thanking Yahweh for his actions toward or for that individual. (See 7:11–15 and 22:29–30) In the third case, an individual could offer a sacrifice freely and unprompted for whatever reason. (7:16–18 and 22:21–25) Finally, a peace offering called an "ordination offering" was presented whenever a new priest was inducted into the priesthood. (See 7:37 and 8:22–32) From all peace offerings, the right thigh and the breast of the animal's meat belonged to the priest as a special contribution, which was waved in Yahweh's presence as a wave offering. (See 7:28–34) See the additional instructions for the priest who offers the peace offering in 7:11–21.

1. The sin offering (ULT; UST: purifying sacrifice) is described in detail in 4:1–5:13. This type of flesh sacrifice covered wrongdoings (sins) that were committed accidentally or unintentionally. Provision is made to address the unintentional sins of the priest (4:2–12), the entire congregation (4:13–21), a prominent leader (4:22–26), or an individual (4:27–35). Additional instructions were given to cover various scenarios in which an individual incurs guilt from wrongdoing (5:1–6), regardless of the individual's ability to purchase expensive cattle or

Leviticus - Chapter 1 Introduction

flock animals. (See the provisions offered in 5:7–13) The primary purpose of this sacrifice was to cleanse a party from the impurity caused by unintentional wrongdoing and so restore the relationship between the community, leader, priest, or individual and their God. See the additional instructions for the priest who offers the sin offering in 6:25–30.

2. The guilt offering (ULT; UST: restoring sacrifice) is a flesh sacrifice described in 5:14 through 6:7 and 7:1–7. The primary purpose of this type of sacrifice was to procure animal blood that would remove the impurity caused by wrongdoing that brings guilt. (See the scenarios in which this happens in 6:1–4) If the wrongdoing involved mistreating one of the holy objects used in the worship and service of Yahweh, then the guilt offering involved making financial restitution for the value of the item that was misused, plus one-fifth. (See 5:16) These actions allowed for the forgiveness of the guilt incurred by the wrongdoing.

Leviticus - Chapter 1 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

In Hebrew, this chapter begins with the word "And," indicating a connection with the previous book (Exodus). This connection not only implies that the first five books of the Bible should be seen as a single unit, but it also situates Leviticus in the narrative setting of the book of Exodus, during the thirteenth month of the Israelite's wandering in the wilderness of Sinai.

The first chapter of Leviticus is comprised of two hypothetical scenarios representing three variations of the burnt offering (1–17):

1. a livestock animal (2–13)
2. a bovine (3–9)
3. a sheep or goat (10–13)
4. a bird (14–17)

As such, the initial heading verse of each section begins with "If" and is followed by the prescribed steps of the sacrifice. Presumably, they are the same for each burnt offering, but more prescriptions are explicit for the first type of burnt offering, the bovine, probably because they are implied for the other two possible burnt offerings. The steps of the sacrificial process for burnt offerings are:

1. Selecting a perfect, unblemished, and otherwise completely healthy animal (1:3–14)
2. Presenting the animal at the entrance to the tent of meeting (1:3)
3. Laying hands on the head of the animal (1:4)
4. Killing the animal (1:5–15)
5. Presenting and sprinkling the animal's blood on the altar (1:5–15)
6. Skinning the animal (1:6)
7. Butchering the animal into its appropriate pieces, usually the head, fat, intestines, and legs (1:6–17)
8. Putting fire on the altar and arranging the wood (1:7)
9. Arranging the pieces, specifically the head and the fat, of the sacrifice over the burning wood of the altar (1:8–12)
10. Washing the legs and the intestines (1:9–13)
11. Burning the entire animal in a way that causes smoke to go up (1:9–17)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Several concepts are crucial for understanding the laws in this chapter. They include: (1) technical sacrificial terminology, (2) atonement, (3) the importance of blood, and (4) the nature of ritual action.

Sacrificial terminology

Throughout the book of Leviticus, the author employs several terms that have a specialized technical meaning in the context of sacrifices or that are only used in this context. In this chapter, such terms are (1) the "burnt offering" and (2) the "gift."

1. The burnt offering

The burnt offering was a particular sacrifice that could be offered by anyone for a variety of reasons. Its name is related to a verb that means "to go up" or "to ascend," suggesting that the sacrifice was to be converted into smoke by the fire and ascend to Yahweh in heaven, as the discussion on the verb phrase "to cause to become smoke" will suggest. Its function was to provide a sacrifice intended to bring about forgiveness for a wide variety of sins and unintentional mistakes that were not specifically covered by the other sacrifices discussed in the first seven chapters of Leviticus. The sacrifice required a perfect male animal that would be completely burned on the altar over a fire that was to be kept burning continually. (See 6:9–13 for more details.) The sacrifice, when accepted by Yahweh, would provide atonement for the individual who offered it. See the book introduction for more information.

1. The gift or offering made by fire

Leviticus - Chapter 1 Introduction

The word translated as "gift" in 1:9, 1:13, 1:17 and throughout the book of Leviticus is variously translated in modern English versions, usually with reference to an offering made by fire, based on the word's presumed relationship with the word for fire. However, some of the sacrifices referred to by this word are not burned on the altar (like the portions of the sacrifices that belonged to the priests in 7:30 and 7:35–36), and many sacrifices, such as the purification offering, that are burned on the altar are not referred to by this term. Instead, this term simply refers to a gift offered to Yahweh that consists of food items. While you may see the phrase "fire offering" or "offering made by fire" in modern English translations, we suggest that you retain translation of the word as "gift."

Atonement

The word translated as "atone" in the ULT is a technical term expressing the act of atonement that was carried out by the priest but always accomplished by Yahweh. Traditionally, it has been understood as a metaphor with the basic meaning of "to cover," but more recently, some scholars have understood it to express the image of "to wipe." If the former is correct, then the metaphor pictures the blood of the sacrifice as covering up the defiling impurity caused by sin. If the latter is correct, then the metaphor pictures the blood of the animal as a sort of ritual detergent that cleanses the person or object from the defiling presence of sin's impurity. Either way, the sacrifice offered by the priest on behalf of the individual or community is accepted in order to restore the relationship between the individual or community and Yahweh, a relationship that has been damaged or defiled because of sin. This is why so many of the laws concerning sacrifice end with the mention of the forgiveness of sins, which was the means by which the relationship with Yahweh could be restored.

The importance of blood

In Leviticus 1, the blood of the animal is collected and applied, via sprinkling or splattering, to the sides of the altar upon which the burnt offering is placed. (See 1:5–15) This act, as explained above, has been variously understood, but it pictures the blood as cleansing the altar from the effects of sin. Blood was able to cleanse sacred space and God's people from the impurities of sin because of its ability to accomplish atonement by means of the life of the animal. (See 17:10–12) Because the blood contained the life of the animal, Yahweh forbade the eating of any animal blood. (See 7:26–27, 17:10–14, and 19:26)

Ritual actions

Three actions in this chapter and throughout Leviticus are ritual in nature and picture important theological realities.

1. The language of "presenting" throughout this chapter means not only bringing the sacrifice to the altar or the priest but also displaying the sacrifice "to the face of Yahweh," that is, to Yahweh himself. This expression pictures the reality that these sacrifices were performed in the presence of Yahweh, literally in the vicinity of the sacred area where Yahweh lived among the Israelites while they were in the wilderness.
2. This chapter features the ritual act of laying one's hands on the head of the sacrificial animal. This action is linked to the acceptance of the animal as an appropriate sacrifice on the individual's behalf. (See 1:4) As a symbolic act, the laying on of hands identifies the individual with the animal he is offering. The implication seems to be that the person is ritually placing his sins on the sacrificial animal so that God will forgive the sins when the animal is sacrificed.
3. The language of "causing the sacrifice to become smoke on the altar" (see 1:9) pictures the sacrifice as being converted to smoke by the fire of the altar and arising to Yahweh in heaven, where he would smell the pleasant aroma of the burning sacrifice. As such, the pleasant smell was either a sign that Yahweh approved the sacrifice and would atone for the individual's sins and forgive him, or it functioned as a necessary requirement for the acceptance of the individual's offering.

Important Figures of Speech in This Chapter

This chapter includes three primary figures of speech that may prove difficult to translate but are important to understanding the chapter. These include (1) the phrase, "to the face of Yahweh," (2) the phrase, "a pleasing smell to Yahweh," and (3) the way of referring to the priests as "the sons of Aaron."

"To the face of Yahweh"

Throughout this chapter and the book as a whole, the author of Leviticus uses the expression "to the face of Yahweh" to mean "where Yahweh sees" or "in the sight of Yahweh" or "in the presence of Yahweh," so that "to the face of" is similar to the English preposition "before." In this position, the person or object receives Yahweh's attention, perspective, and judgment. In the context of Leviticus, being "to the face of Yahweh" means to be within the sacred area of the tent of meeting, either in the sense of the

Leviticus - Chapter 1 Introduction

location directly in front of the tent in which Yahweh resided, or in the sense of being in the presence of Yahweh within the tent of meeting. (See 1:3–12) You can translate either sense of this expression as "in the presence of Yahweh" or simply as "before Yahweh."

"Pleasing smell to Yahweh"
As mentioned previously, throughout this chapter, the priest is instructed to "cause the sacrifice to become smoke on the altar." This refers to burning the sacrifice in a way that causes smoke to go up, picturing the sacrifice as being converted to pleasant-smelling smoke by the fire and arising to Yahweh in heaven, where he would smell the smoke and be pleased. That the sacrifice was accompanied by the gift of the pleasant-smelling smoke of the sacrifice was apparently crucial to the acceptance of the offering as an appropriate sacrifice on the individual's behalf, as it is mentioned several times in this chapter. (See 1:9–17)

"The sons of Aaron"
Throughout Leviticus, but especially in this chapter, the priests are referred to by the expression "the sons of Aaron." Occasionally, the expression is "the sons of Aaron, the priests" (as in 1:5–11). Once in this chapter, the expression is altered to emphasize that it is Aaron who is the original priest, through the phrase "the sons of Aaron the priest." (See 1:7) As the Introduction to Leviticus discusses, at the time when Yahweh spoke to Moses from the tent of meeting, the priests literally were the sons of Aaron, as it was Aaron who was the first high priest. But the instructions in the book also applied to future generations, when the term "sons" would be a way of referring to the priests as Aaron's descendants (with the exception of Leviticus chapters 8–10). Here and throughout the book, if it would be clearer in your language, in your translation you could generally use the term "descendants," which would apply to both the original priests and to their successors.

Other Possible Translation Difficulties in This Chapter

In addition to these important figures of speech, this chapter features several translation difficulties, including:

1. the unclear referent of pronouns
2. the switching between second and third-person address
3. the use of a verb and a related noun (cognate-accusatives)
4. the use of a future form to indicate a request or command
5. the use of specific, technical sacrificial language.

The unclear referent of pronouns
Throughout this chapter, the author of Leviticus uses a third-person pronoun to refer to both the individual who offers the sacrifice and to the priest who performs the sacrifice. As such, it is often difficult (but not impossible) to infer which party performs which actions. In general, the sacrifice is presented to the priest, but the individual who presents the sacrifice is responsible for killing, properly butchering, and presenting the portions of the sacrificial animal to the priest, who will then arrange them on the altar's fire. The only exception to this pattern can be found in the instruction for offering a bird (1:14–17), which specifies that it is the priest who brings the bird to the altar (1:14) before, presumably, completing the preparation for its being burned on the altar as a burnt offering. The UST will indicate which party is the apparent referent of the pronoun.

Second and third-person address
Chapters 1 through 7 in their entirety are written as direct addresses to the people of God through Moses. As mentioned previously, Chapter 1 describes two hypothetical scenarios when an individual might offer three variations of the burnt offering. However, the form of the verb used to refer to the individual in this chapter varies in the second verse (1:2). Initially, Yahweh addresses "a man from you" in the third-person, but then switches to a second-person address ("you shall offer") to indicate the imperatival force of the statement. The ensuing string of third-person verbs (1:3–17) carry the same imperatival weight as the initial second-person verb. Thus, because in this chapter the pronouns "his" and "he" refer to the person bringing an offering to Yahweh, they can be translated in the second person as is done in 1:2 and as modeled by the UST. The pronoun used to refer to the individual who offers the sacrifice switches as follows:

- Third-person: "When a man from you, when he presents" (1:2)
- Second-person: "you shall present" (1:2)
- Third-person: "If his offering" (1:3–17)

As previously discussed, if the switch from third-person forms to second-person and back would not be natural in your language, consider using either the second or third-person forms throughout. The UST models use of second-person forms for the entirety of this chapter, but the notes will often offer translation possibilities with third-person alternatives.

The use of a verb with a related noun (Cognate-accusatives)
For emphasis, the author of Leviticus often uses a verb with a related noun. In this chapter, the verb "to present" is related to the noun translated as "offering." If your language can repeat words for emphasis, it would be appropriate in this context to repeat these words in a similar manner.

The use of specific, technical sacrificial terminology
See above the sections on "Sacrificial terminology" and "Ritual actions." (See: atonement, atone, atoned; and priest, priesthood)

Leviticus 1:1 (#1)

מֵאֹהֶל מוֹעֵד

"from the tent of meeting"

The author of Leviticus is using the possessive to describe Yahweh's **meeting** with Moses (and, by extension, the whole people) within the physical location of the **tent**. If this is not clear in your language, you could use an adjective that better describes the locale of divine presence. Alternate translation: [from the tent where Yahweh met with Moses and lived among the Israelites]

See: Possession

Leviticus 1:1 (#2)

לֵאמֹר

"saying"

The word translated as **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, consider ways in which you might introduce this quotation naturally in your language. Alternate translation: [and he said]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Leviticus 1:1–2 (#1)

לֵאמֹר: דַּבֵּר אֶל־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וְאָמַרְתָּ אֲלֵהֶם

"saying, "Speak to the sons of Israel, and you shall say to them"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation, with a period before: [He told Moses to speak to the sons of Israel and to say to them]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Leviticus 1:2 (#1)

דַּבֵּר אֶל־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וְאָמַרְתָּ אֲלֵהֶם

"Speak to the sons of Israel, and you shall say to them"

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The repetition emphasizes that Moses is to deliver the following speech to the people of Israel. (The speech makes up the first seven chapters of the book.) If your language does not use repetition for emphasis, you could use a single phrase and convey the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [Make sure you say to the people of Israel]

See: Doublet

Leviticus 1:2 (#5)

אָדָם כִּי־יַקְרִיב מִכֶּם

"A man from you, when he presents"

Although the word translated as **A man** is masculine, it has a generic sense that refers to any person who approaches the tent to make a sacrifice. Alternate translation: [When one of you presents] or [When someone presents]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Leviticus 1:2 (#8)

יַקְרִיב & קָרְבָּנוֹ

"he presents an offering"

The word **presents** translates a verb that is related to the noun translated as **offering**. The repetition of related words adds emphasis to the statement. If your language can repeat words for emphasis, it would be appropriate to use that construction here in your translation.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 1:2 (#2)

בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

"the sons of Israel"

This expression speaks of the people of Israel in the time of Moses as if they were literally the **sons** of Israel. It means that they are the physical and spiritual descendants of Jacob, whose name God changed to Israel. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the descendants of Israel]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 1:2 (#6)

אָדָ֗ם & מִכֶּ֣ם & תַּקְרִ֣יבוּ אֶת־קָרְבַּנְכֶ֔ם

“A man from you & you shall present your offering”

As the Introduction to Leviticus discusses, the book often speaks of the Israelites and to the Israelites in the third person, even though it is a direct address to them. Here and throughout the book, if it would be helpful in your language, you could either (1) use the second person in your translation. Alternate translation: [One of you Israelites ... you shall present your offering] or (2) use the third person in your translation. Alternate translation: [An Israelite ... he shall present his offering]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Leviticus 1:2 (#7)

מִכֶּ֣ם & תַּקְרִ֣יבוּ אֶת־קָרְבַּנְכֶ֔ם

“from you & you shall present your offering”

The words **you** and **your** here are plural. These words apply to the entire Israelite community. Use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 1:2 (#9)

תַּקְרִ֣יבוּ

“you shall present”

Alternate translation: [you must present]

Leviticus 1:2 (#3)

בְּנֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל

“the sons of Israel”

Although the word translated as **sons** is masculine and plural, it has a generic sense that applies to both men and women. In your translation, you may wish to use a term that is clearly inclusive of men and women. Alternate translation: [the people of Israel]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Leviticus 1:2 (#4)

וְאָמַרְתָּ֖

“and you shall say”

As the Introduction to Leviticus discusses, here and throughout the book, the author of Leviticus uses a future form to give a law or command. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate these verbs using a command or instruction form. Alternate translation: [and you must say]

See: Statements — Other Uses

Leviticus 1:3 (#1)

קָרְבָּנ֔וֹ & יַקְרִיבֶ֣נּוּ & יַקְרִ֔יב

“his offering & he shall present it & he shall present”

Here, a verb and its object come from the same root. The ULT translates with the noun **offering** and the verb **present**. Your language may have comparable terms that you can use in your own translation.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 1:3 (#4)

לִרְצֹנ֖וֹ

“for its acceptance”

The word translated as **its** could refer to (1) the offering. Alternate translation: [for the acceptance of the animal] or (2) the worshiper. Alternate translation: [for the acceptance of the one offering the animal]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 1:3 (#5)

לִפְנֵ֥י יְהוָֽה

“to the face of Yahweh”

As the Introduction to Leviticus discusses, in contexts such as this, the expression **to the face of Yahweh** refers to a location “where Yahweh sees” and, by extension, “from Yahweh’s perspective” or “in Yahweh’s judgment.” Alternate translation: [from Yahweh’s perspective] or [in Yahweh’s judgment] or [before Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 1:3 (#2)

זָכָ֣ר תָּמִ֔ים יַקְרִיבֶ֣נּוּ

“he shall present it, a perfect male”

For a discussion of the word **perfect**, see the section titled “‘Unblemished’ or ‘perfect’” in Part 3 of the Introduction to Leviticus. Alternate translation: [he should offer a male that is unblemished] or [he should offer a male that is without defect]

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 1:3 (#3)

זָכָר תָּמִים יַקְרִיבֶנּוּ אֶל־פֶּתַח אֹהֶל מוֹעֵד יַקְרִיב אֹתוֹ לִרְצֹנוֹ לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“he shall present it, a perfect male. At the entrance of the tent of meeting, he shall present it for its acceptance to the face of Yahweh”

The word translated as **for** indicates the goal or purpose for offering a sacrifice in the manner prescribed here. If it would be more natural in your language, you could put the last of these phrases first, since the last phrase gives the reason for the actions that the first two phrases describe. Alternate translation: [in order for Yahweh to consider the offering acceptable, he shall present a perfect male at the entrance of the tent of meeting]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Leviticus 1:4 (#3)

לְכַפֵּר עָלָיו

“in order to make atonement for him”

The words **in order to** introduce the purpose of the animal’s acceptance as an appropriate sacrifice. Use an expression in your language that makes it clear that what follows is the purpose.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Leviticus 1:4 (#1)

וְסָמַךְ יָדוֹ עַל רֹאשׁ הָעֹלָה

“And he shall lay his hand on the head of the burnt offering”

This is a symbolic action that identifies the person with the animal he is offering. The implication seems to be that the person is ritually placing his sins on the sacrificial animal so that God will forgive the sins when the animal is sacrificed. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in a footnote or in the text of your translation. Alternate translation: [And he shall lay his hand on the head of the burnt offering. He should do this to ritually place his sins on the animal]

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 1:4 (#2)

וְנִרְצָה

“And it shall be accepted”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh will accept it]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 1:4 (#4)

לְכַפֵּר עָלָיו

“in order to make atonement for him”

For the metaphors potentially lying behind the idea of **atonement**, refer to the Introduction to Leviticus. If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **atonement**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [to restore him to a relationship with Yahweh]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 1:5 (#1)

אֶת־בֶּן הַבָּקָר

“the son of the cattle”

The expression **son of** describes a person or animal that shares the essential qualities of something. Here the phrase describes this animal as **the son of the cattle** because it is a male animal that shares the distinguishing qualities characteristic of the class of bovines. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an equivalent idiom from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the bull] or [the bovine]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 1:5 (#4)

וְהִקְרִיבוּ בְּנֵי אַהֲרֹן הַכֹּהֲנִים אֶת־הַדָּם

“And the sons of Aaron, the priests, shall present the blood”

It is implied that **the priests** would catch **the blood** in a bowl as it drained out of the animal. Then they would bring the bowl with the blood in it and present it to Yahweh at the altar. If this would not be clear in your language, you could supply this information here and in later instances in the book. Alternate translation: [And after catching the blood in a bowl as it drains from the animal, the sons of Aaron, the priests, will present the blood to Yahweh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 1:5 (#3)

בְּנֵי אַהֲרֹן

“the sons of Aaron”

As the Introduction to Leviticus discusses, at the time when Yahweh spoke to Moses from the tent of meeting, the priests literally were **the sons of Aaron**. But the instructions in the book also applied to future generations, when the term "sons" would be a way of referring to the priests as Aaron's descendants (with the exception of Leviticus chapters 8–10). Here and throughout the book, if it would be clearer in your language, in your translation you could generally use that term, which would apply to both the original priests and to their successors.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 1:5 (#2)

לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

"to the face of Yahweh"

As the Introduction to Leviticus discusses, in contexts such as this, the expression **to the face of Yahweh** means "where Yahweh can see" and, by extension, "in Yahweh's presence." If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in Yahweh's presence] or [within the sacred precincts of the tent of meeting, where Yahweh lives among the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 1:6 (#2)

וְנִתַּח אֹתָהּ לִנְתָחֶיהָ

"and he shall cut it into its pieces"

The author of Leviticus assumes his audience will know what portions of the animal constituted **its pieces**. These would have included but perhaps not been limited to the head, suet, innards and legs, as 1:8–9 suggest. If the phrase **its pieces** would not be clear in your context, consider listing what pieces these are. Alternate translation: [and he shall separate it into its appropriate portions]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 1:6 (#1)

וְהִפְשִׁשֵׁיט

"And he shall skin"

Alternate translation: [And the one offering the sacrifice shall skin]

Leviticus 1:6 (#3)

וְנִתַּח אֹתָהּ לִנְתָחֶיהָ

"and he shall cut it into its pieces"

This expression is an emphatic construction that uses a verb and its object, both of which come from the same root. The word **cut** translates a verb that comes from the same root as the noun **pieces**. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 1:7 (#1)

אֵשׁ & הָאֵשׁ

"fire & the fire"

Here, the word **fire** represents the coals that produce fire. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [burning coals ... those burning coals] or [live coals ... those live coals]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 1:8 (#1)

וְאֶת־הַפָּדֶר

"and the suet"

The term **suet** refers to the hard, lumpy fat that surrounds the kidneys and liver of sheep, goats, and bovines. If your language has a word for this portion of fatty tissue, consider using it here.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 1:9 (#1)

וְקִרְבּוֹ וּכְרָעָיו יִרְחַץ בַּמָּיִם

"And he shall wash its innards and its legs with water"

It might seem that the expression **and he shall wash its innards and its legs with water** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in your language. If so, you could use an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [And he shall wash its innards and its legs]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Leviticus 1:9 (#3)

וְהִקְטִיר הַכֹּהֵן אֶת־הַכֹּל הַמִּזְבֵּחָה

“And the priest shall cause everything to become smoke on the altar”

The implication is that the act of burning the offering in this way causes smoke to rise, depicting the sacrifice as going to God in heaven, where he would smell the smoke and be pleased. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [And the priest shall cause all of the sacrifice to turn into smoke by burning it on the fire of the altar. The smoke will ascend toward God in heaven]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 1:9 (#2)

יִרְחַץ

“he shall wash”

The pronoun **he** could refer either to the worshiper or to the priest. But given that every other reference to the priest has been explicit, it is likely that it refers to the worshiper. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this explicit or continue using the same second-person pronoun used thus far. Alternate translation: [the one offering the sacrifice shall wash]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 1:10 (#1)

מִן־הַצֹּאן & מִן־הַכְּשָׂבִים אוֹ מִן־הָעִזִּים

“from the flock—from the lambs or from the goats”

The expressions, **the flock**, **the lambs**, and **the goats** do not refer to specific groups of animals. They describe any groups of animals that an Israelite might own. Express this in the way that would be most natural in your language. Alternate translation: [from any of his flock, whether from his sheep or from his goats]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 1:11 (#1)

לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated the expression **to the face of Yahweh** in 1:5. Alternate translation: [in the presence of Yahweh] or [within the sacred precincts of the tent of meeting, where Yahweh lives among the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 1:12 (#2)

וְנִתַּח אֹתוֹ לִנְתָחָיו

“And he shall cut it into its pieces”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:6.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 1:12 (#1)

וְנִתַּח אֹתוֹ

“And he shall cut it”

Alternate translation: [And the one offering the sacrifice shall cut it]

Leviticus 1:13 (#1)

יִרְחַץ בַּמָּיִם

“he shall wash with water”

See how you translated the expression **wash with water** in 1:9. Alternate translation: [he shall wash thoroughly]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Leviticus 1:13 (#2)

וְהַקֶּרֶב וְהַכְּרָעַיִם יִרְחַץ בַּמָּיִם

“And the innards and the legs he shall wash with water”

The implication seems to be that the worshiper must **wash** the **innards** and **legs** before the priest arranges them on the altar, as 1:12 describes. You can indicate this in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Before the priest arranges the pieces, the one offering the sacrifice shall wash the innards and legs with water]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 1:13 (#3)

וְהִקְטִיר הַמִּזְבֵּחָה

“and he shall cause {them} to become smoke on the altar”

Alternate translation: [and that same priest shall cause them to become smoke on the altar]

Leviticus 1:14 (#1)

מִן־הָעוֹף & מִן־הַתֹּרִים אוֹ מִן־בְּנֵי הַיּוֹנָה

“from the birds & from the doves or from the sons of the pigeon”

The expressions **from the birds**, **from the doves**, and **from the sons of the pigeon** do not refer to specific

birds, that is, to a specific group of turtledoves or pigeons. Rather, these expressions describe any birds (that is, any doves or pigeons) that an Israelite might own or be able to purchase for sacrifice. Express this in the way that would be most natural in your language. Alternate translation: [from any of his birds ... from his doves or from his pigeons]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 1:14 (#2)

מִן־בְּנֵי֙ הַיּוֹנָ֔ה

“from the sons of the pigeon”

The expression **sons of** describes a person or animal that shares the essential qualities of something. The author of Leviticus uses this phrase to describe a group of birds as **the sons of the pigeon** since they were birds that shared the essential qualities of that class of birds. If it would be helpful, you could use an equivalent idiom from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from the pigeons]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 1:15 (#3)

וְנִמְצָ֖ה דָּמ֑וֹ

“And its blood shall be drained”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And the priest shall drain its blood]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 1:15 (#2)

וְהִקְטִ֣יר הַמִּזְבֵּ֔חָה

“and he shall cause {it} to become smoke on the altar”

The object that is to be burned on the altar is not specified. However, because the blood has not yet been removed from the bird and the burning of blood is expressly forbidden in Leviticus, it seems likely that the supplied pronoun **it** here refers to **the head** of the bird. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [and he shall cause the head that he removed to become smoke on the altar]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 1:15 (#5)

וְנִמְצָ֖ה דָּמ֑וֹ עַ֖ל קִ֥יר הַמִּזְבֵּֽחַ

“And its blood shall be drained on the side of the altar”

Draining **its blood on the side of the altar** as a symbolic action to show that the life of the sacrificed animal is being given to Yahweh. If this would not be clear to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [The priest must cause the life-blood of the sacrifice to drip down the walls of the altar]

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 1:15 (#1)

וְהִקְטִ֣יר הַמִּזְבֵּ֔חָה

“and he shall cause {it} to become smoke on the altar”

See note at 1:9. Alternate translation: [and he shall cause it to become smoke on the altar and ascend toward God in heaven]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 1:15 (#4)

וְנִמְצָ֖ה דָּמ֑וֹ

“And its blood shall be drained”

Here, the pronoun **its** no longer refers to the head of the bird but rather, to the body of the sacrificed bird, which would contain blood which must be drained before burning. Alternate translation: [And the blood of the bird shall be drained]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 1:16 (#1)

אֶת־מְרָאָתָ֖ו

“its craw”

A **craw** is the pouch in a bird’s throat where predigested food is stored. If your language has its own term for this anatomical feature, consider using that word here. If not, you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [the bird’s throat pouch]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 1:16 (#2)

וְהִשְׁלִ֥יךְ אֹתָ֛הּ

“and he shall cast it”

Leviticus - Chapter 2 Introduction

The word **it** refers to the **craw**, but since the priest is supposed to **throw it beside the altar** along with the **feathers**, it may be more natural in your language to use the plural pronoun "them," as modeled by the UST.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus - Chapter 2 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter gives instructions about how to make a grain offering. The "And" of 2:1 indicates that the laws of Leviticus 1 are continuing. Yahweh continues telling Moses how the people should offer sacrifices. In outline form, the structure of the chapter can be displayed as follows:

1. The grain offering (2:1–16)
2. Offerings of raw flour (2:1–3)
3. Offerings that are baked, pan-fried, or deep-fried (2:4–10)
4. Laws regarding leaven, honey, and salt (2:11–13)
5. Offerings of grains (2:14–16)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

This chapter introduces several key concepts that are relevant to proper translation, including the sacrifice of the grain offering, which includes the offering of flour, oil, and incense, the concept of the memorial portion, and the identification of yeast and leaven.

Grain offering

The grain offering was a specialized sacrifice consisting of an offering of harvested grain, usually wheat or barley. The grain offering sometimes accompanied the burnt offering. (See 14:20) It is unclear whether the grain offering provided atonement by itself or whether it could only accomplish atonement when presented with the burnt offering or as a substitute for the purification offering for those who could not afford the animals required for that sacrifice. (See 5:11–13) In any case, the grain offering could be offered dry (that is, not mixed with olive oil, 7:10) or mixed with olive oil, or it could be baked in an oven or prepared in a griddle or pan. If the offering of grain were something baked in an oven, the prescribed offering would consist of a loaf of unleavened bread that had been made by kneading the flour with olive oil, or a wafer that had been copiously covered in olive oil. (See 2:4) Alternatively, grain offerings could be prepared by pan-frying the flour and olive oil on a griddle (2:5) or deep-frying the flour and olive oil in a pan (2:7). Furthermore, crushed portions of fresh grain that had been roasted with fire constituted an acceptable grain offering. (See 2:14–16) A portion of the offering was crumbled and completely burned on the altar, resulting in pleasant-smelling smoke that rose to Yahweh in heaven. The remainder of the grain offering, however, belonged to the priests and the male descendants of Aaron for food. (See 2:3, 2:10, and 7:14–18) See the Book Introduction for more information.

Flour

The term translated as "flour" in the ULT and "wheat flour" in the UST is the agricultural product made from the production of wheat grains. (See Exodus 29:2, and 2 Kings 7:16, where is it contrasted with barley.) However, according to some rabbinic sources, the precise commodity referred to in this chapter and elsewhere in Leviticus is the large chunks of crushed grains that remain in the sieve after the grains had been dried, winnowed, and crushed. Since flour would connote the fine powder that falls through the sieve, what remains is more accurately called "grits" or "semolina." (See 1 Kings 5:2, where grits or semolina is contrasted with flour.) However, since this culinary term is not present in many cultures, the term "flour" has been retained. We suggest that you use in your translation whatever word your language has to describe the large chunks of crushed grains that remain in the sieve after the grains have been dried, winnowed, and crushed.

Oil

The term translated as "oil" in the ULT and "olive oil" in the UST refers to the agricultural product made from crushing large quantities of olives into a fine, smooth oil. This oil was used for cooking and baking. (See 2:4–7) It provided fuel for lanterns. (See Exodus 35:8 and Exodus 35:14–15) It also retained symbolic importance as a way of anointing and dedicating sacred objects, priests, and kings. (For sacred objects, see Genesis 28:18, for priests, see Exodus 29:7 and Leviticus 8:12, Leviticus 8:28–30, and Leviticus 21:10, and for kings, see 1 Samuel 10:1 and 1 Samuel 16:13) In this chapter, in addition to being present in most of the grain offerings, olive oil was presented with the grain offering in whatever form it took.

Incense

Scholarly sources suggest that the substance that was burned in ritual spaces for its fragrance was an expensive fragrant gum resin tapped from three species of the Boswellia tree, native only to southern Arabia and Somaliland. (See Jeremiah 6:20) The burning of this substance was required with all grain offerings, regardless of the manner of their preparation. Because both grain offerings and animal offerings provided a pleasing aroma to Yahweh, the addition of incense with grain offerings was to distinguish them from the

Leviticus - Chapter 2 Introduction

animal sacrifices or burnt offerings. (See Chapter 1.) Whereas the olive oil was to be poured all over the grain offerings, the incense was to be placed on top of it, apparently in a large lump. Then the raw flour (or other kind of grain offering) would be mixed with the olive oil and the lump of incense in the priest's hand as he took a large handful. (See 2:2) These ingredients would then be completely burned on the altar and converted into pleasant-smelling smoke, which, when it went up to Yahweh, would please Yahweh and so mark the completion of an acceptable sacrifice.

The memorial portion
The memorial portion of the grain offering refers to the portion that the priest designates to be burned completely on the altar as a sacrifice to Yahweh, as opposed to the portion that will remain as food for the priests to eat. If the offering was raw flour, the priest would lift out a handful of the flour mixed with olive oil and all the incense that was placed on it. If the offering was baked, pan-fried, or deep-fried, the priest would take a portion and crumble it on the altar. These portions that were designated to be burned on the altar constituted the memorial portion. As such, by being completely burned on the altar, this portion represented the entire offering.

Yeast and leaven
In Leviticus 2, the word leaven refers to a lump of dough made from flour and other common ingredients, usually salt and oil, that contains a live leaven culture in the form of wild, natural yeast as its raising agent. The term yeast refers to the microscopic organism consisting of single oval cells that reproduce by budding and are capable of converting sugar into alcohol and carbon dioxide. In the ancient world, yeast was a common household raising agent used in the baking of bread. However, because store-bought, commercial yeast in the form of a dried, deactivated culture that is routinely added to individual batches of dough is a familiar, modern invention, the ULT has chosen the less anachronistic term "leaven culture." This term reflects the slow process of growing wild, naturally occurring yeast from a single, small batch of dough, forming a leaven that would be added to other larger batches of dough. The wild yeast in the leaven would multiply and affect the rest of the larger batch of dough until the entire batch was considered to be leavened.

In Leviticus, grain offerings, whether baked or fried, that were made using "leaven" or included "leaven culture" were expressly forbidden to be burned on the altar, along with grain offerings made with honey. Instead, as Leviticus 2:12 expresses, grain offerings that included either "leaven culture" or "honey" could be offered as first fruit offerings that were not burned on the altar. Eating or baking with "leaven" was forbidden during the events of the first Passover in Egypt before the Exodus and, specifically, during the annual festival of Unleavened Bread. (See: Passover.) Yahweh informs Moses that the practice of excluding leaven and leaven culture from one's diet should serve as a sign and memorial to the people of Israel that reminds them of God's mighty acts of salvation in the Exodus and encourages them to obey his commandments. (See Exodus 13:5–10) It should be noted that it was not always unlawful to eat food products made with leaven or leaven culture, but that the proscription only applied during special feasts and holidays associated with the Exodus.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

The number and person of pronouns
In the address to the Israelites, the author of Leviticus is known for abruptly switching the person, number, and occasionally the gender of pronouns and verbal forms that refer to the person offering sacrifices. In Leviticus 1, it was suggested that any third-person singular pronouns that refer to the worshiper (and not to the priest) could be changed to second-person plural pronouns, based on the nature of the direct address and the presence of a second-person plural pronoun in 1:2 and several times in the current chapter.

The pronouns referring to the worshiper switch person, gender, and number frequently. Verses 1–3 address the worshiper with a third-person singular pronoun. This switches to the second-person, singular pronoun in 2:4–8. The worshiper is addressed in the third person in verse 8, but verse 11 marks a shift to the second person, this time in the plural. The plural pronouns continue throughout verses 11 and 12, but the author of Leviticus switches back to the second-person singular from verse 13 to the end of the chapter.

1. Third-person (2:1–3)

- "... when a person [third-person, feminine singular] presents ..." (2:1)
- "... his [third-person, masculine singular] offering ..." (2:1)
- "... and he [third-person, masculine singular] shall pour ..." (2:1)
- "... and he [third-person, masculine singular] shall put ..." (2:1)

- "... and he [third-person, masculine singular] shall bring ..." (2:2)

1. Second-person (2:4–8)

- "And if you [second-person, masculine singular] present ..." (2:4)
- "And if your [second-person, masculine singular] offering ..." (2:5)
- "Piece [second-person, singular imperative] it ..." (2:6)
- "... and you [second-person, masculine singular] shall pour ..." (2:6)
- "And if your [second-person, masculine singular] offering ..." (2:7)
- "And you [second-person, masculine singular] shall bring ..." (2:8)

1. Third-person (2:8–10)

- "And he [third-person, masculine singular] shall present ..." (2:8)

1. Second-person (2:11–15)

- "Any grain offering that you [second-person, masculine plural] present ..." (2:11)
- "... you [second-person, masculine plural] shall not cause to become smoke ..." (2:11)
- "You [second-person, masculine plural] shall present ..." (2:12)
- "... your [second-person, masculine singular] grain offerings ..." (2:13)
- "... you [second-person, masculine singular] shall salt ..." (2:13)
- "... you [second-person, masculine singular] shall not omit ..." (2:13)
- "... the covenant of your [second-person, masculine singular] God ..." (2:13)
- "... your [second-person, masculine singular] offerings ..." (2:13)
- "... you [second-person, masculine singular] shall present ..." (2:13)
- "And if you [second-person, masculine singular] present ..." (2:14)
- "... you [second-person, masculine singular] shall present ..." (2:14)
- "... your [second-person, masculine singular] first ripe grains ..." (2:14)
- "And you [second-person, masculine singular] shall put ..." (2:15)
- "... and you [second-person, masculine singular] shall place ..." (2:15)

Leviticus 2:1 (#3)

סֹלֶת֙ יִהְיֶ֣ה קָרְבָּנ֔וֹ וְיָצַ֥ק עָלֶ֖יהָ שֶׁ֑מֶן וְנָתַ֥ן עָלֶ֖יהָ לְבֹנָֽה

"his offering shall be flour. And he shall pour oil on it and he shall put frankincense on it"

As the Introduction to Leviticus discusses, Leviticus often uses future statements to give instructions or commands. If it would be helpful in your language, here and throughout the book you could translate these future statements using command or instruction forms. Alternate translation: [his offering should be flour. And he should pour oil on it, and he should put incense on it]

See: Statements — Other Uses

Leviticus 2:1 (#2)

וְנֶ֨פֶשׁ֙ כִּֽי־תַקְרִ֣יב קָרְבַּ֔ן מִנְחָה֙ לַֽיהוָ֔ה & קָרְבָּנ֑וֹ

"And a person, when he presents an offering of a grain offering to Yahweh, his offering"

As the Introduction to Leviticus discusses, the book often speaks of the Israelites in the third person, even though it is a direct address. Here and throughout the book, if it would be helpful in your language, you could use the second person in your translation.

See: First, Second or Third Person

Leviticus 2:1 (#1)

וְנֶ֨פֶשׁ֙ כִּֽי־תַקְרִ֣יב קָרְבַּ֔ן מִנְחָה֙ לַֽיהוָ֔ה & קָרְבָּנ֑וֹ

"And a person, when he presents an offering of a grain offering to Yahweh, his offering"

Here a verb and its object come from the same root. The word **presents** translates a verb that is related to the noun translated as **offering**. The repetition of related words adds emphasis to the statement. If your language can repeat words for emphasis, it would be appropriate to use that construction here in your translation.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 2:2 (#2)

בְּנֵ֥י אַהֲרֹ֖ן

"the sons of Aaron"

See how you translated the same expression in 1:5. Alternate translation: [the descendants of Aaron]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 2:2 (#1)

וְהֵבִיאָהּ

“And he shall bring it”

Alternate translation: [And he shall bring the mixture of flour, oil, and incense]

Leviticus 2:2 (#3)

וְקָמַץ מִשָּׁם מְלֹא קֻמְצוֹ

“and he shall grab from there, {with} the fullness of his handful”

Here a verb and its object come from the same root. The word **grab** translates a verb that is related to the noun translated as **handful**. The use of related words adds clarity to the statement. If your language can use related words for clarity and your language has comparable terms that you can use in your own translation, it would be appropriate to use that construction here.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 2:2 (#4)

אֶת־אַזְכָּרָתָהּ

“its memorial portion”

Alternate translation: [the memorial portion of the grain offering]

Leviticus 2:2 (#5)

וְהִקְטִיר הַכֹּהֵן אֶת־אַזְכָּרָתָהּ הַמִּזְבֵּחָה אִשֶּׁה רֵיחַ נִיחֹחַ לַיהוָה

“And the priest shall cause its memorial portion to become smoke on the altar, a gift, a scent of pleasing to Yahweh”

See how you translated a similar sentence in 1:9 and 1:15. Alternate translation: [And the priest must burn all of the special offering on the altar until it has completely turned into good-smelling smoke for Yahweh to enjoy]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 2:3 (#1)

קֹדֶשׁ קָדָשִׁים

“a holy thing of holy things”

Here, the phrase **a holy thing of holy things** uses the possessive form to describe an offering that should be considered even more holy than those offerings that are also called **holy**. This offering is set apart for the special use of the priests. If this form would not express the idea of unique holiness in your language, consider a more generic way to express this idea. Alternate translation: [a most holy offering] or [an exceptionally holy offering]

See: Possession

Leviticus 2:3 (#2)

מֵאִשֵּׁי יְהוָה

“from the gifts of Yahweh”

In this possessive form, **Yahweh** is the object rather than the subject of **gifts**. That is, this does not mean gifts that Yahweh gives; it means gifts that are given to Yahweh. Alternate translation: [from the gifts that people offer to Yahweh]

See: Possession

Leviticus 2:4 (#4)

מַאֲפֵה תַנּוּר

“a baked item of the oven”

In the world of ancient Israel, an **oven** was a hollow cylindrical construction likely made of clay or rock. A wood fire was lit under or at the bottom portion of the oven; the resulting heat would bake the dough inserted inside it. If your readers would not be familiar with what an oven is, you could use the name of a comparable object in your culture or you could use a general expression.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 2:4 (#3)

מַאֲפֵה תַנּוּר

“a baked item of the oven”

This possessive form describes **a baked item** as having been baked, or cooked by dry heat without exposure to a flame, in an **oven**. If your language would not use a possessive form in this way, you could express the same meaning in another way. Alternate translation: [an item that you baked in the oven] or, in the third person, [an item that a person baked in the oven]

See: Possession

Leviticus 2:4 (#1)

וְכִֽי תַקְרֵ֗ב קָרְבַּ֛ן מִנְחָ֖ה

“And when you present an offering of a grain offering”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:2 and 2:1.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 2:4 (#2)

תַקְרֵ֗ב

“you present”

As the Introduction to this chapter discusses, to this point the author of Leviticus has been using third-person singular pronouns. In this verse, the author of Leviticus starts using second-person singular pronouns. If you have been using the third-person pronouns and the switch to the second-person pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could continue to use the third-person pronouns in your translation.

See: First, Second or Third Person

Leviticus 2:4 (#5)

תַּנּ֣וּר סֹ֔לֶת חַלֹּ֥ת מַצּ֖וֹת בְּלוּלֹ֣ת בַּשֶּׁ֑מֶן וּרְקִיקֵ֥י מַצּ֖וֹת מְשֻׁחִ֥ים בַּשָּֽׁמֶן

“the oven, flour of loaves of unleavened bread {shall be} mixed with oil or wafers of unleavened bread {shall be} anointed with oil”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [you shall mix flour of unleavened loaves with oil or you shall anoint unleavened wafers with oil] or, in the third person, [he shall mix flour of loaves of unleavened bread with oil, or he shall anoint wafers of unleavened bread with oil]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 2:4 (#6)

סֹ֔לֶת חַלֹּ֥ת מַצּ֖וֹת בְּלוּלֹ֣ת בַּשֶּׁ֑מֶן

“flour of loaves of unleavened bread {shall be} mixed with oil”

This possessive form describes **flour** that has been kneaded and formed into **loaves** that, once baked, would consist of **unleavened bread**. If your language would not use a possessive form in this way, you could express the same meaning in another way. Alternate translation: [flour that you have mixed with oil and shaped into unleavened loaves] or, in the third person, [flour that he mixed with oil and shaped into unleavened loaves]

See: Possession

Leviticus 2:5 (#2)

הַמַּחֲבַ֑ת

“the griddle”

This **griddle** was a thick but shallow plate made of either clay or metal that was placed over a fire. The dough was placed on the shallow plate; the heat from the fire would cook or lightly fry or toast the dough on top of the plate. If your readers would not be familiar with what a griddle is, in your translation, you could use the name of a comparable object in your culture, or you could use a general expression.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 2:5 (#3)

סֹ֔לֶת בְּלוּלָ֖ה בַּשֶּׁ֣מֶן מַצָּ֑ה תִּהְיֶֽה

“flour shall be mixed with oil {into} unleavened bread”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [you shall mix flour with oil and then shape it into unleavened bread] or in the third person, [he shall mix flour with oil and then shape it into unleavened loaves]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 2:5 (#1)

וְאִם־מִנְחָ֥ה עַל־הַמַּחֲבַ֖ת קָרְבָּנֶֽךָ

“And if your offering {is} a grain offering on the griddle”

The phrase **a grain offering on the griddle** leaves out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if that would be helpful in your language. Alternate translation: [And if your offering is a grain offering that you have prepared on the griddle] or, in the third person, [And if his offering is a grain offering that he has prepared on the griddle]

See: Ellipsis

Leviticus 2:6 (#1)

פָּתֹ֥ת אֹתָ֖הּ פִּתִּ֑ים

“Piece it {into} pieces”

Here, a verb and its object come from the same root. The word **piece** translates a verb that comes from the same root as the noun **pieces**. The use of related words adds clarity and emphasis to the statement. If your language can repeat words for emphasis and your language has comparable terms that you can use in your own translation, it would be appropriate to use that construction here. Alternate translation: [Break it apart into parts]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 2:6 (#2)

פָּתֹתָ֥ות אֹתָ֖הּ פִּתִּ֑ים

“Piece it {into} pieces”

The pronoun **it** refers to the grain offering, whether baked in an oven (See 2:4) or cooked on a griddle. (See 2:5) It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Piece either kind of grain offering into pieces]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 2:7 (#1)

וְאִם־מִנְחַ֥ת מַרְחֶ֖שֶׁת קָרְבָּנֶ֑ךָ

“And if your offering is a grain offering of a pan”

Here Leviticus is using the possessive form to describe a **a grain offering** that is prepared by using **a pan**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could explain that it is prepared in **a pan**. Alternate translation: [And if your offering is a grain offering prepared in a pan] or, in the third person, [And if his offering is a grain offering prepared in a pan]

See: Possession

Leviticus 2:7 (#2)

מַרְחֶ֖שֶׁת

“a pan”

The word **pan** refers to a plate of metal or clay with rounded edges, possibly with a lid. This plate was deeper than the **griddle** described in 2:5, and, as a result, the dough was placed into the pan and cooked over a hot fire in the oil, resulting in something like deep-frying. If your readers would not be familiar with what a pan is, in your translation you could use the name of a comparable object in your culture, or you could use a general expression.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 2:7 (#3)

סֹ֣לֶת בַּשֶּׁ֣מֶן תֵּעָשֶׂ֑ה

“flour shall be made with oil”

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [you shall prepare flour with oil] or, in the third person, [you shall prepare flour with oil]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 2:8 (#1)

וְהֵבֵאתָ֣ אֶת־הַמִּנְחָ֗ה אֲשֶׁ֤ר יֵעָשֶׂה֙ מֵאֵ֣לֶּה לַיהוָ֔ה

“And you shall bring the grain offering that is made from these to Yahweh”

The expression **to Yahweh** refers to bringing the sacrifice to the altar that was located inside the tent of meeting. Because of the altar’s nearness to the Holy of Holies, where Yahweh lived among the Israelites, bringing the offering to the altar was considered as bringing it directly to Yahweh himself. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [And you shall bring the grain offering that is made from these things to the altar that is inside the tent of meeting, where Yahweh lives among the Israelites] or, in the third person, [And he shall bring the grain offering that is made from these things to the altar that is inside the tent of meeting, where Yahweh lives among the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 2:8 (#3)

מֵאֵ֣לֶּה

“from these”

The phrase **from these** could mean: (1) the ingredients described in 2:4–7. Alternate translation: [from these ingredients] or (2) the methods described in 2:4–7. Alternate translation: [in these ways]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 2:8 (#4)

וְהִקְרִיבָ֖הּ

“And he shall present it”

As the Introduction to this chapter discusses, at this point Leviticus switches from using second-person singular pronouns to using a third-person singular pronoun. If you have been using the second person in your translation and the switch to the third person

would not be natural in your language, you could continue to use the second person here. Alternatively, if you have been using third-person pronouns, you could continue to do so here.

See: First, Second or Third Person

Leviticus 2:8 (#2)

אֲשֶׁ֥ר יֵעָשֶׂ֖ה מֵאֵ֑לֶּה

“that is made from these”

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that you made from these] or, in the third person, [that he made from these]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 2:10 (#1)

קֹ֥דֶשׁ קָדָשִׁ֖ים

“a holy thing of holy things”

See how you translated this expression in 2:3. Alternate translation: [a most holy offering] or [an exceptionally holy offering]

See: Possession

Leviticus 2:10 (#2)

מֵאִשֵּׁ֥י יְהוָֽה

“from the gifts of Yahweh”

See how you translated this phrase in 2:3. Alternate translation: [from the gifts that people offer to Yahweh]

See: Possession

Leviticus 2:11 (#3)

כִּ֣י

“for”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is the reason or grounds for what came before. If it would be helpful to your readers, consider using a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation, following a period: [For this reason]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 2:11 (#4)

מִמֶּ֥נּוּ אִשֶּׁ֖ה לַיהוָֽה

“from it, a gift to Yahweh”

The pronoun **it** refers to a **grain offering** that is designated to be burned on the altar as a sacrifice to Yahweh and, thus, will be considered a **gift** to Yahweh. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [from such a grain offering that you present as a gift to Yahweh] or, in the third person, [from such a grain offering that people present as a gift to Yahweh]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 2:11 (#1)

כָּל־הַמִּנְחָ֗ה אֲשֶׁ֨ר תַּקְרִ֜יבוּ לַיהוָ֗ה לֹ֤א תֵעָשֶׂה֙ חָמֵ֔ץ

“Any grain offering that you present to Yahweh shall not be made {with} leaven”

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Do not present to Yahweh any grain offering that you have made with leaven] or, in the third person, [He shall not present to Yahweh any grain offering that he has made with leaven]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 2:11 (#2)

תַּקְרִ֜יבוּ & לֹא־תַקְטִ֣ירוּ

“you present & you shall not cause to become smoke”

As the Introduction to this chapter discusses, at this point Leviticus starts using second-person plural pronouns. Yahweh is speaking about everyone who will offer grain offerings at the altar located at the entrance to the tent of meeting. If you have been using second-person singular pronouns in your translation and the switch to the plural form would not be natural in your language, you could continue to use singular forms here. Alternatively, if you have been using third-person pronouns, you could continue to do so throughout this chapter.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 2:12 (#1)

קָרְבַּ֣ן רֵאשִׁ֔ית תַּקְרִ֥יבוּ אֹתָ֖ם לַיהוָ֑ה

“You shall present them to Yahweh {as} an offering of first {things”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:2, possibly using a verb and a noun that come from the same root in your language. Alternate translation:

[You shall present them to Yahweh as a gift of first-fruits]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 2:12 (#2)

תַּקְרִיבוּ אֹתָם

“You shall present them”

Alternate translation: [You must offer grain offerings made with leaven or honey] or, in the third person, [Anyone must offer grain offerings made with leaven or honey]

Leviticus 2:13 (#2)

תִּמְלָח

“you shall salt”

As the Introduction to this chapter discusses, Leviticus uses second-person singular forms in this verse and for the rest of the chapter. If you have been using second-person plural forms in your translation and switching to singular forms would not be natural in your language, you could continue to use plural forms in your translation. Alternatively, if you have been using third person forms throughout, you could consider using these forms in your translation.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 2:13 (#1)

בַּמֶּלַח תִּמְלָח

“you shall salt with salt”

Here a verb and its object come from the same root. The phrase **you shall salt** translates a verb that is related to the noun translated as **salt**. The repetition of related words adds emphasis to the statement. If your language can repeat words for emphasis and your language has comparable terms that you can use in your own translation, it would be appropriate to use that construction here in your translation. Alternate translation: [you certainly should season with salt]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 2:13 (#3)

מֶלַח בְּרִית אֱלֹהֶיךָ

“the salt of the covenant of your God”

Alternate translation: [the salt that preserves food and so should remind you of the binding and permanent nature of God’s covenant with you]

Leviticus 2:14 (#1)

אָבִיב קָלוּי בָּאֵשׁ

“a tender ear roasted with fire”

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [a tender ear that you have roasted over a fire]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 2:16 (#1)

וְהִקְטִיר הַכֹּהֵן אֶת־אַזְכָּרָתָהּ

“And the priest shall cause its memorial portion & to become smoke”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:9 and 2:2. Alternate translation: [And the priest shall cause the memorial portion to become smoke on the altar and ascend toward God in heaven]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus - Chapter 3 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter gives laws about how an Israelite might offer a peace offering. In a similar fashion to the burnt offerings described in Leviticus 1, here Yahweh provides laws for sacrifices of peace offerings consisting of a bovine, whether male or female (3:1–5), or a flock animal, whether a lamb (3:6–11) or a goat (3:12–16). The chapter ends with an enduring statute, applicable to any Israelite, regardless of age or location. This statute forbids consuming any fat or blood (3:17). In outline form, the structure of Chapter 3 is as follows:

1. The peace offering (3:1–17)
2. Offering a bovine (3:1–5)
3. Offering a flock animal (3:6–16)
4. Proscription against eating blood or fat (3:17)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Fat and the innards

In ancient times, the fat of an animal was considered the best part of the animal to eat. Therefore, certain fat portions of an animal that was sacrificed belonged exclusively to Yahweh. These were never to be eaten but rather were to be offered on the fire and converted into pleasant-smelling smoke that rose to Yahweh in heaven. The fat portions and internal organs that were to be removed for burning that are referred to in this chapter include:

Leviticus - Chapter 3 Introduction

- For bovine, sheep, and goats:
- the fat covering the innards. This refers to what is known as caul fat, or the thin layer of fat that covers over all of the internal organs in the abdomen of bovines and flock animals. (See in 3:3–14)
- the fat that is on the innards. This refers to what is known as visceral fat, or the thick chunks of fat that are directly adhered to the internal organs, especially the stomach, liver, and kidneys. This specifically includes the fat that is connected to the two kidneys and the two kidneys themselves. (See 3:4–15)
- the lobe on the liver. This refers to one of the four bunches of liver tissue on an animal's liver, along with the liver itself.

For sheep only, in addition to the portions of fat and organs listed above, the worshiper who offered the sacrifice was to include all the fat of the sheep, wherever it was found, but especially the fatty tail. This term refers to the choice portion of fat attached to the short tail of the sheep, which was to be removed in one piece near the end of the spine. (See 3:9) These portions of fat were to be carefully removed by the person offering the sacrifice and presented to the priest to be burned on the altar. It may be that your language does not have specific terms for these portions of fat. If that is the case, consider using general expressions.

Ritual action
This chapter, much like Leviticus 1, includes several ritual actions that are suggestive of deeper theological actions and must be understood in order to properly translate the chapter. They include:

1. the laying of hands on an animal
2. the splashing and sprinkling of blood and
3. the act of burning a sacrifice in a way that causes smoke to go up.
4. Laying hands on the animal

This chapter features the symbolic act of laying one's hands on the head of the sacrificial animal. This action is linked to the acceptance of the animal as an appropriate sacrifice on the individual's behalf. (See 1:4) As a symbolic act, the laying of hands apparently identifies the individual with the animal he is offering. The implication seems to be that the person is ritually placing his sins on the sacrificial animal so that God will forgive the sins when the animal is sacrificed.

1. Splashing and sprinkling blood

The ritual action of splashing the blood of the animal on the altar is frequent in animal sacrifices in Leviticus. In Chapter 3, as in Chapter 1, the blood of the animal is collected and applied via splattering or splashing to the sides of the altar upon which the burnt offering is placed. (See 1:5, 1:11 and 1:15) In Chapter 1 and Chapter 3, the blood appears to have been splashed or splattered against the side of the altar. (See 1:5, 1:11, and 3:2, 3:8, and 3:13) In chapters 4, 5, and 6, the blood will be sprinkled. (See 4:6, 4:17, 5:9, and 6:24) It may be put on the horns of the altar or poured out at the base of the altar. (See 4:7, 4:18, 4:25, 4:30, and 4:34) In the case of birds, the blood would be drained out or squeezed out on either the side of the altar or on the base of the altar. (See 1:15 and 5:9) The blood was the life of the animal. (See 17:11) It was given by God to purify ritually and to remove sin. In this chapter, the blood acts as a ritual detergent or soap with the special ability to cleanse people, sacred objects, and sacred spaces from the impurity of sin.

1. Burning a sacrifice in a way that makes smoke rise

As in Leviticus 1, the language of causing the sacrifice "to become smoke on the altar" pictures the sacrifice as being converted to smoke by the fire of the altar. Then the smoke would arise to Yahweh in heaven, where he would smell the pleasant aroma of the burning sacrifice. As such, the pleasant smell was either a sign that Yahweh approved the sacrifice and would atone for the individual's sins and forgive him, or it functioned as a necessary requirement for the acceptance of the individual's offering. Either way, this term is common in Leviticus but difficult to translate. If your language has a verb that means to turn something into smoke through fire, consider using it here.

Consuming blood or fat
Leviticus 3:17 prohibits any Israelite, regardless of age or location, from eating any fat or blood of any animal. Because the blood contained the life of the animal, it had the special ability to cleanse people, sacred objects, or sacred space from the impurity caused by sin. As such, Yahweh forbade the eating of any animal blood. (See 7:26–27, 17:10–14, and 19:26) While the reason for forbidding the consumption of fat is not given in this chapter, it is presumed that these choice portions of rich fat were especially coveted and so belonged exclusively to Yahweh.

Important Figures of Speech in This Chapter

This chapter includes two primary figures of speech that may prove difficult to translate but are important to understanding the chapter. They include:

1. the phrase "to the face of the tent of meeting" and

Leviticus 3:1 (#3)

2. the phrase “the sons of Aaron.”

“To the face of the tent of meeting”
As with the expression “the face of Yahweh,” the expression “to the face of the tent of meeting” (See 3:2) simply means “before the sacred tent,” that is, directly in front of the interior tent in the courtyard of the sacred tent. If your language has a similar idiomatic expression, consider using it wherever this phrase occurs. However, if this expression would not be natural in your language, consider translating the expression in this chapter simply as “before the tent of meeting” or as “in front of the tent of meeting.”

“The sons of Aaron”
Throughout Leviticus, but especially in this chapter, the priests are referred to by the expression “the sons of Aaron.” Occasionally, the expression is “the sons of Aaron, the priests” (as in 3:2), but often the priests are simply called “the sons of Aaron.” (See 3:5, 3:8, and 3:13) As the Introduction to Leviticus discusses, at the time when Yahweh spoke to Moses from the tent of meeting, the priests literally were the sons of Aaron. But the laws in the book also applied to future generations, when the term “sons” would be a way of referring to the priests as Aaron’s descendants (with the exception of Leviticus chapters 8–10). Here and throughout the book, if it would be clearer in your language, in your translation you could generally use the term “descendants,” which would apply to both the original priests and their successors.

Other Possible Translation Difficulties in This Chapter

In addition to these important figures of speech, this chapter features several translation difficulties, including:

1. the unclear referent of masculine pronouns
2. the switching between second and third-person address
3. the use of a verb and a related noun (cognate-accusatives)
4. the use of a future form to indicate a request or command
5. the use of specific, technical sacrificial language.

The referent of the masculine pronouns
Throughout this chapter, the author of Leviticus uses a third-person pronoun to refer to both the individual who offers the sacrifices and to the priest who performs the sacrifice. As such, it is often difficult (but not impossible) to infer which party performs which actions. In general, the sacrifice is presented to the priest, but the individual who presents the sacrifice is responsible for killing, properly butchering, and presenting the portions of the sacrificial animal to the priest, who will then arrange them on the altar’s fire. The UST will indicate which party is the apparent referent of the pronoun.

Second and third-person address
Chapters 1 through 7 are written as a direct address to the people of God through Moses. Because in Chapter 3 the pronouns “his” and “he” refer to the person bringing an offering to Yahweh, those terms can be translated in the second person, as done in 1:2 and as the UST models, or they can be translated in the third person, as the ULT models. In the present chapter, with the exception of the second-person plural forms in the last verse (3:17), the author of Leviticus consistently uses third-person forms to refer to the individual who offers the sacrifices described. We recommend that you continue to use whichever forms and pronouns you have been using in the previous two chapters.

The use of a verb with a related noun (Cognate-accusatives)
For emphasis, the author of Leviticus often uses a verb with a related noun. In this chapter, the verb “to present” is related to the noun translated as “offering.” (See 3:1–14) If your language can repeat words for emphasis, it would be appropriate in this context to repeat these words in a similar manner.

The use of a future form to indicate a request or command
The writer of Leviticus will often use the future form “you shall” to give an instruction or command. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate these words using a command or instruction form.

The use of specific, technical sacrificial terminology
See above the sections on “Fat and the innards” and “Ritual action.”

Leviticus 3:1 (#3)

מִן־הַבָּקָר

“from the cattle”

The phrase **from the cattle** does not refer to a specific group of animals. It describes any groups of bovines that an Israelite might own. Express this in the way that would be most natural in your language. Alternate translation: [from any of the cows, bulls or oxen that he owns]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 3:1 (#1)

קָרְבָּנוֹ & הַהוּא מַקְרִיב & יַקְרִיבֶנּוּ

“his offering & he is presenting & he shall present it”

For this and similar expressions throughout this chapter, see how you translated the expression in 1:2.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 3:1 (#2)

קָרְבָּנוֹ & הַהוּא מַקְרִיב & יַקְרִיבֶנּוּ

“his offering & he is presenting & he shall present it”

As the Introduction to Leviticus discusses, the book often speaks of the Israelites and to the Israelites in the third person, even though it is a direct address. Here and throughout the book, if it would be helpful in your language, you could use the second person in your translation. Alternatively, if you have been using third-person forms throughout, consider continuing to do so here. Alternate translation: [your offering ... you are presenting ... you shall present it]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Leviticus 3:1 (#4)

תְּמִמִים יַקְרִיבֶנּוּ

“perfect, he shall present it”

As the Introduction to Leviticus discusses, the word **perfect** here refers to a male or female bovine that is completely healthy and an exemplary representative of its species. Alternate translation: [he must offer one that is unblemished] or [he should offer one that is without defect]

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 3:1 (#5)

יַקְרִיבֶנּוּ לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“he shall present it to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated the expression **to the face of Yahweh** in 1:5. Alternate translation: [he shall present it in the presence of Yahweh] or [he shall present it within the sacred precincts of the tent of meeting, where Yahweh is]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 3:2 (#2)

וְסָמַךְ יָדוֹ עַל־רֹאשׁ קָרְבָּנוֹ

“And he shall lay his hand on the head of his offering”

This is a symbolic action that identifies the person with the animal he is sacrificing as an offering. The implication seems to be that the person is ritually placing his sins on the sacrificial animal so that God will forgive the sins when the animal is sacrificed. If it would be helpful to your readers, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [And he shall lay his hand on the head of his offering in order to place his sins on the animal, that they may be removed from him]

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 3:2 (#1)

וְסָמַךְ יָדוֹ עַל־רֹאשׁ קָרְבָּנוֹ וּשְׁחָטוֹ פֶּתַח אֹהֶל מוֹעֵד

“And he shall lay his hand on the head of his offering and he shall slaughter it {at} the entrance of the tent of meeting”

Here and throughout this chapter, the pronoun **he** refers to the worshiper and not to the priest. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [And the one offering the sacrifice shall lay his hand on the head of his offering, and that individual shall slaughter it at the entrance of the tent of meeting]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 3:2 (#3)

בְּנֵי אַהֲרֹן הַכֹּהֲנִים

“the sons of Aaron, the priests”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:5. Alternate translation: [the descendants of Aaron, who are priests]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 3:4 (#1)

עַל־הַכְּלָיוֹת יְסִירֶנָּה

“he shall remove it with the kidneys”

Here, **it** refers to **the lobe on the liver**. If it would be helpful, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [he shall remove the lobe on the liver with the kidneys]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 3:5 (#1)

וְהִקְטִירוּ אֹתוֹ בְּנֵי־אַהֲרֹן הַמִּזְבֵּחָה

“And the sons of Aaron shall cause it to become smoke on the altar”

Although the pronoun **it** here is singular, it refers to all the portions of fat and the internal organs that were described in 3:3–4. If it would be helpful, consider using a plural pronoun as 3:16 does, or making the referents explicit, as the UST models. Alternate translation: [And the sons of Aaron shall cause them to become smoke on the altar]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 3:6 (#3)

מִן־הַצֹּאן

“is} from the flock”

The expression **the flock** does not refer to a specific group of animals. Rather, it describes any groups of sheep or goats that an Israelite might own. Express this in the way that would be most natural in your language. Alternate translation: [is from any of the sheep or goats that he owns]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 3:6 (#1)

קָרְבָּנוֹ & יַקְרִיבֶנּוּ

“his offering & he shall present it”

See how you translated the similar expressions in 1:2.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 3:6 (#2)

מִן־הַצֹּאן

“is} from the flock”

See how you translated this expression in 1:10.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 3:7 (#2)

לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated the expression **to the face of Yahweh** in 1:5.

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 3:7 (#1)

הִוּא־מַקְרִיב אֶת־קָרְבָּנוֹ וְהִקְרִיב אֹתָתוֹ

“he is presenting his offering & then he shall present it”

See how you handled the emphatic use of a verb and a related noun in 1:2. Specifically, see how you translated the similar form of this expression in 3:1.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 3:8 (#2)

לִפְנֵי אֹהֶל מוֹעֵד

“to the face of the tent of meeting”

Here, **to the face of the tent of meeting** refers to a location “before the tent of meeting” and is synonymous with the expression “at the entrance of the tent of meeting.” (See 3:2) If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [at the entrance of the tent of meeting] or [in front of the tent of meeting]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 3:8 (#3)

בְּנֵי אַהֲרֹן

“the sons of Aaron”

See how you translated this description of the priests in 1:5.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 3:8 (#1)

וְסָמַךְ אֶת־יָדוֹ עַל־רֹאשׁ

“And he shall lay his hand on the head of”

This is a symbolic action. See how you translated this phrase in 1:4.

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 3:9 (#2)

חֶלְבּוֹ

“its fat”

The possessive pronoun **its** refers to the lamb described in 3:7–8. If it would be helpful, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [the fat of the lamb that he sacrificed]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 3:9 (#1)

וְהִקְרִיב מִזֶּבַח הַשְּׁלָמִים

“And from the sacrifice of the peace offerings he shall present”

Alternate translation: [And from the sacrifice of the peace offerings, the one offering the sacrifice shall present]

Leviticus 3:11 (#2)

לֶ֖חֶם אִשֶּׁ֥ה לַיהוָֽה

“a food gift to Yahweh”

Alternate translation: [food that is offered to Yahweh as a gift] or [a gift to Yahweh that consists of food]

Leviticus 3:11 (#1)

וְהִקְטִירָ֥ן הַכֹּהֵ֖ן הַמִּזְבֵּֽחָה

“And the priest shall cause it to become smoke on the altar”

Although the word **it** here is singular, it refers to all the portions of fat and the internal organs that were described in 3:3–4. If it would be helpful, consider using a plural pronoun as 3:16 does, or making this explicit, as the UST models. Alternate translation: [And the priest shall cause them to become smoke on the altar]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 3:12 (#1)

קָרְבָּנ֔וֹ וְהִקְרִיבֹ֖

“his offering & then he shall present it”

See how you translated the similar expressions in 1:2.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 3:12 (#2)

לִפְנֵ֥י יְהוָֽה

“to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated this expression in 1:5.

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 3:13 (#1)

וְסָמַ֣ךְ אֶת־יָד֗וֹ עַל־רֹ֤אשׁ

“And he shall lay his hand on its head”

See how you translated this symbolic action in 1:4.

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 3:13 (#2)

לִפְנֵ֣י אֹ֔הֶל מוֹעֵ֑ד

“to the face of the tent of meeting”

See how you translated this expression in 3:8.

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 3:13 (#3)

בְּנֵ֥י אַהֲרֹ֖ן

“the sons of Aaron”

See how you translated this description of the priests in 1:5.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 3:14 (#1)

וְהִקְרִ֣יב מִמֶּ֔נּוּ

“And from it, he shall present”

Alternate translation: [And from it, the one offering the sacrifice shall present]

Leviticus 3:17 (#1)

לְדֹרֹתֵיכֶ֖ם בְּכֹ֣ל מוֹשְׁבֹתֵיכֶֽם

“for your generations in all your dwelling places”

In this verse, the words **your** and **you** are plural. Yahweh is speaking about everyone who will offer sacrifices, regardless of age or location. If you have been using second-person singular forms in your translation and the switch to the plural form would not be natural in your language, you could continue to use singular forms here. Alternatively, if you have been using third-person forms throughout this chapter, consider using whatever form would be clearest in your language. Alternate translation: [for all your offspring everywhere you live]

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 3:17 (#2)

וְכָל־דָּ֖ם

“or any blood”

Alternate translation: [or consume any blood]

Leviticus - Chapter 4 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter begins by reintroducing the narrative framing that was first used at the beginning of the book (“And Yahweh spoke to Moses …”). As such,

Leviticus - Chapter 4 Introduction

Leviticus 4:1–5:13 should be taken as a discrete unit that is nonetheless connected to Leviticus 1–3 within the unit of Leviticus 1–7.

The present chapter, Leviticus 4, gives instructions on how to offer a sacrifice that addresses the guilt incurred by unintentional sins. This sacrifice is called a purification offering because of its ability to purify sacred space and sacred objects that are dedicated to Yahweh from the impurities generated by sin. The structure of Chapter 4 is made up of four hypothetical scenarios in which a person would be required to offer this particular sacrifice, enumerated according to which individual or group has committed the sin:

1. the high priest (4:3–12)
2. the community as a whole (4:13–21)
3. a leader in the community (4:22–26)
4. an ordinary individual member of the community (4:27–35).

Structurally, the whole of 4:1–5:13 could be visually represented as follows:

The Sin Offering (4:1–5:13)

1. Sin Offerings for Unintentional Sins (4:1–35)
2. scenario 1: The High Priest (4:3–12)
3. scenario 2: The Community (4:13–21)
4. scenario 3: A Leader (4:22–26)
5. scenario 4: An Individual (4:27–35)
6. The Graduated Sin Offering
7. scenario 1: Guilt due to the failure to testify in court (5:1)
8. scenario 2: Guilt due to unintentional contact with an unclean animal (5:2) or unintentional contact with human uncleanness (5:3)
9. scenario 3: Guilt due to the failure to fulfill a rashly spoken vow (5:4)
10. the procedure for offering a purification offering (5:5–13)

Because the chapter offers instructions for hypothetical situations where the purification offering is required, the instructions in Chapter 4 offer a detailed outline of the procedure for the sacrifice. The instructed steps include:

1. presenting a perfect animal to the priest (4:3, 14)
2. for the high priest, a young bull (4:3)
3. for the community, a young bull (4:13)
4. for the leader, a male goat (4:23)
5. for the individual, a male goat (4:28) or a female sheep (4:32)
6. bringing the animal to the tent of meeting (4:4, 14, 23, 28, 32)
7. laying hands on the animal (4:4, 15, 24, 29, 33)
8. killing the animal (4:4, 15, 24, 29, 33)
9. bringing the blood into the tent of meeting (4:5, 16)
10. sprinkling the blood seven times before Yahweh towards the curtain (4:6, 17)
11. putting some blood on each of the four horns of an altar (4:7, 18, 25, 30, 34)
12. for the high priest and the community, the blood is applied to the horns of the incense altar (4:7, 18)
13. for the leader and the individual, the blood is applied to the horns of the burnt offering altar (4:25, 30, 34)
14. pouring the rest of the blood out on the base of the burnt offering altar (4:8, 18, 25, 30, 34)
15. properly butchering the animal into the fat portions (4:9–10, 19–20, 26, 31, 35)
16. burning the fat portions and creating the pleasant-smelling smoke (4:10, 19–20, 26, 31, 35)
17. bringing the rest of the sacrificed animal outside the camp to burn it (4:11–12, 21)

It should be noted that every step of this procedure is not repeated for every scenario covered by Leviticus 4. However, because the first two scenarios include a full description of each step, it is reasonable to assume that each scenario required the same procedure, even if a particular action is not included in the description of the sacrificial process.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Several special concepts are crucial for understanding this chapter. They include:

1. several instances of technical sacrificial terminology, especially the purification offering itself and the notion of mistakes or unintentional sins
2. the three-fold use of the term “guilt”
3. the symbolic action of sprinkling or applying blood
4. the location and purposes of the various altars and sacred objects such as the curtain

Leviticus - Chapter 4 Introduction

5. the grounds for removing the portions of the sacrifice that are not burned as sacrifices to Yahweh.

Sacrificial terminology
First, several words or phrases in this chapter have a specialized meaning in the context of sacrifice. They include (1) the purification offering itself and (2) the concept of "unintentional sins."

(1) The purification offering

This chapter offers instructions for how and when to offer a purification offering, also called a "sin offering" due to the term's association with the word translated as "sin." The primary purpose of the purification offering was, as the name suggests, to purify or cleanse the sanctuary and the sacred items dedicated to Yahweh from the impurity brought about by sin, even unintentional sin (as is the case in this chapter). Because of its intended purpose, the offering features the application of blood on the altar in a way that is distinct from the other sacrifices described in Leviticus 1–7 (as explained below). The purification offering not only purified or cleansed these items and spaces that had been defiled by the impurity of sin but also provided atonement and forgiveness to the individual or community who offered it. See the Book Introduction for more information.

(2) The mistake or the unintentional sin

The noun translated as "mistake" (4:2, 4:22, and 4:27 and the use of the phrase "by mistake") is related to the verb translated as "to err mistakenly." (See 4:13) These terms refer to actions by which a person unintentionally does something that incurs guilt before Yahweh. Even while they are unintentional, the actions are still considered to be sins, and so they actively defile the sanctuary and the sacred items. (See 4:1, 4:3, 4:22, and 4:27–28) Specifically, these actions are violations of Yahweh's commandments, whether positive instructions or negative injunctions. (See the note on the phrase "to sin ... from any of the commands of Yahweh which will not be done" in 4:2, 4:13, 4:22, and 4:27) The unintentional nature of these actions is emphasized by the descriptions given in 4:13 and 4:23. Here it is emphasized that the purification offering is required once the individual or group becomes aware of the sinful actions. The awareness of unintentional sins leads to "guilt" (see below). If your language has a verb and a related noun that refers to an unintentional wrongdoing or mistake as described here, consider using it in the contexts where these terms appear.

Guilt
In Chapter 4, the author of Leviticus uses the verb "to become guilty" and the related abstract noun "guilt." (See 4:3, 4:13, 4:22, and 4:27) These terms refer to either the internal feeling of having done wrong, or to a legal state of needing to provide restitution for one's actions, or perhaps both. If your language uses different terms for these, consider using them both in these contexts where the terms appear.

Ritual Action
The ritual action of splashing or sprinkling the blood of the animal on the altar is frequent in animal sacrifices in Leviticus. The laws regarding the purification offering (which begin in the present chapter) are unique in the prominence of blood required in the sacrifice. In Chapter 1 and Chapter 3 the blood is "splashed" or "splattered" against the side of the altar. (See 1:5, 1:11, 3:2, 3:8, and 3:13) In 5 and 6, the blood is "sprinkled" towards the curtain that divided the courtyard of the tent of meeting from the Holy of Holies. (See 4:6, 4:17, 5:9, and 6:24) There it is "put" on the horns of either the incense altar or the altar of the burnt offerings or "poured out" at the base of the altar of burnt offerings. (See 4:7, 4:18, 4:25, 4:30, and 4:34) In the case of birds, the blood is "drained out" or "squeezed out" on either the side of the altar or on the base of the altar. (See 1:15 and 5:9) As explained in previous chapters, the blood, being the life of the animal (17:11), was given by God to ritually purify, cleanse, and remove the defiling impurity brought about by the presence of sin, even unintentional sin. In this chapter, the blood acts as a ritual detergent or soap with the special ability to cleanse sacred objects and sacred spaces from the impurity of sin.

Fat and Internal Organs
In ancient times, the fat of an animal was considered the best part of the animal to eat. Therefore, certain fat portions of an animal that was sacrificed belonged exclusively to Yahweh. These were never to be eaten but rather were to be offered on the fire and converted into pleasant-smelling smoke that rose to Yahweh in heaven. As 4:10, 4:31, and 4:35 make clear, the fat portions and internal organs that were to be removed for burning in the purification offering are the same as those offered in the peace offerings. (See 3:3–4, 3:9–10, and 3:14–15 and the Introduction to chapter 3 for more information.) These portions of fat were to be carefully removed by the person offering the sacrifice and presented to the priest to be burned on the altar. It may be that your language does not have specific terms for these portions of fat. If that is the case, consider using general expressions. Potential alternate translations for these phrases and terms will be offered in the notes.

Leviticus - Chapter 4 Introduction

The "Clean Place" (4:12)

In Chapter 4 Yahweh instructs the people that the portions of the sacrificial animal that are not burned completely on the altar for a purification offering must be brought outside the camp of the people to a clean place (4:12 and 4:21). The adjective translated as "clean" does not refer to a location that is physically free of dirt (as one might describe a freshly washed dish). Rather in the context of sacrifices, the word "clean" refers to a person, animal, or object that has been kept clean from the defiling presence of sin and is fit to be used for sacred purposes or to enter into sacred space. Portions of an animal that were used in sacrifices to purify a person, place, or object from the impurity of sins may have been considered to absorb the defiling sin. As such, contact with these portions, once they had absorbed the impurity brought about by sin, may have been thought to make an individual impure or ceremonially unclean. Consequently, the location where the rest of the sacrificial animal was burned needed to be ceremonially clean in this way so that the potentially defiling presence of the sacrificial animal's corpse could be properly disposed of and so that the camp itself did not become ceremonially unclean by virtue of its proximity to an 'unclean' location.

The various altars and the sacred curtain

The present chapter describes sacred objects and locations that are relevant to the purification offering. Properly understanding the geography and purpose of these items and locations is crucial for properly understanding this chapter. First, the chapter refers to the entrance to the tent of meeting, where the animal to be sacrificed would be presented, hands would be laid on it, and the animal would be killed. (See 4:3–4, 4:14–15, and 4:24–33) The blood of the animal was then brought into the tent of meeting, into the courtyard that resided inside the outer partitions of the tent. (See 4:5, 4:16, 4:25, 4:30, and 4:34) Once inside the courtyard, the priest would proceed to the curtain which divided the inner courtyard from the Holy of Holies, inside which Yahweh resided over the wings of the cherubim on the box of the covenant. The priest would dip his finger in the blood and "sprinkle" the blood seven times in the direction of that sacred curtain, which was also in the direction of Yahweh's dwelling place among the Israelites. (See 4:6, 4:17, and 4:25)

In two cases (when the high priest or the whole community unintentionally sins), the priest would then apply blood to the four horns at the corners of the incense altar and possibly sprinkle it seven times toward the curtain, before pouring the rest of the blood out at the base of the altar of burnt offerings. (See 4:5, 4:16, 4:25, 4:30, and 4:34) In the case of a leader of the community and an ordinary individual's unintentional sin, the priest would dip his finger in the blood of the animal and apply it to the four horns of the corners of the altar of burnt offerings before pouring out the rest of the blood at the base of the same altar, as in the other cases. (See 4:25, 4:30, and 4:34) No explanation is given for this distinction. The altar of the burnt offering is described as being "at the entrance to the tent of meeting," (See: Leviticus 1:5, 4:7, and 4:18) whereas the incense altar is only ambiguously located "to the face of Yahweh in the tent of meeting." (See 4:7) As such, the precise location of the incense altar is debated. This is the geography of the tent of meeting as is relevant for Leviticus 4.

Disposing of the portions of the sacrifice that are not burned

As was briefly mentioned above, in Chapter 4, Yahweh instructs the people that the portions of the sacrificial animal that are not burned completely on the altar for a purification offering must be brought outside the camp of the people to a "clean place" in (4:12 and 4:21). These portions of the sacrifice included the skin, head, legs, innards (probably referring specifically to the intestines and stomach), and any feces of the animal. (See 4:11–12 and also 4:20) Because these parts of the animal were neither suitable to be burned on the altar as a sacrifice to Yahweh or suitable for eating, they had to be disposed of properly. However, if ancient Israel agreed with her neighboring peoples, the people may have conceived of the sacrificial animal absorbing, so to speak, the impurities brought about by the defiling presence of sin. As such, contact with these portions, once they had absorbed the impurity brought about by sin, may have been thought to make an individual impure or ceremonially unclean. Consequently, the location where the rest of the sacrificial animal was burned needed to be ceremonially clean so that the potentially defiling presence of the sacrificial animal's corpse could be properly disposed of and so that the camp itself did not become ceremonially unclean by virtue of its proximity to an 'unclean' location. However, this action could not have been performed by the priest making the sacrifice, because disposing of the animal in this way could potentially cause the priest to become impure, temporarily preventing his ability to serve as a priest to Yahweh in the tent of meeting. Rather, the act of properly disposing of the animal and burning it must have been performed by another, unspecified Israelite.

Leviticus - Chapter 4 Introduction

Important Figures of Speech in This Chapter

This chapter includes three primary figures of speech that may prove difficult to translate but are important to understanding the chapter. They include (1) the phrase "to the face of the tent of meeting," (2) the expression "to sins ... from any of the commands of Yahweh, which will not be done," and (3) the phrase "the sons of Aaron."

"To the face of ..."

As with the expression "to the face of Yahweh," the expression "to the face of the tent of meeting" simply means "before" the tent of meeting. (4:14) That is, it refers to the location directly in front of the interior tent, in its courtyard. Likewise, the similar expression "the face of the curtain" simply means "the front of" the sacred curtain or perhaps "in the direction of" the curtain. (See 4:6 and 4:17) If your language has a similar idiomatic expression, consider using it wherever this phrase occurs. However, if this expression would not be natural in your language, consider translating the expression in this chapter simply as "before the tent of meeting" or as "in front of the tent of meeting" in the first case and as "the front of the curtain" or as "toward the curtain" in the second case.

The expression "to sin ... from any of the commands of Yahweh which will not be done"

Several times in this chapter, the author of Leviticus uses the expression "commands of Yahweh which will not be done" to refer to the commands of Yahweh against doing certain actions. (See 4:2, 4:13, 4:22, 4:27) The expression refers to those commandments that proscribe certain actions or behaviors (called "negative commands"). As the expression makes clear, they have done something that Yahweh has instructed them not to do, performing an action that was forbidden. As such, their actions require restitution and have defiled the sacred space where Yahweh resided among the Israelites and the sacred items that were dedicated to him. In short, their unintentional sin has brought about a scenario in which a purification offering is required.

The expression "to lift up"

Three times in this chapter, the author of Leviticus uses the expression "to lift up" to refer to the process of removing fat from an animal that has been killed to be a sacrifice to Yahweh. (See 4:8, 4:10, and 4:19) If your language has a similar idiom to refer to the actions by which one butchers an animal and removes its fat, consider using it in the places where the expression occurs. If not, consider using a generic expression, as the alternate translations provided by the relevant notes will demonstrate.

"The anointed priest"

Three times in Chapter 4, the author of Leviticus uses the expression "the anointed priest" to refer to the high priest. (See 4:3, 4:5, and 4:16) This expression indicates that the high priest, as the chief leader of the priesthood, has been especially anointed and dedicated for service as a priest to Yahweh and thus has special privileges and responsibilities befitting his position. The use of the word "anointed" refers to the practice of dripping olive oil on priests to dedicate them to Yahweh. If this expression would be unclear or unnatural in your language, consider simply translating the phrase as "the high priest."

To "burn in a way that makes smoke go up"

As in the previous chapters, the language of "causing" the sacrifice "to become smoke on the altar" pictures the sacrifice as being converted to smoke by the fire of the altar and arising to Yahweh in heaven, where he would smell the pleasant aroma of the burning sacrifice. (See 4:10, 4:19, 4:26, 4:31, and 4:35) As such, the pleasant smell was either a sign that Yahweh approved the sacrifice and would atone for the individual's sins and forgive him or functioned as a necessary requirement for the acceptance of the individual's offering. Either way, this term is common in Leviticus but difficult to translate cleanly. If your language has a verb that means "to turn something into smoke through fire," consider using it here.

Other Possible Translation Difficulties in This Chapter

In addition to these important figures of speech, this chapter features several translation difficulties, including:

1. the unclear referent of masculine pronouns
2. the switching between second and third-person address
3. the use of a verb and a related noun (cognate-accusatives)
4. the use of a future form to indicate a request or command
5. the use of specific, technical sacrificial language.

The referent of the masculine pronouns

Throughout this chapter, the author of Leviticus uses a third-person pronoun to refer to both the individual who offers the sacrifices and to the priest who performs the sacrifice. As such, it is often difficult (but not impossible) to infer which party performs which actions. In general, the sacrifice is presented to the priest, but the individual who presents the sacrifice is responsible for killing, properly butchering, and

presenting the portions of the sacrificial animal to the priest, who will then arrange them on the altar's fire. The UST will indicate which party is the apparent referent of the pronoun.

Second and third-person address
The entirety of chapters 1 through 7 are written as direct address to the people of God through Moses. Because in this chapter the pronouns "his" and "he" refer to the person bringing an offering to Yahweh, those terms can be translated in the second person as it is in 1:2 and as the UST models, or they can be translated in the third person, as the ULT models. In the present chapter, the author of Leviticus consistently uses third-person forms to refer to the individual who offers the sacrifices described. Despite this, we recommend that you continue to use whichever forms and pronouns you have been using in the previous two chapters, even if that means continuing to use second-person forms.

The use of a verb with a related noun (Cognate-accusatives)
For emphasis, the author of Leviticus often uses a verb with a related noun. In this chapter, the verb "to present" is used with the related noun that is translated as "offering," just as the verb "to sin" is used with the related noun that is translated as "sin." (See 3:1, 4:3, 4:14, 4:23, 4:28, and 4:35) If your language can repeat words for emphasis, it would be appropriate in this context to repeat these words in a similar manner.

The use of a future form to indicate a request or command
The writer of Leviticus will often use the future form "you shall" to give an instruction or command. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate these words using a command or instruction form.

The use of specific, technical sacrificial terminology
See above the sections on "Sacrificial terminology" and "Ritual action."

Leviticus 4:1 (#1)

לֵאמֹר

"saying"

The word translated as **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, consider ways in which you might introduce this quotation naturally in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Leviticus 4:1–2 (#1)

לֵאמֹר׃ דַּבֵּר אֶל־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל לֵאמֹר׀

"saying, "Speak to the sons of Israel, saying"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation, with a period before: [He told Moses to tell the sons of Israel]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Leviticus 4:2 (#4)

וְעָשָׂה מֵאַחַת מֵהֵנָּה

"and he does from one from them"

The expression **from one from them** uses repetition to refer to any individual command from the body of the commands of Yahweh. If your language can use repetition for emphasis in this manner, consider using a similar expression here. If not, then consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [and he does any one of them]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 4:2 (#3)

כִּי־תֶחֱטָא בִשְׁגָגָה מִכֹּל׀ מִצְוֹת יְהוָה אֲשֶׁר לֹא תֵעָשֶׂינָה

"when he sins by mistake from any of the commands of Yahweh that shall not be done"

The expression **that shall not be done** refers to certain of **the commands of Yahweh**, that is, to commandments that prohibit certain actions or behaviors. Alternate translation: [when he sins by mistake from any of the commands of Yahweh that say what you should not do]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

Leviticus 4:2 (#1)

בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

"the sons of Israel"

This expression speaks of the people of Israel in the time of Moses as if they were literally the **sons of Israel**. It means that they are the physical and spiritual descendants of Jacob, whose name God changed to Israel. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the descendants of Israel]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 4:2 (#2)

לֵאמֹר׀

"saying"

Alternate translation: [and say to them]

Leviticus 4:3 (#1)

אִם הַכֹּהֵן הַמָּשִׁיחַ יֶחֱטָא לְאַשְׁמַת הָעָם

“if the anointed priest sins to the guilt of the people”

The expression **sins to the guilt of the people** refers to an act of wrongdoing against Yahweh that results in the collective guilt of the people in some way. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [if the anointed priest sins in such a way that it causes the people to become guilty]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 4:3 (#3)

לְאַשְׁמַת הָעָם

“to the guilt of the people”

The abstract noun **guilt** refers both to the emotional experience of feeling guilty and to the legal status of having done wrong and needing to offer restitution for the wrongdoing. If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **guilt**, you can express the same idea with an adjective. Alternate translation: [so as to cause the people to be guilty]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 4:3 (#5)

בֶּן־בָּקָר תָּמִים

“a perfect son of the cattle”

The expression **son of** describes a person or animal that shares the essential qualities of something. Here the phrase describes this **bull** as a **son of the cattle** because it is a male animal that shares the essential qualities of the class of domesticated bovines. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an equivalent idiom from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [male bovine without blemish]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 4:3 (#2)

הַכֹּהֵן הַמָּשִׁיחַ

“the anointed priest”

The **anointed priest** refers to the high priest, the member of the priesthood who has been anointed to lead the priesthood. If your language has a similar way of referring to a leading spiritual figure, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [the priest whom Yahweh anointed to be the high priest]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 4:3 (#4)

עַל חַטָּאתוֹ אֲשֶׁר חָטָא

“for his sin that he sinned”

Here, a verb and its object come from the same root. The phrase **he sinned** translates a verb that is related to the noun translated as **sin**. The repetition of related words adds emphasis to the statement. If your language can repeat words for emphasis and your language has comparable terms that you can use in your own translation, it would be appropriate to use that construction here in your translation.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 4:4 (#3)

וְסָמַךְ אֶת־יָדוֹ עַל־רֹאשׁ הַפָּר

“And he shall lay his hand on the head of the bull”

See how you translated this symbolic action in 1:4.

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 4:4 (#4)

וְשָׁחַט אֶת־הַפָּר לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“and he shall slaughter the bull to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar phrase in 1:5.

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 4:4 (#1)

וְהֵבִיא אֶת־הַפָּר

“And he shall bring the bull”

Alternate translation: [And the anointed priest shall bring the bull]

Leviticus 4:4 (#2)

לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated the expression **to the face of Yahweh** in 1:5. Alternate translation: [into the presence of Yahweh] or [to the sacred precincts of the tent of meeting, where Yahweh lives among the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 4:6 (#1)

וְהִזָּ֞ה מִן־הַדָּ֣ם שֶׁ֗בַע פְּעָמִים֙ לִפְנֵ֣י יְהוָ֔ה

“and he shall sprinkle some of the blood seven times to the face of Yahweh”

Here, to **sprinkle some of the blood** of the bull to the face of Yahweh means to sprinkle the blood in the direction of the curtain of the holy place, which separated the worshiper from the Holy of Holies, the location where Yahweh was enthroned above the cherubim on the ark of the covenant. Alternate translation: [and he shall sprinkle some of the blood seven times toward the Holy of Holies, where Yahweh lives among the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 4:6 (#3)

הַקֹּ֑דֶשׁ

“the Holy {Place”

By **Holy Place**, Yahweh means the Holy of Holies. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the Holy of Holies]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 4:6 (#2)

אֶת־פְּנֵ֖י פָּרֹ֥כֶת הַקֹּֽדֶשׁ

“toward the face of the curtain of the Holy {Place”

The **face of the curtain** is an idiom that means the front of the curtain. If your language has a similar idiom, consider using it here. If not, consider using a general expression. Alternate translation: [the front of the curtain]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 4:7 (#2)

מִזְבַּ֞ח קְטֹ֣רֶת הַסַּמִּ֗ים

“the altar of incense of the spices”

Here the author is using the possessive form to describe a **the altar of incense** that is characterized by **spices**. The **altar of incense of the spices** refers to the place where priests burned fragrant incense twice a day. It was located directly in front of the curtain which separated the Holy of Holies from the rest of the tent of meeting. It is described in detail in Exodus 30:1–10. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the altar of the fragrant incenses]

See: Possession

Leviticus 4:7 (#3)

לִפְנֵ֣י יְהוָ֔ה

“to the face of Yahweh”

Because this verse specifies that the altar of incense is located inside the **tent of meeting**, here the expression **to the face of Yahweh** means directly in front of the Holy of Holies, the location where Yahweh was enthroned above the cherubim on the ark of the covenant. Alternate translation: [directly in front of Yahweh’s presence in the Holy of Holies]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 4:7 (#1)

וְנָתַ֨ן הַכֹּהֵ֜ן מִן־הַדָּ֗ם עַל־קַרְנ֤וֹת מִזְבַּח֙ קְטֹ֣רֶת הַסַּמִּ֔ים

“And the priest shall put some of the blood on the horns of the altar of incense of the spices”

This is a symbolic action. By daubing the blood on the extremities of the altar, the priest is ritually removing from the sacred altar the impurities caused by the unintentional sin. If this would not be clear to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text or in a footnote here and in subsequent instances in the book. Alternate translation: [And the priest should put some of the blood on the horns of the altar of incense of the spices in order to purify the altar from the defiling impurities caused by the priest’s unintentional sin]

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 4:8 (#1)

יָרִ֖ים מִמֶּ֥נּוּ

“he shall lift up from it”

The expression **he shall lift up** is an idiom that means to carefully remove and set aside. If it would be helpful in your language, consider using a word or phrase that expresses the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he shall trim from it and set aside]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 4:9 (#1)

יְסִירֶ֖נָּה

“he shall remove it”

As in 3:4, 3:10, and 3:15, the one who removes the fat from the sacrificial animal is usually the worshiper, not the priest. However, because in this case the anointed priest is both the one offering the sacrifice and the one performing the sacrifice, here the pronoun **he** refers to the priest. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [the anointed priest shall remove it]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 4:10 (#1)

כַּאֲשֶׁר יוּרַם מִשּׁוֹר זֶבַח הַשְּׁלָמִים

“just as it is lifted up from the ox of the sacrifice of the peace offering”

Here, **it** refers to all the fat that was described in the instructions about peace offerings in 3:3–4. If it would be helpful, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [just as the fat is lifted up from the ox of the sacrifice of the peace offering]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 4:10 (#2)

כַּאֲשֶׁר יוּרַם מִשּׁוֹר זֶבַח הַשְּׁלָמִים

“just as it is lifted up from the ox of the sacrifice of the peace offering”

Here the author of Leviticus does not use the present tense to describe contemporaneous or ongoing action, as if he were here referring to a specific instance where an individual was preparing a peace offering. Rather, the present tense is being used both to describe an action that was previously described in the book of Leviticus and to depict a hypothetical situation. If it would be helpful in your language, consider choosing language that makes it plain that the author is not referring to specific past actions. Alternate translation: [in the same manner as it would be lifted up from the ox of the sacrifice of the peace offering]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Leviticus 4:10 (#3)

כַּאֲשֶׁר יוּרַם

“just as it is lifted up”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [just as the individual lifted up the fat] or, if you used the second-person form in Chapter 3, [just as you lifted up the fat]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 4:10 (#4)

וְהִקְטִירָם הַכֹּהֵן

“And the priest shall cause them to become smoke”

The pronoun **them** refers to all the pieces of fat and the internal organs described in 4:8–9. If it would be helpful, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [And the priest shall cause all the fat pieces and the internal organs to become smoke]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 4:11 (#1)

וְאֶת־עוֹר הַפָּר וְאֶת־כָּל־בְּשָׂרוֹ עַל־רֹאשׁוֹ וְעַל־כְּרָעָיו וְקִרְבּוֹ וּפִרְשׁוֹ

“And the skin of the bull and all its flesh, with its head and with its legs and its innards and its dung”

This list of animal parts tells the reader what is meant by the expression “all of the bull” in 4:12. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Consider using a phrase to indicate that this list introduces the subject of the verse, which will be restated in 4:12. Alternate translation: [As for the skin of the bull and all its flesh, with its head and with its legs and its innards and its dung]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 4:11 (#2)

וְאֶת־כָּל־בְּשָׂרוֹ

“and all its flesh”

Alternate translation: [all of the bull’s flesh]

Leviticus 4:12 (#3)

אֶל־שֶׁפֶךְ הַדֶּשֶׁן & עַל־שֶׁפֶךְ הַדֶּשֶׁן

“to the pouring out place of the fatty ash & on the pouring out place of the fatty ash”

The **pouring out place of the fatty ashes** is equivalent to the “place of the fatty ashes” referenced in 1:16. See how you translated the similar phrase there.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 4:12 (#1)

וְהוֹצִיא

“and he shall bring out”

The pronoun **he** cannot refer to the priest making the sacrifice, because this action would cause the priest to become impure. Rather, it refers to another, unspecified Israelite. If it would be helpful in your language, consider using a generic word for "a person," as the UST models. Alternate translation: [someone else should bring out]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 4:12 (#2)

אֶת־כָּל־הַפָּר

"all of the bull"

Alternate translation: [all these pieces of the bull]

Leviticus 4:12 (#4)

יִשָּׂרֵף

"it shall be burned"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [someone shall burn it]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 4:13 (#1)

וְנֶעְלַם דָּבָר מֵעֵינֵי הַקָּהָל

"and the matter is hidden from the eyes of the assembly"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and the assembly does not realize that they have sinned]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 4:14 (#1)

וְנוֹדְעָה הַחַטָּאת אֲשֶׁר חָטְאוּ עָלֶיהָ

"and the sin that they sinned concerning it becomes known"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and then they realize the sin that they sinned concerning it]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 4:14 (#3)

עָלֶיהָ

"concerning it"

The pronoun **it** refers to the commands of Yahweh mentioned in 4:13. If it would be helpful, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [with regard to the commands of Yahweh]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 4:14 (#5)

לִפְנֵי אֹהֶל מוֹעֵד

"to the face of the tent of meeting"

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:8.

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 4:14 (#2)

הַחַטָּאת אֲשֶׁר חָטְאוּ

"the sin that they sinned"

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:3.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 4:14 (#4)

פַּר בֶּן־בָּקָר

"a bull, a son of the cattle"

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:3.

See: Idiom

Leviticus 4:15 (#1)

וְסָמְכוּ זִקְנֵי הָעֵדָה אֶת־יְדֵיהֶם עַל־רֹאשׁ הַפָּר

"And the elders of the congregation shall lay their hands on the head of the bull"

See how you translated this symbolic action in 1:4.

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 4:15 (#3)

וְשָׁחַט אֶת־הַפָּר

"And he shall slaughter the bull"

Alternate translation: [And one of the elders of the congregation shall slaughter the bull]

Leviticus 4:15 (#2)

לִפְנֵי יְהוָה & לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“to the face of Yahweh & to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:5. Alternate translation: [in the presence of Yahweh ... in the presence of Yahweh] or [in the sacred precincts of the tent of meeting where Yahweh is ... in the sacred precincts of the tent of meeting where Yahweh is]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 4:17 (#1)

וְהִזָּ֖ה שֶׁ֣בַע פְּעָמִ֑ים לִפְנֵ֥י יְהוָ֖ה אֵ֥ת פְּנֵ֖י הַפָּרֹֽכֶת

“and he shall sprinkle {it} seven times to the face of Yahweh, toward the face of the curtain”

See how you translated these expressions in 4:6.

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 4:18 (#1)

יִתֵּ֔ן & יִשְׁפֹּ֖ךְ

“he shall put & he shall pour out”

Here and in the verses 4:18–20, the pronoun **he** refers to the priest. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [the priest shall put ... the priest shall pour out]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 4:18 (#3)

וְאֵ֖ת כָּל־הַדָּ֑ם

“And all the blood”

Alternate translation: [And the remaining blood of the bull]

Leviticus 4:18 (#2)

הַמִּזְבֵּ֞חַ אֲשֶׁ֣ר׀ לִפְנֵ֣י יְהוָ֗ה אֲשֶׁ֛ר בְּאֹ֥הֶל מוֹעֵֽד

“the altar that {is} to the face of Yahweh, which {is} in the tent of meeting”

The **altar that is to the face of Yahweh, which is in the tent of meeting** is identical to the “altar of incense of the spices” referenced in 4:7. See how you translated these expressions there. The phrase **which is in the tent of meeting** describes where the altar is. It does not distinguish it from another altar that is **to the face of Yahweh**.

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

Leviticus 4:19 (#1)

וְאֵ֖ת כָּל־חֶלְבּ֑וֹ

“And all of its fat”

The expression **all of its fat** refers to the portions of the bull’s fat and internal organs as described in 4:8–9. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [And all of the bull’s fat, including the fat covering over the innards, all the fat that is on the innards, the two kidneys, the fat that is on them that is near the loins, and the lobe on the liver]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 4:19 (#2)

יָרִ֥ים מִמֶּֽנּוּ

“he shall lift up from it”

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:8.

See: Idiom

Leviticus 4:19 (#3)

יָרִ֥ים מִמֶּֽנּוּ

“he shall lift up from it”

Here, **he** refers to the priest and not to the worshiper. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making the referent explicit. Alternate translation: [the priest must lift up from it]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 4:20 (#2)

וְעָשָׂ֣ה לַפָּ֔ר & עָשָׂ֖ה׀ לְפַ֣ר & כֵּ֑ן יַעֲשֶׂ֥ה־לֹּֽו׃

“And he shall do with the bull & he did with the bull of & thus he shall do with it”

Alternate translation: [And he shall prepare the bull ... he prepared the bull ... thus he shall prepare it]

Leviticus 4:20 (#1)

וְעָשָׂ֣ה לַפָּ֔ר כַּאֲשֶׁ֥ר עָשָׂ֖ה׀ לְפַ֣ר הַחַטָּ֑את כֵּ֑ן יַעֲשֶׂ֥ה־לֹּֽו׃

“And he shall do with the bull just as he did with the bull of the sin offering; thus he shall do with it”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If your language can repeat phrases for emphasis, it would be appropriate to use that construction here in your translation. If not, consider combining the phrases. Alternate translation: [And he should do with this bull the exact same thing that he did with the bull of the sin offering]

See: Parallelism

Leviticus 4:20 (#3)

כַּאֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה לְפַר הַחַטָּאת

“just as he did with the bull of the sin offering”

Because it was the anointed priest who prepared the **bull of the purification offering** as described in 4:3–12, in this case, the word **he** refers to the anointed priest, not to the individual member of “the elders of the congregation” who is the subject of the other verbs in this verse. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making the subject explicit here. Alternate translation: [just as the anointed priest did with the bull of the sin offering that he offered because of his own unintentional sin]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 4:20 (#5)

וְכִפֶּר עֲלֵהֶם הַכֹּהֵן

“And the priest shall make atonement for them”

The word translated as **atonement** may have originally indicated either the “covering” or the “wiping away” of sin. Either way, by the time of Leviticus it indicated that the sacrifice would be accepted in order to restore the relationship between the worshiper and Yahweh that had been damaged or defiled by sin. Consider using a word or phrase that conveys this idea effectively in your language. See how you translated the similar expression in 1:4. Alternate translation: [And the priest shall offer the sacrifice that Yahweh will accept on behalf of the people and restore them to relationship with himself]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 4:20 (#6)

וְנִסְלַח לָהֶם

“and it will be forgiven to them”

Here the pronoun **it** refers to the unintentional sin that the community committed that introduced the impurity of sin, which, in turn, required the purification provided by the sin sacrifice. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [and the unintentional sin of the community will be forgiven]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 4:20 (#7)

וְנִסְלַח לָהֶם

“and it will be forgiven to them”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh will forgive the community for their sins]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 4:20 (#4)

כַּאֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה לְפַר הַחַטָּאת

“just as he did with the bull of the sin offering”

Here, the author of Leviticus does not use the past tense to describe previous action, as if he were here referring to a specific past instance where the individual prepared a peace offering. Rather, the past tense is being used both to describe an action that was previously described in the book of Leviticus and to depict a hypothetical situation. If it would be helpful in your language, consider choosing language that makes it plain that the author is not referring to specific past actions. Alternate translation: [just as one might do with the bull of the sin offering]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Leviticus 4:21 (#1)

וְהוֹצִיא אֶת־הַפָּר

“And he shall bring out the bull”

As in 4:12, the pronoun **he** cannot refer to the priest making the sacrifice, because this action would cause the priest to become unclean. Rather, it refers to another, unspecified Israelite. If it would be helpful in your language, consider using a generic word for a person, as the UST models. Alternate translation: [And another person shall bring out the rest of the bull]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 4:21 (#2)

אֶת־הַפָּר

“the bull”

Because 4:20 instructs the community to prepare the bull in the same manner that the high priest prepared the bull for his sin offering (in 4:8–10), here **the bull** implies the pieces of the bull that are not burned on the altar, as listed in 4:11. If it would be helpful, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [the skin of the bull and all its flesh, with its head and with its legs and its innards and its dung]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 4:23 (#2)

אוֹ־הוֹדַע אֵלָיו חַטָּאתּוֹ אֲשֶׁר חָטָא בָּהּ

“or his sin that he sinned with it is made known to him”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [or he becomes aware of the sin that he sinned]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 4:23 (#3)

שְׂעִיר עִזִּים

“a buck of the goats”

The expression **a buck of the goats** refers to an adult male goat that belongs to the class of animals also called goats. If your language possesses a specific term for a male goat, consider using it here, or use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [a mature male goat]

See: Possession

Leviticus 4:23 (#1)

חַטָּאתּוֹ אֲשֶׁר חָטָא בָּהּ

“his sin that he sinned with it”

The expression **his sin that he has sinned with it** uses repetition for emphasis. If your language can use repetition for emphasis in this manner, consider using a similar expression here. If not, then consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [the sin that he committed]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 4:23 (#4)

עִזִּים

“the goats”

The expression **the goats** does not refer to a specific group of animals. Rather, it refers to any goats that an Israelite might own. If it would be helpful in your language, consider stating the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [any of the goats that he owns or can buy]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 4:24 (#1)

וְסָמַךְ יָדוֹ עַל־רֹאשׁ הַשָּׂעִיר

“And he shall lay his hand on the head of the buck”

See how you translated this symbolic action in 1:4.

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 4:24 (#2)

לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated this expression in 1:5.

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 4:26 (#1)

וְאֶת־כָּל־חֶלְבּוֹ

“And all of its fat”

The phrase **all of its fat** refers to the fat portions of the goat described in the laws for peace offerings in 3:14–15. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [And all of the goat’s fat, including the fat covering the innards, all the fat that is on the innards, the two kidneys, the fat that is on them that is by the loins, and the lobe on the liver]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 4:26 (#3)

וְכִפֶּר עָלָיו הַכֹּהֵן מֵחַטָּאתוֹ

“And the priest shall make atonement for him from his sin”

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:20. See how you handled the term **atonement** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 4:26 (#2)

כְּחֵלֶב זֶבַח הַשְּׁלָמִים

“like the fat of the sacrifice of the peace offerings”

The expression **like the fat of the sacrifice of the peace offerings** leaves out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation, without the preceding comma: [like he did with the fat of the sacrifice of the peace offerings]

See: Ellipsis

Leviticus 4:26 (#4)

וְנִסְלַח לוֹ

“and it will be forgiven to him”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh will forgive him]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 4:27 (#1)

מֵעַ֖ם הָאָ֥רֶץ

“from the people of the land”

Alternate translation: [from the common people who live in the land of Israel]

Leviticus 4:27 (#2)

בַּֽעֲשֹׂתָ֕הּ אַחַ֖ת מִמִּצְוֹ֣ת יְהוָ֑ה אֲשֶׁ֥ר לֹא־תֵעָשֶׂ֖ינָה

“by doing it, one {thing} from the commands of Yahweh that shall not be done”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [by doing one thing that Yahweh told the people not to do]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 4:28 (#1)

חַטָּאתֹ֥ו אֲשֶׁ֖ר חָטָ֑א & עַל־חַטָּאתֹ֥ו אֲשֶׁ֖ר חָטָֽא

“his sin that he sinned & for his sin that he sinned”

Here, words are being repeated for emphasis. See how you translated the similar phrase in 4:23.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 4:28 (#2)

הוֹדַ֥ע אֵלָ֛יו חַטָּאתֹ֥ו אֲשֶׁ֖ר חָטָ֑א

“his sin that he sinned is made known to him”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [he becomes aware of the sin that he sinned]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 4:28 (#3)

שְׂעִירַ֥ת עִזִּ֖ים

“a doe of the goats”

The expression **a doe of the goats** refers to an adult female goat that belongs to the class of animals also called goats. If your language possesses a specific term for such a female goat, consider using it here, or use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [a mature female goat] or [a she-goat]

See: Possession

Leviticus 4:31 (#3)

כַּאֲשֶׁ֣ר הוּסַ֗ר חֵ֚לֶב מֵעַ֣ל זֶ֣בַח הַשְּׁלָמִ֔ים

“just as the fat is removed from on the sacrifice of the peace offerings”

As in 4:10, the author of Leviticus does not use the present tense here to describe contemporaneous or ongoing action, as if he were here referring to a specific instance where an individual was preparing a peace offering. Rather, the present tense is being used both to describe an action that was previously described in the book of Leviticus and to depict a hypothetical situation. If it would be helpful in your language, consider choosing language that makes it plain that the author is not referring to specific past actions. Alternate translation: [in the same manner as the fat would be removed from the sacrifice of the peace offerings]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Leviticus 4:31 (#1)

וְהֵסִ֣יר

“he shall remove”

As in 4:20, here, **he** refers to the individual offering the sacrifice, not to the priest. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the person offering the sin offering shall remove]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 4:31 (#5)

וְנִסְלַ֥ח לֹ֖ו

“and it will be forgiven to him”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh will forgive his sin]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 4:31 (#2)

כַּאֲשֶׁ֣ר הוּסַ֗ר חֵ֚לֶב

“just as the fat is removed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [just as a person would remove the fat]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 4:31 (#4)

וְכִפֶּ֥ר עָלָ֛יו הַכֹּהֵ֖ן

“And the priest shall make atonement for him”

See how you handled this expression involving an abstract noun in 1:4 and 4:20.

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 4:33 (#1)

וְסָמַךְ֙ אֶת־יָד֔וֹ עַ֖ל רֹ֣אשׁ הַֽחַטָּ֑את

“And he shall lay his hand on the head of the sin offering”

See how you translated this symbolic action in 1:4.

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 4:34 (#1)

אֶל־יְסֹ֖וד הַמִּזְבֵּֽחַ

“at the base of the altar”

Although unspecified, it is likely that the **altar** mentioned here is the same **altar of the burnt offering** that is referred to in this verse, which is also the place where **the blood** of the sacrificial animal is poured out in the similar expressions in 4:7, 4:18, 4:25, and 4:30. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making the identity of the altar explicit, or using an identifying adjective, as the UST models. Alternate translation: [toward the base of the altar of the burnt offering]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 4:35 (#2)

וְהֵסִ֣יר

“he shall remove”

As in 4:31, here the pronoun **he** refers to the individual offering the sacrifice, not to the priest. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the person offering the sin offering shall remove]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 4:35 (#1)

וְאֶת־כָּל־חֶלְבָּ֗הּ

“And all of its fat”

As in 4:26 and 4:31, the phrase **all of its fat** implies the fat portions of the lamb described in the laws for peace offerings in 3:9–10. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [And all of the lamb’s fat, including the entire fatty tail, the fat covering the innards, all the fat that is on the innards, the two kidneys, the fat that is on them that is by the loins, and the lobe on the liver]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 4:35 (#3)

כַּאֲשֶׁ֣ר יוּסַ֗ר חֵ֚לֶב־הַכֶּ֣שֶׂב ׀ מִזֶּ֣בַח הַשְּׁלָמִ֔ים

“just as the fat of the lamb is removed from the sacrifice of the peace offerings”

As in 4:10, the author of Leviticus does not use the present tense here to describe contemporaneous or ongoing action, as if he were here referring to a specific instance where an individual was preparing a peace offering. Rather, the present tense is being used both to describe an action that was previously described in the book of Leviticus and to depict a hypothetical situation. If it would be helpful in your language, consider choosing language that makes it plain that the author is not referring to specific past actions. Alternate translation: [in the same manner as the fat of the lamb is removed from the sacrifice of the peace offerings]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Leviticus 4:35 (#6)

וְכִפֶּ֥ר עָלָ֛יו הַכֹּהֵ֖ן עַל־חַטָּאתֹ֑ו

“And the priest will make atonement for him for his sin”

See how you handled this expression involving an abstract noun in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 4:35 (#7)

וְנִסְלַ֥ח לֹֽו

“and it will be forgiven to him”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh will forgive the individual of his sin]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 4:35 (#5)

עַ֚ל אִשֵּׁ֣י יְהוָ֔ה

“above the gifts of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar possessive expressions in 2:3 and 2:10. Alternate translation: [on the sacrifices that people offer as gifts to Yahweh]

See: Possession

Leviticus 4:35 (#4)

כַּאֲשֶׁ֣ר יוּסַ֗ר חֵ֚לֶב־הַכֶּ֣שֶׂב ׀ מִזֶּ֣בַח הַשְּׁלָמִ֑ים

“just as the fat of the lamb is removed from the sacrifice of the peace offerings”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [just as a person who offers a lamb as a sacrifice of peace offerings removes the fat of that lamb]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus - Chapter 5 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

As discussed in the Leviticus 4 Chapter Introduction, because of the narrative framings in 4:1 and 5:14, Leviticus 4:1–5:12 should be taken as a discrete unit that is nonetheless connected to Leviticus 1–3 within the unit of Leviticus 1–7.

The word “And” in the first verse of Chapter 5 indicates that the following material should be read in continuity from Chapter 4. That being said, the phrase “And a person, when he sins” (5:1) is used to start a new series of hypothetical scenarios (as in 2:1) in which a person becomes guilty and is in need of a sacrifice to atone for their sin. In 5:1–13, the individual’s guilt requires him to offer a purification offering, as was the case in Chapter 4.

However, because of the reintroduction of the narrative framing where Yahweh speaks to Moses (see 5:14), the scenarios covered in 5:14–19 and continuing into 6:1–7 cover cases where the individual’s guilt requires him to offer a guilt offering. Whereas the purification offering was explained in the introduction to the previous chapter, the guilt offering is described below. The basic structure of this chapter is outlined as follows:

1. The Sin Offering (4:1–5:13)
2. scenario 1: guilt due to the failure to testify in court (5:1)
3. scenario 2: guilt due to unintentional contact with an unclean animal (5:2) or unintentional contact with human uncleanness (5:3)
4. scenario 3: guilt due to the failure to fulfill a rashly spoken vow (5:4)
5. the procedure for offering a Purification Offering (5:5–13)
6. The Guilt Offering (5:14–6:7)
7. scenario 1: a person breaks Yahweh’s commandments regarding holy objects
8. scenario 2: a person unintentionally breaks one of Yahweh’s commandments (5:17–19)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Several special concepts are crucial for understanding this chapter. They include (1) several instances of technical sacrificial terminology, especially the concept of “unclean,” the two-fold use of “guilt,” the guilt offering itself, and the concept of atonement, (2) the special provision of sacrifices accessible for the poor, and (3) instances of symbolic action, especially the sprinkling and application of blood.

Sacrificial terminology

First, several words or phrases in this chapter have a specialized meaning in the context of sacrifice. They include (1) the concept of “unclean” (the opposite of “clean” explained in the introduction to the previous chapter), (2) the two-fold use of the word “guilt,” and (3) the guilt offering itself, which occupies the instructions of the second half of this chapter.

(1) Unclean

The second scenario covered in this chapter by which someone incurs guilt and is therefore required to offer a purification offering (see 5:2–3) involves a situation in which someone touches something unclean (whether intentionally or unintentionally). For an object or body to be unclean means that it is unfit to enter into holy space or touch a holy object. In ancient Israel, this impurity was seen to pollute the holy space where Yahweh lived among the Israelites and could desecrate the sacred items that were consecrated to him. Consequently, anything impure or unclean was not allowed to enter sacred space or to touch anything clean. Furthermore, coming into contact with anything considered unclean or anything that had become unclean would result in the individual becoming unclean himself. (See also 11:24–25) In Leviticus 5:2–3, unclean bodies that would make an individual unclean upon contact include the unclean dead body of a wild animal or a domesticated animal (5:2), the dead body of

Leviticus - Chapter 5 Introduction

an unclean "swarming" or "creeping" animal (5:2), or the "uncleanness of a man" (5:3), that is, uncleanness that comes from a human source. A list of unclean animals is provided in 11:1–8, 11:19–23, and 11:26–31. Situations in which a person can become unclean through other means (perhaps the "uncleanness of a man" mentioned in 5:3) are listed in 11:32–38. The command not to eat or touch an unclean animal or the carcass of any animal (which has become unclean because it is dead) is reiterated in 11:39–47. Other ways in which a person could become unclean include birthing a child (see 12:1–8: a woman is unclean for seven days if she births a male and for fourteen days if she births a female), having a certain infection of the skin (see 13:1–3, 13: 7–8, 13:9–17, 13:18–23, and 13:24–46), touching a dead body (see 22:4), having a bodily secretion or discharge (15:1–3) including seminal emissions (15:16–18) and menstruation (15:19–27), and having contact with unclean furniture and beds (see 15:4–12). Garments with traces of skin diseases (see 13:47–59) or houses that have traces of skin diseases in the walls (see 14:33–53) are likewise unclean. The danger of being unclean in holy space is reiterated in 15:31–33, in which Yahweh warns that they must be careful to remain clean, lest they pollute the sanctuary with their uncleanness and die. By distinguishing between clean and unclean animals in this manner, Yahweh promises the people that they will remain the holy people of God; people who are dedicated and set apart for him. (See 20:22–26)

(2) The two-fold use of the word "guilt"

In this chapter, the word translated as "guilt" is used in two separate senses. In one sense, it refers to both the internal feeling of having committed wrongdoing and the legal state of being required to provide restitution for that wrongdoing, as explained in the introduction to the previous chapter. This sense uses both the verb "to become guilty" and the abstract noun "guilt." The second sense uses the abstract noun "guilt" to refer to the payment or restitution that a person offers to atone for their sins when they realize they have committed wrongdoing. Examples of this are seen in 5:6–7, 5:15, and 5:25, in which an individual or community is instructed to "bring their guilt" to Yahweh (that is, to the tent of meeting where Yahweh lived among the Israelites). This expression does not mean to bring their feelings of guilt to Yahweh but to bring the penalty for their guilt, that is, the animal required by the sacrifice to atone for their sin. This second sense is once used in full in 5:6 ("And he will bring his guilt to Yahweh for his sin that he sinned") and twice in an elided, shortened form. (See 5:7, "then he will bring his guilt that he sinned." See also 5:11, "then he will bring his offering that he sinned".)

(3) The guilt offering

Closely related to the sin offering, in which a person offered a sacrifice to cleanse or purify sacred space from the defiling impurity generated by unintentional sin, the guilt offering is a special sacrifice designed to restore and make restitution for sacred items that had become desecrated due to the defiling presence of an individual's sin. In one possible scenario, an individual trespasses a trespass, that is, he breaks one of Yahweh's commandments, by unintentionally sinning with regard to any holy object that has been dedicated for exclusive use in service to Yahweh (see 5:15–16). The second scenario addressed by this chapter covers any way by which a person unintentionally sins (and, presumably, defiles a sacred object, see 5:17–19). These scenarios required that the individual atone for their guilt in the form of an animal sacrifice (specifically, a male goat). He must provide restitution for the item that their sin desecrated, paying in the form of a carefully calculated amount of silver that had been weighed according to the measurements for silver that were used by the priests who handled the finances of the tent of meeting. In this way, the sacrifice both restored the individual to a right relationship with Yahweh through atoning for his sins and forgiving his guilt, and it also provided the means by which the sacred items in the tent of meeting could be reconsecrated, restored, or replaced.

Sacrifices for the poor

This chapter explains that Yahweh made special provisions for individuals who could not afford costly purification offerings (see 5:7–13). The author of Leviticus uses the expression "if his hand does not touch enough flock animals" (5:7) to describe an individual who cannot afford to offer their own bovine or flock animal or purchase others (as Chapter 4 prescribes). Likewise, the author of Leviticus uses a related expression "if his hand does not reach" (5:11) to describe an individual who cannot afford the four birds that could replace the expensive domesticated animals. Yahweh allows such individuals who cannot afford the bovine of flock animals prescribed for the purification offering in Chapter 4 to offer two turtledoves and two pigeons, bringing two of the birds for a purification offering and the other two for a burnt offering (see 5:7–10). However, if the individual cannot afford the four birds, they are allowed to bring a set amount of raw wheat flour as an acceptable substitute for the animal sacrifice (see 5:11–13). These provisions demonstrate the grace of God, who makes the forgiveness and

Leviticus - Chapter 5 Introduction

restoration of relationship with God that was provided through the sacrifices available to everyone, without excluding those who do not have the means to offer expensive sacrifices.

Restoring the cost of a sacred item with money
Because guilt offerings were designed to reconsecrate and restore sacred space and sacred items that were dedicated exclusively to Yahweh, the guilt offering required not only an animal sacrifice but also the restitution of the monetary value of whatever sacred item became defiled and unclean through the impurity brought about by the sin of the individual, whether intentional or unintentional. This monetary value was calculated in two ways. First, the value of the animal sacrifice (usually a male goat, see 5:15 and 5:18) would be calculated according to the measurements for silver used by the priests who operated the finances of the sanctuary. This is expressed by the phrase "in your valuation, silver shekels, in the shekel of the holy place" (5:15, see also the expression "in your valuation" in 5:18). Second, the individual is required to calculate the monetary value of whatever sacred item had been desecrated or defiled by their sin and bring that amount, plus one-fifth of that value, to the priests in the form of silver, again (presumably) calculated according to the measurements for silver used by the priests who operated the finances of the sanctuary. (See 5:16) This process results in the restitution of 120% of the monetary value of whatever had been defiled, along with the monetary value of the male goat that was sacrificed for the guilt offering. In this way, the individual provided for the replacement of the object that their sin desecrated.

Ritual action
This chapter, much like Leviticus 1, includes the ritual action of splashing or sprinkling the blood of the animal on the altar. Neither the laws regarding the purification offering (which continue in the present chapter from the previous chapter) nor the laws regarding the guilt offering (5:14–19) are unique in the lack of mentions of blood. This, however, does not mean that blood was unimportant in the sacrificial process. Whereas in Leviticus 1 and 3, the blood is "splashed" or "splattered" against the side of the altar (see 1:5, 1:11, 3:2, 3:8, and 3:13), Leviticus 4 makes it clear that the purification offering required that the blood would be "sprinkled" towards the curtain that divided the courtyard of the tent of meeting from the Holy of Holies (see 4:6 and 4:17), "put" on the horns of either the incense altar or the altar of the burnt offerings (see 4:7, 4:18, 4:25, 4:30, and 4:34), or "poured out" at the base of the altar of burnt offerings (see 4:7, 4:18, 4:25, 4:30, and 4:34). In the case of birds, the blood is "drained out" or "squeezed out" on either the side of the altar (see 1:15) or on the base of the altar (see 5:9). This was likely the case in the animal sacrifices described in Leviticus 5. As explained in previous chapters, the blood, being the life of the animal (see 17:11), was given by God to ritually purify, cleanse, and remove the defiling impurity brought about by the presence of sin, even unintentional sin. In this chapter, the blood acts as a ritual detergent or soap with the special ability to cleanse sacred objects and sacred spaces from the impurity of sin.

Important Figures of Speech in This Chapter

This chapter includes several figures of speech that may prove difficult to translate but are important to understanding the chapter.

"If his hand does not touch" or "If his hand does not reach"
As previously discussed, the author of Leviticus uses the expression "if his hand does not touch enough flock animals" (5:7) to describe an individual who cannot afford to offer their own bovine or flock animal or purchase others (as Leviticus 4 prescribes). Likewise, the author of Leviticus uses a related expression, "if his hand does not reach," (5:11) to describe an individual who cannot afford the four birds that could replace the expensive domesticated animals. If such an expression would not be clear in your language, use whatever expression would be clearest to your readers. Alternate translations will be provided in the following notes where the expressions appear.

Other Possible Translation Difficulties in This Chapter

In addition to these important figures of speech, this chapter features several translation difficulties, including:

1. the unclear referent of masculine pronouns
2. the switching between second and third-person address
3. the use of a verb and a related noun (cognate-accusatives)
4. the use of a future form to indicate a request or command
5. the use of specific, technical sacrificial language.

The referent of the masculine pronouns
Throughout this chapter, the author of Leviticus uses a third-person pronoun to refer to both the individual who offers the sacrifices and to "the priest" who performs the sacrifice. As such, it is often difficult (but not impossible) to infer which party performs which

actions. In general, the sacrifice is presented to the priest, but the individual who presents the sacrifice is responsible for killing, properly butchering, and presenting the portions of the sacrificial animal to the priest, who will then arrange them on the altar's fire. The UST will indicate which party is the apparent referent of the pronoun.

Second and third-person address
All of Leviticus 1 through 7 is written as direct address to the people of God through Moses. Because in this chapter the words "his" and "he" refer to the person bringing an offering to Yahweh, those terms can be translated in the second person as it is in 1:2 and as the UST models or they can be translated in the third person, as the ULT models. In the present chapter, the author of Leviticus consistently uses third-person forms to refer to the individual who offers the sacrifices described. Despite this, we recommend that you continue to use whichever forms and pronouns you have been using in the previous two chapters, even if that means continuing to use second-person forms.

The use of a verb with a related noun (cognate-accusatives)
For emphasis, the author of Leviticus often uses a verb with a related noun. In this chapter, several expressions follow this pattern, including the expression "the sin that he sinned" (see 5:6, 5:10, and 5:13), the expression "the uncleanness that a person becomes unclean with it" (5:3), the expression "to grab ... the fullness of a handful" (5:12), the expression "to trespass a trespass" (5:18), and the expression "the mistake that he mistook" (5:18). If your language can repeat words for emphasis, it would be appropriate in this context to repeat the words in these expressions in a similar manner whenever the relevant expressions occur.

The use of a future form to indicate a request or command
The writer of Leviticus will often use the future form "you shall" to give an instruction or command. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate these words using a command or instruction form.

The use of specific, technical sacrificial terminology
See above the sections on "Sacrificial terminology" and "Ritual actions."

Leviticus 5:1 (#1)

קְקוֹל אָלָ֔ה

"the sound of a {judge's} curse"

The sound of a curse is an idiom that refers to a public call for someone who can bear witness to a crime to come forward. The call includes a curse on any person who was a witness to the crime but refuses to testify about it. (See the parallel text in Proverbs 29:24) Alternate translation: [the call for a witness to swear to what he knows about a crime]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 5:1 (#2)

וְנָשָׂ֥א עֲוֹנֹֽו

"then he shall bear his iniquity"

The expression **he shall bear his iniquity** refers to being responsible to make restitution for the guilt acquired by an individual's wrongdoing, whether intentional or unintentional. If your language has a similar idiom, consider using it here. If not, consider stating the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he must make a guilt offering]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 5:2 (#6)

וְנֶעְלַ֥ם מִמֶּ֖נּוּ וְהוּא֙ טָמֵ֣א וְאָשֵֽׁם

"and it is hidden from him, then he {is} unclean and he will be guilty"

The author of Leviticus is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from verses 3 and 4 if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and it is hidden from him, when he knows, then he is unclean and he will be guilty]

See: Ellipsis

Leviticus 5:2 (#4)

בְּנִבְלַ֣ת שֶׁ֔רֶץ טָמֵ֖א

"the carcass of an unclean creeping animal"

The expression **the carcass of an unclean creeping animal** does not refer to a specific animal. Rather, it describes the carcass of any animal that creeps on the ground, including winged, swarming insects, mice, rats, and lizards. (See 11:20–23 and 11:24–29 for the full list of these animals.) Express this in the way that would be most natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the carcass of any unclean animal that creeps or swarms on the ground]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 5:2 (#1)

טָמֵא & טְמֵאָה & טְמֵאָה & טָמֵא & טָמֵא

“unclean & unclean & unclean & unclean & is} unclean”

For an object or body to be **unclean** implies that it has acquired impurity through its perceived proximity to death. In ancient Israel, this impurity was seen to pollute the holy space where Yahweh lived among the Israelites and could desecrate the sacred items that were consecrated to him. Consequently, anything impure or unclean was not allowed to enter the sacred space or touch anything clean or holy. If your language has a similar word, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic term. Alternate translation: [polluted ... polluted ... polluted ... polluted ... is polluted himself]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 5:2 (#2)

בְּנִבְלַ֥ת חַיָּ֖ה טְמֵאָ֑ה

“the unclean carcass of an animal”

The expression **the unclean carcass of an animal** does not refer to the body of a specific animal. Rather, it describes the carcass of any wild animal that an Israelite might encounter. Express this in the way that would be most natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the dead body of any wild animal]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 5:2 (#3)

בְּנִבְלַ֤ת בְּהֵמָה֙ טְמֵאָ֔ה

“the unclean carcass of livestock”

The expression **the unclean carcass of livestock** does not refer to a the body of a specific animal. Rather, it describes the carcass of any domesticated animal that an Israelite might own. Express this in the way that would be most natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the unclean carcass of any livestock]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 5:2 (#5)

וְנֶעְלַ֥ם מִמֶּ֖נּוּ

“and it is hidden from him”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and he does not realize that he touched something unclean]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 5:2 (#7)

וְאָשֵֽׁם

“and he will be guilty”

Here, to be **guilty** implies both to feel the internal sense of having done wrong and to enter into a legal state of needing to make reparations for wrongdoing, whether intentional or unintentional. As the Introduction to the chapter discusses, this kind of guilt resulted in the need for the guilt offering, by which a person atoned for himself and made reparation for the impurity that he brought into the sacred space by his wrongdoing. Alternate translation: [and he needs to make reparations for his wrongdoing]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 5:3 (#6)

וְנֶעְלַ֥ם מִמֶּ֖נּוּ

“and it is hidden from him”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and he does not realize it] or [and he does not know about it]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 5:3 (#1)

אוֹ֩ כִֽי־יִגַּ֨ע בְּטֻמְאַ֜ת אָדָ֗ם

“Or when he touches the uncleanness of a man”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **uncleanness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [Or if he touches another human body in such a way that he himself becomes polluted]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 5:3 (#2)

בְּטֻמְאַ֜ת אָדָ֗ם

“the uncleanness of a man”

The expression **the uncleanness of a man** uses the possessive form to refer to the uncleanness that is acquired from a human source. Alternate translation: [the uncleanness that comes from a person]

See: Possession

Leviticus 5:3 (#3)

לְכֹל֙ טֻמְאָתוֹ֔ אֲשֶׁ֥ר יִטְמָ֖א בָּהֵ֑ה

“with regard to all of his uncleanness that he becomes unclean with it”

Here a verb and its object come from the same root. The phrase **he becomes unclean** translates a verb that is related to the noun translated as **uncleanness**. The repetition of related words adds emphasis to the statement. If your language can repeat words for emphasis and your language has comparable terms that you can use in your own translation, it would be appropriate to use that construction here in your translation.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 5:3 (#5)

לְכֹל֙ טֻמְאָתוֹ֔

“with regard to all of his uncleanness”

The pronoun **his** refers to the **man** mentioned earlier in the verse, which, although masculine, has a generic sense that refers to any human being, whether living or dead. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [with regard to any uncleanness that comes from a human being, whether living or dead]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 5:3 (#4)

לְכֹל֙ טֻמְאָתוֹ֔ אֲשֶׁ֥ר יִטְמָ֖א בָּהֵ֑ה

“with regard to all of his uncleanness that he becomes unclean with it”

Alternate translation: [with regard to all of a person’s sins by which he sins]

Leviticus 5:4 (#4)

וְנֶעְלַ֥ם מִמֶּ֖נּוּ

“and it is hidden from him”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and he does not realize it] or [and he does not know about it]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 5:4 (#2)

לְבַטֵּ֖א בִּשְׂפָתַ֑יִם

“by speaking thoughtlessly with two lips”

Here, **with two lips** refers to the words that the person speaks with his lips. Alternate translation: [by speaking rashly with their words]

See: Synecdoche

Leviticus 5:4 (#3)

לְכֹ֣ל אֲשֶׁ֣ר יְבַטֵּ֣א הָאָדָ֔ם בִּשְׁבֻעָ֖ה

“with regard to everything that the man thoughtlessly speaks in an oath”

Although the word **man** is masculine, it has a generic sense that refers to any person who speaks rashly while swearing an oath. If your language has a generic word for an individual that is grammatically feminine, consider using it here, or use a generic noun. Alternate translation: [with regard to everything that a person speaks rashly in an oath]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Leviticus 5:4 (#5)

לְאַחַ֥ת מֵאֵ֖לֶּה

“with regard to one from these {things”

The writer assumes that his readers will understand that the phrase **from these things** refers to the ways of sinning unintentionally, as described in 5:1–4. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [because of speaking thoughtlessly when swearing an oath, whether to do evil or to do good]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 5:4 (#1)

נֶ֣פֶשׁ כִּֽי תִשָּׁבַ֣ע ׀ לְבַטֵּ֣א בִשְׂפָתַ֗יִם לְהָרַ֙ע֙ ׀ א֣וֹ לְהֵיטִ֔יב

“a person, when he swears {an oath} by speaking thoughtlessly with two lips to do evil or to do good”

Here, **speaking thoughtlessly with two lips to do evil or to do good** implies that after the person **swears** the oath, he either cannot fulfill it or he chooses not to fulfill it. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [a person hastily swears an oath without the intention to do what he promised, whether to do evil or to do good]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 5:5 (#1)

וְהִתְוַדָּ֖ה אֲשֶׁ֣ר חָטָ֥א עָלֶֽיהָ

“then he shall confess that he sinned regarding it”

As in 4:14, the phrase **regarding it** refers to the commands of Yahweh mentioned in 4:13. If it would be helpful, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [then he shall confess that he sinned with regard to the commands of Yahweh]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 5:6 (#2)

וְהֵבִ֤יא אֶת־אֲשָׁמ֙וֹ֙ לַיהוָ֔ה

“And he shall bring his guilt to Yahweh”

Here Leviticus seems to be referring to the sacrifice as **his guilt** by association with the way that it is required to atone for the person’s guilt. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [then he shall bring the sacrifice required to make restitution for his guilt]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 5:6 (#1)

וְהֵבִ֤יא אֶת־אֲשָׁמ֙וֹ֙ לַיהוָ֔ה

“And he shall bring his guilt to Yahweh”

Here, **his guilt** does not refer to the legal status of guilt that it did in 5:2–5. Rather, it refers to the required penalty for that person’s guilt, that is, the animal sacrifice that will provide atonement for the individual’s guilt that he acquired by sinning unintentionally. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [And he must present to Yahweh the required sacrifice]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 5:6 (#3)

חַטָּאתוֹ֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר חָטָ֔א

“his sin that he sinned”

Here words are being repeated for emphasis. See how you translated the similar phrase in 4:23 and 4:28.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 5:6 (#4)

שְׂעִירַ֥ת עִזִּ֖ים

“a kid of the goats”

Here, a **kid** means a young goat. If your language has a specific word for the young of this particular animal group, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [a young goat]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 5:6 (#5)

וְכִפֶּ֥ר עָלָ֛יו הַכֹּהֵ֖ן

“And the priest shall make atonement for him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 5:7 (#1)

וְאִם־לֹ֤א תַגִּ֙יעַ יָד֔וֹ דֵּ֖י שֶׂ֑ה

“But if his hand does not reach the sufficiency of a sheep”

The expression **his hand does not reach** is an idiom that refers to being unable to afford to offer an animal from one’s own flock or to purchase another’s flock animal. If your language has a similar idiomatic expression, consider using it here. Otherwise, if it would be helpful in your language, consider stating the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [But if he is unable to offer his own flock animal or to purchase someone else’s animal]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 5:7 (#3)

בְּנֵ֥י־יוֹנָ֖ה

“sons of a pigeon”

See how you translated the similar terms in 1:14.

See: Idiom

Leviticus 5:7 (#2)

וְהֵבִ֤יא אֶת־אֲשָׁמ֙וֹ֙

“then he shall bring his guilt offering”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:6.

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 5:10 (#1)

כַּמִּשְׁפָּ֑ט

“according to the regulation”

The phrase **according to the regulation** refers to the commandments and laws of Yahweh given to

the people of Israel, likely the regulations for burnt offerings that Yahweh gave, which are recorded in the first chapter of Leviticus. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [according to the laws for burnt offerings that Yahweh gave to the people of Israel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 5:10 (#2)

וְכִפֶּ֥ר עָלָ֛יו הַכֹּהֵ֖ן מֵחַטָּאתֹ֑ו

“And the priest shall make atonement for him from his sin”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 5:10 (#3)

מֵחַטָּאתֹ֥ו אֲשֶׁר־חָטָ֖א

“from his sin that he sinned”

See how you handled the poetic repetition of words in the similar expression in 5:6.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 5:10 (#4)

וְנִסְלַ֥ח לֹֽו

“and it will be forgiven to him”

Alternate translation: [and Yahweh will forgive him for his sin]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 5:11 (#1)

וְאִם־לֹ֣א תַשִּׂ֗יג יָדֹו֙ לִשְׁתֵּ֣י תֹרִ֔ים אֹו֙ לִשְׁנֵ֣י בְנֵי־יֹונָ֔ה

“But if his hand does not reach two doves or two sons of a pigeon”

Like the similar expression in 5:7, the phrase **if his hand does not reach** is an idiom that refers to being unable to afford to purchase one of these kinds of birds for a sacrifice. If your language has a similar idiomatic expression, consider using it here. Otherwise, if it would be helpful in your language, consider stating the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [But if he is unable to purchase two turtledoves or two sons of a pigeon for his offering]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 5:11 (#3)

וְהֵבִ֗יא אֶת־קָרְבָּנֹו֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר חָטָ֔א

“then he shall bring his offering that he sinned”

As in 5:7, the expression **his offering that he sinned** is an abbreviated form of the similar phrase found in 5:6 and leaves out some words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. If it would be helpful, you could supply the missing words from 5:6. Alternate translation: [then he shall bring his offering for his sin that he sinned]

See: Ellipsis

Leviticus 5:11 (#4)

עֲשִׂירִ֥ת הָאֵפָ֖ה סֹ֑לֶת

“a tenth of an ephah of flour”

An **ephah** is an ancient measurement of volume equivalent to approximately 22.8 liters. Consequently, a **tenth of an ephah** is a little more than two liters. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the equivalent modern measurement in your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [about two liters of flour]

See: Biblical Volume

Leviticus 5:11 (#2)

בְּנֵי־יֹונָ֖ה

“sons of a pigeon”

See how you translated these terms in 1:14.

See: Idiom

Leviticus 5:11 (#6)

כִּ֥י חַטָּ֖את הִֽיא

“for it {is} a sin offering”

The word **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation, with a period preceding: [This is because this flour is being offered as a sin offering]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 5:11 (#5)

עֲשִׂירִ֥ת

“a tenth of”

A **tenth** is one part out of ten equal parts.

See: Fractions

Leviticus 5:12 (#2)

וְקָמַץ הַכֹּהֵן ׀ מִמֶּנָּה מְלֹא֣וֹ קֶמְצֹ֗ו

“and the priest shall grab from it, {with} the fullness of his handful”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:2.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 5:12 (#1)

וְהֵבִיאָהּ֙

“And he shall bring it”

The pronoun **it** refers to the tenth of an ephah of flour mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [And he shall bring the tenth of an ephah of flour]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 5:13 (#2)

עַל־חַטָּאתֹ֥ו אֲשֶׁר־חָטָ֖א

“for his sin that he sinned”

See how you translated these poetically repeated terms in 4:27 and 4:35 and the similar expression in 5:6.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 5:13 (#1)

וְכִפֶּ֤ר עָלָיו֙ הַכֹּהֵ֔ן

“And the priest shall make atonement for him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 5:13 (#3)

מֵאַחַ֣ת מֵאֵ֑לֶּה

“from one of these”

The expression **from one from these** refers to the commandments of Yahweh which the individual sinned and violated in the ways described in 5:1–4. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [with regard to one of these ways of violating Yahweh’s commandments about how a person can unintentionally become guilty]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 5:13 (#5)

וְהָיְתָ֥ה לַכֹּהֵ֖ן

“And it shall be for the priest”

The expression **it will be for the priest** implies that the portion of the tenth of an ephah of flour that is not burned as part of the memorial portion (as described in 5:12) should be given as food to the priest performing the sacrifice, just as is the case with the portion of the **grain offering** that is not burnt as part of the memorial portion. Alternate translation: [And the remaining portion of the flour that was not burned as part of the memorial portion shall belong to the priest as his food]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 5:13 (#4)

וְנִסְלַ֥ח לֹ֛ו

“and it will be forgiven to him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:20. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh will forgive him for his sins]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 5:14 (#1)

לֵאמֹֽר

“saying”

The word translated as **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, consider ways in which you might introduce this quotation naturally in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Leviticus 5:15 (#1)

תִּמְעֹ֥ל מַעַ֖ל

“he trespasses a trespass”

Here, a verb and its object come from the same root. The phrase **he trespasses** translates a verb that is related to the noun translated as **trespass**. The repetition of related words adds emphasis to the statement. If your language can repeat words for emphasis and your language has comparable terms that you can use in your own translation, it would be appropriate to use that construction here in your translation.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 5:15 (#2)

וְחָטְאָה֙ בִּשְׁגָגָ֔ה מִקָּדְשֵׁ֖י יְהוָ֑ה

“and he sins by mistake from the holy {things} of Yahweh”

The expression **sins by mistake from the holy things of Yahweh** implies unintentionally violation of Yahweh’s commands regarding the proper treatment of the sacred space and the sacred objects related to the worship of Yahweh. If it would be helpful, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [and he sins by mistake with regard to Yahweh’s commandments about how to behave in the sacred space and handle the sacred objects consecrated to Yahweh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 5:15 (#7)

בְּעֶרְכְּךָ֨

“in your valuation”

The expression **in your valuation** refers to the process of determining the monetary value of the ram described in this verse through the use of weights, using **the shekel of the holy place** as a base measurement. If it would be helpful in your language, consider stating this plainly. Alternate translation: [along with your assessment of the value of the ram in silver]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 5:15 (#9)

בְּעֶרְכְּךָ֨ כֶּ֤סֶף־שְׁקָלִים֙ בְּשֶׁ֣קֶל־הַקֹּ֔דֶשׁ

“in your valuation, silver shekels, in the shekel of the Holy {Place”

The **silver shekel** that was used in **the holy place** was an ancient measurement of the weight of silver that functioned as a currency, equivalent to approximately 10 grams or two-fifths of an ounce of silver. You could try to express this amount in terms of the current monetary value of silver, but that might cause your translation to become outdated and inaccurate since those values can change over time. Instead, consider using a generic phrase. Alternate translation: [in your valuation, the standard weight of silver that is used by the priests in the holy place]

See: Biblical Money

Leviticus 5:15 (#5)

וְהֵבִיא֙ אֶת־אֲשָׁמ֔וֹ

“then he shall bring his guilt”

Here Leviticus is referring to the sacrifice as **his guilt** by association with the way that the sacrifice is required to atone for the person’s guilt. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [then he shall bring the sacrifice required to seek atonement for his guilt]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 5:15 (#6)

מִן־הַצֹּ֑אן

“from the flock”

See how you translated this expression in 5:6.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 5:15 (#3)

וְחָטְאָה֙ בִּשְׁגָגָ֔ה

“and he sins by mistake”

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:2.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 5:15 (#4)

וְהֵבִיא֙ אֶת־אֲשָׁמ֔וֹ לַיהוָ֖ה

“then he shall bring his guilt to Yahweh”

Here, to **bring** the required sacrifice **to Yahweh** implies transporting the sacrifice to the altar that is located at the entrance of the tent of meeting, as described with the other sacrificial processes in the previous chapters. Because the tent of meeting was where Yahweh lived among the Israelites, taking the offering to the altar is considered the same as bringing it directly to Yahweh himself. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [then he shall bring his guilt to the altar that is located inside the tent of meeting, where Yahweh lives among the Israelites]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 5:15 (#8)

בְּעֶרְכְּךָ֨

“in your valuation”

Even though Yahweh is speaking to a group of people, the pronoun **you** is singular in this verse. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Leviticus 5:16 (#9)

וְנִסְלַח לוֹ

“and it will be forgiven to him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:20. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh will forgive him]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 5:16 (#2)

וְאֵת אֲשֶׁר־חָטָא

“And that which he sinned”

Alternate translation: [And whatever item that he desecrated by mishandling it]

Leviticus 5:16 (#4)

וְאֶת־חֲמִישִׁתוֹ יוֹסֵף עָלָיו

“and a fifth of it he shall add to it”

Here, the pronoun **it** refers to **that which he sinned**. However, the expressions **a fifth of it** and **he will add to it** do not refer to the addition of a physical portion of the sacred object. Rather, these expressions refer to the item’s monetary value. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [and a fifth of the value of the sacred object he shall add to the value of that object]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 5:16 (#6)

וְנָתַן אֹתוֹ

“and he shall give it”

The pronoun **it** refers to the monetary sum of the value of the sacred item plus **a fifth of it**, resulting in 120% of the value of the original item. Alternate translation, with a comma after: [and he shall give the value of the sacred object plus a fifth of its value]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 5:16 (#1)

וְאֵת אֲשֶׁר־חָטָא מִן־הַקֹּדֶשׁ יְשַׁלֵּם

“And that which he sinned from the holy {thing} he shall restore”

The expression **he shall restore** does not mean that the guilty individual must physically replace the desecrated object in the sacred tent. Rather, the expression implies the process of bringing the monetary value of the object in silver (in addition to one-fifth of its value) to the priest as part of the sacrifice. Be sure that this distinction is clear in your translation. Alternate translation: [And he shall make restitution for that which he sinned]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 5:16 (#3)

מִן־הַקֹּדֶשׁ

“from the holy {thing”

The expression **from the holy thing** implies the sacred items that are consecrated to Yahweh for special use in the sacred tent. If it would be helpful, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [regarding the sacred items that are consecrated to Yahweh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 5:16 (#7)

וְהַכֹּהֵן יְכַפֵּר עָלָיו

“And the priest shall make atonement for him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 5:16 (#8)

בְּאֵיל הָאָשָׁם

“with the ram of the guilt offering”

Here, the expression **the ram of the guilt offering** uses the possessive form to describe a **ram** that is characterized by its use as a **guilt offering**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could state the meaning generically. Alternate translation: [with the ram that the individual offers as a guilt offering]

See: Possession

Leviticus 5:16 (#5)

וְאֶת־חֲמִישִׁתוֹ

“and a fifth of it”

The **fifth** is one part out of five equal parts.

See: Fractions

Leviticus 5:17 (#1)

וְאָשֵׁם

“then he becomes guilty”

See how you translated this expression in 5:2.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 5:18 (#3)

וְהוּא לֹא־יָדַע

“but he himself did not know”

This phrase is a parenthetical aside that functions to provide essential background information for the current thought. That the individual **himself did not know** clarifies that he has done wrong without being aware of it, as opposed to flagrantly defying Yahweh’s commandments (that is, the “sin with a high hand”). Alternate translation: [but he was unaware]

See: Background Information

Leviticus 5:18 (#2)

עַל שְׁגִגָתוֹ אֲשֶׁר־שָׁגָגָ

“for his mistake that he mistook”

Here, a verb and its object come from the same root. The phrase **he mistook** translates a verb that is related to the noun translated as **mistake**. The repetition of related words adds emphasis to the statement. If your language can repeat words for emphasis and your language has comparable terms that you can use in your own translation, it would be appropriate to use that construction here in your translation. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [for his unintentional mistake]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 5:18 (#1)

וְכִפֶּר עָלָיו הַכֹּהֵן

“And the priest shall make atonement for him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 5:18 (#4)

וְהוּא לֹא־יָדַע

“but he himself did not know”

This expression uses the reflexive pronoun **himself** to emphasize how significant it was that the person who previously was unaware of his unintentional sin has now come to realize what he has done. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this significance. Alternate translation: [but even he did not know]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Leviticus 5:18 (#5)

וְנִסְלַח לוֹ

“and it will be forgiven to him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:20. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh will forgive him for his sin]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 5:19 (#1)

אָשֹׁם אָשַׁם לַיהוָה

“being guilty, he is guilty to Yahweh”

The expression **being guilty, he is guilty** translates a verb that is repeated for emphasis. If your language can repeat words for emphasis, it would be appropriate to use that construction here in your translation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh certainly considers him guilty]

See: Reduplication

Leviticus - Chapter 6 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Although this chapter starts with a reiteration of Yahweh speaking to Moses, reinforcing the narrative framing of the book, the laws of 6:1–7 continue the instructions for hypothetical scenarios in which someone would need to offer a guilt offering. In this way, the first seven verses are a continuation of 5:14–18, offering the third of three hypothetical scenarios in which a guilt offering is required (the first two being described in 5:14–18).

However, the next reiteration of Yahweh speaking to Moses in 6:8 starts a new section that addresses the priests for how they should handle particular details of the burnt offering (6:9–13) and the grain offering (6:14–18).

Another reiteration of Yahweh speaking to Moses is included in 6:19, which begins a new section describing the prescribed offering for the priests on the day of their being anointed as priests to Yahweh (6:19–23).

A final reiteration of Yahweh speaking to Moses is introduced in 6:24, which addresses the priests for how they should handle particular details of the purification offering (6:24–30). These instructions then continue into Chapter 7, which is likewise addressed to the priests. To put this outline in bullet points, the chapter can be detailed as follows:

1. The guilt offering (5:14–6:7)

Leviticus - Chapter 6 Introduction

2. scenario 3: guilt due to a person "denying" a fellow Israelite (6:1–7)
3. The administrative instructions for priests (6:8–7:21)
4. The priests' instructions for the burnt offering (6:8–13)
5. The priests' instructions for the grain offering (6:14–18)
6. The priests' offering on the day of anointing (6:19–23)
7. The priests' Instruction for the purification offering (6:24–30)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The scenarios for a guilt offering in this chapter (6:1–7)

The beginning of this chapter explains several hypothetical scenarios in which people may act in such a way that they incur guilt (and thereby "impurity"). Each of the following describes a way an Israelite might "trespass a trespass against Yahweh" (6:2). The scenarios are:

(1) a person "denies" his "fellow citizen" with either a "deposit" or with "a pledge of a hand" (6:2). This expression uses an idiom that refers to the actions whereby someone swears a socially binding oath with a member of their family or clan and commits himself or herself to certain actions regarding the other person but afterward fails to behave in accordance with the stipulations of the oath. The expression "a pledge of a hand" refers to a physical item that is given from one member of a community to another. This item would commit the individual who received it to carry out the stipulations of the oath.

(2) a person "extorts his fellow citizen" (6:2), likely by refusing to pay an employee his or her wages, or one member of a party willfully withholding a previously agreed-upon amount of money from the other. If this is not clear in your language, consider stating the meaning plainly.

(3) a person finds some item that another Israelite has lost but then denies having found it in order to keep the item for himself (6:3).

(4) a person takes an oath with another person deceitfully, that is, with the intention not to carry out the required actions of the oath (6:3).

"Fellow citizen"

The expression "fellow citizen" is used several times in this chapter to refer to a fellow Israelite, possibly one within the larger familial or clan network of relationships within the people of Israel. The expression translates a single Hebrew word and emphasizes the closeness of the relationship between two persons who are "fellow citizens." While the ancient world did not know national "citizenship" in a modern sense (as in "I am a citizen of the United States of America"), the term does carry the sense of marking an individual by their relationship to a larger body of people (hence the word "citizen").

Guilt

In this chapter, the word translated as "guilt" is used is two separate senses. In one sense, it refers to both the internal feeling of having committed wrongdoing and the legal state of being required to provide restitution for that wrongdoing. An example of this sense is found in 6:5, in which the expression "the day of his guilt" refers to the moment in which a person incurs legal guilt. This sense uses both the verb "to become guilty" and the abstract noun "guilt." The second sense uses the abstract noun "guilt" to refer to the payment or restitution that a person offers to atone for their sins when they realize they have committed wrongdoing. An example of this is seen in 6:6, in which an individual is instructed to "bring his guilt" to Yahweh (that is, to the tent of meeting where Yahweh lived among the Israelites). This expression does not mean to bring their feelings of guilt to Yahweh but to bring the penalty for their guilt, that is, the animal that the sacrifice to atone for their sin requires.

The "clean place" (6:11)

In Leviticus 6, Yahweh instructs the people that the portions of the sacrificial animal that are not burned completely on the altar for a guilt offering must be brought outside the camp of the people to a clean place (6:11). The adjective translated as "clean" does not refer to a location that is physically free of dirt (as one might describe a freshly washed dish). Rather, in the context of sacrifices, the word "clean" refers to a person, animal, or object that has been kept separated from the defiling presence of sin and is fit to be used for sacred purposes or enter into sacred space. Portions of an animal that were used in sacrifices to purify a person, place, or object from the impurity of sins may have been considered to absorb the defiling sin, so to speak. As such, contact with these portions, once they had absorbed the impurity brought about by sin, may have been thought to make an individual impure or ceremonially unclean. Consequently, the location where the rest of the sacrificial animal was burned needed to be ceremonially clean in this way so that the potentially defiling presence of the sacrificial animal's corpse could be properly disposed of and so

that the camp itself did not become ceremonially unclean by virtue of its proximity to an 'unclean' location.

Important Figures of Speech in This Chapter

"This is the law of"
In several places in this chapter, the expression "this is the law of ..." uses the possessive form to describe instructions that are characterized by their relationship to a particular sacrifice or offering. (See, for example, 6:9, 6:14, and 6:25) If your language would not use the possessive form for this, consider stating the meaning plainly, as the notes below will suggest.

Other Possible Translation Difficulties in This Chapter

The use of a verb with a related noun (Cognate-accusatives)
For emphasis, the author of Leviticus often uses a verb with a related noun. In this chapter, several expressions follow this pattern, including "trespasses a trespass" (6:2), the "robbery that he robbed" (6:4), and "the deposit that was deposited with him" (6:4).

Leviticus 6:1 (#1)

לֵאמֹֽר

"saying"

The word translated as **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, consider ways in which you might introduce this quotation naturally in your language. Alternate translation, following a period instead of the comma: [Yahweh said]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Leviticus 6:2 (#4)

אוֹ־בִתְשׂוּמֶ֥ת יָ֖ד

"or with a pledge of a hand"

The expression **a pledge of a hand** refers to a physical item that is given from one member of a community to another. This item would commit the individual who received it to carry out the stipulations of the oath. Alternate translation: [or with a physical item that served as a reminder of the terms of the oath made between them]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 6:2 (#1)

וּמָעֲלָ֥ה מַ֖עַל

"and he trespasses a trespass"

See how you translated the similar expression using repeated words in 5:15.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 6:2 (#2)

וְכִחֵ֥שׁ בַּעֲמִיתֹ֖ו

"and he denies his fellow citizen"

As the Introduction to this chapter discusses, in the context of 6:2–3, the expression **denies his fellow citizen** is an idiom that refers to the actions whereby someone swears a socially-binding oath with a member of their family or clan and commits himself or herself to certain actions regarding the other person but afterward fails to behave in accordance with the stipulations of the oath. This could be done by stealing from the other individual, extorting them out of wages or any owed money, finding something that belongs to the other individual but failing to return it, or any other way of proving that the original oath was taken without intent to abide by it honestly. If the idiom here does not communicate this meaning in your language, consider using a more general expression. Alternate translation: [and he acts in such a way that he breaks an oath that he made with his fellow citizen]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 6:2 (#3)

בְּפִקָּדֹ֔ון

"with a deposit"

This **deposit** refers to either (1) a monetary down payment that served to guarantee the full payment of a larger amount. Alternate translation: [with a down payment on a larger owed sum] or (2) an item that was given from one individual to another for safekeeping. Alternate translation: [with an item given to him for safekeeping]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 6:2 (#6)

אֹ֥ו עָשַׁ֖ק אֶת־עֲמִיתֹֽו

"or he extorts his fellow citizen"

Alternate translation: [or he refuses to pay his employees what he owes them, or he intentionally withholds money that he agreed to pay to his fellow citizen]

Leviticus 6:2 (#5)

אֹ֥ו גָזַ֖ל

“or with robbery”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **robbery**, you can express the same idea with a verbal form. Alternate translation: [or by robbing him]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 6:3 (#2)

וְנִשְׁבַּ֥ע עַל־שָׁ֖קֶר

“or he swears upon falsehood”

The expression **swears upon falsehood** is an idiom that refers to deceitfully making a promise to another person with an oath, that is, with no intention to carry out the required actions of the oath. Alternate translation: [or he swears an oath without the intention to fulfill the conditions of the oath, and so, he swears the oath deceitfully]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 6:3 (#3)

וְנִשְׁבַּ֥ע עַל־שָׁ֖קֶר

“or he swears upon falsehood”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **falsehood**, you could express the same idea in other ways. Alternate translation: [or he swears falsely]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 6:3 (#1)

וְנִשְׁבַּ֥ע עַל־שָׁ֖קֶר עַל־אַחַ֣ת מִכֹּ֑ל אֲשֶׁר־יַעֲשֶׂ֥ה הָאָדָ֛ם לַחֲטֹ֥אָה בָהֵֽנָּה

“or he swears upon falsehood regarding one {thing} from all that which humanity does to sin by them”

Alternate translation: [and he swears falsely in any of the ways people act and, consequently, sin]

Leviticus 6:4 (#1)

וְאָשֵֽׁם׃

“and he becomes guilty”

See how you translated this expression in 5:2 and throughout the previous chapter.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 6:4 (#2)

אֶת־הַגְּזֵלָ֣ה אֲשֶׁ֣ר גָּזָ֔ל

“the robbery that he robbed”

Here, a verb and its object come from the same root. The phrase **he robbed** translates a verb that is related to the noun translated as **robbery**. The repetition of related words adds emphasis to the statement. If your language can repeat words for emphasis and your language has comparable terms that you can use in your own translation, it would be appropriate to use that construction here in your translation. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [whatever he stole]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 6:4 (#4)

אֶת־הַפִּקָּדוֹ֙ן אֲשֶׁ֣ר הָפְקַ֔ד אִתּ֑וֹ

“the deposit that was deposited with him”

Here, a verb and its object come from the same root. The phrase **was deposited** translates a verb that is related to the noun translated as **deposit**. The repetition of related words adds emphasis to the statement. If your language can repeat words for emphasis and your language has comparable terms that you can use in your own translation, it would be appropriate to use that construction here in your translation. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation [whatever was deposited with him]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 6:4 (#5)

אֲשֶׁ֣ר הָפְקַ֔ד אִתּ֑וֹ

“that was deposited with him”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that his fellow citizen deposited with him]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 6:4 (#3)

אוֹ֩ אֶת־הָעֹ֨שֶׁק אֲשֶׁ֜ר עָשָׁ֗ק

“or the extortion that he extorted”

Here, a verb and its object come from the same root. The phrase **he extorted** translates a verb that is related to the noun translated as **extortion**. The repetition of related words adds emphasis to the statement. If your language can repeat words for emphasis and your language has comparable terms that you can use in your own translation, it would be appropriate to use that construction here in your translation. If not,

consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [or whatever money he refused to pay]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 6:5 (#3)

בְּרֹאשׁוֹ

“in its principal”

The expression **in its head** is an emphatic idiom that means “totally” or “completely.” In this context, it connotes repaying the entire value of the monetary value of whatever the individual has stolen, extorted, or withheld from his fellow Israelite. If your language has a similar idiom, consider using it here. Alternate translation: [completely] or [totally]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 6:5 (#2)

יִשָּׁבַע עָלָיו לַשָּׁקֶר

“he swore concerning it as a lie”

See how you translated the similar idiom in 6:3.

See: Idiom

Leviticus 6:5 (#1)

אֹו מִכֹּל אֲשֶׁר־יִשָּׁבַע עָלָיו לַשָּׁקֶר

“or from all that he swore concerning it as a lie”

Alternate translation: [or in whatever way he deceitfully swore and did not fulfill his oath]

Leviticus 6:5 (#5)

לַאֲשֶׁר הוּא לֹו

“To whomever it {is} to him”

Alternate translation: [To whomever it is owed]

Leviticus 6:5 (#4)

וַחֲמִשָּׁתָיו

“and & the fifth of it”

The **fifth** is one part out of five equal parts.

See: Fractions

Leviticus 6:5 (#6)

יִתְּנֶנּוּ

“he shall give it”

The pronoun **it** refers to the full monetary value of what the individual owes plus the additional one-fifth that the law requires. Alternate translation: [he shall give the full monetary amount of what is owed plus the required extra one-fifth]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 6:5 (#7)

בְּיוֹם אַשְׁמָתֹו

“on the day of his guilt”

Here, the expression **on the day of his guilt** uses the possessive form to describe either: (1) whichever **day** is characterized by the recognition of **guilt**, both in the sense of the internal feeling of having committed wrongdoing and in the legal sense of needing to provide restitution for that wrongdoing. Alternate translation: [whenever he realizes that he is guilty] or (2) the day on which this individual offers his guilt offering. Alternate translation: [on the day when he offers his guilt offering]

See: Possession

Leviticus 6:5 (#8)

בְּיוֹם אַשְׁמָתֹו

“on the day of his guilt”

Here, the abstract noun **guilt** does not refer to the guilt offering itself, to which the same expression in 5:6 and elsewhere in the previous chapter referred. Rather, it refers to either: (1) both the internal sense of having committed wrongdoing and the legal state of needing to provide reparations for that wrongdoing, whether intentional or unintentional, in the same sense as the expression that you encountered in 6:4. Alternate translation: [on the day that he becomes guilty] or (2) the day of the individual’s guilt offering. Alternate translation: [on the day when he offers his guilt offering]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 6:6 (#1)

וְאֶת־אֲשָׁמֹו יָבִיא לַיהוָה

“And he shall bring his guilt to Yahweh”

As in 5:6, here, **his guilt** does not refer to the legal status of guilt or to the feeling of having committed wrongdoing, but to the required penalty for that person’s guilt, that is, the sacrifice that will provide atonement for the individual’s guilt that he acquired by sinning unintentionally. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making the meaning plain.

Alternate translation: [And he shall bring to Yahweh the sacrifice required to make restitution for his guilt]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 6:6 (#2)

בְּעֶרְכְּךָ

“in your valuation”

See how you translated this expression in 5:15.

See: Biblical Money

Leviticus 6:7 (#4)

מִכֹּל אֲשֶׁר־יַעֲשֶׂה לְאַשְׁמָה

“from all that he does to {his} guilt”

The pronouns **he** and **his** do not refer here to a specific person, but generally to anyone who does something that causes him to acquire legal guilt. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [from all that any individual might do to his guilt] or [from everything that someone could do to his guilt]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 6:7 (#2)

וְנִסְלַח לוֹ

“and it will be forgiven to him”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh will forgive him]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 6:7 (#3)

עַל־אַחַת מִכֹּל אֲשֶׁר־יַעֲשֶׂה לְאַשְׁמָה בָהּ

“concerning one {thing} from all that he does to {his} guilt with it”

In the phrase **all that he does to his guilt**, the abstract noun **guilt** is not the indirect object of the verb **does**, but its result or consequence. In other words, the person’s **guilt** comes as a result of something that they have done. If it would be helpful in your language, consider stating the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [concerning one thing from all that he does and becomes guilty by doing it]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 6:7 (#1)

לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated this expression in 1:5. Alternate translation: [in the presence of Yahweh] or [in the precincts of the sacred tent, where Yahweh lives among the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 6:8 (#1)

לֵאמֹר

“saying”

Alternate translation: [and he said]

Leviticus 6:8–9 (#1)

לֵאמֹר׃ צַו אֶת־אַהֲרֹן וְאֶת־בָּנָיו לֵאמֹר

“saying, “Command Aaron and his sons, saying”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation, with a period before: [He told Moses to command Aaron and his sons]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Leviticus 6:9 (#1)

אֶת־אַהֲרֹן וְאֶת־בָּנָיו

“Aaron and his sons”

As in 2:2, at the time when Yahweh spoke to Moses from the tent of meeting, **Aaron** and **his sons** constituted the priesthood. But these laws also applied to future generations, when the term “sons” would be a way of referring to the priests as Aaron’s “descendants.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use that term, which would apply to both the original priests and their successors. Alternate translation: [Aaron and to his descendants]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 6:9 (#2)

תּוֹרַת הָעֹלָה

“is} the law of the burnt offering”

Here, the expression **the law of the burnt offering** uses the possessive form to describe the law that concerns **the burnt offering**. Alternate translation: [the instruction regarding how the priest should perform the burnt offering]

See: Possession

Leviticus 6:9 (#3)

הִוא הָעֹלָה עַל־מוֹקְדָה עַל־הַמִּזְבֵּחַ

“It {is} the burnt offering on the hearth, on the altar”

Alternate translation: [It, the burnt offering, is on the hearth, on the altar]

Leviticus 6:9 (#4)

עַל־מוֹקְדָה עַל־הַמִּזְבֵּחַ

“on the hearth, on the altar”

The **hearth** of **the altar** refers to the floor of the fireplace area of the altar, where the burning coals and wood sat and burned the **burnt offering** above the fire continually until it was entirely consumed by the fire coming **on the hearth**. Alternate translation: [on the hearth of the altar]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 6:9 (#5)

וְאֵשׁ הַמִּזְבֵּחַ תּוּקַד בּוֹ

“And the fire of the altar shall be made to burn on it”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And the priests should keep the fire of the altar burning]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 6:9 (#6)

וְאֵשׁ הַמִּזְבֵּחַ

“And the fire of the altar”

Here, the expression **the fire of the altar** uses the possessive form to describe **fire** that is located on **altar**. Alternate translation: [And the fire that is on the altar]

See: Possession

Leviticus 6:10 (#2)

בַּד & בַּדִּ֖ים

“linen & linen”

This **linen** of which this garment is made is a flax-based textile made from fibers derived from the stems of the flax plant. If your language does not have a word for this kind of fabric, consider using a general expression. Alternate translation: [fine fabric ... fine fabric]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 6:10 (#4)

יִלְבַּשׁ עַל־בְּשָׂרוֹ

“he shall wear on his flesh”

Here, **flesh** is either: (1) an idiomatic expression for bare skin. Alternate translation: [he should wear directly on his skin] or (2) a euphemism for male genitals. Alternate translation: [he should wear in order to cover his genitals]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 6:10 (#6)

אֶת־הַדָּשֶׁן

“the fatty ash”

See how you translated the similar term in 1:16.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 6:10 (#1)

מִדּוֹ בַד

“his linen robe”

This **linen robe** is described in Exodus 28:1–5 and Exodus 28:31–35. It was a blue linen robe made of one piece of fabric, covered in a design of blue, purple, and scarlet pomegranates, and included gold bells on the hem. If your language has a term for a special outer garment, especially in religious contexts, consider using it here.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 6:10 (#5)

וְהֵרִים

“And he shall raise up”

See how you translated this idiom in 4:8. Alternate translation: [And he must remove]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 6:10 (#3)

וּמִכְנְסֵי־בַד

“and the undergarments of linen”

These **undergarments of linen** are described in Exodus 28:1–5 and Exodus 28:42–43. Covering the priest

from the waist to the thigh, they were required whenever the priest entered the tent of meeting or approached the altar to perform a sacrifice. If your language has a word for special undergarments that a person might wear in religious contexts, consider using it here. Alternate translation: [and his ceremonial linen underwear]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 6:10 (#7)

אֲשֶׁשֶׂר תֹּאכַל הָאֵשׁ אֶת־הָעֹלָה עַל־הַמִּזְבֵּחַ

“where the fire consumes the burnt offering on the altar”

Leviticus uses the image of **the fire** consuming or eating **the burnt offering** to refer to the process that the sacrifice undergoes as the fire burns it until it is **fatty ash**. If your language has a similar idiom used to describe a fire that completely burns something, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [where the fire has completely burned the burnt offerings on the altar so that they are now nothing but ash]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 6:12 (#1)

וְהָאֵשׁ עַל־הַמִּזְבֵּחַ תּוּקַד־בּוֹ

“But the fire on the altar shall be made to burn on it”

See how you translated the similar expression in 6:9. Alternate translation: [You must make the fire burn on the alter continually]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 6:12 (#3)

חֶלְבֵי הַשְּׁלָמִים

“the fat of the peace offerings”

Alternate translation: [the fat portions that are required for the peace offerings, including the fat covering the innards, all the fat that is on the innards, the two kidneys and the fat that is on them that is by the loins, and the lobe on the liver]

Leviticus 6:12 (#2)

בַּבֹּקֶר בַּבֹּקֶר

“in the morning, in the morning”

The repetition of the phrase **in the morning** is an emphatic way to say “every morning.” If your language also uses repetition for emphasis in this way, consider doing so here. If not, consider stating the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [every morning] or [morning by morning]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 6:13 (#1)

אֵשׁ תָּמִיד תּוּקַד עַל־הַמִּזְבֵּחַ

“Fire shall be made to burn continually on the altar”

Alternate translation: [Make fire burn continually on the altar]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 6:14 (#3)

לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated this expression in 1:5. Alternate translation: [in the precinct of the sacred tent, where Yahweh lives among the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 6:14 (#4)

אֶל־פְּנֵי הַמִּזְבֵּחַ

“toward the face of the altar”

Here, **face** represents the presence of a thing, the space before the front side of the altar. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [before the altar] or [in the space in front of the altar]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 6:14 (#1)

וְזֹאת תּוֹרַת הַמִּנְחָה

“And this {is} the law of the grain offering”

See how you translated the similar expression in 6:9. Alternate translation: [And this is the instruction regarding how the priest should perform the grain offering]

See: Possession

Leviticus 6:14 (#2)

בְּנֵי־אַהֲרֹן

“sons of Aaron”

See how you translated this expression in 1:5.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 6:16 (#3)

מַצּוֹת תֵּאָכֵל֙

“unleavened bread shall be eaten”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [They shall eat the unleavened bread]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 6:16 (#2)

מַצּוֹת תֵּאָכֵל֙ בְּמָקֹום קָדֹ֔שׁ בַּחֲצַ֖ר אֹ֣הֶל־מֹועֵ֑ד יֹאכְלוּהָ

“unleavened bread shall be eaten in a holy place; in the courtyard of the tent of meeting, they shall eat it”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Unleavened bread should be eaten in a holy place, indeed, the priests must eat it in the courtyard of the tent of meeting]

See: Parallelism

Leviticus 6:16 (#1)

אַהֲרֹ֥ן וּבָנָ֖יו

“Aaron and his sons”

See how you translated the similar way of referring to the priests in 2:2.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 6:17 (#1)

לֹ֣א תֵאָפֶ֔ה חָמֵ֑ץ

“It shall not be baked {with} leaven”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Do not bake it with leaven]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 6:17 (#3)

חֶלְקָ֣ם נָתַ֔תִּי אֹתָ֖הּ

“Their portion, I have given it”

Here the pronoun **Their** refers to Aaron and his sons, mentioned in the previous verse. If it would be helpful, consider making the referent explicit. Alternate translation: [I have given the portion belonging to Aaron and his sons]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 6:17 (#4)

קֹ֥דֶשׁ קָדָשִׁ֖ים הִ֑וא

“It {is} a holy thing of holy things”

See how you translated this expression in 2:3.

See: Possession

Leviticus 6:17 (#2)

חֶלְקָ֣ם נָתַ֔תִּי אֹתָ֖הּ

“Their portion, I have given it”

Alternate translation: [I have given their portion]

Leviticus 6:18 (#1)

מֵאִשֵּׁ֣י יְהוָ֔ה

“from the gifts of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar possessive form in 2:3.

See: Possession

Leviticus 6:18 (#2)

כֹּ֖ל אֲשֶׁר־יִגַּ֣ע בָּהֶ֑ם יִקְדָּֽשׁ

“Anything that touches them will be holy”

This could mean: (1) any object or person that touches the portion of the offering reserved for the priests’ food becomes as holy as the portion itself. Alternate translation: [Anyone or anything that touches them becomes holy] or (2) any person who touches this offering must be someone set apart for handling sacred items, that is, the priests alone. Alternate translation: [Anyone who touches them must be holy themselves]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 6:20 (#3)

בְּיֹום֙ הִמָּשְׁחֹ֣ה אֹתֹ֔ו

“on the day of his being anointed”

The expression **the day of his being anointed** implies that either Aaron or one of his sons is being anointed in order to become a priest. If it would be helpful in

your language, consider providing this implied information. Alternate translation: [on the day of his being anointed to serve as a priest]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 6:20 (#4)

בְּיוֹם֙ הִמָּשַׁ֣ח אֹתֹ֔ו

“on the day of his being anointed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [on the day when the high priest anoints a son of Aaron to become a priest]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 6:20 (#6)

עֲשִׂירִ֤ת הָאֵפָה֙ סֹ֔לֶת

“a tenth of an ephah of flour”

An **ephah** is an ancient measurement of volume equivalent to approximately 22.8 liters. Consequently, a **tenth of an ephah** is a little more than two liters. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the equivalent modern measurement in your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [about two liters of flour]

See: Biblical Volume

Leviticus 6:20 (#1)

קָרְבַּ֣ן & יַקְרִיבוּ֮

“is} the offering of & they shall present”

See how you translated the emphatic repetition of these words in 1:2.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 6:20 (#7)

עֲשִׂירִ֤ת

“a tenth of”

A **tenth** is one part of ten equal parts.

See: Fractions

Leviticus 6:20 (#8)

מַחֲצִיתָ֣הּ בַּבֹּ֔קֶר וּמַחֲצִיתָ֖הּ בָּעָֽרֶב

“half of it in the morning and half of it in the evening”

The phrase implies knowledge of the requirement to bring **half** of the prescribed grain offering in the first half of the day, and the other half later on, in the second half of the day. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation, with a period before: [The priest should bring half of the grain offering in the morning and the other half in the evening]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 6:20 (#2)

אַהֲרֹ֥ן וּבָנָ֖יו

“Aaron and his sons”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:3.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 6:20 (#5)

בְּיוֹם֙ הִמָּשַׁ֣ח אֹתֹ֔ו

“on the day of his being anointed”

The possessive pronoun **his** refers in a general way to any individual male descendent of **Aaron** who will be anointed to be a priest. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [on the day of the anointing of any of the sons of Aaron to be a priest]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 6:21 (#3)

מֻרְבֶּ֣כֶת

“Mixed”

The word translated as **Mixed** implies either (1) the flour and oil being well-mixed or kneaded together. Alternate translation: [You should bring it well kneaded] or (2) the flour being “well soaked” with oil. Alternate translation: [You should bring it thoroughly soaked with oil] If it would be helpful in your language, consider providing this implied information.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 6:21 (#2)

מַחֲבַ֖ת

“a griddle”

See how you translated this term in 2:5.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 6:21 (#4)

תְּבִיאֶנָּה & תַּקְרִיב

“you shall bring it & you shall present”

As the Introduction to Leviticus discusses, the book often speaks of the Israelites and to the Israelites in the third person, even in a direct address. However, as the Chapter 6 Introduction discusses, here and throughout the rest of the chapter, the author of Leviticus switches to a second-person address. If you have been using third-person pronouns since Chapter 4, and the sudden switch to second-person pronouns would not be natural in your language, consider continuing to use the third person in your translation. Alternate translation: [he shall bring it ... he shall present]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Leviticus 6:21 (#1)

עַל־מַחֲבַת בַּשֶּׁשֶׁם תֵּעָשֶׂה

“It shall be made on a griddle in oil”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [The priest should cook it in oil on a griddle]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 6:22 (#2)

לַיהוָה כָּלִיל תְּקֻטָּר

“to Yahweh, a whole {offering} shall be made to become smoke”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. To formulate this sentence with an active form, see how you translated the expression in 1:9. Alternate translation: [the priests should burn the whole offering to Yahweh, making it to become smoke]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 6:22 (#1)

וְהַכֹּהֵן הַמָּשִׁיחַ תַּחְתָּיו מִבָּנָיו יַעֲשֶׂנָּה אֹתָהּ

“And the anointed priest under him from his sons shall do it”

Here, **it** refers to the unique grain offering required on the day of the priest’s anointing for the priesthood, as described in 6:19–20. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making the referent explicit. Alternate translation: [And the anointed priest under him from his sons should prepare this particular grain offering]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 6:23 (#1)

וְכָל־מִנְחַת כֹּהֵן כָּלִיל תִּהְיֶה

“And every grain offering of the priest shall be a whole {offering”

This phrase **a whole offering** implies that the priests must offer this particular grain offering in its entirety, as opposed to the normal grain offerings, where the priest only burned the portion that he lifted out with a handful of the pieces that he chose to crumble upon the altar. In those cases, the priest was permitted to keep the rest of the grain offering for food. Alternate translation: [As opposed to normal grain offerings, this special grain offering that a priest offers when he is anointed to become a priest should be offered on the altar in its entirety]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 6:23 (#2)

לֹא תֵאָכֵל

“It shall not be eaten”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [No one should eat this special grain offering that a priest offers when he is anointed to become a priest]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 6:24–25 (#1)

לֵאמֹר׃ דַּבֵּר אֶל־אַהֲרֹן וְאֶל־בָּנָיו לֵאמֹר

“saying, “Speak to Aaron and to his sons, saying”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [He told Moses to speak to Aaron and his sons, saying]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Leviticus 6:25 (#1)

תּוֹרַת הַחַטָּאת

“is} the law of the sin offering”

As is the case with the similar expression in 6:9, the expression **the law of the sin offering** uses the

possessive form to describe law regarding **the sin offering**. Alternate translation: [is the law concerning how a priest should perform the sin offering]

See: Possession

Leviticus 6:25 (#3)

בִּמְקֹ֗ום אֲשֶׁר֙ תִּשָּׁחֵ֣ט הָעֹלָ֔ה

“in the place where the burnt offering is slaughtered”

Here the author of Leviticus does not use the present tense to describe contemporaneous or ongoing action, as if he were here referring to a specific instance where an individual was preparing this specific sacrifice. Rather, the present tense is being used both to describe the action that was previously described in the book of Leviticus and to depict a hypothetical situation. If it would be helpful in your language, consider choosing language that makes it plain that the author is not referring to specific past actions. Alternate translation: [in the place where the burnt offering would normally be slaughtered]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Leviticus 6:25 (#4)

תִּשָּׁחֵ֥ט הַחַטָּ֖את

“the sin offering shall be slaughtered”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [people should slaughter the sin offering]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 6:25 (#2)

בִּמְקֹ֗ום אֲשֶׁר֙ תִּשָּׁחֵ֣ט הָעֹלָ֔ה

“in the place where the burnt offering is slaughtered”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [in the place where people slaughter the burnt offering]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 6:25 (#5)

לִפְנֵ֥י יְהוָ֖ה

“to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:5.

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 6:25 (#6)

קֹ֥דֶשׁ קָדָשִׁ֖ים הֽוּא

“It {is} a holy thing of holy things”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:3.

See: Possession

Leviticus 6:26 (#1)

בְּמָקֹ֥ום קָדֹ֖שׁ תֵּאָכֵ֑ל

“In a holy place, it shall be eaten”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [He shall eat it in a holy place]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 6:27 (#1)

בִּבְשָׂרָ֖הּ

“its flesh”

Alternate translation: [the flesh of the sin offering that is not burned completely on the altar]

Leviticus 6:27 (#2)

וַאֲשֶׁ֣ר יִזֶּ֗ה מִדָּמָהּ֙ עַל־הַבֶּ֣גֶד אֲשֶׁר֮ יִזֶּה֣ עָלָיו֒ תְּכַבֵּ֣ס בְּמָקֹ֔ום קָדֹֽשׁ

“And whoever sprinkles some of the blood on the clothing, wherever he sprinkles on it, you shall wash in a holy place”

Alternate translation: [And whoever sprinkles some of its blood on any clothing should wash the places where the blood was sprinkled on the clothing in a holy place]

Leviticus 6:27 (#3)

וַאֲשֶׁ֣ר יִזֶּ֗ה מִדָּמָהּ֙ עַל־הַבֶּ֣גֶד אֲשֶׁר֮ יִזֶּה֣ עָלָיו֒ תְּכַבֵּ֣ס בְּמָקֹ֔ום קָדֹֽשׁ

“And whoever sprinkles some of the blood on the clothing, wherever he sprinkles on it, you shall wash in a holy place”

It is implied that the blood should be sprinkled not on clothing but only on sacred objects like the altar, in order to cleanse them from the impurity of sin. This phrase refers to a hypothetical scenario in which, in the process of sprinkling the blood on the sacred objects, some blood also comes into contact

with someone's clothing, requiring the clothing to be carefully washed. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And whoever, in the process of sprinkling blood on the sacred objects of the tent of meeting, also accidentally sprinkles some of the blood on the clothing, wherever he sprinkles on it, he must wash that spot in a holy place]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 6:27 (#4)

תְּכַבֵּבֵס

"you shall wash"

As the Introduction to Leviticus discusses, the book often speaks of the Israelites and to the Israelites in the third person, even though it is a direct address. However, as the Introduction to this chapter discusses, here and throughout the rest of the chapter, the author of Leviticus switches to a second-person address. If you have been using third-person pronouns since chapter 4, and the sudden switch to second person would not be natural in your language, consider continuing to use the third person in your translation. Alternate translation: [a person shall wash]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Leviticus 6:28 (#2)

חֶרֶשׂ

"earthenware"

The **container** is described as made of **earthenware**, which refers to clay that could be shaped as a pot-shaped vessel and baked in a kiln until hardened but still porous. It would not be heated so hot that the clay would turn to glass or ceramic material. If your language has a specific word for this material, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [baked and hardened clay]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 6:28 (#3)

וְאִם־בִּכְלִי נְחֹשֶׁת בֻּשָּׁלָה

"But if it is boiled in a container of bronze"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [But if the priest has boiled it in a container of bronze]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 6:28 (#4)

וּמֹרַק וְשֻׁטַּף בַּמָּיִם

"then it shall be scoured and it shall be rinsed with water"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [then he shall scour it and he shall rinse it with water]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 6:28 (#1)

וּכְלִי־חֶרֶשׂ אֲשֶׁר תְּבֻשַּׁל־בּוֹ יִשָּׁבֵר

"And a container of earthenware, which it is boiled in it, shall be shattered"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [The priest should shatter any container of earthenware in which he has boiled the sin offering]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 6:29 (#1)

קֹדֶשׁ קָדָשִׁים הֽוּא

"It {is} a holy thing of holy things"

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:3.

See: Possession

Leviticus 6:30 (#3)

לֹא תֵאָכֵל

"it shall not be eaten"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh forbids anyone to eat it]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 6:30 (#4)

תִּשָּׂרֵף

"It shall be burned"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [The priest must burn it]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 6:30 (#1)

וְכָל־חַטָּאת אֲשֶׁר־יוּבָא מִדָּמָהּ אֶל־אֹהֶל מוֹעֵד

"But every sin offering that some of its blood is brought into the tent of meeting"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [But every sin offering that requires the priest to bring some of its blood into the tent of meeting]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 6:30 (#2)

לְכַפֵּר

"to make atonement"

See how you translated this expression in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus - Chapter 7 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

As was suggested in the Introduction to Chapter 6, this chapter continues the administrative instructions to the priests for how they should handle particular matters of specific sacrifices. It addresses:

1. the guilt offering (7:1–6)
2. the food portions for the priests from various sacrifices (7:7–10)
3. the peace offering (7:11–21)

A fresh reiteration of Yahweh speaking to Moses, reestablishing the narrative context of these first seven chapters, occurs in 7:22. It shifts the instructions from those concerning the priests to those concerning the people of Israel as a whole, addressing the prohibition of eating animal blood or fat (7:22–27). Then the author of Leviticus records Yahweh speaking to Moses again in 7:28, which introduces a new section, again addressed to the people of Israel as a whole, that covers the wave offering and the food portions for the priests from the peace offering (7:28–36) before the chapter ends with a summary of chapters 1 through 7 as a whole (7:37–38). In outline form, this chapter is structured as follows:

1. The Administrative Laws for Priests (6:8–7:21)
2. The Guilt Offering (7:1–6)
3. The Priestly Portions of Food (7:7–10)
4. The Peace Offering (7:11–21)
5. General Address to the People of Israel (7:22–36)
6. Prohibition of Consuming Blood or Fat (7:22–27)
7. Laws for the Peace Offering (7:28–36)
8. Conclusion to Chapters 1–7 (7:37–38)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The guilt, peace, and wave offerings

In this chapter, laws for the priests' handling of the guilt, peace, and wave offerings are discussed. See the Introduction to Leviticus for details concerning the nature and identity of these types of sacrifices.

"That person shall be cut off from his people" (7:20, 21, 27)

This chapter introduces the punishment for two forbidden actions: (1) eating the meat of the peace offering while being unclean or impure (Lev 7:20–21) and (2) drinking or consuming blood (Lev 7:27). The punishment for these actions is spoken of as if the person were being literally cut off from his or her people. This could be (1) an idiom that refers to Yahweh's executing divine judgment against the individual in some unspecified manner, thus removing the person from the people of God or (2) a metaphor that refers to the people excommunicating or exiling the individual from his or her community. If possible, translate in such a way that allows for both options, since the expression is ambiguous. Additionally, if your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language.

Blood

In this chapter, Yahweh forbade the eating of any animal blood because the blood contained "the life" of the animal. (See 7:26–27) In sacrifices, the blood of the animal is collected and applied, via sprinkling or splattering, to the sides of the altar upon which the burnt offering is placed. This act, as explained above, has been variously understood, but it pictures the blood as cleansing the altar from the effects of sin. Blood was able to cleanse sacred space and God's people from the impurities of sin because of its ability to accomplish atonement by means of "the life" of the animal. (See 17:10–12)

Important Figures of Speech in This Chapter

The holy thing of holy things

In this chapter, Yahweh reserves portions of the guilt offering for the priests as their food. These portions are called "the holy thing of holy things." (See Lev 7:1 and Lev 7:6) All food that was offered to Yahweh was considered a "holy thing" (see "the holy things" and

"a holy thing" in Lev 22:2–4, 22:6–7, 22:10, and 22:14–16), but certain food offerings were designated as "the holy thing of holy things." The expression "the holy thing of holy things" uses the possessive form to describe an offering that is exceptionally or uniquely holy. As such, the expression may be translated as "the most holy thing" or "the exceptionally holy thing."

Other Possible Translation Difficulties in This Chapter

Second- and third-person address
The entirety of chapters 1 through 7 are written as a direct address to the people of God through Moses. In the present chapter, the author of Leviticus consistently uses third-person forms to refer to either the priest or the individual who offers the sacrifices described until a sudden switch to second-person plural forms in 7:23–26, before returning to third-person singular forms in 7:27 and throughout the rest of the chapter. If the switch from third-person to second-person forms and back would not be natural in your language, consider continuing to use whichever form you have been using for the previous chapters. In the places where second-person address is used, the word "you" is plural. It refers to the people of Israel who would offer sacrifices at the tent of meeting. If your language uses a plural form to address a group of people, consider using that form here. If not, consider using the third-person form.

Leviticus 7:1 (#1)

קֹ֥דֶשׁ קָדָשִׁ֖ים הִֽוא

"It {is} a holy thing of holy things"

See how you translated this expression in 2:3.

See: Possession

Leviticus 7:2 (#1)

בִּמְקֹ֗ום אֲשֶׁ֤ר יִשְׁחֲטוּ֙ אֶת־הָעֹלָ֔ה

"In the place where they will slaughter the burnt offering"

Here the author of Leviticus is not using this verb form to describe ongoing action, as if he were referring to a specific instance where an individual will perform this specific action. Rather, the future tense is being used both to describe an action that was previously described in the book of Leviticus and to depict a hypothetical situation. Alternate translation: [In the location where the burnt offering would normally be slaughtered]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Leviticus 7:2 (#2)

יִשְׁחֲטוּ֙ & יִשְׁחֲטֶ֔

"they will slaughter & they shall slaughter"

Here, **they** refers generically to anyone who might perform these actions. If it would be helpful in your language, consider using a general expression for a person. Alternate translation: [someone normally slaughters ... people shall slaughter] or [an individual slaughters ... that individual shall slaughter]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 7:2 (#3)

יִשְׁחֲטוּ֙ & יִשְׁחֲטֶ֔

"they will slaughter & they shall slaughter"

Although the end of the last chapter addressed the people of Israel using a second-person singular form, here the author of Leviticus addresses everyone who approaches the tent of meeting to sacrifice using a third-person plural form. If the switch from second-person forms to third-person forms would not be natural in your language, consider using whichever form you have been using throughout the previous chapters.

See: First, Second or Third Person

Leviticus 7:6 (#1)

יֵאָכֵ֖ל

"it shall be eaten"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [they shall eat it]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 7:6 (#2)

קֹ֥דֶשׁ קָדָשִׁ֖ים הִֽוא

"It {is} a holy thing of holy things"

See how you translated this expression in 2:3.

See: Possession

Leviticus 7:7 (#1)

יְכַפֵּ֔ר

"makes atonement"

See how you handled the use of the abstract noun **atonement** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 7:7 (#2)

לֹ֥ו יִהְיֶ֖ה

“it shall be for him”

The expression **it shall be for him** implies that the portion of the animal (in context, the skin of the peace offering, along with the breast meat and the right thigh) belongs to the priest as his allotment from Yahweh. It is questionable whether the skin serves as a food source for the priests, as the other portions do. Rather, it seems likely that the skin would be used for other, unspecified uses. Alternate translation: [these portions of the sacrifice shall belong to the priest who made the atonement with it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 7:8 (#1)

אֶת־עֹ֣לַת אִ֔ישׁ

“a burnt offering of a man”

In this expression, although the word **man** is masculine, it refers in a generic way to any individual who offers this sacrifice. The possessive form, **a burnt offering of a man**, does not mean offering a human being as a burnt offering. but rather it means a burnt offering presented by any person, whoever they might be. If it would be helpful in your language, consider using a generic term for a person in this possessive form. Alternate translation: [someone’s burnt offering] or [the burnt offering that anyone might offer]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Leviticus 7:8 (#2)

לֹ֥ו יִהְיֶ֖ה

“It shall be for him”

See how you translated the similar expression in the previous verse, 7:7.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 7:9 (#2)

וְכָל־נַעֲשָׂה֙ בַּמַּרְחֶ֔שֶׁת

“and everything made in a pan”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and anything that someone has made in a pan or on a griddle]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 7:9 (#1)

וְכָל־מִנְחָ֗ה אֲשֶׁ֤ר תֵּאָפֶה֙ בַּתַּנּ֔וּר

“And every grain offering that is baked in an oven”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. See how you translated **in an oven** in 2:4. Alternate translation: [And any grain offering that someone baked in an oven]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 7:10 (#2)

וַחֲרֵבָ֔ה

“or dry”

The term translated as **dry** implies that this is a grain offering of wheat flour that has not been mixed or kneaded with olive oil. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [or not mixed with any oil]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 7:10 (#3)

בְּנֵ֥י אַהֲרֹ֖ן

“the sons of Aaron”

See how you translated the similar manner of referring to the priests in 1:5.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 7:10 (#1)

וְכָל־מִנְחָ֗ה בְּלוּלָ֤ה בַשֶּׁ֙מֶן֙ וַחֲרֵבָ֔ה

“And every grain offering, mixed with oil or dry”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And every grain offering, whether someone mixes it with oil or offers it dry]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 7:11 (#1)

אֲשֶׁ֥ר יַקְרִ֖יב לַיהוָֽה

“that he will present to Yahweh”

Here, although the pronoun **he** is masculine, it refers generally to any person who might offer this kind

of sacrifice. If it would be helpful in your language, consider using a generic term for a person. Alternate translation: [that someone will present to Yahweh] or [that anyone will present to Yahweh]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Leviticus 7:11 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר יַקְרִיב לַיהוָה

“that he will present to Yahweh”

Here, the author of Leviticus does not use the future tense to describe future action, as if he were here referring to a specific instance where an individual would perform this specific action. Rather, the future tense is being used to depict a hypothetical situation. If it would be helpful in your language, consider choosing language that makes it plain that the author is not referring to a specific future action. Alternate translation: [that anyone will present to Yahweh]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Leviticus 7:12 (#5)

חַלֹּת מַצּוֹת בְּלוּלֹת בַּשָּׁמֶן & וְסֹלֶת מֻרְבֶּכֶת חַלֹּת בְּלוּלֹת בַּשָּׁמֶן

“loaves of unleavened bread mixed with oil & and mixed flour loaves mixed with oil”

Based on the similar expression found in 2:4, the expressions **loaves of unleavened bread mixed with oil** and **loaves mixed with oil** leave out some words that some languages might consider essential for understanding. If it would be helpful in your language, consider clarifying the expressions with the elided words. Alternate translation: [flour mixed with oil into loaves of unleavened bread ... and flour that has been well-mixed with oil into loaves] or [loaves of unleavened bread made of flour mixed with oil ... and flour that was mixed with oil to make loaves]

See: Ellipsis

Leviticus 7:12 (#3)

יַקְרִיבֶנּוּ

“he will present it”

The pronoun **it** refers to the peace offerings. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making the referent explicit. Alternate translation: [he will present a sacrifice of peace offerings]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 7:12 (#1)

אִם עַל־תּוֹדָה יַקְרִיבֶנּוּ

“If he will present it for thanksgiving”

Here the author of Leviticus does not use the future tense to describe future action, as if he were here referring to a specific instance where an individual would perform this specific action. Rather, the future tense is being used to depict a hypothetical situation. If it would be helpful in your language, consider choosing language that makes it plain that the author is not referring to a specific future action. Alternate translation: [If, hypothetically, he is presenting it for thanksgiving]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Leviticus 7:12 (#2)

יַקְרִיבֶנּוּ

“he will present it”

Here and throughout the following verses, the word **he** refers generally to anyone who might present this kind of sacrifice to Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, consider using a generic term for a person. Alternate translation: [someone will present it] or [anyone will present it]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Leviticus 7:12 (#4)

עַל־תּוֹדָה

“for thanksgiving”

The expression **for thanksgiving** refers to the unique circumstance in which a person might offer a peace offering for the specific purpose of expressing gratitude or thanks to Yahweh for something Yahweh did in his life. If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **thanksgiving**, you could express the same idea in a verbal form. Alternate translation: [for the purpose of expressing gratitude to Yahweh]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 7:12 (#6)

חַלֹּת מַצּוֹת

“loaves of unleavened bread”

See how you translated this expression in 2:4.

See: Possession

Leviticus 7:12 (#7)

וּרְקִיקֵ֣י מַצּ֔וֹת מְשֻׁחִ֖ים בַּשָּׁ֑מֶן

“and biscuits of unleavened bread anointed with oil”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and wafers of unleavened bread which he shall anoint with oil]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 7:12 (#8)

וְסֹ֥לֶת מֻרְבֶּ֖כֶת

“and mixed flour”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. See how you translated the similar passive form in 6:14. Alternate translation: [and flour which the person who prepared it mixed thoroughly to make]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 7:13 (#1)

חַלֹּ֣ת לֶ֔חֶם חָמֵ֖ץ

“loaves of bread {with} leaven”

Here, the expression **loaves of bread with leaven** uses the possessive form to describe a loaf that is characterized by its consisting of **bread** that has been prepared with **leaven**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [leavened bread]

See: Possession

Leviticus 7:13 (#2)

יַקְרִ֣יב קָרְבָּנ֗וֹ

“he shall present his offering”

See how you translated the similar use of related words in 1:2.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 7:13 (#3)

זֶ֚בַח תּוֹדַ֣ת שְׁלָמָ֔יו

“the sacrifice of thanksgiving of his peace offerings”

The expression **the sacrifice of thanksgiving of his peace offerings** uses the possessive form to describe the animal sacrifices of a peace offering that are being offered for the purposes of expressing gratitude to Yahweh. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [the animal sacrifices that constitute his peace offerings that he is offering for thanksgiving]

See: Possession

Leviticus 7:14 (#1)

מִמֶּ֔נּוּ

“from it”

The pronoun **it** refers to the entire peace offering, including the animal sacrifices and the prescribed grain offerings. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making the referent explicit. Alternate translation, with a comma afterwards: [from everything he is offering as a peace offering, including the animal sacrifice and the grain offerings]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 7:14 (#2)

אֶחָ֖ד מִכָּל־קָרְבָּ֑ן

“one from each offering”

The expression **one from each offering** implies that the individual making the offering should present one portion from the animal sacrifices and one portion from the grain offerings, respectively. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [one portion from the animal sacrifices and one portion from the grain offerings]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 7:14 (#3)

תְּרוּמָ֖ה לַיהוָ֑ה

“as a contribution to Yahweh”

Here the author of Leviticus is using God’s name, Yahweh, by association to mean the priests of Yahweh. So, the expression **as a contribution to Yahweh** means “as a special contribution of food to Yahweh’s priests.” Make sure that your translation makes this clear and does not imply that the food is for Yahweh. Alternate translation: [as a special contribution of food to Yahweh’s priests]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 7:15 (#1)

וּבְשַׂשַׂר זֶבַח תּוֹדַת שְׁלָמָיו בְּיוֹם קָרְבָּנוֹ יֵאָכֵל

“And the meat of the sacrifice of thanksgiving of his peace offerings shall be eaten on the day of his offering”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And the priest shall eat the meat of the sacrifice of thanksgiving of his peace offerings on the day of his offering]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 7:15 (#2)

בְּיוֹם קָרְבָּנוֹ

“on the day of his offering”

The expression **on the day of his offering** uses the possessive form to refer to the day on which someone offers this particular offering. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [on whatever day he offers it] or [whenever he offers it]

See: Possession

Leviticus 7:15 (#3)

וּבְשַׂשַׂר זֶבַח תּוֹדַת שְׁלָמָיו

“And the meat of the sacrifice of thanksgiving of his peace offerings”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **thanksgiving**, you can express the same idea with a verbal form. Alternate translation: [And the meat of the sacrifice of his peace offerings that he offers to express gratitude to Yahweh]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 7:15 (#4)

עַד־בֹּקֶר

“until morning”

Alternate translation: [until the following day]

Leviticus 7:16 (#2)

בְּיוֹם הַקְרִיבוֹ אֶת־זִבְחוֹ

“on the day of his presenting his sacrifice”

As before, the expression **on the day of his presenting his sacrifice** uses the possessive form to refer to any day on which someone offers this particular offering. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [on whatever day he presents his sacrifice] or [whenever he presents his sacrifice]

See: Possession

Leviticus 7:16 (#3)

יֵאָכֵל & וְהַנּוֹתָר מִמֶּנּוּ יֵאָכֵל

“it shall be eaten & the remainder of it may be eaten”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the priests should eat it ... and they should eat the remainder from it]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 7:16 (#1)

זֶבַח קָרְבָּנוֹ

“the sacrifice of his offering”

The expression **the sacrifice of his offering** refers to the portion of the peace offering constituted by animal sacrifices, distinct from the grain offerings that were to be offered alongside those portions. If it would be helpful, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [the portions of the animal sacrifices that come from his peace offerings]

See: Possession

Leviticus 7:16 (#4)

וּמִמָּחֳרָת וְהַנּוֹתָר מִמֶּנּוּ

“Also from tomorrow, the remainder of it”

Alternate translation: [And the next day, the rest of it]

Leviticus 7:17 (#2)

וְהַנּוֹתָר מִבְּשַׂשַׂר הַזֶּבַח בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁלִישִׁי בָּאֵשׁ יִשָּׂרֵף

“But the remainder from the flesh of the sacrifice shall be burned with fire on the third day”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [But the priests should burn the remainder of the flesh of the sacrifice with fire on the third day]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 7:17 (#3)

וְהַנּוֹתָ֣ר מִבְּשַׂ֣ר הַזֶּ֔בַח

“But the remainder from the flesh of the sacrifice”

Alternate translation: [But any meat that remains from the sacrifice]

Leviticus 7:17 (#4)

בַּיּ֥וֹם הַשְּׁלִישִׁ֖י

“on the third day”

The word **third** is the ordinal number for three. The day that the animal is sacrificed counts as the first day. Alternate translation: [after two days]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Leviticus 7:17 (#1)

וְהַנּוֹתָ֣ר מִבְּשַׂ֣ר הַזֶּ֔בַח בַּיּ֥וֹם הַשְּׁלִישִׁ֖י בָּאֵ֣שׁ יִשָּׂרֵֽף

“But the remainder from the flesh of the sacrifice shall be burned with fire on the third day”

It might seem that the expression **shall be burned with fire** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in your language. If so, you could use an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [But the remainder from the flesh of the sacrifice will be completely burned on the third day]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Leviticus 7:18 (#5)

לֹ֤א יֵחָשֵׁב֙ לַ֣עֹשֵׂ֔הוּ

“it will not be accounted to him”

Here, the forgiveness brought about by the sacrifice is spoken of using legal or possibly financial terminology, as if the sacrifice would be accredited to a person’s account before Yahweh. If your language uses similar metaphors to convey these ideas, consider using them here. If not, consider using a general expression. Alternate translation: [the person who offers the sacrifice will not be forgiven]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 7:18 (#4)

לֹ֤א יֵחָשֵׁב֙ לַ֣עֹשֵׂ֔הוּ

“it will not be accounted to him”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will not account the sacrifice to him] or [Yahweh will not credit the sacrifice to him]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 7:18 (#1)

וְאִ֣ם הֵאָכֹ֣ל יֵֽאָכֵל֮ מִבְּשַׂר־זִבְחַ֣ שְׁלָמָיו֒

“And if some of the meat of the sacrifice of his peace offering is eaten, being eaten”

Here the author of Leviticus uses a repetition of the verbal form **is eaten** in order to intensify the idea that it expresses. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [And if some of the meat of the sacrifice of his peace offerings is at any time eaten] or [And if anyone eats some of the meat of the sacrifice of his peace offering]

See: Reduplication

Leviticus 7:18 (#2)

וְאִ֣ם הֵאָכֹ֣ל יֵֽאָכֵל֮ מִבְּשַׂר־זִבְחַ֣ שְׁלָמָיו֒

“And if some of the meat of the sacrifice of his peace offering is eaten, being eaten”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And if, eating, anyone eats some of the meat of the sacrifice of his peace offerings]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 7:18 (#3)

לֹ֤א יֵרָצֶה֙ הַמַּקְרִ֣יב אֹתֹ֔ו

“the person who presented it will not be accepted”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will not accept the person who presented it]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 7:18 (#6)

עֲוֹנֹ֖ו תִּשָּֽׂא

“he will bear his iniquity”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:1.

See: Idiom

Leviticus 7:19 (#7)

כָּל־טָהֹר

“any clean {person”

The expression **any clean person** implies any person who has succeeded in remaining ceremonially clean by abstaining from touching anything that would render him unclean, as instructed in Leviticus. If it would be helpful in your language, consider stating this plainly. Alternate translation: [any person who has not touched anything unclean and so has, himself, remained clean]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 7:19 (#2)

וְהַבָּשָׂר

“And the meat”

The phrase **the meat** does not refer to a specific portion of the flesh, but rather, it generally refers to any flesh which was sacrificed and which touches something unclean. Express this in the way that would be most natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And any meat]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 7:19 (#6)

וְהַבָּשָׂר

“But the meat”

The phrase **But the meat** leaves out information that some languages might consider essential to understanding. It refers to clean meat that has not touched anything unclean, in contrast to **the meat that touches any unclean thing**. You could supply words from 7:16–17 if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [But as for clean meat that has not touched any unclean thing]

See: Ellipsis

Leviticus 7:19 (#1)

וְהַבָּשָׂר אֲשֶׁר־יִגַּע בְּכָל־טָמֵא לֹא יֵאָכֵל

“And the meat that touches any unclean {thing} shall not be eaten”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And the priests shall not eat the meat that touches any unclean thing]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 7:19 (#3)

בְּכָל־טָמֵא

“any unclean {thing”

See how you translated the use of this term in 5:2.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 7:19 (#4)

בָּאֵשׁ יִשָּׂרֵף

“It shall be burned with fire”

See how you translated this expression in 7:17.

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Leviticus 7:19 (#5)

יִשָּׂרֵף

“It shall be burned”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [The priests shall burn it]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 7:19 (#8)

בָּשָׂר

“meat”

Here the term **meat** is, by implication, the meat that has not touched anything unclean, and so, it is considered clean. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [any clean meat]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 7:20 (#3)

וְטֻמְאָתוֹ עָלָיו

“and his uncleanness {is} on him”

The words **his** and **him** are being used generically to refer to anyone who might become unclean and so should avoid eating the meat that is especially set apart for holy purposes. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [and the uncleanness of that person is on him]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Leviticus 7:20 (#2)

וְטֻמְאָתוֹ עָלָיו

“and his uncleanness {is} on him”

A person who is not fit for God’s special, sacred space is spoken of as if **his uncleanness** were physically resting **on him**. If your language would use a similar metaphor, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [and he is unclean]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 7:20 (#5)

וְנִכְרְתָה הַנֶּפֶשׁ הַהִוא מֵעַמֶּיהָ

“then that person shall be cut off from his people”

Here a person who eats the meat that is dedicated to Yahweh while he is considered unclean is spoken of as if he were part of a material that could be cut off from the whole. This means that the people must expel him from their community. Alternate translation: [then that person should be removed from his people and excommunicated] or, to avoid the passive form, [then the people should remove that person from the community and they should refuse to have contact with him]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 7:20 (#1)

בָּשָׂר מִזֶּבַח הַשְּׁלָמִים אֲשֶׁר לַיהוָה

“meat from the sacrifice of the peace offerings that {are} for Yahweh”

The expression **the peace offerings that are for Yahweh** might seem to imply that the peace offerings supply Yahweh with food. However, as stated before, Yahweh does not eat, nor does he need food from human beings. The peace offerings belong to Yahweh in the sense that they are dedicated to Yahweh’s special purposes. Consequently, the portions of meat from these sacrifices are not to be used for any common purpose. In your translation, make sure that it is not implied that the meat from these sacrifices provides Yahweh with food.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 7:20 (#4)

וְטֻמְאָתוֹ עָלָיו

“and his uncleanness {is} on him”

See how you handled the abstract noun **uncleanness** in 5:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 7:20 (#6)

וְנִכְרְתָה הַנֶּפֶשׁ הַהִוא

“then that person shall be cut off”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. For interpretive options for this expression, see the previous note. Alternate translation: [the people of Israel shall cut off that person] or [Yahweh shall cut off that person]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 7:21 (#5)

וְנִכְרְתָה הַנֶּפֶשׁ הַהִוא מֵעַמֶּיהָ

“that person shall be cut off from his people”

See how you translated the similar expressions in 7:20.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 7:21 (#4)

וְאָכַל

“and he eats”

Here, **he** refers to anyone who might eat the meat of the sacrifice. If it would be helpful, consider using a generic expression for a person. Alternate translation: [and that person eats]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Leviticus 7:21 (#1)

בְּטֻמְאַת אָדָם

“the uncleanness of a man”

See how you translated the use of this expression in 5:3.

See: Possession

Leviticus 7:21 (#2)

טָמֵא & טָמֵאָה

“unclean & unclean”

As the Introduction to Leviticus discusses, the animals considered clean and **unclean** are described in detail in 11:1–47. Something was considered unclean and potentially able to defile the space or objects that were dedicated especially for Yahweh and for his purposes

when they were culturally associated with death. If your language has a term for this concept, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [ritually polluted ... ritually polluted]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 7:21 (#3)

בְּכָל־שֶׁקֶץ טָמֵא

“any unclean detestable thing”

This **unclean detestable thing** refers to the specific animals that Yahweh forbids both eating and touching in 11:29–31. These included the mole rat, the mouse, and several kinds of lizard. If your language has a specific term for the kind of animal that is considered forbidden to touch or to eat, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [any unclean animal that is forbidden to eat or to touch]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 7:22 (#1)

לֵאמֹר

“saying”

The word translated as **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, consider ways in which you might introduce this quotation naturally in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Leviticus 7:22–23 (#1)

לֵאמֹר׃ דַּבֵּר אֶל־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“saying, “Speak to the sons of Israel”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation, with a period before: [He told Moses to tell the sons of Israel]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Leviticus 7:23 (#1)

לֹא תֹאכֵלוּ

“You shall not eat”

As the Introduction to this chapter discusses, here and until 7:26 the author of Leviticus switches from the use of third-person pronouns to the use of second-person plural forms. If the switch from third person to second-person forms would not be natural in your language, consider continuing to use whichever form you have been using for the previous chapters. Alternate translation: [No one should eat]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Leviticus 7:23 (#2)

לֹא תֹאכֵלוּ

“You shall not eat”

Here, **You** is plural. It refers to the people of Israel who would offer sacrifices at the tent of meeting. If your language uses a plural form to address a group of people, consider using that form here. If not, consider using a third-person form, as modeled by the previous note. Alternate translation: [My people must not eat]

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Leviticus 7:24 (#1)

וְחֵלֶב נְבֵלָה וְחֵלֶב טְרֵפָה יֵעָשֶׂה

“And the fat of a carcass or the fat of a torn animal shall be made”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in an active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And you shall use the fat of a carcass or the fat of a torn animal] or, in the third person, [And anyone shall use the fat of a carcass or the fat of a torn animal]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 7:24 (#4)

וְאָכֹל לֹא תֹאכְלֻהוּ

“but you shall certainly not eat it”

Here the expression **eating, you shall not eat it** uses a repetition of the verbal form in order to intensify the idea that the eating of these fat portions is forbidden. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [but you should certainly never eat it] or, using the third-person, [but no one should ever eat it]

See: Reduplication

Leviticus 7:24 (#6)

לֹא תֹאכְלֻהוּ

“you shall & not eat it”

If the switch from third-person to second-person forms would not be natural in your language, consider continuing to use whichever form you have been using for the previous chapters. Alternate translation: [no one shall eat it]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Leviticus 7:24 (#2)

וְחֵ֥לֶב נְבֵלָ֖ה

“And the fat of a carcass”

The expression **fat of a carcass** implies any fat portion from any animal, wild or domesticated, that has died, usually referring to those domestic animals that have died of natural causes and wild animal that any Israelite might find in the desert wilderness. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And any fat portion from any dead animal, whether wild or domesticated]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 7:24 (#3)

וְחֵ֥לֶב טְרֵפָ֖ה

“or the fat of a torn animal”

The expression **the fat of a torn animal** implies the fat portions of an animal, usually a domesticated animal, that has been attacked and killed by wild animals. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [or the fat of a domesticated animal that was killed and torn apart by wild animals]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 7:24 (#5)

לֹ֣א תֹאכְל֔וּהוּ

“you shall & not eat it”

Here, **you** is plural. It refers to the people of Israel, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 7:25 (#2)

וְנִכְרְתָ֣ה הַנֶּ֔פֶשׁ הָאֹכֶ֖לֶת מֵעַמֶּֽיהָ

“then the person, the one eating it, shall be cut off from his people”

See how you translated the similar expressions in 7:20.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 7:25 (#1)

חֵ֚לֶב מִן־הַבְּהֵמָ֔ה אֲשֶׁ֥ר יַקְרִ֖יב מִמֶּ֑נָּה אִשֶּׁ֣ה לַיהוָ֔ה

“fat from the livestock that he presents from it {as} a gift to Yahweh”

Alternate translation: [fat that comes from a domesticated animal from which someone has presented portions of meat or fat as a gift to Yahweh]

Leviticus 7:26 (#2)

וְכָל־דָּ֕ם לֹ֥א תֹאכְל֖וּ בְּכֹ֣ל מוֹשְׁבֹתֵיכֶ֑ם

“And you shall not eat any blood in any of your dwelling places”

If you have been using third-person forms throughout this chapter, consider using whatever form would be clearest in your language. Alternate translation: [And no one shall eat any blood in any of his dwelling places]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Leviticus 7:26 (#1)

וְכָל־דָּ֕ם לֹ֥א תֹאכְל֖וּ בְּכֹ֣ל מוֹשְׁבֹתֵיכֶ֑ם

“And you shall not eat any blood in any of your dwelling places”

In this verse, the words **you** and **your** are plural. Yahweh is speaking about everyone who will offer sacrifices, regardless of where they happen to live. Consider using the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 7:26 (#3)

לָעֹ֥וף וְלַבְּהֵמָֽה

“of the bird or of the livestock”

The expressions **the bird** and **the livestock** do not refer to specific animals or groups of animals. The terms describe any animal or group of animals that an Israelite might own or purchase to eat. Express this in the way that would be most natural in your language. Alternate translation: [of any bird or any livestock that you own] or, using the third-person, [of any bird or any livestock that someone might own]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 7:28–29 (#1)

לֵאמֹ֖ר: דַּבֵּ֣ר אֶל־בְּנֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל

“saying, “Speak to the sons of Israel”

This sentence has a quotation within a quotation. You can translate this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation, with a period before: [He told Moses to speak to the sons of Israel]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Leviticus 7:29 (#1)

הַמַּקְרִ֣יב אֶת־זֶ֣בַח שְׁלָמָ֔יו לַיהוָ֖ה יָבִ֣יא אֶת־קָרְבָּנ֑וֹ לַיהוָ֖ה מִזֶּ֣בַח שְׁלָמָֽיו

“The person presenting the sacrifice of his peace offerings to Yahweh shall bring his offering to Yahweh from the sacrifice of his peace offerings”

Alternate translation: [Any person who presents the sacrifice of his peace offerings to Yahweh must make sure to bring this portion of meat to Yahweh that comes from the flesh of the sacrifice of his peace offerings]

Leviticus 7:29 (#2)

הַמַּקְרִ֣יב אֶת־זֶ֣בַח שְׁלָמָ֔יו לַיהוָ֖ה יָבִ֣יא אֶת־קָרְבָּנ֑וֹ לַיהוָ֖ה מִזֶּ֣בַח שְׁלָמָֽיו

“The person presenting the sacrifice of his peace offerings to Yahweh shall bring his offering to Yahweh from the sacrifice of his peace offerings”

Here, the author of Leviticus uses the word **his** to switch back to the use of third-person singular forms to address the people of Israel. If the switch from third-person to second-person back to third-person forms would not be natural in your language, consider continuing to use whichever form you have been using in your translation throughout the previous chapters. Alternate translation: [If you present the sacrifice of your peace offerings to Yahweh, you should bring your offering to Yahweh from the sacrifice of your peace offerings]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Leviticus 7:30 (#1)

יָדָ֣יו תְּבִיאֶ֔ינָה

“His hands shall bring”

Here, **his hands** represent the whole person, emphasizing the individual’s personal responsibility and agency in bringing the sacrifice. If your language uses a similar expression to express this idea, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [He himself should bring] or, using the second-person [You yourself should bring]

See: Synecdoche

Leviticus 7:30 (#2)

אֶת־הַחֵ֣לֶב עַל־הֶֽחָזֶ֔ה & אֵ֖את הֶֽחָזֶ֑ה

“the fat on the breast & the breast”

Here, the **breast** is the portion of the animal’s flesh consisting of the larger part of the animal’s chest below the region of the neck. The **breast** and **the fat on the breast** were considered uniquely choice portions of meat and fat. Consequently, it was dedicated especially to Yahweh. If your language has a special term for this portion of meat and fat, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [the fat that is on the breast meat ... the breast meat itself]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 7:30 (#3)

לְהָנִ֥יף אֹתָ֛ם תְּנוּפָ֖ה לִפְנֵ֣י יְהוָ֑ה

“to raise it {as} a raised offering to the face of Yahweh”

For the priest **to wave** the offering in Yahweh’s presence is a symbolic gesture that shows that the person is dedicating the sacrifice to Yahweh. This act could mean: (1) merely presenting the sacrifice to Yahweh in a unique way. Alternate translation: [to lift and show off the breast meat of the sacrifice in Yahweh’s presence] or (2) causing the smell of the sacrifice to waft in Yahweh’s direction, creating a [pleasant smell to Yahweh] that would result in the acceptance of the sacrifice. Alternate translation: [to move the breast meat of the sacrifice back and forth overhead so that the smell of the meat is wafted to Yahweh’s presence]

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 7:30 (#4)

לִפְנֵ֣י יְהוָ֑ה

“to the face of Yahweh”

Here, the expression **to the face of Yahweh** means “toward the presence of Yahweh.” It indicates that Moses waved the loaves and the wafer in the direction of the Most Holy Place, where Yahweh lived among the Israelites. If it would be helpful to your readers, consider stating this plainly. Alternate translation: [in the direction of the Most Holy Place where Yahweh lived among the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 7:31 (#2)

לְאַהֲרֹן וּלְבָנָיו

“for Aaron and for his sons”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:2.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 7:31 (#1)

וְהָיְתָה֙ הֶֽחָזֶ֔ה לְאַהֲרֹ֖ן וּלְבָנָֽיו

“and the breast shall be for Aaron and for his sons”

This expression means that the meat of **the breast** should not be burned completely on the altar, but rather, it should be given to the priests for food. See how you translated this similar expression in 7:7.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 7:32 (#3)

תִּתְּנ֥וּ & שַׁלְמֵיכֶֽם

“you shall give & your peace offerings”

Here, **you** and **your** are plural. They refer to the people of Israel who would offer sacrifices at the tent of meeting. If your language uses a plural form to address a group of people, consider using that form here. If not, consider using the third person, as modeled by the previous note.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Leviticus 7:32 (#4)

תְּרוּמָ֖ה לַכֹּהֵ֑ן

“as} a contribution to the priest”

Previously the **contribution** belonged to Yahweh. Here it is implied that this unique portion of meat belonged to Yahweh for his purposes, specifically, to provide the priests with their allotment of food. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [as an important contribution of choice meat that provides the priests with food]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 7:32 (#2)

תִּתְּנ֥וּ & שַׁלְמֵיכֶֽם

“you shall give & your peace offerings”

As the Introduction to this chapter discusses, here the author of Leviticus suddenly switches from the use of third-person pronouns to the use of second-person plural forms. If the switch from third person to second-person forms would not be natural in your language, consider continuing to use whichever form you have been using for the previous chapters. Alternate translation: [the person presenting the offering shall give ... his peace offerings]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Leviticus 7:32 (#1)

וְאֵ֥ת שׁ֖וֹק הַיָּמִ֑ין

“And the right thigh”

The **right thigh** is the upper part of the right leg of the animal, directly above the knee and below the hip joint. Although the reason for the choice of the **right** portion of the thighs is unknown and debated, the **thigh** itself was considered a uniquely choice portion of meat, and so was especially dedicated to Yahweh and to his special purposes, such as providing food for the priests. If your language has a word for this choice portion of an animal’s meat, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [And the choice portion of meat between the hip and the knee joints on the right leg of the animal]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 7:33 (#1)

מִבְּנֵ֥י אַהֲרֹ֖ן

“from the sons of Aaron”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:5.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 7:33 (#2)

לֹ֥ו תִּהְיֶ֖ה שׁ֣וֹק הַיָּמִ֑ין לְמָנָֽה

“the right thigh shall be for him for a portion”

As the Introduction to this chapter discusses, this **portion** refers to the special allotment of food provided for the priests according to the laws that Yahweh gave to the people of Israel. Because the Levites, the sons of Aaron, were not given any portion of land and therefore could not farm for themselves, they were dependent on the contributions of their fellow Israelites for food. Yahweh provided this food by setting apart these choice portions for the priests. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the right thigh shall be for that priest as the allocation of his food given by Yahweh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 7:34 (#4)

אֹתָֽם

“them”

The pronoun **them** refers to the **breast** and the **right thigh**, those special portions of meat that Yahweh provided for the priests’ food. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the breast meat and the portion of the right thigh]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 7:34 (#5)

לְאַהֲרֹ֥ן הַכֹּהֵ֖ן וּלְבָנָ֑יו

“to Aaron the priest and to his sons”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:2.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 7:34 (#2)

לָקַ֜חְתִּי & וָאֶתְּנֵ֗ן

“I took & and I gave”

The pronoun **I** refers to Yahweh, who now speaks directly about himself. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [I, Yahweh, took … and I, Yahweh, gave]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 7:34 (#3)

בְּנֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל & בְּנֵ֥י יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל

“the sons of Israel & the sons of Israel”

See how you translated this expression in 1:2.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 7:34 (#6)

לְחָק־עוֹלָ֑ם

“as an enduring portion”

Alternate translation: [as a portion of food that should always be provided for the priests]

Leviticus 7:34 (#1)

כִּ֣י

“For”

The word translated as **For** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [This is because] or, using the second-person, [You should do this because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 7:35 (#1)

זֹ֚את מִשְׁחַ֣ת אַהֲרֹ֔ן וּמִשְׁחַ֖ת בָּנָ֑יו

“This {is} the allotment of Aaron and the allotment of his sons”

This **allotment** is the same as the “enduring portion” of the previous verse. It refers to the choice portions of meat—the breast and the right thigh—that Yahweh instructed should be given to the priests for food from the peace offerings that the people of Israel will offer. If your readers would not be familiar with this term, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [This is the portion of the meat of the sacrifices that should be given to Aaron and to his sons]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 7:35 (#3)

בְּי֗וֹם הַקְרִ֤יב אֹתָם֙ לְכַהֵ֣ן לַיהוָ֔ה

“on the day he presented them as priests to Yahweh”

The pronoun **he** refers to Moses, and **them** refers to **Aaron** and **his sons**. The expression **on the day he presented them as priests to Yahweh** refers to the day when Moses anointed Aaron and his sons with oil to dedicate them as priests in the service of Yahweh, as described in 8:12 and 8:30. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [on the day Moses presented Aaron and his sons as priests to Yahweh]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 7:35 (#2)

מֵאִשֵּׁ֥י יְהוָ֖ה

“from the gifts of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:3.

See: Possession

Leviticus 7:36 (#5)

חֻקַּ֥ת עוֹלָ֖ם לְדֹרֹתָֽם

“an enduring statute for their generations”

The expression **an enduring statute for their generations** leaves out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. It implies that every Israelite should always obey this commandment wherever they live. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [as an enduring statute] or [which will be an enduring statute]

See: Ellipsis

Leviticus 7:36 (#2)

בְּיוֹם֙ מָשְׁחָ֣ו אֹתָ֔ם

“on the day of his anointing them”

As in the previous verse, the pronoun **his** refers to Moses and **them** refers to the priests, that is, to Aaron and his sons. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [on the day Moses anointed Aaron and his sons as priests to Yahweh]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 7:36 (#4)

בְּנֵ֥י יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל

“the people of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:2.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 7:36 (#1)

בְּיוֹם֙ מָשְׁחָ֣ו אֹתָ֔ם מֵאֵ֖את בְּנֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל

“on the day of his anointing them from the people of Israel”

The expression **the day of his anointing them from the people of Israel** refers to the anointing of the priests to be especially dedicated to Yahweh, set apart from the rest of the people of God for special, sacred service to him. In this sense, the priests are anointed **from** the people of Israel. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [on the day of his anointing them to be priests to Yahweh and to be set apart from the rest of the people of Israel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 7:36 (#3)

בְּיוֹם֙ מָשְׁחָ֣ו אֹתָ֔ם

“on the day of his anointing them”

The act of **anointing** the priests was a symbolic action in which oil, usually olive oil, was liberally applied to the head of the priests to mark their dedication to special, sacred service to Yahweh. If this would not be clear to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [on the day of his anointing them with oil to mark their dedication to Yahweh as priests to him]

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 7:37 (#1)

וְלַמִּלּוּאִ֖ים

“and of the ordination offering”

This **ordination offering** was a special sacrifice that was offered on the occasion of the dedication of a priest to the priesthood, the special, sacred service to Yahweh. It is described in detail in 8:22–32. Alternate translation: [and of the sacrifice that is offered for the priests when they are dedicated to Yahweh as priests]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 7:38 (#1)

בְּי֣וֹם צַוֹּתֹ֔ו

“on the day of his commanding”

The expression **on the day of his commanding** could refer to: (1) Yahweh commanding the people of Israel to begin bringing their sacrifices. Alternate translation: [on the day Yahweh commanded] or (2) Moses, relaying the laws he received from Yahweh, commanding the people of Israel to begin bringing their sacrifices. Alternate translation: [on the day Moses commanded]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 7:38 (#3)

לְהַקְרִיבָ֥ אֶת־קָרְבְּנֵיהֶ֖ם

“to present their offerings”

See how you handled the poetic repetition of words in 1:2.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 7:38 (#2)

אֶת־בְּנֵ֥י יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל

“the sons of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:2.

Leviticus - Chapter 8 Introduction

See: Metaphor

Leviticus - Chapter 8 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter is a narrative, the first of a series of narratives that make up Leviticus 8–10. This story details how Moses inaugurated Aaron and his four sons to be priests in Israel. Yahweh instructs Moses to gather together Aaron and his sons and the whole congregation of Israel, along with the necessary elements of the inauguration ceremony (8:1–3). Once Moses does this (8:4–5), he prepares Aaron and his sons for the ceremony by ritually washing them with water (8:6) and clothing Aaron with the special clothing of the high priest (8:6–9). Moses then takes the special anointing oil and anoints the sacred tent, all its tools used for the worship and service of Yahweh (8:10–11), and Aaron as priest (8:12), before clothing Aaron's four sons with the special clothing of the priesthood (8:13). Next, Moses transitions to offering the various sacrifices required of the ceremony, including a bull for the sin offering (8:14–17), a ram for the burnt offering (8:18–21), and another ram for an ordination offering (8:22–29), the blood of which Aaron daubs on the extremities of Aaron and his sons in order to purify them from all uncleanness that comes from death, sin, or wrongdoing (8:23–24). From the ordination offering, Moses takes the special portions of fat, the right thigh, and the breast meat, and places them into the hands of Aaron and his sons and waves them in Yahweh's presence to dedicate them to Yahweh (8:25–27). The breast meat then belongs to Moses as food, as per Yahweh's law (8:28–29). Finally, Moses anoints Aaron and his sons and their clothing with oil once again, this time mixed with the purifying blood of the sacrifice (8:30), before instructing them how to eat the portions of the sacrifice that belong to them as food and how to participate in the seven-day process of being inaugurated as priests to Yahweh (8:31–35). The structure of the chapter is as follows:

1. Yahweh instructs Moses (8:1–3)
2. The Inauguration Ceremony (8:4–36)
3. Moses gathers the people (8:4–5)
4. Moses washes the priests and clothes Aaron (8:6–9)
5. Moses anoints the sacred tent, its tools, and Aaron with oil (8:10–12)
6. Moses clothes Aaron's sons (8:13)
7. Moses offers the sin offering (8:14–17)
8. Moses offers the burnt offering (8:18–21)
9. Moses offers the ordination offering (8:22–29)
10. Moses anoints Aaron and his sons with oil and blood (8:30)
11. Moses instructs the priests (8:31–36)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Many of the special concepts in this chapter are covered in the Introduction to Leviticus, including the burnt offering, the sin and ordination offerings, and the special role of blood in the sacrificial system of Leviticus. However, here blood and oil are applied in a unique way, warranting some explanation:

The expression "the oil of anointing" is used twice in this chapter to refer to the special olive oil that was used for the purpose of dedicating places, people, and objects for Yahweh's use alone. (See 8:10 and 8:30) In 8:10, the oil is expressly said to "make holy" whatever is sprinkled with oil. (Again, see 8:10–12 and 8:30) The oil is also poured on Aaron's head to set him apart for the unique task of being Israel's high priest, whereas it is "sprinkled," mixed with the blood of the ordination offering, on Aaron, his sons, and their clothing (8:30). This action likewise "makes holy" Aaron, his sons, and their clothing. If your language has a special word or expression for consecrating or anointing something or someone with oil, especially if there is a unique word for pouring this special oil on someone's head, consider using these words in this chapter.

Blood plays a similar but unique role in this chapter. Whereas the blood of the sacrifice often serves to purify the altar from the impurity of sin or uncleanness that the sacrifice "absorbs," so to speak (see it perform this function in this chapter in 8:15 and 8:19), here Moses applies the blood to the extremities of Aaron and his sons, specifically their right earlobes, thumbs of their right hand, and big toes of their right foot. (See 8:23–24) Because of the special property of blood (as the "life" of the animal) to remove impurity, this ritual action removes any impurity caused by proximity to death, sin, or wrongdoing from the whole body of Aaron and his sons. By metonymy, their extremities represent their entire bodies. If this action would not be clear in your language, consider explaining its meaning in a footnote or in the body of your translation. Additionally, if your language has a specific word or expression for applying blood to a person, especially in a ritual or religious context, consider using that word or expression here.

Leviticus 8:1 (#1)

לֵאמֹֽר

“saying”

The word translated as **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, consider ways in which you might introduce this quotation naturally in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Leviticus 8:2 (#1)

וְאֶת־בָּנָ֖יו אִתּֽוֹ

“and his sons with him”

Alternate translation: [and his four sons, Nadab, Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar]

Leviticus 8:2 (#3)

וְאֵ֥את שֶׁ֖מֶן הַמִּשְׁחָ֑ה

“and the oil of anointing”

The expression **oil of anointing** uses the possessive form to describe olive oil that was mixed with perfuming spices and used for ceremonially setting priests and kings apart for service to Yahweh. This was done by sprinkling or pouring the oil on whomever or whatever was being set apart. This oil is described in detail in Exodus 30:23–24. If your language does not have an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **anointing**, you can express the same idea with a verbal form. Alternate translation: [and the oil that is used to anoint people and things for service to Yahweh]

See: Possession

Leviticus 8:2 (#4)

וְאֵ֥את ׀ פַּ֖ר הַחַטָּֽאת

“and the bull of the sin offering”

The expression **the bull of the sin offering** uses the possessive form to describe the bull that had been selected to be sacrificed for a **sin offering**. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and the bull that Aaron and his sons will present as a sin offering]

See: Possession

Leviticus 8:2 (#2)

וְאֵת֙ הַבְּגָדִ֔ים

“and the clothes”

Alternate translation: [and the priestly garments] or [and the special clothes that the priests wore]

Leviticus 8:6 (#2)

וַיִּרְחַ֥ץ אֹתָ֖ם בַּמָּֽיִם

“and he washed them with water”

This is a symbolic action that is required by the ordination ceremony as described in Exodus 29:1–46. Here, washing with water is part of a ritual cleaning that prepares Aaron and his sons to become priests. If it would be helpful to your readers, consider explaining the significance of this action in a footnote or in the text of your translation. Alternate translation: [and he washed them with water in order to purify them and prepare them to become priests to Yahweh]

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 8:6 (#1)

וַיַּקְרֵ֥ב מֹשֶׁ֖ה אֶת־אַהֲרֹ֣ן וְאֶת־בָּנָ֑יו

“Moses presented Aaron and his sons”

To **present** someone or something is a symbolic action that includes bringing the person, object, or animal to the entrance of the tent of meeting, where Yahweh lived among the Israelites. Here, the same verb is used of Aaron and his sons that was used for the sacrifices in Leviticus 1–7. Alternate translation: [And Moses brought Aaron and his sons forward to stand in Yahweh’s presence]

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 8:6 (#3)

וַיִּרְחַ֥ץ אֹתָ֖ם בַּמָּֽיִם

“and he washed them with water”

It might seem that the expression **and he washed them with water** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in your language. If so, you could use an equivalent expression. See how you translated this expression in 1:9. Alternate translation: [and he thoroughly washed them]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Leviticus 8:7 (#2)

אֶת־הַמְּעִ֔יל

“with} the robe”

This **robe** was a blue and purple outer garment made from woven wool; it was a single piece of fabric with

an opening for the head, as described in Exodus 28:31–35 and Exodus 39:22–26. If your language has a term for a piece of religious clothing of this type, consider using it here. If not, use a generic term. Alternate translation: [with the special coat]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 8:7 (#3)

אֶת־הָאֵפֹד

“the ephod”

The word **ephod** is a word borrowed from Hebrew. You will need to decide if you will also borrow this word into your language or if you will translate the meaning. Either approach has broad support. If you borrow the word, you could spell it the way it sounds in your language and then put the translation in a footnote. Alternate translation: [the priest’s special apron]

See: Copy or Borrow Words

Leviticus 8:7 (#4)

בְּחֵשֶׁב הָאֵפֹד

“with the finely woven waistband of the ephod”

This **finely woven waistband** was a piece of skillfully woven linen embroidered with blue, red, and purple thread; it was to be worn around the waist, and it matched the priestly **ephod**. It is described in Exodus 28:8, Exodus 39:5, and Exodus 39:20–21. If your language has a term for a piece of religious clothing of this type, consider using it here. If not, use a generic term. Alternate translation: [with the special linen belt of the ephod]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 8:7 (#5)

וַיֶּאְפֹּד לוֹ בּוֹ

“and he fastened {the ephod} on him with it”

Alternate translation: [and he attached the ephod to him with it]

Leviticus 8:7 (#1)

בָּאַבְנֵט

“with the sash”

This **sash** was a length of linen fabric that was worn on top of the **tunic** and was embroidered with blue, purple, and scarlet colors and hemmed with little bells and the designs of pomegranates, as described in Exodus 28:4, Exodus 28:39–40, Exodus 29:9, and Exodus 29:29. If your language has a term for a piece of religious clothing of this type, consider using it here. If not, use a generic term. Alternate translation: [with the special girdle]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 8:8 (#1)

אֶת־הָאוּרִים וְאֶת־הַתֻּמִּים

“the Urim and the Thummim”

Although their exact identity and function are debated, **the Urim and the Thummim** appear to have been objects that the priests used as oracles in the sacred tent in order to determine the will of Yahweh. The **Urim and the Thummim** rested in the pocket of the priests’ **breastpiece** and Exodus 28:30 states that they were to be “over Aaron’s heart when he comes before the Lord.” If your language has a word for this kind of religious object, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [the special stones that the priests use to determine what Yahweh wants to do]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 8:8 (#2)

אֶת־הָאוּרִים וְאֶת־הַתֻּמִּים

“the Urim and the Thummim”

The words **Urim** and **Thummim** are borrowed from Hebrew. You will need to decide if you will also borrow these words into your language or if you will translate their meaning. If you borrow the words, you could spell them in the way they sound in your language and then put the translation in a footnote. Alternate translation: [the special stones that helped the priest determine Yahweh’s will]

See: Copy or Borrow Words

Leviticus 8:9 (#1)

אֶת־הַמִּצְנֶפֶת

“the turban”

A **turban** is a man’s head covering made from a long piece of cloth wrapped around the head. This **turban** was made of finely woven linen (according to Exodus 28:39) and was to be worn by the priests to cover their heads when they offered sacrifices to Yahweh. If your language has a term for a piece of religious clothing of this type, consider using it here. If not, use a generic term. Alternate translation: [the high priest’s special headdress] or [the headgear worn by the high priest]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 8:9 (#2)

אֶל־מִמּוּל פָּנָיו

“to the front of its face”

The expression **the front of its face** is an idiom. It refers to the front of the turban to which the **plate of gold** was affixed. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to the front side of the turban]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 8:9 (#3)

אֵת צִיץ הַזָּהָב

“the flower of gold”

This **flower of gold** was likely a decorative, shaped plate of gold engraved with the words “Holy to Yahweh,” (according to Exodus 28:36). Exodus 28:36–38 explains that this **flower of gold** allowed the priests to bear the guilt of the Israelites as they offered sacrifices on behalf of the people. If your language has a term for this special religious item, consider using it here. If not, use a generic term. Alternate translation: [the special engraved gold sign]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 8:9 (#4)

נֵזֶר הַקֹּדֶשׁ

“the crown of holiness”

The expression **the crown of holiness** uses the possessive form to refer to either: (1) a crown that was especially holy. Alternate translation: [the holy crown] or (2) a crown that bore and represented the priest’s own holiness. Alternate translation: [the crown that shows how holy the priest is]

See: Possession

Leviticus 8:10 (#1)

אֶת־שֶׁמֶן הַמִּשְׁחָה

“the oil of anointing”

See how you translated this expression in 8:2.

See: Possession

Leviticus 8:10 (#2)

וַיִּמְשַׁח אֶת־הַמִּשְׁכָּן וְאֶת־כָּל־אֲשֶׁר־בּוֹ

“and he anointed the Dwelling and all that {was} in it”

This is a ritual action. By sprinkling and pouring the special anointing oil on all the utensils and furniture of the tent of meeting, Moses set them apart for exclusive use for Yahweh’s purposes. This ceremony is described in detail in Exodus 30:26–29.

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 8:11 (#1)

וַיַּז מִמֶּנּוּ

“And he sprinkled some of it”

The pronoun **it** refers to the oil of anointing referenced in the previous verse. If it would be helpful for your readers, consider making the referent explicit. Alternate translation: [And he sprinkled some of the oil of anointing]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 8:11 (#5)

לְקַדְּשָׁם

“to consecrate them”

Here the word **to** marks **consecrate** as the goal or purpose of sprinkling them with the oil of anointing. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. It may be helpful to start a new sentence here. Alternate translation, with a period before: [He did this to make them holy]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Leviticus 8:11 (#2)

וְאֶת־כָּל־כֵּלָיו

“all its utensils and”

Alternate translation: [every pot, pan, shovel, and fork used at the altar in the tent of meeting]

Leviticus 8:11 (#3)

וְאֶת־הַכִּיֹּר

“the basin and”

This **basin** was a large bronze tub that was filled with water and used for ritual washing. It is described in Exodus 30:17–21. If your language has a term for a religious item of this type, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic term. Alternate translation: [and the special bronze tub]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 8:11 (#4)

וְאֶת־כַּנּוֹ

“and & its base”

This **base** was made of bronze. On top of it sat **the basin**. It is mentioned in Exodus 30:18, where the basin is also described. If your language has a term for a religious item of this type, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic term. Alternate translation: [and the bronze stand for the basin]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 8:12 (#2)

וַיִּמְשַׁ֥ח אֹתָ֖ו

“and he anointed him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:10.

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 8:12 (#1)

מִשֶּׁ֣מֶן הַמִּשְׁחָ֑ה

“some of the oil of anointing”

See how you translated the similar possessive form in 8:2.

See: Possession

Leviticus 8:12 (#3)

לְקַדְּשֹׁ֖ו

“to consecrate him”

Here the word **to** marks the consecration of Aaron as the goal or purpose of pouring **the oil of anointing** on his head. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. It may be helpful to start a new sentence here. Alternate translation, with a period before: [He did this to make Aaron holy]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Leviticus 8:13 (#2)

מִגְבָּעֹ֥ות

“headbands”

These **headbands** were made of cloth of finely woven linen that were likely wound about the head. If your language has a term for a piece of religious clothing of this type, consider using it here. If not, use a generic term. Alternate translation: [the priests’ special head-wrappings]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 8:13 (#1)

וַיַּקְרֵ֣ב מֹשֶׁ֔ה אֶת־בְּנֵ֖י אַהֲרֹ֑ן

“And Moses presented the sons of Aaron”

See how you translated this symbolic action in 8:6.

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 8:14 (#3)

וַיִּסְמְכ֣וּ אַהֲרֹ֔ן וּבָנָ֖יו אֶת־יְדֵיהֶ֑ם עַל־רֹ֖אשׁ פַּ֥ר הַחַטָּֽאת

“And Aaron and his sons laid their hands on the head of the bull of the sin offering”

This is a symbolic action that identifies **Aaron and his sons** with the animal they are offering. In this way, they are placing their sin on the animal in Yahweh’s presence. See how you translated this action in 1:4.

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 8:14 (#2)

אֵ֖ת פַּ֣ר הַחַטָּ֑את & פַּ֥ר הַחַטָּֽאת

“the bull of the sin offering & the bull of the sin offering”

See how you translated this possessive form in 8:2.

See: Possession

Leviticus 8:14 (#1)

וַיַּגֵּ֖שׁ אֵ֣את פַּ֣ר הַחַטָּ֑את

“And he brought the bull of the sin offering near”

To bring **the bull of the sin offering near** is a symbolic action equivalent to the expression “to present” used in this chapter and elsewhere in Leviticus. It refers to bringing the person, object, or animal to the entrance of the tent of meeting, where Yahweh lived among the Israelites and showing it off to Yahweh. If the significance of this action would be unclear in your language, consider making the meaning plain. Alternate translation: [And he led the bull of the sin offering to Yahweh’s presence in the tent of meeting]

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 8:15 (#4)

וַיְקַדֵּ֣שׁ עָלָ֔יו לְכַפֵּ֖ר עָלָֽיו

“And he made it holy to make atonement on it”

Here, the word **to** marks making **atonement** on the altar as the goal or purpose of Moses purifying the altar. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. Alternate translation:

[And he made it holy. He did this so that atonement might be made on it]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Leviticus 8:15 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁחָט

“And he slaughtered {it”

The one who offered a sacrifice would usually be the one who would slaughter the animal for that sacrifice. However, in this case, even though Moses is offering the sacrifice, the pronoun **he** likely refers to Aaron, acting together with his sons. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making the referent plain. Alternate translation: [And Aaron and his sons slaughtered it]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 8:15 (#5)

לְכַפֵּר עָלָיו

“to make atonement on it”

See how you handled this expression and its abstract noun in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 8:15 (#3)

וַיְחַטֵּא אֶת־הַמִּזְבֵּחַ

“And he purified the altar”

Here, **he purified the altar** means that his symbolic action cleansed it from the impurity caused by the presence of sin. By putting blood on the horns of the altar and pouring blood on the altar’s base, Moses uses the cleansing power of blood to purify the altar and prepare it to be a vessel through which acceptable sacrifices might be offered. If this would be unclear in your language, consider clarifying by adding words in your translation or by supplying a footnote. Alternate translation: [And, by putting blood on the altar, he purified the altar from the impurity of sin in order to make it an acceptable place to offer sacrifices to Yahweh]

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 8:15 (#2)

וַיִּקַּח מֹשֶׁה אֶת־הַדָּם

“and Moses took the blood”

See how you handled the implied information in this expression in 1:5.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 8:17 (#1)

שָׂרַף בָּאֵשׁ

“he burned with fire”

See how you handled the extra information in this expression in 4:12.

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Leviticus 8:17 (#2)

שָׂרַף בָּאֵשׁ

“he burned with fire”

Although the subject is not stated, the pronoun **he** cannot refer to either Moses, who offers the sacrifice as the priest, or to Aaron and his sons, who are being ordained as priests. As previously mentioned, this action must be accomplished by someone else who can afford to risk becoming unclean through contact with the carcass of the dead animal. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making the referent explicit. Alternate translation: [someone else burned with fire] or [another Israelite burned with fire]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 8:18 (#2)

וַיִּסְמְכוּ אַהֲרֹן וּבָנָיו אֶת־יְדֵיהֶם עַל־רֹאשׁ הָאָיִל

“And Aaron and his sons laid their hands on the head of the ram”

This is a symbolic action that identifies **Aaron and his sons** with the animal they are offering. In this way, they are placing their sin on the animal in Yahweh’s presence. See how you translated this in 1:4.

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 8:18 (#1)

אֵאֵת אֵיל הָעֹלָה

“the ram of the burnt offering”

See how you translated the similar possessive form in 8:2.

See: Possession

Leviticus 8:19 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁחָט

“And he slaughtered {it”

The one who offered a sacrifice would usually slaughter the animal for that sacrifice. However, in this case, even though Moses is offering the sacrifice, the pronoun **he** likely refers to Aaron, acting together with his sons. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making the referent plain. Alternate translation: [And Aaron and his sons slaughtered it]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 8:20 (#2)

וְאֶת־הַנְּתָחִים

“and the pieces”

The expression **the pieces** implies all the portions of the animal’s body, all but the skin, that would be included in the burnt offering, according to the laws recorded in Leviticus 1:8 and Leviticus 7:8. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and, except for the skin that was given to the priest, all of the body parts]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 8:20 (#1)

וְאֶת־הָאַיִל נִתַּח לְנְתָחָיו

“And he cut the ram into its pieces”

For emphasis, a verb and its object from the same root are being used. The verb **cut** is related to the noun **pieces**. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [And he carefully and thoroughly butchered the ram into its various pieces]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 8:20 (#3)

וְאֶת־הַפָּדֶר

“and the suet”

See how you translated this fat portion in 1:8.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 8:21 (#1)

רָחַץ בַּמָּיִם

“he washed with water”

See how you handled the extra information in this expression in 1:5.

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Leviticus 8:22 (#1)

אֵיל הַמִּלֻּאִים

“the ram of the ordination offering”

The expression **the ram of the ordination offering** uses the possessive form to describe the **ram** that had been selected to be sacrificed for an **ordination offering**. If this would be unclear in your language, consider making the meaning explicit. Alternate translation: [the ram that Aaron and his sons presented as an ordination offering]

See: Possession

Leviticus 8:23 (#1)

וַיִּתֵּן עַל־תְּנוּךְ אֹזֶן־אַהֲרֹן הַיְמָנִית וְעַל־בֹּהֶן יָדוֹ הַיְמָנִית וְעַל־בֹּהֶן רַגְלוֹ הַיְמָנִית

“and he put {it} on the earlobe of the right ear of Aaron and on the thumb of his right hand and on the big toe of his right foot”

This is a symbolic action. Just as placing blood on the extremities of the altar purified it and prepared it to be an appropriate vessel through which acceptable sacrifices might be offered to Yahweh, by placing blood on Aaron’s right earlobe, the thumb of his right hand, and the big toe of his right foot Moses purifies Aaron and prepares him to be set apart for offering acceptable sacrifices to Yahweh. If this would not be clear in your language, consider explaining the meaning of this rite in a footnote or in the text of your translation. Alternate translation: [and he gave it on the earlobe of the right ear of Aaron and on the thumb of his right hand and on the big toe of his right foot. He did this in order to purify Aaron from the impurity of sin and to prepare him to offer acceptable sacrifices to Yahweh]

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 8:24 (#2)

וַיִּתֵּן מֹשֶׁה מִן־הַדָּם עַל־תְּנוּךְ אָזְנָם הַיְמָנִית וְעַל־בֹּהֶן יָדָם הַיְמָנִית וְעַל־בֹּהֶן רַגְלָם הַיְמָנִית

“and Moses put some of the blood on the earlobe of their right ear and on the thumb of their right hand and on the big toe of their right foot”

Just as was done with Aaron, this is a ritual action. Just as placing blood on the extremities of the altar purified it and prepared it to be an appropriate vessel through which acceptable sacrifices might be offered to Yahweh, by placing blood on Aaron’s sons’ right

earlobes, the thumbs of their right hands, and the big toes of their right feet, Moses purified Aaron's sons and prepared them to be set apart for offering acceptable sacrifices to Yahweh. If this would not be clear in your language, consider explaining the meaning of this rite in a footnote or in the text of your translation. Alternate translation: [and Moses gave some of the blood on the earlobe of their right ear and on the thumb of their right hand and on the big toe of their right foot. He did this in order to purify Aaron's sons from the impurity of sin and to prepare them to offer acceptable sacrifices to Yahweh]

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 8:24 (#1)

וַיַּקְרֵ֔ב אֶת־בְּנֵ֖י אַהֲרֹ֑ן

"And he presented the sons of Aaron"

See how you translated this symbolic action in 8:6.

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 8:26 (#2)

וּמִסַּ֣ל הַמַּצּ֗וֹת

"And from the basket of the unleavened bread"

The expression **the basket of the unleavened bread** uses the possessive form to describe a basket that is characterized by the presence of unleavened bread. If this would be unclear in your language, consider stating the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And from the basket that contained the unleavened bread]

See: Possession

Leviticus 8:26 (#3)

וְחַלַּ֥ת לֶ֖חֶם שֶׁ֣מֶן אַחַ֑ת

"and one loaf of bread of oil"

The expression **loaf of bread of oil** uses the possessive form to describe a loaf of bread that is characterized by the presence of oil on top. It corresponds to the bread whose flour is well-soaked with oil in 7:12. Alternate translation: [and one loaf of bread that was well-soaked with oil]

See: Possession

Leviticus 8:26 (#1)

וּמִסַּ֣ל הַמַּצּ֗וֹת אֲשֶׁ֤ר ׀ לִפְנֵ֬י יְהוָ֗ה

"And from the basket of the unleavened bread that {was} to the face of Yahweh"

The expression **to the face of Yahweh** here refers to the location of the **basket of the unleavened bread**, as specified in Exodus 29:3. If it would be helpful in your language, consider stating the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And from the basket of the unleavened bread that was placed in Yahweh's presence in the sacred precincts of the sacred tent where Yahweh lived among the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 8:27 (#2)

וַיָּ֥נֶף אֹתָ֛ם תְּנוּפָ֖ה

"and he raised them {as} a raised offering"

Although the subject is not named, because it is usually the person offering the sacrifice who is authorized to dedicate the portions of the sacrifice to Yahweh by waving them in his presence, it is likely that **he** here refers to Aaron and his sons. This is further clarified by the fact that Moses placed the portions of fat, the right thigh, and the loaves of bread in the open palms of Aaron and his sons. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making the referent explicit. Alternate translation: [and Aaron and his sons waved them as a wave offering]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 8:27 (#3)

וַיָּ֥נֶף אֹתָ֛ם תְּנוּפָ֖ה

"and he raised them {as} a raised offering"

See how you translated this symbolic action and its corresponding type of offering in 7:30.

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 8:27 (#1)

אֶת־הַכֹּ֑ל

"the whole"

Here, **the whole** implies giving Aaron and his sons the fat portions, the right thigh, and all of the loaves of bread. If it would be helpful, consider making the referent explicit. Alternate translation: [all the portions of fat, the right thigh, and the loaves of bread]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 8:27 (#4)

לִפְנֵ֥י יְהוָֽה

"to the face of Yahweh"

Here, the expression **to the face of Yahweh** means "toward the presence of Yahweh." It indicates that Moses waved the loaves and the wafer in the direction of the Most Holy Place, where Yahweh lived among the Israelites. If it would be helpful to your readers, consider stating this plainly. Alternate translation: [in the direction of the Most Holy Place where Yahweh lived among the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 8:28 (#1)

וַיִּקַּ֤ח מֹשֶׁה֙ אֹתָ֔ם

"And Moses took them"

Here, the pronoun **them** refers to the fat portions, the right thigh, and all of the loaves of bread. If it would be helpful, consider making the referent explicit. Alternate translation: [And Moses took the portions of fat, the right thigh, and the loaves of bread]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 8:29 (#1)

וַיְנִיפֵ֥ם תְּנוּפָ֖ה

"and he raised it {as} a raised offering"

See how you translated this symbolic action and its corresponding type of offering in 7:30.

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 8:29 (#2)

לִפְנֵ֥י יְהוָ֖ה

"to the face of Yahweh"

Here, the expression **to the face of Yahweh** means "in the presence of Yahweh," or "toward the direction of the Most Holy Place where Yahweh lives among the Israelites." If it would be helpful to your readers, consider stating this plainly. Alternate translation: [in the direction of the Most Holy Place, where Yahweh lives among the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 8:30 (#1)

וּמִן־הַדָּ֛ם אֲשֶׁ֥ר עַל־הַמִּזְבֵּ֖חַ

"and some of the blood that {was} on the altar"

The expression **the blood that was on the altar** implies the blood of the sacrificed animal that had earlier been placed on the horns of the altar. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and some of the blood that he had previously put on the four horns of the altar]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 8:30 (#2)

וַיַּ֤ז עַל־אַהֲרֹן֙ עַל־בְּגָדָ֔יו וְעַל־בָּנָ֖יו וְעַל־בִּגְדֵ֣י בָנָ֑יו אִתּ֔וֹ

"and he sprinkled {them} on Aaron, on his clothes, and on his sons, and on the clothes of his sons with him"

This is a ritual action. Just as sprinkling the oil on the utensils of the sacred tent sanctified them and dedicated them for service to Yahweh, the mixture of blood and oil both dedicated Aaron and his sons for service to Yahweh as priests and purified them and their clothing from the impurity of sin through the cleansing nature of blood. If this would not be clear to your readers, consider stating the meaning of the symbolic action in a footnote or in the text of your translation. Alternate translation: [and he sprinkled them on Aaron, on his clothes, and on his sons and on the clothes of his sons with him. He did this in order to dedicate Aaron and his sons and to purify them from the impurity of sin]

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 8:31 (#1)

אֶת־הַבָּשָׂר֙

"the meat"

Although it is unclear, it is likely that here **the meat** implies the meat of the ram that Aaron and his sons offered as an ordination offering and that Moses waved as a wave offering in Yahweh's presence. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the meat of the ram of the ordination offering]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 8:31 (#4)

כַּאֲשֶׁ֥ר צִוֵּ֖יתִי לֵאמֹ֑ר אַהֲרֹ֥ן וּבָנָ֖יו יֹאכְלֻֽהוּ

"just as I commanded, saying, 'Aaron and his sons shall eat it"

This is a quotation within a quotation. You can state this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [just as I commanded when I said that Aaron and his sons shall eat it]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Leviticus 8:31 (#3)

בְּסַל הַמִּלֻּאִים

“is} in the basket of the ordination offering”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:22.

See: Possession

Leviticus 8:31 (#2)

תֹּאכְלֻ֑הוּ

“you shall eat”

Here, the pronoun **you** is plural. It refers to Aaron and his sons, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 8:32 (#1)

בָּאֵשׁ תִּשְׂרֹֽפוּ

“you shall burn in the fire”

See how you handled the extra information in this expression in 4:12.

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Leviticus 8:32 (#2)

בָּאֵשׁ תִּשְׂרֹֽפוּ

“you shall burn in the fire”

Here, **you** is plural. It refers to Aaron and his sons, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 8:33 (#1)

תֵּצְא֗וּ & מִלֻּאֵיכֶם & אֶת־יֶדְכֶם

“you shall & go out & your ordination & your hand”

The pronouns **you** and **your** are plural here. They refer to Aaron and his sons, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 8:33 (#4)

כִּֽי שִׁבְעַ֥ת יָמִ֛ים יְמַלֵּ֖א אֶת־יֶדְכֶֽם

“because {for} seven days, he will fill your hand”

The expression **he will fill your hand** is an idiom that means to induct someone into the ministry and responsibilities of the priesthood. According to this verse, it will take seven days for Yahweh to induct Aaron and his sons into the priesthood. (See Exodus 28:41 and Exodus 29:9 for representative examples.) If this would not be clear to your readers, consider stating the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [because it will take seven days for Yahweh to give you the responsibilities of the priesthood and dedicate you as priests]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 8:33 (#2)

עַ֚ד יוֹם֙ מְלֹ֣את יְמֵ֔י מִלֻּאֵיכֶ֖ם

“until the day of the filling of the days of your ordination”

Words from the same root are being repeated in a poetic word-play. The words **filling** and **ordination** come from the same root as the verbal expression **he will fill**. If your language has similarly related words that would convey these meanings, consider using them here. If not, consider stating the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [until the day when your ordination is filled up because, during those seven days, he will fill up your hands]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 8:33 (#3)

יְמֵ֔י מִלֻּאֵיכֶ֖ם

“the days of your ordination”

Alternate translation: [the days when you are being ordained as priests in service to Yahweh]

Leviticus 8:34 (#1)

כַּאֲשֶׁ֥ר עָשָׂ֛ה בַּיּ֥וֹם הַזֶּ֖ה צִוָּ֣ה יְהוָ֑ה לַֽעֲשֹׂ֖ת

“Just as he did on this day, Yahweh commanded to do”

Alternate translation: [What has been done today is just as Yahweh commanded should be done]

Leviticus 8:34 (#2)

לְכַפֵּ֥ר עֲלֵיכֶֽם

“to make atonement for you”

See how you handled the word **atonement** in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 8:34 (#3)

לְכַפֵּ֥ר עֲלֵיכֶֽם

“to make atonement for you”

Here, **to** marks making **atonement** as the goal or purpose of Yahweh’s commandments regarding the procedure of the various sacrifices performed on this day. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. It may be helpful to start a new sentence here. Alternate translation, with a period before: [He did this so that he might make atonement for you]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Leviticus 8:34 (#4)

עֲלֵיכֶם

“for you”

Here, the pronoun **you** is plural. It refers to Aaron and his sons, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 8:35 (#6)

כִּי־כֵ֖ן צִוֵּ֥יתִי

“because thus I have been commanded”

The word translated as **because** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation, with a period before: [You should do all this because thus I have been commanded]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 8:35 (#5)

כִּי־כֵ֖ן צִוֵּ֥יתִי

“because thus I have been commanded”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [because thus Yahweh commanded me]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 8:35 (#7)

צִוֵּ֥יתִי

“I have been commanded”

Here the pronoun **I** refers to Moses. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [I, Moses, have been commanded]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 8:35 (#3)

וּשְׁמַרְתֶּ֣ם אֶת־מִשְׁמֶ֣רֶת יְהוָ֔ה

“and you shall keep the watch of Yahweh”

To **keep** the **watch of Yahweh** does not mean to stand and guard the entrance to the sacred tent. Rather, the expression implies carefully avoiding Yahweh’s prohibitions, the things Yahweh has commanded his people not to do. If this meaning would not be clear, consider stating the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you will carefully keep Yahweh’s laws about what you are not to do]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 8:35 (#4)

וְלֹ֥א תָמֻ֖תוּ

“and you will not die”

The phrase **and you will not die** is the result of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a result of what came before. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [and by doing this, you will not die]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 8:35 (#1)

תֵּשְׁבוּ֙ & וּשְׁמַרְתֶּ֣ם & וְלֹ֥א תָמֻ֖תוּ

“you shall stay & and you shall keep & and you will not die”

Here, the pronoun **you** is plural. It refers to Aaron and his sons, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 8:35 (#2)

וּשְׁמַרְתֶּ֣ם אֶת־מִשְׁמֶ֣רֶת יְהוָ֔ה

“and you shall keep the watch of Yahweh”

Words from the same root are repeated for emphasis. The word **watch** is from the same root as the verb **keep**. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 8:36 (#1)

אֲשֶׁר־צִוָּ֥ה יְהוָ֖ה בְּיַד־מֹשֶֽׁה

“that Yahweh commanded by the hand of Moses”

The expression **by the hand of Moses** uses one part of a person, the **hand**, to represent all of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that Yahweh commanded through Moses]

See: Synecdoche

Leviticus - Chapter 9 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter is another narrative piece in which Moses instructs Aaron to offer sin and burnt offerings for himself, and sin, burnt, grain, and peace offerings for the people, so that the “glory of Yahweh” would appear to the people, having atoned them. After instructing Aaron (9:1–7), Aaron offers for himself the sin offering, offering a bull calf in the prescribed way (9:8–11). Next, he offers the burnt offering for himself, offering a ram in the prescribed way (9:12–14). After this, Aaron makes sacrifices for the people of Israel, offering a male goat for a sin offering (9:15), a bull calf and a lamb for burnt offerings (9:16), a grain offering (9:17), and finally, an ox and a ram for peace offerings (9:18–20) complete with a wave offering of the breast meat and the right thigh of the ox and the ram (9:21). In an incredible conclusion, Aaron blesses the people, and Moses and Aaron enter the sacred tent (9:22–23). When they come out, after blessing the people again, the “glory of Yahweh” appears to the people as “fire from before the face of Yahweh” comes out of the sacred tent and consumes the fat and meat on the burnt offering altar (9:23–24). In response to this incredible sight, the people shout and fall to the ground (9:24). The structure of the chapter is as follows:

1. Moses instructs Aaron (9:1–7)
2. Aaron performs sacrifices for himself (9:8–14)
3. the sin offering for Aaron (9:8–11)
4. the burnt offering for Aaron (9:12–14)
5. Aaron performs sacrifices for the people of Israel (9:15–21)
6. the sin offering for the people (9:15)
7. the burnt offering for the people (9:16)
8. the grain offering for the people (9:17)
9. the peace offering for the people, including the wave offering (9:18–21)
10. The glory of Yahweh appears to the people (9:22–24)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Most of the special concepts in this chapter are discussed in the Introduction to Leviticus, including the burnt, grain, sin, and peace offerings, including the wave offering, the unique function of blood, the abstract noun “atonement,” and the ritual act of converting sacrifices to smoke on the altar.

Leviticus 9:1 (#2)

בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁמִינִי

“on the eighth day”

The **eighth day** is the first day after the seven-day period of the ordination ceremony. Alternate translation: [on the first day after the ordination ceremony was completed]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Leviticus 9:1 (#1)

בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁמִינִי

“on the eighth day”

The word **eighth** is the ordinal number for eight.

See: Ordinal Numbers

Leviticus 9:2 (#5)

לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“to the face of Yahweh”

As the Introduction to Leviticus discusses, in contexts such as this, the expression **to the face of Yahweh** means “where Yahweh can see” and, by extension, “in Yahweh’s presence.” See how you translated this expression in 1:5. Alternate translation: [before Yahweh] or [in the precincts of the sacred tent, where Yahweh lives among the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 9:2 (#2)

וַיֹּאמֶר אֶל־אַהֲרֹן

“And he said to Aaron”

The word translated as **said** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, consider ways in which you might introduce this quotation naturally in your language. Alternate translation: [And he spoke to Aaron, saying] or [And he told Aaron]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Leviticus 9:2 (#1)

עֵגֶל בֶּן־בָּקָר לְחַטָּאת וְאַיִל לְעֹלָה תְּמִימִם

“a calf, a son of the cattle, for a sin offering, and a ram for a burnt offering, perfect”

For a discussion of the word **perfect**, see the section titled “‘Unblemished’ or ‘perfect’” in Part 3 of the Introduction to Leviticus. Alternate translation: [an unblemished calf, a son of the cattle, for a sin offering, and an unblemished ram for a burnt offering] or [a calf without blemish, a son of the cattle, for a sin offering, and a ram without blemish for a burnt offering]

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 9:2 (#4)

וְהַקְרֵב

“and present {them”

See how you translated this symbolic action in 8:6.

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 9:2 (#3)

בֶּן־בָּקָר

“a son of the cattle”

See how you translated this expression in 1:5.

See: Idiom

Leviticus 9:3 (#3)

תְּדַבֵּר

“you will speak”

Here, **you** is singular. It refers to Aaron, so use the singular form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 9:3 (#6)

עִזִּים

“the goats”

The expression **the goats** does not refer to a specific group of goats. It describes any groups of goats that an Israelite might own. Express this in the way that would be most natural in your language. Alternate translation: [any of the goats that you own]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 9:3 (#1)

וְאֶל־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל תְּדַבֵּר לֵאמֹר קְחוּ שְׂעִיר־עִזִּים

“And to the sons of Israel, you will speak, saying, ‘Take a buck of the goats”

This expression introduces a direct quote within a direct quote. You could change this into an indirect quote. Alternate translation: [And you should tell the sons of Israel to take a buck of the goats]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Leviticus 9:3 (#2)

בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the sons of Israel”

See how you translated this expression in 1:2.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 9:3 (#4)

לֵאמֹר

“saying”

The word translated as **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, consider ways in which you might introduce this quotation naturally in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Leviticus 9:3 (#5)

שְׂעִיר־עִזִּים

“a buck of the goats”

The expression **a buck of the goats** used the possessive form to refer to a male goat that belongs to the class of animals also called goats. If your language possesses a specific term for a male goat, consider using it here or use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [an adult male goat]

See: Possession

Leviticus 9:3 (#7)

וְעֵגֶל וָכֶבֶשׂ בְּנֵי־שָׁנָה תְּמִימִם

“and a calf and a lamb, perfect sons of a year”

The expression **sons of a year** is an idiom that refers to animals that are a year old. If your language has a similar idiom, consider using it here. If not, state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and a perfect calf and a perfect lamb that are a year old] or [and a

perfect calf and a perfect lamb that are twelve months of age]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 9:4 (#2)

וּמִנְחָ֖ה בְּלוּלָ֑ה בַּשָּׁ֖מֶן

“and a grain offering mixed with oil”

See how you translated this expression in 7:10. Alternate translation: [and a grain offering they mixed with oil]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 9:4 (#4)

אֲלֵיכֶֽם

“to you”

Here, the pronoun **you** is plural. It refers to the Israelite people, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 9:4 (#1)

לִפְנֵ֣י יְהוָ֔ה

“to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated this expression in 1:5. Alternate translation: [in Yahweh’s presence] or [in the precincts of the sacred tent, where Yahweh lives among the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 9:4 (#3)

כִּ֣י הַיּ֗וֹם יְהוָה֙ נִרְאָ֣ה אֲלֵיכֶֽם

“for today Yahweh will appear to you”

Here, **for** marks Yahweh’s appearing to the people of Israel as the goal or purpose of presenting all the sacrificial animals that Moses names here. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. It may be helpful to start a new sentence here. Alternate translation, with a period before: [You should do this because Yahweh will appear to you today]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Leviticus 9:5 (#2)

אֵ֚ת אֲשֶׁ֣ר צִוָּ֔ה מֹשֶׁ֖ה

“that which Moses commanded”

Alternate translation: [the animals for the sacrifices and the grain for the offerings as Moses instructed]

Leviticus 9:5 (#1)

וַיִּקְח֗וּ

“And they brought”

The pronoun **they** refers to the Israelite people, the “sons of Israel.” If it would be helpful to your readers, consider making the referent explicit. Alternate translation: [And the people of Israel brought]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 9:5 (#3)

אֶל־פְּנֵ֖י אֹ֣הֶל מוֹעֵ֑ד

“to the face of the tent of meeting”

Here, **to the face of the tent of meeting** refers to a location, “before the tent of meeting.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an idiom from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [at the entrance of the tent of meeting]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 9:5 (#5)

וַיַּעַמְד֖וּ לִפְנֵ֥י יְהוָֽה

“and they stood to the face of Yahweh”

Here, the expression **they stood to the face of Yahweh** refers to the fact that the Israelite people came to stand before the altar in the courtyard of the tent of meeting, where Yahweh lived among the Israelites. If it would be helpful in your language, consider stating this meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they stood in Yahweh’s presence near the tent of meeting, in which Yahweh lived among the Israelites]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 9:5 (#4)

וַיִּקְרְב֖וּ כָּל־הָעֵדָ֑ה

“And the whole congregation presented {them”

See how you translated this symbolic action in 8:6.

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 9:6 (#1)

צִוָּ֣ה יְהוָ֔ה תַּעֲשׂ֖וּ

“Yahweh commanded you will do”

Here, **you** is plural. It refers to the Israelite people, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of 'You' — Singular

Leviticus 9:6 (#2)

וְיֵרָ֖א אֲלֵיכֶ֑ם כְּבֹ֖וד יְהוָֽה

"and the glory of Yahweh will appear to you"

Here, the expression **the glory of Yahweh** refers to the earthly manifestation of Yahweh in the form of fire. (See 9:23–24) If it would be helpful in your language, consider stating this meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh himself will appear to you in the form of heavenly fire]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 9:7 (#1)

וַעֲשֵׂ֣ה אֶת־חַטָּאתְךָ֣ וְאֶת־עֹלָתֶ֗ךָ & וַעֲשֵׂ֞ה אֶת־קָרְבַּ֤ן הָעָם֙

"and make your sin offering and your burnt offering & And make the offering of the people"

Alternate translation: [and offer your sin offering and your burnt offering ... And offer the offering of the people]

Leviticus 9:7 (#2)

אֶת־קָרְבַּ֤ן הָעָם֙

"the offering of the people"

The expression **the offering of the people** uses the possessive form to describe the sacrifices that Yahweh has commanded the people of Israel to bring. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the offering that Yahweh commanded the people to bring]

See: Possession

Leviticus 9:8 (#1)

אֲשֶׁר־לֹ֑ו

"which {was} for himself"

The expression **which was for himself** implies that this animal, the calf of the sin offering, was being offered for Aaron's sake and not for the sake of the people. If it would be helpful to your readers, consider stating the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [which he offered to make atonement for his sin]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Leviticus 9:9 (#1)

וַיַּקְרִ֣בוּ בְנֵי־אַהֲרֹ֣ן אֶת־הַדָּ֔ם אֵלָ֖יו

"And the sons of Aaron presented the blood to him"

See how you translated this symbolic action in 1:2.

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 9:9 (#2)

בְּנֵי־אַהֲרֹ֣ן

"the sons of Aaron"

Alternate translation, with a comma after: [Aaron's four sons, Nadab, Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar]

Leviticus 9:9 (#3)

וַיִּטְבֹּ֤ל אֶצְבָּעֹו֙ & וַיִּתֵּ֣ן & יָצַ֔ק

"and he dipped his finger & and he put {it & he poured out"

Alternate translation: [and Aaron dipped his finger ... and Aaron daubed it ... he poured out]

Leviticus 9:10 (#1)

וְאֶת־הַכְּלָיֹ֨ת וְאֶת־הַיֹּתֶ֜רֶת מִן־הַכָּבֵ֗ד

"and the kidneys and the lobe from the liver"

See how you translated these internal organs in 3:4.

Leviticus 9:11 (#1)

וְאֶת־הַבָּשָׂ֣ר

"But the meat"

Here, **the meat** implies the portions of the calf of the sin offering that were to be taken outside of the camp and burned. According to 4:11, this included the calf's head, the legs, the remaining internal organs (other than the kidney and the liver), and any remaining meat (other than the breast meat and the right thigh). If it would be helpful to your readers, consider stating this meaning plainly. Alternate translation, with a comma after: [But the meat of the calf, along with its head and its legs, its entrails, its dung]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 9:11 (#2)

שָׂרַ֥ף בָּאֵ֖שׁ

"he burned with fire"

See how you handled the extra information in the similar expression in 6:30.

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Leviticus 9:13 (#1)

וְאֶת־הָעֹלָ֖ה הִמְצִ֣יאוּ אֵלָ֑יו

“And the burnt offering they brought to him”

The pronoun **they** refers to the sons of Aaron, while the pronoun **him** refers to Aaron himself. If it would be helpful to your readers, consider making these referents explicit. Alternate translation: [And the burnt offering Aaron’s four sons brought to their father]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 9:15 (#1)

וַיַּקְרֵ֣ב אֵ֔ת קָרְבַּ֖ן הָעָ֑ם

“And he presented the offering of the people”

See how you translated the similar repetition of related words in 1:2.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 9:15 (#3)

אֵ֔ת קָרְבַּ֖ן הָעָ֑ם

“the offering of the people”

See how you translated this expression in 9:7.

See: Possession

Leviticus 9:15 (#4)

אֶת־שְׂעִ֣יר הַֽחַטָּאת֮

“the goat of the sin offering”

See how you translated the similar possessive form in 8:2.

See: Possession

Leviticus 9:15 (#5)

כָּרִאשׁוֹן

“like the first”

The word **first** is the ordinal number for one. The expression **the first one** refers to the calf that Aaron offered as a sin offering for himself. Alternate translation: [like the calf that Aaron offered as a sin offering for himself]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Leviticus 9:15 (#2)

וַיַּקְרֵ֑ב

“And he presented”

See how you translated this symbolic action in 8:6.

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 9:17 (#1)

וַיְמַלֵּ֥א כַפּ֖וֹ מִמֶּ֑נָּה

“and he filled his palm from it”

The expression **he filled his palm from it** refers to the priests’ practice of designating what portion of a grain offering would be burned by scooping out whatever he could fit in his open, upturned hand. This practice is described in 2:2 and 5:12. If it would be helpful to your readers, consider making this meaning plain. Alternate translation: [and Aaron filled his palm with a handful of the grain offering in order to designate how much he would burn on the altar]

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 9:17 (#3)

מִלְּבַד֙ עֹלַ֣ת הַבֹּ֔קֶר

“in addition to the burnt offering of the morning”

The expression **the burnt offering of the morning** uses the possessive form to describe the burnt offering that was offered as the first sacrifice of each day. Normally, the priests would offer this burnt sacrifice in the morning before any other sacrifice. If it would be helpful to your readers, consider stating this meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in addition to the burnt offering that had been offered earlier that morning as the usual first sacrifice of the day]

See: Possession

Leviticus 9:17 (#2)

וַיַּקְטֵ֥ר עַל־הַמִּזְבֵּ֖חַ

“and he caused {it} to become smoke on the altar”

Here, the pronoun **it** refers not to the whole grain offering, but to the portion that Aaron scooped out with his palm. If it would be helpful to your readers, consider making this meaning plain. Alternate translation: [and he caused the portion of the grain offering that he scooped out with his palm to become smoke on the altar]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 9:18 (#1)

וְאֶת־הָאַיִל זֶבַח הַשְּׁלָמִים

“and the ram of the sacrifice of the peace offerings”

The expression **the ram of the sacrifice of the peace offerings** uses the possessive form to describe a ram that was chosen to be the animal sacrifice for a peace offering. If it would be helpful to your readers, consider stating this meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The ram that the people had presented to Aaron as the sacrifice for their peace offering]

See: Possession

Leviticus 9:21 (#1)

הֵנִיף אַהֲרֹן תְּנוּפָה

“Aaron raised {as} a raised offering”

See how you translated this symbolic action and its corresponding type of offering in 7:30.

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 9:21 (#2)

לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“to the face of Yahweh”

As the Introduction to Leviticus discusses, in contexts such as this, the expression **to the face of Yahweh** means “where Yahweh can see” and, by extension, “in Yahweh’s presence.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in Yahweh’s presence] or [within the sacred precincts of the tent of meeting, where Yahweh lives among the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 9:22 (#2)

וַיְבָרְכֵם

“and he blessed them”

Aaron is asking Yahweh to bless the people. You could express this as either a blessing or a prayer, in whichever way is more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and he prayed Yahweh’s blessing over the people]

See: Blessings

Leviticus 9:22 (#1)

וַיִּשָּׂא אַהֲרֹן אֶת־יָדוֹ אֶל־הָעָם

“And Aaron lifted his hands toward the people”

Lifting one’s hands is a symbolic action that signals a physical posture of prayer. If this would not be clear to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [And Aaron lifted his hands toward the people so that he could pray for them]

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 9:22 (#3)

וַיֵּרֶד מֵעֲשֹׂת הַחַטָּאת וְהָעֹלָה וְהַשְּׁלָמִים

“And he came down from making the sin offering and the burnt offering and the peace offerings”

The expression **And he came down** implies that Aaron was likely elevated off the ground, probably by means of steps or a ramp, in order to offer the sacrifices on top of the altar. Consequently, Aaron would have been higher than where the people were standing. If it would be helpful, consider supplying this implied information. Alternate translation: [And, because Aaron was elevated above the people when he offered the sacrifices, he came down from making the sin offering and the burnt offering and the peace offerings]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 9:23 (#1)

וַיְבָרְכוּ אֶת־הָעָם

“and they blessed the people”

Aaron and Moses asked Yahweh to bless **the people**. You could express this as either a blessing or a prayer, in whichever way is more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and they prayed that Yahweh would bless the people]

See: Blessings

Leviticus 9:23 (#2)

וַיֵּרָא כְּבוֹד־יְהוָה אֶל־כָּל־הָעָם

“And the glory of Yahweh appeared to all the people”

See how you translated the expression **the glory of Yahweh** in 9:6.

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 9:24 (#1)

מִלִּפְנֵי יְהוָה וַתֹּאכַל

“before the face of Yahweh, and it consumed”

The expression **fire went forth before the face of Yahweh** implies that the fire came from the direction

of Yahweh's presence in the Most Holy Place, where he lived among the Israelites. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [from Yahweh's presence in the Most Holy Place, where he lived among the Israelites, and it consumed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 9:24 (#2)

וַיַּ֣רְא כָּל־הָעָ֔ם

"And all the people saw"

The expression **And all the people saw** is missing some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And all the people saw how Yahweh provided the fire to consume the offering and fat on the altar] or [And all the people saw how the fire from before the face of Yahweh consumed the burnt offering and the fat on the altar]

See: Ellipsis

Leviticus 9:24 (#4)

וַיִּפְּלוּ֖ עַל־פְּנֵיהֶֽם

"and they fell on their faces"

To fall on one's **face** is a symbolic action. As an act of reverence, honor, and submission, It refers to either: (1) bowing on one's knees with one's face to the ground. If your language has a similar idiom to refer to bowing with respect to authority, consider using it here. If not, consider stating the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they knelt down in respect and awe with their faces toward the ground] or (2) lying flat on the ground. Alternate translation: [and they lay flat out on the ground]

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 9:24 (#3)

וַיָּרֹנּ֑וּ

"and they shouted"

Here, **they shouted** means that they cried out in joy with a loud voice. If this would not be clear in your language, consider stating the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [and they cheered loudly]

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus - Chapter 10 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter includes the last narrative of the section that began in Leviticus 8. It tells the story of how Aaron's two sons, Nadab and Abihu, offered "strange fire that he did not command them" (10:1). As a result of this action, Yahweh kills the two men with fire sent out from his presence (10:2). Moses then interprets the events as a demonstration of Yahweh's utter holiness (10:3), before instructing that the men's bodies be removed carefully (10:4–5) and guiding Aaron's remaining sons how they should mourn as priests (10:5–7). Yahweh then gives instruction to Aaron concerning the consumption of alcoholic drink in connection to the priesthood (10:8–9), clarifying that the role of the priesthood in Israel is to help the people distinguish between what is pure and what is impure so that they may follow Yahweh's laws and be his holy people (10:10–11). Following this, Moses instructs Aaron's remaining two sons, Eleazar and Ithamar, that they are to eat the remaining food portions of the sacrifice and to do so in a clean and holy place (10:12–15). However, when Moses later searches for the meat of the sin offering, he discovers that it had been burnt rather than eaten (10:16). When Moses questions why this happened, as the sin offering was exactly the type whose meat should have been eaten by the priests (10:17–18), Aaron responds that he believes that the presence of his son's bodies in the sanctuary has made the sin offering unacceptable to eat (10:19). The narrative ends as Moses is satisfied with this answer (10:20). The structure of the chapter is as follows:

1. The death of Nadab and Abihu (10:1–2)
2. Moses' interpretation and instructions (10:3–7)
3. the removal of the bodies (10:3–5)
4. mourning as priests (10:6–7)
5. Yahweh instructs Aaron (10:8–11)
6. Moses instructs Eleazar and Ithamar (10:12–15)
7. The debate between Moses and Aaron concerning the sin offering (10:16–20)

Note that Leviticus 10:3 is a line of poetry. Some translations set each line of poetry farther to the right than the rest of the text to make it easier to read. The ULT does this with the poetry in 10:3.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Mourning practices

In Leviticus 10:6–7, Moses instructs Aaron's remaining sons, Eleazar and Ithamar that, when they are per-

forming their duties as priests, they are not to mourn as they normally would mourn. Instead, they are to let the people of Israel mourn for them. (See 10:6) The symbolic actions associated with mourning practices that they are to avoid are:

1. letting their hair be disheveled and loose. The expression in Lev 10:6 ("Do not let your heads be loose") is a figure of speech. Here, the word "heads" refers by association to the hair of one's head, so the expression "Do not let your heads be loose" refers to letting one's hair hang down disheveled and unkempt. It is implied that Aaron's sons' hair was long enough to hang down over their heads. This was a common practice associated with mourning for a dead relative. If it would be helpful in your language, consider stating the meaning plainly.
2. tearing their clothes in grief. The practice of tearing one's clothes was a common sign of public mourning in ancient Israel. This was a common practice associated with mourning for a dead relative. If your culture has an expression that describes a similar symbolic action, consider using that expression here. If not, consider using a generic expression and explaining the meaning of this action in a footnote or in the body of your translation.

These are symbolic actions associated with mourning for dead relatives. If your language does not have similar actions associated with a period of mourning, consider explaining the meaning of these actions in a footnote or in the text of your translation.

Important Figures of Speech in This Chapter

Fire and "strange fire"
In this chapter, the word translated as "fire" appears both as literal fire and as referring to live, burning coals that produce fire. The notes below (as well as the UST) will serve to distinguish which meaning is present in each context. If it would be helpful in your language, where the word "fire" represents the coals that produce fire, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. In Leviticus 10:2, the expression "strange fire" appears. Here, "fire" refers to coals that produce fire rather than to the fire itself. In context, the expression means that either (1) Aaron's sons, Nadab and Abihu, had used burning coals that came from a common everyday source rather than from a holy source, as Yahweh had commanded, or (2) the incense that Aaron's sons Nadab and Abihu placed on top of the burning coals was not the kind of incense that Yahweh had commanded to be offered in the tent of meeting. The notes and the UST favor the first option, but the second is possible as well.

Other Possible Translation Difficulties in This Chapter

The use of plural "you"
Throughout this chapter, the words "you" and "your" are plural. They often refer to Aaron and his sons. Consider using the plural form of the second-person pronouns of your language in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

Leviticus 10:1 (#5)

אֵ֣שׁ זָרָ֔ה

"strange fire"

It is likely that the expression **strange fire** means that either: (1) Nadab and Abihu had used burning coals that came from a common, everyday source rather than from a holy source, as Yahweh had commanded. Alternate translation: [common fire that was not set apart exclusively for Yahweh's purposes] or (2) the incense that Nadab and Abihu placed on top of the burning coals was not the kind of incense that Yahweh had commanded should be offered in the tent of meeting. Alternate translation: [unauthorized incense]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 10:1 (#1)

וַיִּקְח֗וּ

"And & took"

The word **And** indicates that the action of this chapter immediately follows what happened in the previous chapter. The events recorded here should be considered to be a continuation of the story of the ordination ceremony. In your translation, be sure to use a connecting word that signals this to your readers.

See: Connect — Sequential Time Relationship

Leviticus 10:1 (#4)

לִפְנֵ֥י יְהוָ֖ה

"to the face of Yahweh"

See how you translated this expression in 1:5. Alternate translation: [in the precincts of the tent of meeting where Yahweh lived among the Israelites] or [in Yahweh's presence]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 10:1 (#3)

אֵ֑שׁ

“fire”

Here, the word **fire** represents the coals that produce fire. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [glowing coals] or [live coals]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 10:1 (#2)

מַחְתָּתֹ֔ו

“his censer”

A **censer** is a shallow bronze container that priests could use to carry hot coals on which to burn incense. If your language has a word for this religious object, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [his incense pan]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 10:2 (#1)

אֵ֖שׁ

“fire”

Here, fire means flames and not hot coals, as it did in the previous verse. The poetic repetition of words is intended to be ironic. Nadab and Abihu offered fire as coals, but flames of fire consumed them in judgment. If your language has words for live coals and for flaming fire that are similar and that could preserve this irony, consider using those terms here. If not, use the word for flaming fire here. Alternate translation: [blazing flames]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 10:2 (#3)

וַתֹּ֥אכַל אוֹתָ֑ם

“and it consumed them”

The author of Leviticus uses the image of the **fire** consuming or eating Aaron’s two sons to refer to the process that the sacrifice undergoes as the fire burns it until it is completely ash. If your language has a similar idiom used of fire completely burning something, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [and it killed them]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 10:2 (#2)

מִלִּפְנֵ֥י יְהוָֽה

“from before the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated this expression in 1:5. Alternate translation: [from the Holy of Holies where Yahweh lived among the Israelites] or [from Yahweh’s presence]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 10:3 (#4)

אֶקָּדֵ֔שׁ

“I will show myself to be holy”

The expression **I will show myself to be holy** implies that, by killing Aaron’s sons who had sinned, either: (1) Yahweh demonstrated that he alone is God. He is not only set apart from sin, but he is also perfect and powerful. Alternate translation: [I will show that I am God and that I alone am set apart from sin] or (2) Yahweh removed the impurity caused by the sins of Nadab and Abihu, thus purifying himself. Alternate translation: [I will purify myself from the impurity of people’s sin]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 10:3 (#1)

הוּא֣ אֲשֶׁר־דִּבֶּ֣ר יְהוָ֗ה ׀ לֵאמֹר֮ בִּקְרֹבַ֣י אֶקָּדֵ֒שׁ וְעַל־פְּנֵ֣י כָל־הָעָ֔ם אֶכָּבֵֽד

“This is what Yahweh spoke, saying, ‘Among those who draw near to me, I will show myself to be holy. And on the faces of all the people, I will be honored”

This has a quotation within a quotation. You can state this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [This is what Yahweh spoke when he said that he would show himself to be holy among those who draw near to him and that he would be honored on the faces of all the people]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Leviticus 10:3 (#6)

אֶכָּבֵֽד

“I will be honored”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [people will honor me]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 10:3 (#2)

לֵאמֹר׃

“saying”

The word translated as **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, consider ways in which you might introduce this quotation naturally in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Leviticus 10:3 (#5)

וְעַל־פְּנֵי כָל־הָעָם

“And on the faces of all the people”

Here, the **faces of all the people** refers to the people’s faculties of sight and, by extension, what they can see. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And in the sight of all the people]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 10:3 (#3)

בִּקְרֹבַי

“Among those who draw near to me”

Alternate translation: [Among the priests who offer sacrifices to me]

Leviticus 10:4 (#5)

אֶת־אֲחֵיכֶם׃

“your brothers”

Here, **your** is plural. It refers to Mishael and Elzaphan, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 10:4 (#1)

מִישָׁאֵל׃ & אֶלְצָפָן בְּנֵי עֻזִּיאֵל׃

“Mishael & Elzaphan, the sons of Uzziel”

Mishael and **Elzaphan** are the names of Aaron’s cousins, the sons of his uncle, **Uzziel**.

See: How to Translate Names

Leviticus 10:4 (#2)

עֻזִּיאֵל׃

“Uzziel”

Uzziel is the name of Aaron’s uncle.

See: How to Translate Names

Leviticus 10:4 (#4)

קִרְבוּ׃

“Present {yourselves”

To **Present** oneself is a symbolic action that refers to bringing oneself into Yahweh’s presence to do his purposes. If it would be helpful to your readers, consider stating the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Come near to the precincts of the tent of meeting, where Yahweh lives among the Israelites, and be ready to do what Yahweh requires of you]

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 10:4 (#3)

דֹּדַ֣ד אַהֲרֹ֔ן

“the uncle of Aaron”

Here the term **uncle** specifically refers to Aaron’s father’s brother. Since Aaron and Moses are brothers, Uzziel is also the uncle of Moses. If your language has a specific word for an uncle, it would be appropriate to use it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [Aaron’s father’s brother]

See: Kinship

Leviticus 10:4 (#6)

מֵאֵ֖ת פְּנֵי־הַקֹּ֑דֶשׁ

“from the face of the Holy Place”

Here, **from the face of the Holy Place** refers to a location before the Holy Place. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an expression from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from the space in front of the Holy Place within the tent of meeting]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 10:5 (#1)

וַיִּשְׂאֵם֙ בְּכֻתָּנְתָּ֔ם

“and they lifted them by their tunics”

The text implies that Mishael and Elzaphan carried Nadab and Abihu **by their tunics** so as to not come in direct contact with their dead bodies, which would have made Mishael and Elzaphan ceremonially un-

clean. If it would be helpful in your language, consider providing this implied information in a footnote or in the text of your translation. Alternate translation: [and, because they did not want to become unclean by touching the dead bodies, they lifted them by their tunics]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 10:5 (#2)

וַיִּשָּׂאֵם

“and they lifted them”

Here the pronoun **them** refers to the bodies of Nadab and Abihu. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and they lifted the bodies of Nadab and Abihu]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 10:5 (#3)

בְּכֻתָּנְתָּם

“by their tunics”

Here the possessive pronoun **their** could refer to (1) Nadab and Abihu. Alternate translation: [by Nadab and Abihu’s tunics] or (2) Mishael and Elzaphan. Alternate translation: [by Mishael and Elzaphan’s tunics]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 10:6 (#6)

וַאֲחֵיכֶם

“But your brothers”

Here, the word **brothers** does not mean male relatives. Rather, it likely refers to all their fellow Israelites, who were to be considered to be members of a single extended family. Alternate translation: [But all your fellow Israelites]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 10:6 (#7)

כָּל־בֵּית יִשְׂרָאֵל

“all of the house of Israel”

Here, **house** refers to the whole people of Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, consider stating the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all the people of Israel]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 10:6 (#9)

אֶת־הַשְּׂרֵפָה אֲשֶׁר שָׂרַף יְהוָה

“for} the burning that Yahweh has burned”

The word **burning** implies the fire that came out from the Holy Place and consumed Nadab and Abihu. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [for the way that Yahweh killed Nadab and Abihu with fire]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 10:6 (#1)

רָאשֵׁיכֶם אַל־תִּפְרָעוּ ׀ וּבִגְדֵיכֶם לֹא־תִפְרֹמוּ

“Do not let your heads be loose and do not tear your clothes”

These are symbolic actions associated with mourning for dead relatives. If your language does not have similar actions associated with a period of mourning, consider explaining the meaning of these actions in a footnote or in the text of your translation. Alternate translation: [Do not mourn for your relatives by letting your heads be loose or by tearing your clothes]

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 10:6 (#2)

רָאשֵׁיכֶם אַל־תִּפְרָעוּ

“Do not let your heads be loose”

Here, the word **heads** refers by association to the hair of one’s head, so the expression **Do not let your heads be loose** refers to letting one’s hair hang down disheveled and unkempt. It is implied that Aaron’s sons’ hair was long enough to hang down from their heads. As the previous note suggests, this was a common practice associated with mourning for a dead relative. If it would be helpful in your language, consider stating the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not let your long hair hang down loose]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 10:6 (#3)

רָאשֵׁיכֶם & וּבִגְדֵיכֶם & וְלֹא תָמֻתוּ & וַאֲחֵיכֶם

“your heads & and & your clothes, so that you will not die and & not & But your brothers”

Here the pronouns **you** and **your** are plural. They refer to Aaron’s sons, Eleazar and Ithamar, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of 'You' — Singular

Leviticus 10:6 (#8)

אֶת־הַשְּׂרֵפָ֖ה אֲשֶׁ֣ר שָׂרַ֑ף יְהוָ֖ה

"for} the burning that Yahweh has burned"

Here, a verb and its object come from the same root. The phrase **Yahweh has burned** translates as a verb that is related to the noun translated as **burning**. The repetition of related words adds emphasis to the statement. If your language can repeat words for emphasis and your language has comparable terms that you can use in your own translation, it would be appropriate to use that construction here in your translation.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 10:6 (#4)

רָאשֵׁיכֶ֣ם אַל־תִּפְרָעוּ֮ ׀ וּבִגְדֵיכֶם֒ לֹא־תִפְרֹ֗מוּ וְלֹ֤א תָמֻ֙תוּ֙ וְעַ֣ל כָּל־הָעֵדָ֔ה יִקְצֹ֖ף

"Do not let your heads be loose and do not tear your clothes, so that you will not die and against all the congregation he will {not} be angry"

Here, **so that** marks **you will not die and against all the congregation he will {not} be angry** as the goal or purpose of **Do not let your heads be loose and do not tear your clothes**. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. Alternate translation: [Do not let your heads be loose and do not tear your clothes. If you do not do these things, you will not die and against all the congregation he will {not} be angry]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 10:6 (#5)

יִקְצֹ֖ף

"he will & be angry"

The pronoun **he** refers to Yahweh. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will not be angry]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 10:7 (#1)

לֹ֣א תֵצְא֗וּ & תָּמֻ֙תוּ֙ & עֲלֵיכֶ֔ם

"you shall not go out & you die & is} on you"

Here the pronoun **you** is plural. It refers to Eleazar and Ithamar, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of 'You' — Singular

Leviticus 10:7 (#4)

וַיַּעֲשׂ֖וּ כִּדְבַ֥ר מֹשֶֽׁה

"And they did according to the word of Moses"

The term **word** is being used to mean the message that Moses spoke. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And they did exactly what Moses told them to do]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 10:7 (#2)

כִּ֣י

"for"

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation, with a period before: [This is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 10:7 (#3)

שֶׁ֥מֶן מִשְׁחַ֖ת יְהוָ֑ה

"the oil of the anointing of Yahweh"

The expression **the oil of the anointing of Yahweh** uses the possessive form to describe oil that is used to anoint people for service to Yahweh. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could state the meaning with a generic expression. Alternate translation: [the special oil that is used to set people apart to serve as priests to Yahweh]

See: Possession

Leviticus 10:9 (#1)

וְשֵׁכָ֖ר

"or beer"

Here, **beer** is likely a fermented and alcoholic beverage brewed from wheat, barley, or other grains. If your language has a word for this beverage, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [or other alcoholic beverage]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 10:9 (#2)

אַתָּ֣ה ׀ וּבָנֶ֣יךָ אִתָּ֑ךְ

“you or your sons with you”

Here, the pronoun **you** is singular. It refers to Aaron, so use the singular form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 10:9 (#3)

בְּבֹאֲכֶם & וְלֹא תָמֻתוּ & לְדֹרֹתֵיכֶם

“when you go & so you will not die & throughout your generations”

The pronouns **you** and **your** are plural. They refer to Aaron and his sons, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 10:10 (#2)

הַקֹּדֶשׁ & הַחֹל

“the holy & the common”

The adjectives **holy** and **common** are being used as nouns to refer to that which is set apart for Yahweh alone and that which is associated with ordinary everyday life. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [that which is holy ... that which is common]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Leviticus 10:10 (#4)

הַטָּמֵא & הַטָּהוֹר

“the unclean & the clean”

The adjective **clean** is being used as a noun to refer to that which is able to be in holy space and come into contact with holy objects. The adjective **unclean** is being used as a noun to refer to that which is impure and cannot be in holy space without introducing impurity to that space and those objects. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [that which is clean ... that which is unclean]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Leviticus 10:10 (#3)

הַחֹל

“the common”

The word **common** refers to things, animals, or people that are not set apart for Yahweh but are associated with ordinary, everyday life. If it would be helpful in your language, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [the ordinary] or [the usual]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 10:10 (#1)

וּלְהַבְדִּיל

“and to separate”

The word translated as **and** indicates that the ability to separate between holy and common and between clean and unclean is a further consequence of abstaining from drinking alcohol while conducting priestly duties. Use a natural form in your language to connect this statement to the previous one. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [That way you will also be able to separate]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Leviticus 10:11 (#2)

אֶת־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the sons of Israel”

See how you translated this expression in 1:2.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 10:11 (#1)

וּלְהוֹרֹת

“and to teach”

Here, **in order to** marks teaching **the sons of Israel** as the goal or purpose of learning to separate between holy and common, between clean and unclean. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. Alternatively, it may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation, with a period before: [The priests should learn to do this so that they might be able to teach]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Leviticus 10:11 (#3)

בְּיַד־מֹשֶׁה

“by the hand of Moses”

Here, **hand** represents the agency of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [through Moses]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 10:12 (#2)

וְאִכְלֻ֖הוּ

“and eat it”

Here the pronoun **it** refers to whatever portion of the **grain offering** was left over and had not been burned on the altar. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and eat the remaining grain offering]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 10:12 (#1)

מֵאִשֵּׁ֣י יְהוָ֑ה

“from the gifts of Yahweh”

See how you translated this expression in 2:3.

See: Possession

Leviticus 10:12 (#4)

קֹ֥דֶשׁ קָדָשִׁ֖ים הִֽוא

“it is a holy thing of the holy things”

See how you translated this expression in 2:3.

See: Possession

Leviticus 10:12 (#3)

כִּ֚י קֹ֣דֶשׁ קָדָשִׁ֔ים הִֽוא

“for it is a holy thing of the holy things”

The word **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation, with a period before: [This is because it is a holy thing of the holy things]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 10:13 (#2)

אֹתָ֔הּ

“it”

Alternate translation: [the remaining part of th grain offering]

Leviticus 10:13 (#3)

כִּֽי־חָקְךָ֥ וְחָק־בָּנֶ֖יךָ הִ֑וא מֵאִשֵּׁ֣י יְהוָ֔ה

“because it {is} your portion and the portion of your sons from the gifts of Yahweh”

The word **because** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation, with a period before: [You should do this because it is your portion and the portion of your sons from the gifts of Yahweh]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 10:13 (#4)

מֵאִשֵּׁ֣י יְהוָ֑ה

“from the gifts of Yahweh”

See how you translated this expression in 2:3.

See: Possession

Leviticus 10:13 (#5)

כִּֽי־כֵ֖כֵן צִוֵּ֥יתִי

“because thus I have been commanded”

The word **because** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation, with a period before: [This is so because thus I have been commanded]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 10:13 (#6)

כִּֽי־כֵ֖כֵן צִוֵּ֥יתִי

“because thus I have been commanded”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [because thus Yahweh commanded me]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 10:13 (#1)

וַאֲכַלְתֶּ֥ם

“And you shall eat”

Here, the pronoun **you** is plural. It refers to Aaron and his sons. Consider using the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 10:14 (#4)

תֹּאכְלוּ׀

“you shall eat”

Here, **you** is plural. It refers to Aaron and his sons. Consider using the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 10:14 (#7)

כִּי־חָקְךָ֣ וְחָק־בָּנֶ֗יךָ נִתְּנ֛וּ

“for they are given {as} your portion and the portion of your sons”

The word **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation, with a period before: [You should do this because they are given {as} your portion and the portion of your sons]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 10:14 (#1)

וְאֵתׂ֨ חֲזֵ֤ה הַתְּנוּפָה֙

“And the breast of the raised offering”

The expression **the breast of the wave offering** uses the possessive form to describe breast meat that is to be offered as a wave offering. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And the breast meat that Aaron and his sons presented as a wave offering]

See: Possession

Leviticus 10:14 (#6)

אַתָּ֣ה וּבָנֶ֔יךָ וּבְנֹתֶ֖יךָ אִתָּ֑ךְ & חָקְךָ֣ & בָּנֶ֗יךָ

“you and your sons and your daughters with you & as} your portion & your sons”

Here, the words **you** and **your** are singular. They refer to Aaron alone. Consider using the singular form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 10:14 (#8)

כִּי־חָקְךָ֣ וְחָק־בָּנֶ֗יךָ נִתְּנ֛וּ

“for they are given {as} your portion and the portion of your sons”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [for Yahweh has given them as your portion and the portion of your sons]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 10:14 (#9)

נִתְּנ֛וּ

“they are given”

Here the pronoun **they** does not refer to Aaron’s sons and daughters. Rather, it refers to the breast meat of the wave offering and the thigh meat of the contribution. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the breast meat of the wave offering and the thigh meat of the contribution are given]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 10:14 (#2)

הַתְּנוּפָ֖ה

“the raised offering”

See how you translated this type of offering in 7:30.

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 10:14 (#3)

וְאֵ֥ת ׀ שֹׁ֖וק הַתְּרוּמָ֑ה

“and the thigh of the contribution”

The expression **the thigh of the contribution** uses the possessive form to describe thigh meat that has been chosen to be offered as a special contribution of food to Yahweh’s priests. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the thigh meat that Aaron and his sons presented as a special contribution]

See: Possession

Leviticus 10:14 (#5)

אַתָּ֣ה וּבָנֶ֔יךָ וּבְנֹתֶ֖יךָ אִתָּ֑ךְ

“you and your sons and your daughters with you”

The pronouns **you** and **your** refer to Aaron. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [you, Aaron, and your sons and your daughters with you]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 10:14 (#10)

בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the sons of Israel”

See how you translated this expression in 1:2.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 10:15 (#4)

לְהָנִיף תְּנוּפָה

“to raise {as} a raised offering”

See how you translated this ritual action and its corresponding type of offering in 7:30.

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 10:15 (#5)

לְהָנִיף תְּנוּפָה

“to raise {as} a raised offering”

Here, **to** marks waving the meat and fat portions as a **wave offering** as reason to bring them to the tent of meeting. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Leviticus 10:15 (#2)

אִשֵּׁי הַחֲלָבִים

“the gifts of the fat portions”

Here, **the gifts of the fat portions** implies all the portions of fat and internal organs that would normally be offered with sacrifices of peace offerings. See 3:3–4, 3:9–10, and 3:14–15 for the exact portions.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 10:15 (#6)

לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated this expression in 1:5. Alternate translation: [in the precincts of the tent of meeting where Yahweh lived among the Israelites] or [in Yahweh’s presence]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 10:15 (#3)

יָבִיאוּ

“they shall bring”

Here the pronoun **they** likely refers to the people of Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, consider stating the referent explicitly. Alternate translation: [the people of Israel shall bring]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 10:15 (#1)

שׁוֹק הַתְּרוּמָה וְחֲזֵה הַתְּנוּפָה

“The thigh of the contribution and the breast of the raised offering”

See how you translated these expressions in 10:14.

See: Possession

Leviticus 10:16 (#1)

וְאֵת ׀ שְׂעִיר הַחַטָּאת

“And the goat of the sin offering”

See how you translated this possessive form in 9:15. Here, the **goat of the sin offering** refers to the butchered meat of the animal rather than to the live animal itself. If this would not be clear in your language, consider stating the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And the meat of the goat of the sin offering]

See: Possession

Leviticus 10:16 (#2)

דָּרֹשׁ דָּרַשׁ מֹשֶׁה

“Moses, searching, searched for”

This expression repeats the verb **searched for** in order to intensify the idea that it expresses. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [Moses diligently searched for]

See: Reduplication

Leviticus 10:16 (#3)

שֹׂרֵף

“It had been burned up”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Aaron’s sons had burned it up]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 10:17 (#3)

כִּֽי־קֹ֨דֶשׁ קָדָשִׁ֜ים הִ֗וא

“for it is a holy thing of holy things”

The word **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation, with a question mark before and a period after: [You should have done this because it is a holy thing of holy things]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 10:17 (#4)

לָשֵׂאת֙ אֶת־עֲוֹ֣ן הָעֵדָ֔ה

“to bear the iniquity of the congregation”

Here, **to** marks bearing the **iniquity of the people** as the goal or purpose of Yahweh’s having given the meat of the **sin offering** to the priests to eat. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Leviticus 10:17 (#6)

לְכַפֵּ֥ר עֲלֵיהֶ֖ם

“to make atonement for them”

Here, **to** marks making **atonement** for the people as the goal or purpose of Yahweh’s having given the meat of the **sin offering** to the priests to eat. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Leviticus 10:17 (#1)

מַדּ֨וּעַ לֹא־אֲכַלְתֶּ֜ם & לָכֶ֗ם

“Why have you not eaten & to you”

Here the pronoun **you** is plural. It refers to Eleazar and Ithamar, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 10:17 (#2)

אֶת־הַחַטָּאת֙

“the sin offering”

Alternate translation: [the meat of the goat that was offered as a sin offering]

Leviticus 10:17 (#7)

לְכַפֵּ֥ר

“to make atonement”

See how you translated this expression in 1:4.

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 10:17 (#5)

לָשֵׂאת֙ אֶת־עֲוֹ֣ן הָעֵדָ֔ה

“to bear the iniquity of the congregation”

See how you translated this idiom in 5:1.

See: Idiom

Leviticus 10:17 (#8)

לִפְנֵ֥י יְהוָֽה

“to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated this expression in 1:5. Alternate translation: [in Yahweh’s presence] or [in Yahweh’s judgment]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 10:18 (#4)

הַקֹּ֖דֶשׁ פְּנִימָ֑ה

“the inner Holy Place”

The **inner Holy Place** refers to the space within the tent of meeting, particularly, the space of the inner tent known as the Holy of Holies. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the interior section of the tent of the Holy Place]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 10:18 (#3)

אֶת־דָּמָ֔הּ

“its blood”

Here, the possessive pronoun **its** refers to the sin offering. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the blood of the sin offering]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 10:18 (#6)

תֹּאכְל֥וּ

“you shall eat”

Here the pronoun **you** is plural. It refers to Aaron and his sons, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction. Alternate translation: [you must eat]

See: Forms of 'You' — Singular

Leviticus 10:18 (#1)

לֹא־הוּבָא אֶת־דָּמָהּ אֶל־הַקֹּדֶשׁ פְּנִימָה

"its blood was not brought into the inner Holy Place"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [this sacrifice did not require the priests to bring its blood into the inner Holy Place]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 10:18 (#5)

אָכֹל תֹּאכְלוּ אֹתָהּ

"Eating, you shall eat it"

This expression repeats the verb **eat** in order to intensify the idea that it expresses. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [You must certainly eat it]

See: Reduplication

Leviticus 10:18 (#2)

לֹא־הוּבָא אֶת־דָּמָהּ אֶל־הַקֹּדֶשׁ פְּנִימָה

"its blood was not brought into the inner Holy Place"

According to 6:23, sin offerings that required the priest to bring the blood of the animal into the inner sanctuary of the Holy Place could not be eaten by the priests. Rather, this variety of sin offerings had to be burned completely. Moses is saying that because the sin offering presented by the people was not this particular kind of sin offering, it should have been eaten by the priests. If this would not be clear to your readers, consider explaining the significance of this statement in a footnote or in the text of your translation. Alternate translation: [if the blood of the sin offering had been brought into the inner Holy Place, it could not have been eaten. But since it was the sin offering that the people presented, it did not require this]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 10:19 (#4)

וְאָכַלְתִּי חַטָּאת הַיּוֹם הֲיִיטַב בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה

"But {if} I ate the sin offering today, would it have been good in the eyes of Yahweh"

Aaron here uses the question form to question Moses about the appropriateness of eating the meat of the sin offering when his two sons were killed within the holy space of the tent of meeting itself. His question anticipates a negative response. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation, followed by a period rather than a question mark: [But even if I ate the sin offering today, it would not have been good in the eyes of Yahweh]

See: Rhetorical Question

Leviticus 10:19 (#5)

הֲיִיטַב בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה

"would it have been good in the eyes of Yahweh"

Here, **eyes** represent the sight of a person and, by extension, their judgment or approval. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [would it have been good in Yahweh's judgment]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 10:19 (#2)

לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

"to the face of Yahweh"

See how you translated this expression in 1:5. Alternate translation: [in the precincts of the tent of meeting, where Yahweh lived among the Israelites] or [in Yahweh's presence]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 10:19 (#6)

הֲיִיטַב בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה

"would it have been good in the eyes of Yahweh"

The expression **good in the eyes of Yahweh** is an idiom that means "to be pleasing to Yahweh" or "to be acceptable to Yahweh." If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [would Yahweh have approved] or [would it have pleased Yahweh]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 10:19 (#3)

וַתִּקְרֶאנָה אֹתִתַי כָּאֵלֶּה

“and it has happened to me according to these things”

Aaron is referring to the death of his sons, Nadab and Abihu, in a polite way by using the phrase **it has happened to me according to these things**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to these events in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [and now my sons lie dead outside of the camp, having been consumed by Yahweh’s fire]

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 10:19 (#1)

הִקְרִיבוּ אֶת־חַטָּאתָם וְאֶת־עֹלָתָם

“they presented their sin offering and their burnt offering”

Here the pronouns **they** and **their** refer to Aaron’s four sons, who had offered **burnt offerings** and **sin offerings** on their own behalf as well as on the behalf of the people. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [my four sons presented their sin offerings and their burnt offerings]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 10:20 (#1)

וַיִּיטַב בְּעֵינָיו

“and it was good in his eyes”

The expression **good in his eyes** is an idiom that means “to be pleasing to him” or “to be acceptable to him.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he approved] or [and it seemed good to him]

See: Idiom

Leviticus - Chapter 11 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

In Leviticus 11, Yahweh speaks to Moses again and delivers a series of laws about all things clean and unclean that continues through Leviticus 15. This chapter concerns the animals that Israel is allowed to eat and how to distinguish between what is clean and what is unclean. (See Leviticus 11:46–47) The list begins with four unclean quadrupeds, establishing a rule for identifying clean and unclean four-footed animals; they must both chew cud and possess a fully cloven hoof (11:2–4). As such, camels (11:4), rock badgers (11:5), rabbits (11:6), and pigs (11:7) are unclean because these animals meet one but not both of these criteria. The section which follows describes a rule for determining clean and unclean creatures that live in water; they must possess both scales and fins. (See 11:9–12) Next, Yahweh gives a list of unclean birds, although he does not describe why these are unclean. (See 11:13–19) This is followed by a list of clean insects and a rule for distinguishing them from unclean ones (11:20–23). The rule for determining unclean quadrupeds is reiterated (11:24–28) before a list of unclean “swarming things” is provided (11:29–31), along with instructions for what to do when such unclean creatures come into contact with various everyday items and objects (11:32–38). Yahweh reiterates that no one should touch or eat the dead body of an unclean animal (11:39–40), before reiterating the rule for unclean “swarming things” (11:41–43). Yahweh then explains that the reason for these laws is found in his own holiness and his desire for his people to be just as holy (11:44–45) by following his laws and distinguishing between what is clean and what is unclean (11:46–47). The structure of the chapter is as follows:

1. Clean and Unclean Animals
2. The rule for clean and unclean quadrupeds (11:1–8)
3. The rule for clean and unclean water creatures (11:9–12)
4. A list of unclean birds (11:13–19)
5. The rule for clean and unclean insects (11:20–23)
6. The rule for clean and unclean quadrupeds, again (11:24–28)
7. A list of unclean “swarming” creatures (11:29–31)
8. Handling objects that come into contact with unclean creatures (11:32–38)
9. Prohibition against touching or eating dead unclean animals (11:39–40)
10. Unclean “swarming” creatures, again (11:41–43)
11. Yahweh’s concluding explanation for the law (11:44–47)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Clean and unclean animals

This chapter describes the animals, birds, and other creatures that were “unclean,” meaning that the Is-

raelites were not allowed to eat them. It also describes the ones that were "clean," which the Israelites were permitted to eat. The lists of four-legged animals, water creatures, and insects tell how to determine which ones are clean and which ones are not. The lists of birds and swarming creatures do not provide that information.

Interpreters continue to debate the grounds on which creatures were considered clean or unclean. However, it is likely that in the mind of the ancient Israelite, unclean creatures had an association with death, or they did not fit properly into their own category of creation, or they were associated with the false gods of the nations that lived around Israel.

For example, birds that ate the flesh of dead animals were unclean because that associated them with death. The ostrich was considered unclean because it is a bird that does not fly, so it does not fit into its own category. There was also an association between the ostrich and the religious practices of the Egyptians.

But in general, the book of Leviticus leaves the logic unstated and implicit that defines clean and unclean. In your translation, it may be best to do the same. As a translator, it is important not to introduce into your translation of Leviticus current cultural notions of which foods are acceptable.

Important Figures of Speech in This Chapter

Repeated words
Throughout this chapter, several related words are repeated for emphasis. Examples of this are found in the expressions "dividing a hoof" (11:3–7), "splitting the cleft of hooves" (11:3 and 11:7), "chew the cud" (11:7), "any food that is eaten" and "any drink that is drunk" (11:34), "any seed, a sown seed that will be sown" (11:37), and "every swarming thing, the one swarming on the ground" (11:41). You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning of these expressions.

The use of generic nouns
Throughout this chapter, generic nouns are used to describe clean and unclean animals. When these nouns use the article "the" (as in "the rock badger"), the expression does not refer to a specific animal. Rather, it describes any animal of that type that an Israelite might encounter. Express this in the way that would be most natural in your language.

Other Possible Translation Difficulties in This Chapter

"Clean" and "unclean"
To understand the concepts of clean and unclean, it may be helpful to review the section of the Introduction to Leviticus labeled "What is the meaning of 'holy' and 'holiness' in the book of Leviticus?" as well as the section in the Introduction to Chapter 5 labeled "Unclean."

The identity of the clean and unclean animals
The exact identities of several of the animals listed in this chapter are ambiguous and debated, especially in the lists of unclean birds (11:13–19) and "swarming" creatures (11:29–31). Not only is it likely that some of these animals are extinct or no longer exist in the same form as they did in ancient Israel, but it is also likely that the ancient Israelites categorized animals differently than modern zoological taxonomies. Despite this, the ULT gives a reasonable translation for the animals in these lists. In your translation, it is best to keep the names of the animals in these lists as general as possible. Consider using words or expressions that describe a category of birds (such as "hawks" or "lizards") rather than the name of a specific species of bird (like "the Swainson's Hawk" or "the monitor lizard"). If your language does not have many different words for similar animals, you may have to list fewer animals than the ULT does. See the UST for a model of this kind of translation.

Leviticus 11:1 (#1)

לֵאמֹ֖ר אֲלֵהֶֽם

"saying to them"

The word **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, consider ways in which you might introduce this quotation naturally in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Leviticus 11:1–2 (#1)

לֵאמֹ֖ר אֲלֵהֶֽם׃ דַּבְּר֣וּ אֶל־בְּנֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל לֵאמֹ֑ר

"saying to them, "Speak to the sons of Israel, saying"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation, with a period before: [He told them to tell the sons of Israel]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Leviticus 11:2 (#3)

הַחַיָּהּ

“is} the living thing”

The expression **the living thing** does not refer to a specific animal. It describes any animal, bird, fish, lizard, or insect that an Israelite might encounter. Express this in the way that would be most natural in your language. Alternate translation: [is the type of creature]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 11:2 (#2)

זֹאת הַחַיָּהּ

“This {is} the living thing”

In this verse, the word **living thing** is singular in form, but it refers to all the following animals, birds, fish, lizards, and insects as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this plainly. Alternate translation: [These are the creatures]

See: Collective Nouns

Leviticus 11:2 (#1)

בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the sons of Israel”

See how you translated this way of referring to the people of Israel in 1:2.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 11:3 (#3)

מַפְרֶסֶת פַּרְסָה

“dividing a hoof”

Here, words are being repeated for emphasis. The verb **dividing** comes from the same root as the noun **hoof**. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [that has a completely divided hoof]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 11:3 (#1)

כֹּל ׀ מַפְרֶסֶת פַּרְסָה וְשֹׁסַעַת שֶׁשַׁע פְּרָסוֹת מַעֲלַת גֵּרָה בַּבְּהֵמָה

“Anything dividing a hoof and splitting the cleft of hooves, making the cud go up among the livestock”

Alternate translation: [Animals that have a divided hoof, split in two parts, and they bring up and rechew their food]

Leviticus 11:3 (#4)

וְשֹׁסַעַת שֶׁשַׁע פְּרָסוֹת

“and splitting the cleft of hooves”

Here, words are being repeated for emphasis. The verb **splitting** comes from the same root as the noun **cleft**. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [and with hooves that are thoroughly split in two]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 11:3 (#5)

מַעֲלַת גֵּרָה

“making the cud go up”

This expression is an idiom that refers to the process of chewing partly digested food. This expression should not be taken in a modern, technical sense, as the inclusion of rock badgers and rabbits (which do not strictly chew cud) suggests. If your language has a general word for this digestive process, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [that eats partially digested food]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 11:3 (#6)

גֵּרָה

“the cud”

Here, **the cud** does not refer to a specific food substance. Rather, it refers to any food that an animal brings up and chews again or food that is digested, passed, and eaten again, as with rabbits and rock badgers. Express this in the way that would be most natural in your language. Alternate translation: [any food from the first eating]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 11:3 (#7)

אֹתָהּ תֹּאכֵלוּ

“you shall eat it”

Here, **it** refers to any individual land-dwelling quadruped that meets both of the criteria listed in this verse. That is, it must both chew cud and possess a

completely divided hoof to be considered clean and acceptable for eating. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [you should eat any four-footed animal that meets these criteria]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 11:3 (#2)

כֹּ֖ל ו מַפְרֶ֣סֶת פַּרְסָ֑ה וְשֹׁסַ֥עַת שֶׁ֙סַע֙ פַּרְסֹ֔ת

“Anything dividing a hoof and splitting the cleft of hooves”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Anything dividing the hoof that splits the cleft of the hooves completely]

See: Parallelism

Leviticus 11:4 (#4)

וּפַרְסָה֙ אֵינֶ֣נּוּ מַפְרִ֔יס

“but a hoof it is not dividing”

Here, words are being repeated for emphasis. The verb **dividing** comes from the same root as the noun **hoof**. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis. Alternate translation, preceded by a comma: [but it does not have a fully divided hoof]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 11:4 (#2)

אֶת־הַגָּמָ֛ל

“the camel”

This **camel** is a large, long-necked animal that usually lives in hot, dry climates. It has long slender legs, broad cushioned feet, and either one or two humps of fatty tissue on its back. They are still used as beasts of burden. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of animal, you could use the name of something similar in your area, or you could use a more general term.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:4 (#3)

כִּ֤י

“because”

The word **because** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [for the reason that]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 11:4 (#1)

אֶת־הַגָּמָ֛ל

“the camel”

The expression **the camel** does not refer to a specific animal. It describes any camel that an Israelite might own or encounter. Express this in the way that would be most natural in your language. Alternate translation: [any camel]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 11:5 (#4)

וּפַרְסָ֖ה לֹ֣א יַפְרִ֑יס

“but it does not divide a hoof”

Here, words are being repeated for emphasis. The verb **divide** comes from the same root as the noun **hoof**. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [but it does not have a totally divided hoof]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 11:5 (#2)

וְאֶת־הַשָּׁפָ֔ן

“And the rock badger”

This **rock badger** is a small-to-medium-sized rodent-like animal that lives and hunts in rocky places. It is also known as the hyrax, the rock rabbit, or, in some places, the coney. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of animal, you could use the name of something similar in your area, or you could use a more general term. Like camels, rock badgers meet one condition, but not both. While it does not chew the cud like a camel, it moves its jaw in a similar manner as animals that chew the cud. Moreover, rock badgers habitually eat food that has already been digested and passed. Nonetheless, rock badgers do not possess a completely divided hoof, because they do not have hooves at all. Because of this, it should be considered unclean. It may be helpful to clarify this

for your readers in a footnote or in the text of your translation.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:5 (#1)

וְאֶת־הַשָּׁפָ֗ן כִּי

“And the rock badger, because”

The word **because** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Likewise, you shall not eat the rock badger. This is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 11:5 (#3)

וְאֶת־הַשָּׁפָ֗ן

“And the rock badger”

The expression **the rock badger** does not refer to a specific animal. It describes any rock badger that an Israelite might encounter. Express this in the way that would be most natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And any rock badger]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 11:6 (#2)

וְאֶת־הָאַרְנֶ֗בֶת

“And the rabbit”

The **rabbit** is a burrowing, plant-eating animal with long ears, long hind legs, and a short tail. If your language has a word for such an animal, consider using it here. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of animal, you could use the name of something similar in your area, or you could use a more general term. Like rock badgers, rabbits meet one condition, but not both. While it does not chew the cud like a camel, it moves its jaw in a similar manner as animals that chew the cud. Moreover, rabbits habitually eat food that has already been digested and passed. Nonetheless, they do not possess a completely divided hoof, because they do not have hooves at all. Because of this, rabbits should be considered unclean. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers in a footnote or in the text of your translation.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:6 (#1)

וְאֶת־הָאַרְנֶ֗בֶת כִּי

“And the rabbit, because”

The word **because** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Likewise, you shall not eat the rabbit. This is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 11:6 (#3)

וְאֶת־הָאַרְנֶ֗בֶת

“And the rabbit”

The expression **the rabbit** does not refer to a specific animal. It describes any rabbit that an Israelite might encounter in their daily life. Express this in the way that would be most natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And any rabbit]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 11:6 (#4)

וּפַרְסָ֣ה לֹ֔א הִפְרִ֖יסָה

“but it does not divide a hoof”

See how you translated these repeated words in 11:5.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 11:7 (#3)

וְאֶת־הַֽחֲזִ֔יר

“And the pig”

The expression **the pig** does not refer to a specific animal. It describes any pig that an Israelite might encounter. Express this in the way that would be most natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And any pig]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 11:7 (#7)

וְה֤וּא גֵּרָה֙ לֹא־יִגָּ֔ר

“but it itself does not ruminate the cud”

Here, words are being repeated for emphasis. Here, the verb **chew** comes from the same root as the noun **cud**. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of

showing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [but it itself does not chew the cud]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 11:7 (#2)

וְאֶת־הַֽחֲזִיר

“And the pig”

This **pig** is a hoofed swine with a flat snout for rooting in the soil. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of animal, you could use the name of something similar in your area, or you could use a more general term.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:7 (#5)

מַפְרִיס פַּרְסָה הֽוּא

“it is dividing a hoof”

See how you translated these repeated words in 11:5.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 11:7 (#4)

כִּי־מַפְרִיס פַּרְסָה הֽוּא וְשֹׁסַעַ שֶׁשַׁע פַּרְסָה

“because it is dividing a hoof and splitting the cleft of a hoof”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [because it is dividing the hoof in a way that splits the cleft of the hooves completely]

See: Parallelism

Leviticus 11:7 (#1)

וְאֶת־הַֽחֲזִיר כִּי

“And the pig, because”

The word **because** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Likewise, you shall not eat the pig. This is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 11:7 (#6)

וְשֹׁסַעַ שֶׁשַׁע פַּרְסָה

“and splitting the cleft of a hoof”

Here, words are being repeated for emphasis. The verb **splitting** comes from the same root as the noun **cleft**. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [and the cleft if the hoof is totally split]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 11:7 (#8)

וְהַֽהוּא גֵּרָה לֹא־יִגָּֽר

“but it itself does not ruminate the cud”

This expression uses the word **itself** to emphasize that **the pig** does not chew the cud. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this significance. Alternate translation: [but the pig itself does not chew the cud]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Leviticus 11:9 (#3)

וְקַשְׂקֶשֶׂת

“and scales”

Here, **scales** refers to the small, bony, protective plates that cover the body of the fish.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:9 (#1)

כֹּל אֲשֶׁר־לוֹ סְנַפִּיר וְקַשְׂקֶשֶׂת

“everything that is to it fins and scales”

Alternate translation: [anything that has both fins and scales]

Leviticus 11:9 (#2)

סְנַפִּיר

“fins”

Here, **fins** refers to the thin, flat body parts that the fish uses to move through the water.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:9 (#4)

אֹתָם תֹּאכֵֽלוּ

“them you shall eat”

Here, **them** refers to the fish that possess both **fins** and **scales**. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making the referents explicit. Alternate translation: [you shall eat anything that lives in water that possesses both fins and scales]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 11:10 (#4)

וּמִכֹּ֗ל נֶ֙פֶשׁ֙ הַחַיָּ֔ה אֲשֶׁ֖ר בַּמָּ֑יִם

“and from every life of a living thing that is in the water”

This expression, **life of a living thing**, uses the possessive form to describe **living things** that are both living, breathing creatures and live in **water**. Whereas the expression **swarming thing of the water** refers to schools of small fish, this expression likely refers to larger fish and mammals that live in water. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [and from every living creature that lives in the water]

See: Possession

Leviticus 11:10 (#2)

וְכֹ֨ל֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר אֵין־לוֹ֩ סְנַפִּ֨יר וְקַשְׂקֶ֜שֶׂת

“But everything that there is not to it fins and scales”

Alternate translation: [But anything that does not have both fins and scales]

Leviticus 11:10 (#1)

אֵין־לוֹ֩ סְנַפִּ֨יר וְקַשְׂקֶ֜שֶׂת

“there is not to it fins and scales”

The phrase **there is not to it fins and scales** is meant to distinguish the unclean sea creatures from the clean sea creatures. This expression establishes criteria by which the people of Israel may determine whether a creature that lives in the water, regardless of whether it lives in the seas or in the rivers, is acceptable for eating. The animal must possess both **fins** and **scales**. If an animal fulfills only one of these criteria, it should be considered **a detestable thing** and should be avoided. Alternate translation: [does not have both fins and scales]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

Leviticus 11:10 (#3)

מִכֹּ֣ל שֶׁ֭רֶץ הַמָּ֑יִם

“from every swarming thing of the water”

This expression uses the possessive form to describe **swarming** fish that live in **water**, that is, schools of small fish that swim together in large numbers. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [from every fish that swarms in large numbers and lives in the water]

See: Possession

Leviticus 11:12 (#1)

כֹּ֚ל אֲשֶׁ֣ר אֵין־לוֹ֩ סְנַפִּ֨יר וְקַשְׂקֶ֜שֶׂת

“Everything that there is not to it fins or scales”

Alternate translation: [Anything that does not have both fins and scales]

Leviticus 11:13 (#4)

וְאֶת־הַפָּ֖רֹס

“and the vulture”

Although the exact designation of this bird is debated, it likely refers to a what is commonly known as a **vulture**. Specifically, a vulture is a large bird of prey with the head and neck more or less bare of feathers, feeding mostly on carrion. If your readers would not be familiar with this specific bird, you could use the name of a similar species of bird in your area, or you could use a more general term.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:13 (#1)

מִן־הָעֹ֑וף

“from the bird”

The word **bird** is singular in form, but it refers to all winged animals as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this plainly. Alternate translation: [from winged animals]

See: Collective Nouns

Leviticus 11:13 (#3)

אֶת־הַנָּ֖שֶׁר

“the eagle”

Although the exact designation of the **eagle** is debated, it likely refers to a large carrion-eating bird of prey such as the is commonly known as an eagle. Like

many of the birds on this list, this bird is a large bird of prey. If your readers would not be familiar with this specific bird, you could use the name of a similar species of bird in your area, or you could use a more general term.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:13 (#5)

וְאֶת הָעָזְנִיָּה

“and the buzzard”

Although the exact designation of this bird is debated, it likely refers generally to a **buzzard**. Like all the birds in this verse, it is a large carnivorous bird but it prefers to capture and eat live animals. If your readers would not be familiar with this group of birds, you could use the name of a similar species of bird in your area, or you could use a more general term.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:13 (#2)

לֹ֣א יֵאָכְל֔וּ

“They shall not be eaten”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [You must not eat them]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 11:14 (#1)

וְאֶת־הַדָּאָ֑ה

“and the kite”

Although the exact designation of this bird is debated, it likely refers to a **kite**, a small-to-medium-sized bird of prey that eats dead animals and insects. A **kite** has a partly bare face and short beak. If your readers would not be familiar with this specific bird, you could use the name of a similar species of bird in your area, or you could use a more general term.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:14 (#2)

וְאֶת־הָאַיָּ֖ה

“and the falcon”

Although the exact designation of this group of birds is debated, the word likely refers to a **falcon**, a bird of prey ranging in size from large to small, with long, pointed wings and a notched beak. If your readers would not be familiar with this specific bird, you could use the name of a similar species of bird in your area, or you could use a more general term.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:15 (#1)

אֵ֖ת כָּל־עֹרֵֽב

“any raven”

Although the exact designation of this bird is debated, it likely refers to a **raven**, a medium-to-large-sized bird with entirely black feathers. It feeds mostly on carrion. If your readers would not be familiar with this specific bird, you could use the name of a similar species of bird in your area, or you could use a more general term.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:16 (#3)

וְאֶת־הַשָּׁ֑חַף

“and the gull”

Although the exact designation of this bird is debated, it likely refers to a **gull**, a common bird that lives and hunts in large bodies of water. If your readers would not be familiar with this group of birds, you could use the name of a similar species of bird in your area, or you could use a more general term.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:16 (#2)

וְאֶת־הַתַּחְמָ֖ס

“and the owl”

Although the exact designation of this bird is debated, it likely refers generally to an **owl**, a bird that hunts at night. It ranges from small to large in size, and it has large eyes and a hooked beak. If your readers would not be familiar with this specific group of birds, you could use the name of a similar species of bird in your area, or you could use a more general term.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:16 (#4)

וְאֶת־הַנֵּ֥ץ לְמִינֵֽהוּ

“and the hawk of its kind”

Although the exact designation of this bird is debated, it likely refers to a **hawk**, a small-to-medium-sized bird of prey with broad, rounded wings and a long tail. If your readers would not be familiar with this group of birds, you could use the name of a similar species

of bird in your area, or you could use a more general term.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:16 (#1)

וְאֶתbבַּתh הַיַּעֲנָֽה

“and the daughter of clamor”

The expression **the daughter of clamor** describes a bird which possesses a cry that sounds like a loud and confused noise. Specifically, this expression is used to describe an ostrich. a flightless, fast-running bird which has a long neck, long bare legs, and two toes on each foot. In the ancient world, it was associated with ruins and desolate places and, therefore, with death and destruction. If it would be helpful, you could use an equivalent idiom from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the ostrich]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 11:17 (#3)

וְאֶת־הַיַּנְשׁוּף

“and the big owl”

Although the exact designation of this bird is debated, it likely refers to a **big owl**, a large-sized variety of owls, a nocturnal bird of prey that also feeds on carrion. If your readers would not be familiar with this group of birds, you could use the name of a similar species of bird in your area, or you could use a more general term. See how you translated the word “owl” in the previous verse.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:17 (#1)

וְאֶת־הַכּֽוס

“and the little owl”

Although the exact designation of this bird is debated, it likely refers to the **little owl**, a small-sized variety of owls, a nocturnal bird of prey that commonly feeds on carrion. If your readers would not be familiar with this group of birds, you could use the name of a similar species of bird in your area, or you could use a more general term. See how you translated the word “owl” in the previous verse.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:17 (#2)

וְאֶת־הַשָּׁלָךְ

“and the cormorant”

Although the exact designation of this bird is debated, it likely refers to a **cormorant**, a large, diving bird with a long neck, long hooked bill, and dark feathers. If your readers would not be familiar with this specific bird, you could use the name of a similar species of bird in your area, or you could use a more general term.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:18 (#1)

וְאֶת־הַתִּנְשֶׁמֶת

“and the waterhen”

Although the exact designation of this bird is debated, it likely refers to a **waterhen**, a small-to-medium-sized water bird that lives in the water and hunts by wading in shallow water. If your readers would not be familiar with this group of birds, you could use the name of a similar species of bird in your area, or you could use a more general term.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:18 (#3)

וְאֶת־הָרָחָם

“and the ibis”

Although the exact designation of this bird is debated, it likely refers to an **ibis**, a group of wading water birds that have long necks and legs and a long, curved beak. If your readers would not be familiar with this group of birds, you could use the name of a similar species of bird in your area, or you could use a more general term.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:18 (#2)

וְאֶת־הַקָּאָֽת

“and the pelican”

Although the exact designation of this bird is debated, it likely refers to a **pelican**, a large white or grey water bird with a large bill designed for scooping up fish and prey. This word may specifically refer to a variety of **pelican** that lives in the desert. If your readers would not be familiar with this group of birds, you could use the name of a similar species of bird in your area, or you could use a more general term.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:19 (#1)

וְאֶת הַחֲסִידָה

“and the stork”

Although the exact designation of this bird is debated, it likely refers to a **stork**, a tall long-legged bird with a long, heavy bill. The stork wades in shallow water to catch fish and water animals to eat. If your readers would not be familiar with this specific type of bird, you could use the name of a similar species of bird in your area, or you could use a more general term.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:19 (#4)

וְאֶת־הָעֲטַלֵּף

“and the bat”

Although the exact designation of this flying animal is debated, it likely refers to a **bat**, a winged, rodent-like mammal that usually flies and hunts at night. Although the bat is not a bird, it is a flying creature associated with death and destruction in the ancient world because of its tendency to live near desolate or deserted places. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of animal, you could use the name of a similar flying animal in your area, or you could use a more general term.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:19 (#3)

וְאֶת־הַדּוּכִיפַת

“and the hoopoe”

Although the exact designation of this bird is debated, it likely refers to a **hoopoe**, a salmon-pink bird with a long, thin beak and black and white wings and tail. In the ancient world, it was often associated with filth and excrement. If your readers would not be familiar with this specific bird, you could use the name of a similar species of bird in your area, or you could use a more general term.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:19 (#2)

הָאֲנָפָה לְמִינָהּ

“the heron of its kind”

Although the exact designation of this bird is debated, it likely refers to a **heron**, a tall, fish-eating bird with long legs. It is recognizable by its long S-shaped neck and long, pointed bill. If your readers would not be familiar with this specific bird, you could use the name of a similar species of bird in your area, or you could use a more general term.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:20 (#1)

כֹּל שֶׁרֶץ הָעוֹף הַהֹלֵךְ עַל־אַרְבַּע

“Every swarming thing of the wing, the one walking on four”

Here, the expression **the one walking on four** is an idiom that means to crawl on the ground on four legs. This sets these insects apart from other flying things, such as birds, that have only two feet. Alternate translation: [Every swarming thing of the wing that has four legs]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 11:20 (#2)

כֹּל שֶׁרֶץ הָעוֹף

“Every swarming thing of the wing”

The expression **every swarming thing of the wing** uses the possessive form to describe a swarming insect that is characterized by possessing wings. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [Every winged, swarming insect]

See: Possession

Leviticus 11:21 (#1)

מִכֹּל שֶׁרֶץ הָעוֹף הַהֹלֵךְ עַל־אַרְבַּע

“from every swarming thing of the wing, the one walking on four”

See how you translated these expressions in 11:20.

See: Possession

Leviticus 11:21 (#3)

לְנַתֵּר בָּהֵן

“to jump with them”

Here, **to** marks jumping as the goal or purpose of having jointed legs. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Leviticus 11:21 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר־לֹא כְרַעַיִם מִמַּעַל לְרַגְלָיו לְנַתֵּר בָּהֵן עַל־הָאָרֶץ

“that which to it {are} legs from above to its feet to jump with them on the earth”

The expression **to it {are} legs from above to its feet to jump with them** implies a criterion by which the people of Israel may distinguish whether a winged, swarming insect is acceptable for eating. The insect must have jointed legs with which it jumps to move about on the ground. The implication is that if an insect does not have jointed legs, the people of Israel should consider the insect to be unclean. Express this in whatever way is most natural for your language. Alternate translation: [that which has jointed legs above its feet with which it jumps on the ground]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

Leviticus 11:22 (#2)

אֶת־הָאַרְבֶּה לְמִינֵהוּ וְאֶת־הַסָּלְעָם לְמִינֵהוּ וְאֶת־הַחַרְגֹּל לְמִינֵהוּ וְאֶת־הֶחָגָב לְמִינֵהוּ

“the locust of its kind and the bald locust of its kind and the cricket of its kind and the grasshopper of its kind”

Although the exact designation of these insects is debated, these terms likely refer to locust- or cricket-like insects that have wings and jointed legs by which they jump on the ground. Although these insects usually have six legs, 11:20 describes these insects as swarming things that have four legs. This is because, in most cases, these insects walk on four legs and use their back two legs, quite different in size and appearance from the rest, to jump. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers in a footnote or in the text of your translation. If your readers would not be familiar with these types of insects, you could use the names of similar insects in your area, or you could use more general terms.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:22 (#1)

אֶת־אֵלֶּה מֵהֶם

“These from them”

Alternate translation: [These from among them]

Leviticus 11:23 (#1)

וְכֹל שֶׁרֶץ הָעוֹף אֲשֶׁר־לוֹ אַרְבַּע רַגְלָיִם

“But every swarming thing of the wing that to it {are} four feet”

Alternate translation: [Every winged, swarming insect that has four legs]

Leviticus 11:23 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר־לוֹ אַרְבַּע רַגְלָיִם

“that to it {are} four feet”

This statement reiterates what 11:20 stated. Any winged, swarming insect that only has four legs with which it walks on the ground, other than the ones listed in the previous verse, are to be considered unclean. If it would be helpful in your language, consider clarifying this for your readers in a footnote or in the text of your translation.

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

Leviticus 11:24 (#1)

וּלְאֵלֶּה

“And by these”

Here, **these** refers to either: (1) any winged, swarming insect that has four legs and does not possess jointed legs. Alternate translation: [And by any winged, swarming insect that has four legs that are not jointed on which it walks] or (2) all the unclean quadrupeds, including the ones that have paws, listed in 11:26–27. Alternate translation: [And by any quadruped that either chews the cud or has a completely cloven hoof, but does not possess both characteristics, or by any quadruped that has paws]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 11:25 (#1)

וְכָל־הַנֹּשֵׂא מִנִּבְלָתָם

“and anyone lifting {one} of their carcasses”

Alternate translation: [and whoever picks up one of their carcasses]

Leviticus 11:25 (#2)

יְכַבֵּס בְּגָדָיו

“shall wash his clothes”

The act of washing one’s clothing is not for hygienic purposes but rather for the purpose of removing ritual impurity from one’s body or from anything with which one comes into contact. If this would be unclear to your readers, consider explaining the significance of this action in a footnote or in the text of your translation. Alternate translation: [shall wash his clothes in order to remove any impurity from them that they might have acquired by touching the carcass of the unclean insect or animal]

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 11:26 (#1)

לְכָל־הַבְּהֵמָה אֲשֶׁשֶׁר הִוא֣ מַפְרֶ֔סֶת פַּרְסָ֖ה וְשֶׁשַׁסַּ֣ע ׀ אֵינֶ֣נָּה שֹׁסַ֑עַת וְגֵרָ֥ה אֵינֶ֖נָּה מַעֲלָ֥ה

“To any livestock that it {is} dividing the hoof, but it is not splitting the cleft, and it is not making the cud go up”

See how you translated these expressions in 11:3.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 11:29 (#2)

וְהָעַכְבָּ֔ר

“and the mouse”

Although the exact designation of this animal is debated, this term likely refers to a **mouse**, a small rodent, typically having long ears and a long tail. If your readers would not be familiar with this animal, you could use the name of a some animal in your area, or you could use a more general term.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:29 (#3)

וְהַצָּ֖בַ לְמִינֵ֑הוּ

“and the large lizard of its kind”

Although the exact designation of this animal is debated, this term may refer to a **large lizard**. This term includes a wide variety of large scaly reptiles with four short legs. If your readers would not be familiar with this kind of animal, you could use the name of a similar group of animals in your area, or you could use a more general term.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:29 (#1)

הַחֹ֙לֶד

“the rat”

Although the exact designation of this animal is debated, this term likely refers to a **rat**, a large rodent, typically having a pointed nose and a long, bare tail. If your readers would not be familiar with this animal, you could use the name of a some animal in your area, or you could use a more general term.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:30 (#2)

וְהַכֹּ֣חַ

“and the monitor lizard”

Although the exact designation of this animal is debated, this term may refer to a **monitor lizard**, a term that includes a wide variety of large, heavy-set lizards with large claws and a forked, snake-like tongue. If your readers would not be familiar with this kind of animal, you could use the name of a similar group of animals in your area, or you could use a more general term.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:30 (#1)

וְהָאֲנָקָ֔ה

“and the gecko”

Although the exact designation of this animal is debated, this term may refer to a **gecko**, a large group of small lizards with sticky pads on their feet by which they climb. If your readers would not be familiar with this kind of animal, you could use the name of a similar group of animals in your area, or you could use a more general term.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:30 (#3)

וְהַלְּטָאָ֖ה

“and the lizard”

Although the exact designation of this animal is debated, this term may generally refer to a **lizard**, including a wide variety of small-to-large-sized scaly reptiles with four short legs and a long tail. If your readers would not be familiar with this general group of animals, you could use the name of a similar kind of animal in your area, or you could use a more general term.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:30 (#4)

וְהַחֹ֥מֶט

“and the skink”

Although the exact designation of this animal is debated, this term may refer to a **skink**. This term includes a wide variety of small, smooth-skinned lizards that typically burrow in sandy ground. If your readers would not be familiar with this kind of animal, you could use the name of a similar group of animals in your area, or you could use a more general term.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:30 (#5)

וְהַתִּנְשָׁמֶת

“and the chameleon”

Although the exact designation of this animal is debated, this term may refer to a **chameleon**. If this is the case, this term refers to a small, slow lizard with a long, curved tail, and a long, sticky tongue. It also has bulging eyes that move independently, and it is most recognizable for its ability to blend in with its surroundings by changing color. If your readers would not be familiar with this specific animal, you could use the name of a similar animal in your area, or you could use a more general term.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:32 (#3)

כָּל־כְּלִי֩ אֲשֶׁר־יֵעָשֶׂ֨ה מְלָאכָ֜ה בָּהֶ֗ם בַּמַּ֤יִם יוּבָא

“any vessel that work is done with them shall be brought into the water”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the owner of any such item with which he does work should bring it into water]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 11:32 (#1)

מֵהֶ֑ם

“one} from them”

The expression **one from them** refers to any unclean animal, but specifically the list of lizards and “swarming things” from 11:29–30.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 11:32 (#2)

מִכָּל־כְּלִי־עֵ֡ץ אוֹ־בֶ֩גֶד֩ אוֹ־ע֨וֹר אוֹ־שָׂ֜ק

“from any vessel of wood or cloth or leather or sackcloth”

Here, the phrase **of wood or cloth or leather or sackcloth** is using the possessive form to describe a **vessel** that is characterized by being made of one or more of those materials. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could state this in another way that is natural to your language. Alternate translation: [anything made from wood or cloth or leather or sackcloth]

See: Possession

Leviticus 11:33 (#3)

וְאֹתָ֖ו תִּשְׁבֹּֽרוּ

“and you shall break it”

Here, **it** refers to the **vessel of clay**. If it would be helpful to your readers, consider making the referent explicit. Alternate translation: [and you shall break the vessel of clay]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 11:33 (#1)

מֵהֶ֑ם

“one} from them”

See how you translated this expression in 11:32.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 11:33 (#2)

וְאֹתָ֖ו תִּשְׁבֹּֽרוּ

“and you shall break it”

Here, **you** is plural. It refers to the people of Israel, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 11:34 (#3)

אֲשֶׁ֥ר יָבֹ֛וא עָלָ֖יו מַ֑יִם

“that {such} water comes onto, it”

Alternate translation: [onto which any such water comes]

Leviticus 11:34 (#2)

מִכָּל־הָאֹ֨כֶל אֲשֶׁ֥ר יֵאָכֵ֖ל

“Any food that is eaten”

Words are being repeated for emphasis. Specifically, the verb **eaten** comes from the same root as the noun **food**. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [From anything that can be eaten]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 11:34 (#6)

בְּכָל־כְּלִ֖י

“from any vessel”

Alternate translation: [from any vessel into which a dead, unclean animal has fallen]

Leviticus 11:34 (#1)

מִכָּל־הָאֹ֨כֶל אֲשֶׁ֤ר יֵאָכֵל֙

“Any food that is eaten”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Any food that someone eats]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 11:34 (#5)

וְכָל־מַשְׁקֶ֥ה אֲשֶׁ֛ר יִשָּׁתֶ֖ה

“And any drink that is drunk”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and any drink that you drink]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 11:34 (#4)

וְכָל־מַשְׁקֶ֥ה אֲשֶׁ֛ר יִשָּׁתֶ֖ה

“And any drink that is drunk”

Here words are being repeated for emphasis. Here, the verb **drunk** comes from the same root as the noun **drink**. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [and any liquid that you can drink]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 11:35 (#2)

תַּנּ֥וּר וְכִירַ֖יִם יֻתָּ֑ץ

“An oven or stove shall be smashed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [You shall shatter an oven or stove] or [The owner of the oven or stove shall shatter it]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 11:35 (#4)

וְכִירַ֖יִם

“or stove”

This **stove** was likely a household item on which food could be cooked in or over an open flame. If your language has a word for such an item, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [or other means of cooking food]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:35 (#1)

מִנִּבְלָתָ֖ם

“one} of their carcasses”

Here, **their** refers to the list of unclean animals. If it would be helpful to your readers, consider making the referent explicit. Alternate translation: [one of the carcasses of any unclean animal]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 11:35 (#3)

תַּנּ֥וּר

“An oven”

See how you translated this household item in 2:4.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 11:36 (#1)

בְּנִבְלָתָ֖ם

“their carcass”

Here, **their** refers to the list of unclean animals. If it would be helpful to your readers, consider making the referent explicit. Alternate translation: [the carcass of any unclean animal]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 11:37 (#1)

מִנִּבְלָתָ֖ם

“part} of their carcass”

Here, **their** refers to the list of unclean animals. If it would be helpful to your readers, consider making the referent explicit. Alternate translation: [one of the carcasses of any unclean animal]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 11:37 (#2)

כָּל־זֶ֥רַע זָרוּעַ֖ אֲשֶׁ֥ר יִזָּרֵֽעַ

“any seed, a sown seed that will be sown”

Words are being repeated for emphasis. The noun **seed** is related to the verb **sown**. The emphasis dis-

tinguishes these seeds as plant seeds and not any other kind of seed, whether male sperm, discharge, or otherwise. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [any plant seeds that are sown in the ground]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 11:37 (#3)

כָּל־זֶ֖רַע זֵרוּעַ֣ אֲשֶׁ֑ר יִזָּרֵֽעַ

“any seed, a sown seed that will be sown”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [any seed that someone might plant in the ground]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 11:38 (#3)

עַל־זָ֖רַע

“on seed”

In this verse, the word **seed** is singular in form, but it refers to all plant seeds as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this plainly. Alternate translation: [on some seeds]

See: Collective Nouns

Leviticus 11:38 (#2)

וְכִֽי־יִתַּ֥ן מַ֛יִם עַל־זָ֖רַע

“But when water is put on seed”

This expression is an idiom that refers to watering a seed after it has been planted in the ground. If your language has a similar expression, consider using it here. However, if this meaning would not be clear in your language, consider stating the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [But when a seed is watered after it has been planted in the ground]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 11:38 (#4)

מִנִּבְלָתָֽם

“and {a} carcass of theirs”

Here, **their** refers to the list of unclean animals. If it would be helpful to your readers, consider making the referent explicit. Alternate translation: [one of the carcasses of any unclean animal]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 11:38 (#1)

וְכִֽי־יִתַּ֥ן מַ֛יִם עַל־זָ֖רַע

“But when water is put on seed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [But when you water the seed] or [But when someone waters the seed]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 11:39 (#1)

וְכִֽי־יָמ֣וּת מִן־הַבְּהֵמָ֗ה אֲשֶׁר־הִ֥יא לָכֶ֛ם לְאָכְלָ֖ה

“But when {one} from the livestock that it {is} to you to eat dies”

The expression **that it is to you to eat** refers to animals which are raised to provide food rather than other useful products. Alternate translation: [But whenever one of the livestock that is acceptable for you to eat dies]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

Leviticus 11:39 (#2)

הַנֹּגֵ֖עַ בְּנִבְלָתָֽהּ

“the one touching its carcass”

The phrase **the one touching** represents anyone who touches these animals in general, not one particular person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [whoever touches its carcass]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 11:40 (#2)

וְהַנֹּשֵׂ֖א אֶת־נִבְלָתָֽהּ

“And the one lifting its carcass”

The phrase **the one lifting** represents anyone who removes these dead animals in general, not one particular person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [And whoever picks up its carcass]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 11:40 (#1)

וְהָאֹכֵ֖ל מִנִּבְלָתָֽהּ

“And the one eating from its carcass”

The phrase **the one eating** represents anyone who eats meat from these animals in general, not one particular person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [And whoever eats meat from its carcass]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 11:41 (#1)

וְכָל־הַשֶּׁרֶץ הַשֹּׁרֵץ עַל־הָאָרֶץ

“And every swarming thing, the one swarming on the ground”

This expression is an emphatic construction that uses a verb and its object that comes from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [Anything at all that swarms on the ground]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 11:41 (#2)

לֹא יֵאָכֵל

“It shall not be eaten”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [You must not eat it]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 11:42 (#1)

כֹּלֹ֤ הוֹלֵךְ֙ עַל־גָּחוֹן

“Everything going on a belly”

This expression is an idiom that refers to any swarming animal that crawls and possesses short limbs or limbs that are angled in such a way that its belly drags on the ground. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [Any animal that crawls with its belly on the ground]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 11:42 (#2)

עַ֚ד כָּל־מַרְבֵּ֣ה רַגְלַ֔יִם

“up to anything multiplying feet”

This expression is an idiom that refers to any swarming animal that possesses many legs. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [or anything with numerous legs]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 11:42 (#3)

לְכָל־הַשֶּׁרֶץ הַשֹּׁרֵץ עַל־הָאָרֶץ

“of any swarming thing, the one swarming on the earth”

This expression is an emphatic construction that uses a verb and its object that comes from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [to anything at all that swarms all over the ground]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 11:43 (#1)

אַל־תְּשַׁקְּצוּ֙ אֶת־נַפְשֹׁתֵיכֶ֔ם

“You shall not make your lives detestable”

Yahweh is using a future statement to give an instruction or command. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate these words using a command or instruction form. Alternate translation: [You must not make your lives detestable]

See: Statements — Other Uses

Leviticus 11:43 (#2)

בְּכָל־הַשֶּׁרֶץ הַשֹּׁרֵץ

“with any swarming thing, the one swarming”

This expression is an emphatic construction that uses a verb and its object that comes from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [with anything at all that swarms all over]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 11:43 (#4)

וְנִטְמֵתֶ֖ם בָּ֑ם

“and be made unclean by them”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and do not let them make you unclean]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 11:43 (#3)

וְלֹ֣א תְטַמְּא֔וּ בָּהֶ֖ם וְנִטְמֵתֶ֣ם בָּ֑ם

“And you shall not make yourselves unclean with them and be made unclean by them”

Yahweh repeats the same idea twice with different words in order to strengthen the command that the people of Israel are not to eat the meat of any unclean animal. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [And you should not make yourselves unclean with them. No, certainly, you should never be made unclean by them]

See: Parallelism

Leviticus 11:44 (#2)

וְלֹ֣א תְטַמְּא֔וּ אֶת־נַפְשֹׁתֵיכֶ֖ם

“And you shall not make your lives unclean”

Alternate translation: [And you shall not make yourselves unclean]

Leviticus 11:44 (#1)

כִּ֣י אֲנִ֣י יְהוָ֔ה אֱלֹהֵיכֶ֑ם

“For I {am} Yahweh your God”

The word translated as **For** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [You should not make yourselves unclean with them, because I am Yahweh your God]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 11:45 (#2)

לִֽהְיֹ֥ת לָכֶ֖ם לֵֽאלֹהִ֑ים

“to be God for you”

Here, the word **to** marks Yahweh being Israel’s God as the goal or purpose of his bringing them out of Egypt. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. Alternate translation, with a period before: [so that I could be God for you]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Leviticus 11:45 (#3)

כִּֽי־קָד֖וֹשׁ אֲנִ֑י

“for I {am} holy”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation, with a period before: [You must be a holy people because I am holy]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 11:45 (#1)

כִּֽי׀ אֲנִ֣י יְהוָ֗ה

“For I {am} Yahweh”

The word translated as **For** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [You should not make yourselves unclean, because I am Yahweh]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 11:46 (#2)

הַבְּהֵמָה֙ וְהָע֣וֹף

“the livestock and the bird”

The expressions **the livestock** and **the bird** do not refer to specific groups of animals. Rather, they describe animals which are raised to provide food and other useful products. or any bird that an Israelite might own or encounter. Express this in the way that would be most natural in your language. Alternate translation: [any of the animals you raise and the birds]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 11:46 (#5)

וּלְכָל־נֶ֣פֶשׁ הַשֹּׁרֶ֔צֶת עַל־הָאָֽרֶץ

“and of every life, the ones crawling on the earth”

Alternate translation: [and of every living creature that crawls about on the ground]

Leviticus 11:46 (#1)

זֹ֣את תּוֹרַ֗ת הַבְּהֵמָה֙ וְהָע֣וֹף

“This {is} the law of the livestock and the bird”

This expression uses the possessive form to describe the **law** that is characterized by its referring to the wide variety of animals, fish, and living things listed in this verse. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [This is the law that has to do

with the livestock and the bird] or [This is the law that pertains to the livestock and the bird]

See: Possession

Leviticus 11:46 (#4)

וְכֹלׇ֣ נֶ֔פֶשׁ הַחַיָּ֖ה

“and every life of the living thing”

The expression **life of the living thing** uses the possessive form to describe an animal that is a living, breathing, creature. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [and every living creature]

See: Possession

Leviticus 11:46 (#3)

וְהָעֹ֑וף

“and the bird”

The word **bird** is singular in form, but it refers to all winged animals as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this plainly. See how you translated this collective noun in 11:13. Alternate translation: [and the winged animals]

See: Collective Nouns

Leviticus 11:47 (#1)

לְהַבְדִּ֔יל

“to separate”

Here, the word **to** marks distinguishing between clean and unclean animals as the goal or purpose of these instructions. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. Alternate translation, with a period before: [This instruction is intended to help you separate]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Leviticus 11:47 (#3)

הַחַיָּ֣ה הַנֵּאָכָ֗לֶת & הַחַיָּ֔ה אֲשֶׁ֥ר לֹ֖א תֵּאָכֵֽל

“the living thing, the one being eaten & the living thing that shall not be eaten”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the living thing that you will eat ... the living thing that you must not eat]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 11:47 (#2)

בֵּ֣ין הַטָּמֵ֔א וּבֵ֖ין הַטָּהֹ֑ר

“between the unclean and between the clean”

The adjectives **unclean** and **clean** are being used as nouns to refer to that which is able to be in holy space and come into contact with holy objects, and that which is impure and cannot be in holy space without introducing impurity to that space and those objects. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [between that which is unclean and that which is clean]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Leviticus - Chapter 12 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This short chapter continues Yahweh’s law concern clean and unclean things. In this chapter, Yahweh describes the process by which a woman becomes unclean after giving birth to children, as well as the process for her purification. The structure of this chapter is as follows:

1. Becoming unclean due to childbirth (12:1–5)
2. Giving birth to a male child (12:1–4)
3. Giving birth to female child (12:5)
4. Sacrifices required for purification (12:6–8)
5. The normal burnt and sin offering requirements (12:6–7)
6. Provisions for the inability to acquire the normal offerings (12:8)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Becoming unclean in childbirth

In this chapter, a woman is described as becoming unclean in the process of childbirth. This is because any loss of blood and all bodily discharges made a person ritually unclean. For this reason, this chapter also describes how a woman may become purified from the uncleanness of the blood loss during and following childbirth. It is important to note that this uncleanness is not because a woman’s flowing blood was considered sinful. Uncleanness was acquired when a person bled, because the loss of blood was considered a sign of proximity to death.

It is also important to note that there is a difference in the length of purification when a woman gives birth to a girl rather than a boy. While the reason for this

is debated, the difference is not due to the fact that girls were considered more unclean than boys. In your translation, make sure not to convey this misunderstanding.

The expression "the blood of her purification" (12:4–5) uses the possessive form to describe a flow of blood which begins a period of time during which the woman must wait to be purified. This is called the "days of her purification" (12:4 and 12:6). The implication is that for the 33 (after giving birth to a boy) or 66 days (after giving birth to a girl) during which time the woman is unclean because of bleeding from childbirth, the woman is waiting to be purified from the impurity caused by the blood that she bled during her childbirth.

Leviticus 12:1 (#1)

לֵאמֹֽר

"saying"

The word translated as **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, consider ways in which you might introduce this quotation naturally in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Leviticus 12:1–2 (#1)

לֵאמֹר׃ דַּבֵּ֞ר אֶל־בְּנֵ֤י יִשְׂרָאֵל֙ לֵאמֹ֔ר

"saying,"Speak to the sons of Israel, saying"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation, with a period before: [He told Moses to tell the sons of Israel]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Leviticus 12:2 (#2)

כִּימֵ֥י נִדַּ֖ת דְּוֹתָ֑הּ

"Like the days of the menstruation of her menstruating"

This expression uses the possessive form to describe **days** during which a woman is **menstruating**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Like when she is normally menstruating]

See: Possession

Leviticus 12:2 (#1)

כִּימֵ֥י נִדַּ֖ת דְּוֹתָ֑הּ

"Like the days of the menstruation of her menstruating"

Words are being repeated for emphasis. If your language can repeat words for emphasis, it would be appropriate to use that construction here in your translation. Alternate translation: [Like the days when she is menstruating]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 12:3 (#1)

וּבַיּ֣וֹם הַשְּׁמִינִ֔י

"And on the eighth day"

The word **eighth** is the ordinal number for eight. If your language does not use ordinal numbers, you could use a cardinal number here or an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [And after seven days]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Leviticus 12:3 (#2)

יִמּ֖וֹל בְּשַׂ֥ר עָרְלָתֽוֹ

"the flesh of his foreskin shall be circumcised"

Only the priest could perform circumcision. If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [a priest must circumcise the flesh of the foreskin of the baby boy]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 12:4 (#2)

תֵּשֵׁ֖ב בִּדְמֵ֣י טָהֳרָ֑הּ

"she shall stay in the blood of her purification"

The phrase **blood of her purification** refers to the bleeding a woman experiences after childbirth. The bleeding that accompanies childbirth marks a time of waiting until she will be declared ritually pure once again. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [she shall wait to be purified from the impurity of the blood that she bled during childbirth]

See: Possession

Leviticus 12:4 (#3)

עַד־מְלֹ֣את יְמֵ֔י טָהֳרָ֑הּ

"until the days of her purification are full"

In these phrases, the author is using the term "days" to refer to a specific time, **the days of her purification**. He is doing this by association with the way a lifetime is made up of individual days. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [until the waiting time for her purification is ended] or [until the time she is waiting to be purified is complete]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 12:4 (#1)

וּשְׁלֹשִׁ֣ים יוֹם֮ וּשְׁלֹ֣שֶׁת יָמִ֒ים

"And thirty days and three days"

Alternate translation: [And for 33 days]

Leviticus 12:5 (#1)

שְׁבֻעַ֣יִם

"for} two sets of seven {days"

Alternate translation: [for fourteen days] or [for 14 days]

Leviticus 12:5 (#2)

וְשִׁשִּׁ֣ים יוֹם֮ וְשֵׁשֶׁ֣ת יָמִ֒ים

"And sixty days and six days"

Alternate translation: [And for 66 days]

Leviticus 12:6 (#3)

כֶּ֣בֶשׂ בֶּן־שְׁנָת֔וֹ

"a lamb, a son of its year"

The expression **a son of its year** is an idiom that refers to an animal that is a year old. If your language has a similar idiom, consider using it here. If not, state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar expression in 9:3. Alternate translation: [a year-old lamb] or [a twelve-months old lamb]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 12:6 (#5)

אֶל־פֶּ֣תַח אֹהֶל־מוֹעֵ֔ד אֶל־הַכֹּהֵֽן

"to the entrance of the tent of meeting, to the priest"

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word that shows that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [to the entrance of the tent of meeting, where the priest is] or [to the priest at the entrance of the tent of meeting]

See: Parallelism

Leviticus 12:6 (#1)

וּבִמְלֹאת֙ ׀ יְמֵ֣י טָהֳרָ֔הּ

"And when the days of her purification are full"

See how you translated this expression in 12:4. Alternate translation: [And when the days of her purification are completed]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 12:6 (#2)

לְבֵ֥ן ׀ אֹ֖ו לְבַ֑ת

"for a son or for a daughter"

Alternate translation: [whether 33 days for a son or 66 days for a daughter]

Leviticus 12:6 (#4)

וּבֶן־יוֹנָ֔ה

"and a son of a pigeon"

The expression **son of** describes a person or animal that shares the essential qualities of something. The author of Leviticus uses this phrase to describe this bird as **the son of the pigeon** since it is a bird that shares the essential qualities of that class of birds. If it would be helpful, you could use an equivalent idiom from your language or state the meaning plainly. See how you translated this expression in 1:14. Alternate translation: [and a pigeon]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 12:7 (#2)

וְכִפֶּ֥ר עָלֶ֖יהָ

"and he shall make atonement for her"

See how you translated the abstract noun **atonement** in 1:4. However, in your translation, make it clear that the woman does not need atonement because of any sin on her part. Here, the sacrifices performed by the priest provide for the removal of impurity from the women—in this case, impurity acquired by the presence of blood that had discharged from the woman's body, not by any sin but as is normal following childbirth. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers in a footnote or in the text of your translation.

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 12:7 (#5)

תּוֹרַת הַיֹּלֶדֶת לַזָּכָר אוֹ לַנְּקֵבָה

“is} the law of the {woman} who bears a male or a female”

This expression uses the possessive form to describe these instructions that pertain to women who gave birth, whether to boys or girls. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is the law that pertains to the woman who bears a male or a female]

See: Possession

Leviticus 12:7 (#4)

מִמְּקֹר דָּמֶיהָ

“from the flow of her blood”

The implication of the phrase **purified from the flow of her blood** is that the woman was made impure because of the presence of blood discharging from her body. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [from the impurity that she acquired because of the bloody discharge related to childbirth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 12:7 (#1)

לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated this expression in 1:3.

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 12:7 (#3)

וְטָהֲרָה מִמְּקֹר דָּמֶיהָ

“And she will be purified from the flow of her blood”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh will cleanse her from the flow of her blood]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 12:7 (#6)

הַיֹּלֶדֶת לַזָּכָר אוֹ לַנְּקֵבָה

“the {woman} who bears a male or a female”

Alternate translation: [the woman who births either a son or a daughter]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 12:8 (#2)

וְכִפֶּר עָלֶיהָ הַכֹּהֵן

“And the priest shall make atonement for her”

See how you translated the abstract noun **atonement** in 1:4. However, in your translation, make it clear that the woman does not need atonement because of any sin on her part. Here, the sacrifices performed by the priest provide for the removal of impurity from the women—in this case, impurity acquired by the presence of blood discharging from the woman’s body, not by any sin. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers in a footnote or in the text of your translation.

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 12:8 (#1)

וְאִם־לֹא תִמְצָא יָדָהּ דֵּי שֶׂה

“And if her hand does not find enough {for} a sheep”

This expression is an idiom that refers to being unable to afford to offer an animal from one’s own flock animal or that was purchased. If your language uses a similar idiom, consider using it here. Otherwise, if it would be helpful in your language, consider stating the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar expressions in 5:7 and 5:11. Alternate translation: [But if she cannot afford to offer her own flock animal or to purchase someone else’s]

See: Idiom

Leviticus - Chapter 13 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues Yahweh’s law concerning clean and unclean things.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Skin disease

This chapter addresses the ways a priest was to decide if a person had a skin disease causing a person to be unclean. This was important because these diseases could have easily spread among the people in the ancient Near East. This is also true concerning things growing on clothing or things that touch a person’s skin. (See: priest, priesthood)

Leviticus 13:1 (#1)

לֵאמֹֽר

“saying”

The word translated as **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, consider ways in which you might introduce this quotation naturally in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Leviticus 13:2 (#2)

בְּעוֹר־בְּשָׂרוֹ & בְּעוֹר־בְּשָׂרֹֽו

“on the skin of his flesh & on the skin of his flesh”

Alternate translation: [on the skin of his body ... on the skin of his body]

Leviticus 13:2 (#3)

שְׂאֵ֥את

“a swelling”

This **swelling** refers to a portion of skin that has become raised, inflamed, swollen, and unusually discolored. In some instances, it can be the symptom of an infectious skin disease. If your language has a word for this kind of skin condition, consider using it here. If not, use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [a raised spot of skin] or [a place that is swollen]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 13:2 (#4)

סַפַּ֖חַת

“a scab”

This **scab** refers to a discolored, hard, crusty portion of skin that forms over an opening in the skin during healing. In some instances, it can be the symptom of an infectious skin disease. If your language has a word for this kind of skin condition, consider using it here. If not, use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [a dry, rough crust]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 13:2 (#5)

לְנֶ֣גַע צָרָ֑עַת

“an infection of skin disease”

The expression **an infection of skin disease** uses the possessive form to describe a contagious skin disease that is characterized by the presence of certain symptoms—in this case, a visible infection. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [a likely symptom of a contagious skin condition]

See: Possession

Leviticus 13:2 (#6)

צָרָ֑עַת

“skin disease”

The phrase **skin disease** may be commonly translated as “leprosy,” but, in terms of modern medicine, the phrase actually covers a large range of contagious skin diseases not limited to the modern designation of Hansen’s disease, better known as leprosy. If your language has a word or expression that describes a wide range of infectious and sometimes deadly skin diseases, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [a contagious disease that affects people’s skin]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 13:2 (#7)

וְהוּבָ֗א אֶל־אַהֲרֹן֙ הַכֹּהֵ֔ן

“then he shall be brought to Aaron the priest”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [then someone shall bring him to Aaron the priest]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 13:2 (#1)

אָדָ֡ם כִּֽי־יִהְיֶ֣ה

“A man, when he has”

To help explain how to apply this law, the author of Leviticus uses the expression **A man, when he has** to introduce an imaginary situation. Use a natural method in your language for introducing an imaginary situation. Alternate translation: [If some man has]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Leviticus 13:3 (#1)

וְשֵׂעָ֣ר בַּנֶּ֔גַע הָפַ֖ךְ ׀ לָלָ֑בָן

“and {if} the hair on the infection has turned white”

The expression implies that the presence of **hair** on **the infection** that is **white** in color should indicate to the priest that the infection might be the symptom of an infectious skin disease. Specifically, **white** hair refers to hair that is discolored and unhealthy in

appearance. If your language refers to unhealthy or diseased hair with a specific color, consider using that color here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [and if the hair on the infection looks diseased]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 13:4 (#2)

וְהִסְגִּיר הַכֹּהֵן אֶת־הַנֶּגַע

“then the priest shall separate the infection”

This expression implies the existence of a process of quarantining the person who has the infection for a period of time. This allows the infection to either heal itself or progress in a way that develops symptoms more easily identifiable as an infectious skin disease while preventing spread of the disease to others. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [then, in order to better determine what is the cause of the infection, the priest shall isolate the infection]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 13:4 (#3)

אֶת־הַנֶּגַע

“the infection”

Here, the expression **the infection** represents the whole person who has the infection. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the infected person] or [the person who has the infection]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 13:4 (#1)

וְעָמֹק אֵין־מַרְאֶהָ מִן־הָעוֹר

“and deep is not the appearance of it from the skin”

Alternate translation: [and it does not look as though it is beneath the skin] or [and it does not appear to be under the skin]

Leviticus 13:5 (#1)

בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי׃

“on the seventh day”

The word **seventh** is the ordinal form of the number seven. Alternate translation: [on the last day of that weeklong period]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Leviticus 13:5 (#2)

וְהִנֵּה הַנֶּגַע עָמַד

“and behold, the infection stands”

Here, **the infection stands** is an idiom that refers to the infection remaining as it was before the seven-day quarantine, not having spread or grown on the person’s skin. If your language has a similar expression, consider using it here. If, alternatively, this expression does not have this meaning in your language, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [and look, the infection has remained as it was] or [and look, the infection is unchanged]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 13:5 (#3)

בְּעֵינָיו

“in his eyes”

Here, **eyes** represent the sight of a person and, by extension, their judgment or assessment. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in his assessment] or [as far as he can determine]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 13:5 (#4)

שִׁבְעַת יָמִים שֵׁנִית

“for} a second seven days”

This expression refers to a second seven-day period during which the person with the infection is to be quarantined from other people. The word **second** is the ordinal form of the number two. If your language does not use ordinal numbers, you could use a cardinal number here or an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [for another seven days]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Leviticus 13:6 (#1)

בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי שֵׁנִית׃

“on the second seventh day”

The word **seventh** is the ordinal form of the number seven, and **second** is the ordinal form of the number two. Alternate translation: [on the last day of the additional week-long period]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Leviticus 13:6 (#2)

וְהִנֵּה֙ כֵּהָ֣ה הַנֶּ֔גַע

“and behold, the infection has faded”

For the infection to have **faded** implies that it has reduced in size and become dimmer in color. If this meaning would not be clear to your readers, consider stating the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and indeed, the infection has reduced in size and the color of the infection is closer to the person’s normal skin color]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 13:6 (#3)

וְכִבֶּ֥בֶס בְּגָדָ֖יו וְטָהֵֽר

“and he shall wash his clothes, and he will be clean”

Here, a person is to wash his or her clothes to become religiously and ceremonially clean, not in order to be physically clean. If your language has a special word that refers to washing clothing for a religious (and not hygienic) purpose, consider using it here. If not, use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [and he shall clean his clothing, and he will be ritually clean]

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 13:7 (#1)

וְאִם־פָּשֹׂ֤ה תִפְשֶׂה֙ הַמִּסְפַּחַ֔תֶ בָּעֹ֑ור

“But if, spreading, the scab spreads on the skin”

This expression repeats the verb **spread** in order to intensify the idea that it expresses. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [But if the scab spreads to a larger area on the skin]

See: Reduplication

Leviticus 13:7 (#2)

וְאִם־פָּשֹׂ֤ה

“But if, spreading”

The author of Leviticus uses the expression **But if** to introduce an imaginary situation to help explain what could happen. Use a natural method in your language for introducing an imaginary situation. Alternate translation: [But supposing that, spreading]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Leviticus 13:7 (#3)

שֵׁנִֽית

“a second {time”

The word **second** is the ordinal form of the number two. Alternate translation: [again]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Leviticus 13:9 (#1)

בְּאָדָ֖ם

“on a man”

Although the term **man** is masculine, it is being used the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [on a person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Leviticus 13:9 (#2)

וְהוּבָ֖א אֶל־הַכֹּהֵֽן

“then he shall be brought to the priest”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [then someone must bring him to the priest]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 13:10 (#2)

וּמִחְיַ֥ת בָּשָׂ֖ר חַ֣י בַּשְּׂאֵֽת

“and a preservation of living flesh {is} on the swelling”

Alternate translation: [and raw skin is on the swelling]

Leviticus 13:10 (#1)

וְהָֽהָפְכָ֥ה שֵׂעָ֛ר לָבָ֖ן

“and it has turned the hair white”

The expression implies that the presence of **hair** on the **swelling** that is **white** in color should indicate to the priest that the swelling might be the symptom of an infectious skin disease. Specifically, **white** hair refers to hair that is discolored and unhealthy. If your language refers to unhealthy or diseased hair with a specific color, consider using that color here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [and if the hair on the swelling is unhealthy and looks diseased]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 13:11 (#1)

לֹ֣א יַסְגִּרֶ֔נּוּ כִּֽי־טָמֵ֥א הֽוּא

“He shall not separate him, because he {is} unclean”

See verse 45 and following for what additional actions the priest was to take.

Leviticus 13:12 (#3)

מֵרֹאשׁ֖וֹ וְעַד־רַגְלָ֑יו

“from his head and to his feet”

The expression refers to all of the person by naming the parts that are at the extreme ends of it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the entire person]

See: Merism

Leviticus 13:12 (#2)

אֵ֚ת כָּל־עֹ֣ור הַנֶּ֔גַע

“all the skin of the infection”

Here, **the infection** represents the whole person who has the infection. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all the skin of the infected person] or [all the skin of the person with the infection]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 13:12 (#1)

וְאִם־פָּרֹ֤וחַ תִּפְרַח֙ הַצָּרַ֣עַת בָּעֹ֔ור

“But if, breaking out, the skin disease breaks out on the skin”

The author repeats the verb **breaking out** in order to intensify the idea that it expresses. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [But if the skin disease breaks out aggressively on the skin]

See: Reduplication

Leviticus 13:12 (#4)

לְכָל־מַרְאֵ֖ה עֵינֵ֥י הַכֹּהֵֽן

“to the whole vision of the eyes of the priest”

Here, **eyes** represent the sight of a person and, by extension, their judgment or assessment. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the whole appearance, as far as the priest can see] or [the whole appearance, as the priest judges]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 13:13 (#1)

וְטִהַ֥ר אֶת־הַנֶּ֖גַע

“Then he shall pronounce the infection clean”

Here, the expression **the infection** represents the whole person who has the infection. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Then he shall pronounce the infected person clean]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 13:13 (#2)

כֻּלֹּ֥ו הָפַ֖ךְ לָבָ֑ן

“All of it has turned white”

Alternate translation: [All of the person’s infected skin has naturally fallen off, leaving uninfected, white skin in its place]

Leviticus 13:14 (#1)

וּבְיֹ֗ום הֵרָאֹ֛ות בֹּ֥ו בָּשָׂ֖ר חָ֑י

“And on the day of the appearing of living flesh on him”

Alternate translation: [But if ever living flesh appears on him]

Leviticus 13:15 (#1)

הַבָּשָׂ֥ר הַחַ֖י טָמֵ֣א הֽוּא

“The living flesh, it {is} unclean”

Here, the expression **the living flesh** represents the whole person who has raw skin or an open sore. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The person with the raw skin or open sore is unclean]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 13:16 (#1)

וְנָהְפַ֥ךְ לְלָבָ֖ן

“and it is turned to white”

Here, **turned to white** implies that if the priest sees **white** skin all over the person’s body, then the **living flesh**, that is, the raw skin, may be healing naturally. The infected skin may be falling off naturally, leaving white, new skin in its place. If this meaning would not be clear in your language, it may be helpful to clarify it for your readers in a footnote or in the text of your translation. See how you handled the presence of **white** skin in 13:13.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 13:18 (#1)

שְׁחִין

“a boil”

A **boil** is a painful, discolored, swollen area on the skin that contains infection. In some instances, it can be the symptom of an infectious skin disease. If your language has a word for this kind of skin condition, consider using it here. If not, use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [an abscess]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 13:18 (#2)

וְנִרְפָּא

“and it has been healed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and it returned to good health]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 13:19 (#2)

וְנִרְאָה אֶל־הַכֹּהֵן

“then he shall show himself to the priest”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [then he shall show it to the priest]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 13:19 (#1)

בִּמְקֹ֣ום הַשְּׁחִ֔ין

“in the place of the boil”

Here Leviticus is using the possessive form to describe a **place** that is characterized by the **boil**. The expression **the place of the boil** refers to the spot on the skin where the boil was previously. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [where the boil had been] or [where the boil was previously located]

See: Possession

Leviticus 13:20 (#2)

נֶגַע־צָרַעַת הִוא בַּשְּׁחִין פָּרָחָה

“It {is} an infection of skin disease; it has broken out in the boil”

This expression refers to the instruction that after the priest observes the symptoms, the priest should pronounce the person unclean. Do not imply that the disease is the result of the priest’s pronouncement. Rather, the disease is the reason, and the pronouncement is the result. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a result of what came before. Alternate translation: [The symptoms indicate that it is an infection of skin disease that has broken out in the boil]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 13:20 (#1)

וּשְׂעָרָה הָפַךְ לָבָן

“and its hair has turned white”

Alternate translation: [and if the hair on the swelling or the bright spot is unhealthy and looks diseased]

Leviticus 13:21 (#2)

וּשְׁפָלָה אֵינֶנָּה מִן־הָעֹור

“and lower it is not than the skin”

Alternate translation: [and it is not deeper than the surface of the skin]

Leviticus 13:21 (#1)

וְאִם ׀ יִרְאֶ֣נָּה הַכֹּהֵ֗ן

“And if the priest sees it”

Here, **it** refers to the white swelling or bright spot on the skin. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And if the priest sees the bright spot or the swelling]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 13:22 (#1)

וְאִם־פָּשֹׂה תִפְשֶׂה בָּעֹור

“But if, spreading, it spreads on the skin”

This expression repeats the verb **spread** in order to intensify the idea that it expresses. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [But if it spreads aggressively on the skin]

See: Reduplication

Leviticus 13:23 (#1)

וְאִם־תַּחְתֶּיהָ תַּעֲמֹד הַבַּהֶרֶת

“But if the bright spot stands under it”

Here, **stands under it** is an idiom that refers to the **bright spot** remaining unchanged in the place on the person’s skin where the **boil** once was. If your language has a similar expression, consider using it here. If, alternatively, the meaning of this expression would not be clear to your readers, consider stating the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [But if the bright spot remains unchanged in the place where the boil once was]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 13:23 (#3)

צָרֶבֶת הַשְּׁחִין הִוא

“it {is} the scar of the boil”

Alternate translation: [it is only a scar that has resulted from the healed boil]

Leviticus 13:23 (#2)

וְאִם־תַּחְתֶּיהָ תַּעֲמֹד הַבַּהֶרֶת

“But if the bright spot stands under it”

Here, **it** refers to the **boil** that has healed, as described in 13:18. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [But if the bright spot stands under the place of the boil that has now healed]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 13:24 (#1)

אוֹ בָשָׂר כִּי־יִהְיֶה בְעֹרוֹ מִכְוַת־אֵשׁ

“Or flesh, when it has a burn of fire on his skin”

Alternate translation: [Or when someone has a burn of fire on his skin]

Leviticus 13:24 (#3)

מִחְיַת הַמִּכְוָה

“the preservation of the burn”

Alternate translation: [the new skin on the burn site]

Leviticus 13:24 (#2)

מִכְוַת־אֵשׁ

“a burn of fire”

This expression uses the possessive form to describe a **burn** that has resulted from a person’s contact with **fire**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [a burn]

See: Possession

Leviticus 13:25 (#1)

וְהִנֵּה נֶהְפַּךְ שֵׂעָר לָבָן

“and behold, the hair has been turned white”

Alternate translation: [and look, the hair appears to be unhealthy and diseased]

Leviticus 13:25 (#2)

וּמַרְאֶהָ עָמֹק מִן־הָעוֹר

“and the appearance of it {is} deeper than the skin”

Alternate translation: [and it appears to be deeper than the skin]

Leviticus 13:25 (#3)

צָרַעַת הִוא & נֶגַע צָרַעַת הִוא

“it {is} a skin disease & It {is} an infection of skin disease”

Alternate translation: [The discolored raw skin is actually a symptom of an infectious skin disease]

Leviticus 13:26 (#2)

וּשְׂפָלָה אֵינֶנָּה מִן־הָעוֹר

“and deeper it is not than the skin”

Alternate translation: [and it is not deeper than the skin]

Leviticus 13:26 (#1)

וְאִם ׀ יִרְאֶנָּה הַכֹּהֵן

“But if the priest sees it”

Here, **it** refers to the raw skin that grows on the burn on the person's skin. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [But if the priest sees the discolored, raw skin growing on the burn]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 13:26 (#3)

וְהִנֵּה֙ כֵּהָ֔ה

"but it {is} faded"

Alternate translation: [but it has reduced in size and its color is closer to the person's normal skin color]

Leviticus 13:27 (#2)

אִם־פָּשֹׂ֥ה תִפְשֶׂ֖ה בָּעוֹר

"If, spreading, it has spread on the skin"

This expression repeats the verb **spread** in order to intensify the idea that it expresses. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [If it has spread aggressively on the skin]

See: Reduplication

Leviticus 13:27 (#1)

בַּיּ֣וֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִ֔י

"on the seventh day"

The word **seventh** is the ordinal form of the number seven. Alternate translation: [on the last day of that week-long period]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Leviticus 13:28 (#2)

שְׁאֵ֣את הַמִּכְוָ֔ה הִ֖וא

"it {is} the swelling of the burn"

Alternate translation: [the bright spot is merely a swelling caused by the burn]

Leviticus 13:28 (#3)

כִּֽי־צָרֶ֥בֶת הַמִּכְוָ֖ה הִֽוא

"because it {is} the scar of the burn"

The word translated as **because** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation, with a period before: [The priest should pronounce the person clean because it is the scar of the burn]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 13:28 (#1)

וְאִם־תַּחְתֶּ֥יהָ תַעֲמֹ֖ד הַבַּהֶ֑רֶת

"But if the bright spot stands under it"

Here, **stands under it** is an idiom that refers to the **bright spot** remaining unchanged in the place on the person's skin where the burn once was. If your language has a similar expression, consider using it here. If, alternatively, the meaning of this expression would not be clear to your readers, consider stating the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [But if the bright spot remains unchanged in the spot where the burn once was]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 13:29 (#1)

וְאִישׁ֩ אֹ֨ו אִשָּׁ֜ה כִּֽי־יִהְיֶ֤ה בְבֹו֙ נֶ֔גַע

"And a man or a woman, when he has an infection on him"

Alternate translation: [And when a man or a woman has an infection]

Leviticus 13:29 (#2)

כִּֽי־יִהְיֶ֤ה בְבֹו֙ נֶ֔גַע

"when he has an infection on him"

Although the words **he** and **him** are masculine, they are being used in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [when any person has an infection on him]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Leviticus 13:29 (#3)

אֹ֥ו בְּזָקָֽן

"or in a beard"

Here, **a beard** represents the lower portion of a man's face where hair typically grows. But since the verse explicitly includes men and women, this word should not be limited to refer only to men's faces. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [or on the lower part of the face where hair might grow]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 13:30 (#3)

נֶתֶק הוּא

“It {is} a scall”

A **scall** is a scaly and scabby infection that is typically itchy. These are associated with the scalp or places that grow hair and are generally symptoms of a wide variety of infectious skin diseases. If your language has a word for this kind of skin condition, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [It is an itchy, scabbed infection]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 13:30 (#1)

וְהִנֵּה מַרְאֵהוּ עָמֹק מִן־הָעוֹר

“And behold, the appearance of it {is} deeper than the skin”

Alternate translation: [And look, it appears to be deeper than the skin of his flesh]

Leviticus 13:30 (#2)

וּבוֹ שֵׂעָר צָהֹב דָּק

“and on it {is} yellow, thin hair”

Alternate translation: [and the hair on the infection looks unhealthy and diseased]

Leviticus 13:30 (#4)

צָרַעַת הָרֹאשׁ אוֹ הַזָּקָן הִוא

“It {is} a skin disease of the head or the beard”

This expression uses the possessive form to describe a **skin disease** that is characterized by its location on the person’s **head** or **beard**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [It is a skin disease that has affected the head or the beard]

See: Possession

Leviticus 13:30 (#5)

הַזָּקָן

“the beard”

As in the previous verse, here, **the beard** represents the lower portion of the face where hair typically grows. Since the verse explicitly includes men and women, this word should not be limited to men. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the lower part of the face where hair might grow]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 13:31 (#1)

אֶת־נֶגַע הַנֶּתֶק & אֶת־נֶגַע הַנֶּתֶק

“the infection of the scall & the infection of the scall”

These expressions use the possessive form to describe an **infection** that is characterized by its characteristics that qualify it as a **scall** If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [the itchy, scabby infection ... the itchy, scabby infection]

See: Possession

Leviticus 13:31 (#2)

וְשֵׂעָר שָׁחֹר אֵין בּוֹ

“and there is no black hair on it”

Here, **black hair** implies healthy hair, as opposed to the yellow, thin hair that grows out of the **scall**. If your language refers to healthy hair with a specific color, consider using that color here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [and there is no healthy hair on it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 13:31 (#3)

אֶת־נֶגַע הַנֶּתֶק

“the infection of the scall”

Here, the expression **the infection of the scall** represents the person who has the infection. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the person who has the infection of the scall]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 13:32 (#2)

וּמַרְאֵה הַנֶּתֶק אֵין עָמֹק מִן־הָעוֹר

“and the appearance of the scall is not deeper than the skin”

Alternate translation: [and it does not look as though it is deeper than the skin]

Leviticus 13:32 (#1)

בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי

“on the seventh day”

The word **seventh** is the ordinal form of the number seven. Alternate translation: [on the last day of that week-long period]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Leviticus 13:33 (#1)

וְאֶת־הַנֶּתֶק לֹא יְגַלֶּחַ

“but the scall shall not be shaved”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [but he shall not shave the scall]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 13:33 (#2)

אֶת־הַנֶּתֶק

“the scall”

Here, **the scall** represents the person who has the infection. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the person who has the scall]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 13:33 (#3)

שִׁבְעַת יָמִים שֵׁנִית

“for} a second seven days”

The word **second** is the ordinal form of the number two. Alternate translation: [for seven days once again]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Leviticus 13:34 (#2)

וּמַרְאֵהוּ אֵינֶנּוּ עָמֹק מִן־הָעוֹר

“and the appearance of it is not deeper than the skin”

Alternate translation: [and it does not look as though it is deeper than the skin]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 13:34 (#3)

וְכִבֶּס בְּגָדָיו

“And he shall wash his clothes”

As the Introduction to this chapter discusses, a person was to wash his or her clothes not only to be physically clean but also as to become religiously and ceremonially clean. If your language has a special word that refers to washing clothing for a religious (and not hygienic) purpose, consider using it here. If not, use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [and he shall clean his clothing with water]

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 13:34 (#1)

בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי

“on the seventh day”

The word **seventh** is the ordinal form of the number seven. Alternate translation: [on the last day of that week-long period]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Leviticus 13:35 (#1)

וְאִם־פָּשֹׂה יִפְשֶׂה הַנֶּתֶק בָּעוֹר

“But if, spreading, the scall has spread on the skin”

This expression repeats the verb **spread** in order to intensify the idea that it expresses. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [But if the scall has spread aggressively on the skin]

See: Reduplication

Leviticus 13:37 (#2)

עָמַד הַנֶּתֶק

“the scall stands”

The **scall stands** is an idiom that refers to the **scall** remaining unchanged (as opposed to spreading aggressively). If your language has a similar expression, consider using it here. If, alternatively, the meaning of this expression would not be clear to your readers, consider stating the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the scall has not changed or spread at all] or [the scall has remained as it was]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 13:37 (#3)

וְשֵׂעָר שָׁחוֹר

“and black hair”

Alternate translation: [and healthy hair]

Leviticus 13:37 (#1)

בְּעֵינָיו

“in his eyes”

Here, **eyes** represent the sight of a person and, by extension, their judgment or assessment. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. See how you translated this expression in 13:5. Alternate translation: [in his assessment] or [in his best judgment]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 13:37 (#4)

נִרְפָּא הַנֶּגַע

“the scall has been healed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [then the scall has healed]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 13:38 (#1)

וְאִישׁ אוֹ־אִשָּׁה כִּי־יִהְיֶה בְעוֹר־בְּשָׂרָם בֶּהָרֹת

“And a man or a woman, when he has on the skin of their flesh bright spots”

Alternate translation: [And when a man or a woman has bright spots on the skin of his or her body]

Leviticus 13:40 (#1)

וְאִישׁ כִּכְי יִמָּרֵט רֹאשׁוֹ

“And a man, when his head is made bare”

The author of Leviticus uses the expression **And a man, when** to introduce an imaginary situation to help explain how to apply this law. Use a natural method in your language for introducing an imaginary situation. Alternate translation: [If some man loses the hair from the top of his head]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Leviticus 13:40 (#2)

כִּכְי יִמָּרֵט רֹאשׁוֹ

“when his head is made bare”

This expression is an idiom. It does not refer to shaving one’s head intentionally but to the natural process of male balding, specifically of balding on the back of one’s head (that is, on the crown of the head). If your language has a similar expression that refers generally to balding, consider using it here. If, alternatively, the meaning of this expression would not be clear to your readers, consider stating the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when he becomes bald naturally]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 13:40 (#3)

קֵרֵחַ הוּא

“he {is} bald”

Alternate translation: [he is losing the hair from the crown of his head in a natural way]

Leviticus 13:41 (#1)

יִמָּרֵט רֹאשׁוֹ

“his head is made bare”

Alternate translation: [he loses the hair of his head]

Leviticus 13:41 (#2)

מִפְּאַת פָּנָיו

“from the corners of his face”

The expression **the corners of his face** is an idiom that refers to one’s hairline on the front of their face. If your language has a similar expression, consider using it here. If, alternatively, the meaning of this expression would not be clear to your readers, consider stating the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [on the hairline of his forehead]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 13:43 (#1)

כְּמַרְאֵה צָרַעַת עוֹר בָּשָׂר

“like the appearance of the skin disease of the skin of the flesh”

Alternate translation: [like the appearance of a skin disease that presents itself on a person’s body]

Leviticus 13:44 (#1)

אִישׁ־צָרוּעַ הוּא

“He {is} a man of a skin disease”

The expression **man of skin disease** uses the possessive form to describe a man who has contracted this kind of infectious skin disease. If your language would

not use the possessive form for this, you could use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [The man has contracted a skin disease]

See: Possession

Leviticus 13:44 (#2)

טָמֵא֙ יְטַמְּאֶ֣נּוּ הַכֹּהֵ֔ן

“Being unclean, the priest shall pronounce him unclean”

This expression repeats the word **unclean** in order to intensify the idea that it expresses. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [The priest shall certainly pronounce him unclean]

See: Reduplication

Leviticus 13:44 (#3)

בְּרֹאשׁ֖וֹ נִגְעֽוֹ

“on his head of his infection”

This expression uses the possessive form to describe the person’s **head** that has contracted the **infection**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [because of his infected head]

See: Possession

Leviticus 13:45 (#2)

יִהְיוּ֙ פְּרֻמִ֔ים

“they shall be torn”

Here, **they** refers to the person’s infected clothes. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the person’s infected clothes shall be torn]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 13:45 (#4)

וְרֹאשׁ֖וֹ יִהְיֶ֣ה פָּרֻ֑ועַ

“and his head shall be unbound”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and he shall let his head be unbound] or [he shall unbind his head]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 13:45 (#7)

שָׂפָ֔ם

“the mustache”

Here, **the mustache** does not refer to a specific mustache but to the infected person’s facial hair. In this way, it represents the upper lip generally. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [any facial hair] or [any upper lip]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 13:45 (#1)

וְהַצָּרוּעַ֮ אֲשֶׁר־בּ֣וֹ הַנֶּ֣גַע בְּגָדָ֣יו

“But the person with a skin disease, who {has} on him the infection, on his clothes”

Alternate translation: [But the person who has a skin disease and the infection is on his clothes]

Leviticus 13:45 (#3)

יִהְיוּ֙ פְּרֻמִ֔ים

“they shall be torn”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [he must tear his clothes]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 13:45 (#5)

וְרֹאשׁ֖וֹ יִהְיֶ֣ה פָּרֻ֑ועַ

“and his head shall be unbound”

Here, **head** represents the hair of one’s head. Consequently, the expression **his head shall be unbound** refers to letting one’s long hair hang down loose and untied. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and his long hair shall hang down loose and untied]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 13:45 (#6)

וְעַל־שָׂפָ֖ם יַעְטֶ֑ה

“and he shall cover over the mustache”

Covering over one’s **mustache** is a symbolic action to show one’s public shame. If this would not be clear to your readers, you could explain the significance of this

action in the text or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [and he shall cover his mustache to express his shame]

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 13:46 (#1)

כָּל־יְמֵי֩ אֲשֶׁ֨ר הַנֶּ֜גַע בּ֗וֹ

“All the days that the infection {is} on him”

In these phrases, the author is using the term “days” to refer to a specific time, **the days that the infection is on him**. He is doing this by association with the way a lifetime is made up of individual days. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [During the time that he has the infection]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 13:46 (#2)

מִח֥וּץ לַֽמַּחֲנֶ֖ה

“shall be} outside the camp”

Alternate translation: [shall be away from the location where everyone else lives]

Leviticus 13:47 (#1)

וְהַבֶּ֖גֶד כִּֽי־יִהְיֶ֣ה בּ֑וֹ נֶ֥גַע צָרָ֖עַת

“But the clothing, when it has on it the infection of disease”

Alternate translation: [But when the clothing carries and spreads the disease]

Leviticus 13:47 (#3)

נֶ֥גַע צָרָ֖עַת

“the infection of disease”

Although this expression is the same as the one used previously for contagious aspects of infectious skin diseases, here the issue is with infections that can be spread on clothing and other household objects. Consequently, this expression likely refers to infectious molds or mildews. If your language has an expression that can describe both skin diseases and these kinds of molds and mildews, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [an infectious mold or mildew]

See: Possession

Leviticus 13:47 (#5)

בְּבֶ֥גֶד פִּשְׁתִּ֛ים

“on clothing of linen”

See how you translated this type of clothing in 6:10.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 13:47 (#2)

וְהַבֶּ֖גֶד

“But the clothing”

The expression **the clothing** refers to all clothing in general, not one piece of clothing in particular. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [But any piece of clothing]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 13:47 (#4)

בְּבֶ֥גֶד צֶ֖מֶר

“on clothing of wool”

This **wool** is the shorn hair of sheep, goats, or similar animals. Wool is used in the production of textiles for warm clothing and blankets. If your language has a word for this kind of material, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [on clothing of woolen fabric]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 13:48 (#1)

א֣וֹ בְשֶׁתִי֮ א֣וֹ בְעֵרֵב֒ לַפִּשְׁתִּ֣ים וְלַצֶּ֔מֶר

“or in the warp or in the woof of the linen or of the wool”

The words **warp** and **woof** refer to a structure used in weaving and the production of textiles. Specifically, **warp** refers to the threads that run vertically, or up and down, and **woof** (or weft) refers to the threads that run horizontally, or from side to side. If your language has an expression for this kind of weaving structure, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [or on linen or woolen threads that are being woven together on a loom]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 13:48 (#2)

לַפִּשְׁתִּ֣ים

“of the linen”

Here, **the linen** does not refer to a specific piece of fabric, but to any linen product generally. If it would

be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [of any linen that you are weaving]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 13:48 (#4)

בְּכָל־מְלֶאכֶת עֹור

“on any work of leather”

The expression **any work of leather** uses the possessive form to describe an object made of leather. This includes a large variety of items such as belts, bags, saddles, straps, etc. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [on anything that has been made of leather] or [on any piece of leatherwork]

See: Possession

Leviticus 13:48 (#3)

וְלַצֶּמֶר

“or of the wool”

Here, **the wool** does not refer to a specific piece of wool, but to any woolen product generally. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [of any wool that you are weaving]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 13:49 (#2)

נֶגַע צָרַעַת הוּא

“it {is} an infection of disease”

Alternate translation: [the infection on the material is actually an indication of infectious disease]

Leviticus 13:49 (#1)

כְּלִי־עֹור

“article of leather”

The expression **articles of leather** implies that something useful has been made from an animal hide or skin. It may refer to the same leatherwork that the previous verse called “any work of leather.” If this meaning would not be clear in your language, consider stating the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [useful things made of leather] or [leatherwork]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 13:49 (#3)

וְהֶרְאָה אֶת־הַכֹּהֵן

“And the priest shall be made to see {it”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And the owner of the fabric should show it to the priest]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 13:50 (#1)

אֶת־הַנֶּגַע

“the infection”

Here, the expression **the infection** represents the whole article of clothing, thread of fabric, or leatherwork that has mold or mildew on it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the infected item] or [the item with the infection on it]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 13:51 (#3)

צָרַעַת מַמְאֶרֶת הַנֶּגַע טָמֵא הוּא

“the infection {is} a malignant disease. It {is} unclean”

A **malignant disease** is a condition of health or wholeness which tends to lead to deterioration or death. It is a condition which causes injury and tends to spread. Because of its connection with death, any malignant disease would cause the bearer of that disease to be declared **unclean**. Alternate translation: [the infection will threaten the wellbeing of all who come in contact with it, so the material is judged to be unclean]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 13:51 (#2)

לְכֹל אֲשֶׁר־יֵעָשֶׂה הָעֹור לְמְלָאכָה

“of any equipment into which the leather was made”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [of anything that someone made of leather]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 13:51 (#1)

בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי

“on the seventh day”

The word **seventh** is the ordinal form of the number seven. Alternate translation: [on the last day of that week-long period]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Leviticus 13:52 (#1)

כִּי־צָרַעַת מַמְאֶרֶת הִוא

“because it {is} a malignant disease”

The word translated as **because** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [because the infection could spread and harm others]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 13:52 (#2)

בָּאֵשׁ תִּשָּׂרֵף

“It shall be burned with fire”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [He shall burn it with fire]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 13:52 (#3)

בָּאֵשׁ תִּשָּׂרֵף

“It shall be burned with fire”

This expression contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. See how you handled the similar expression in 7:17. Alternate translation: [It shall be completely burned]

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

Leviticus 13:54 (#2)

אֵת אֲשֶׁר־בּוֹ הַנָּגַע

“that which the infection {was} on it”

Alternate translation: [whichever item has the mold or mildew on it]

Leviticus 13:54 (#3)

שִׁבְעַת־יָמִים שֵׁנִית

“for} a second seven days”

The word **second** is the ordinal form of the number two. Alternate translation: [for seven days once again]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Leviticus 13:54 (#1)

וְצִוָּה הַכֹּהֵן

“then the priest shall command”

This expression leaves out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. Here, the **priest** is telling the people what to do with household items that were infected with mold or mildew. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [then the priest shall command the people what they must do]

See: Ellipsis

Leviticus 13:55 (#1)

אַחֲרֵי | הֻכַּבַּס אֶת־הַנָּגַע

“after the infection has been washed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [after the item’s owner has washed the infection]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 13:55 (#2)

וְהִנֵּה לֹא־הָפַךְ הַנֶּגַע אֶת־עֵינוֹ

“and behold, the infection has not turned its eye”

The expression **turned its eye** is an idiom that refers to the appearance of the infection changing. In other words, for an infection to have **turned its eye** is for that infection to have changed its appearance, likely by spreading or changing color. If your language has a similar expression, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [and note, the infection appears to be unchanged]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 13:55 (#5)

בָּאֵשׁ תִּשְׂרְפֶנּוּ

“You shall burn it with fire”

This expression contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. See how you handled the similar expression in 7:17. Alternate translation: [You must burn it completely]

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

Leviticus 13:55 (#6)

פְּחֶחָת הִוא

“It {is} a rot”

Alternate translation: [It is judged to be an infection and decaying mold or mildew]

Leviticus 13:55 (#3)

בָּאֵשׁ תִּשָּׂרֵפֶנּוּ

“You shall burn it with fire”

Here, **you** is singular. It refers to the owner of the infected item, so use the singular form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 13:55 (#4)

בָּאֵשׁ תִּשָּׂרֵפֶנּוּ

“You shall burn it with fire”

As the Introduction to this chapter discusses, here the author of Leviticus switches to a second-person address. If the sudden switch to the second person would not be natural in your language, consider continuing to use the third person in your translation. Alternate translation: [The owner of the item should burn it with fire]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Leviticus 13:56 (#1)

וְהִנֵּה֙ כֵּהָה֙ הַנֶּ֔גַע

“and behold, the infection has faded”

Alternate translation: [and look, the infection has reduced in size and the color of the infection is closer to the item’s normal color]

Leviticus 13:56 (#3)

וְקָרַע אֹתוֹ

“then he shall tear it”

Here, **it** refers to the portion of the item that has the infectious mold or mildew on it. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [then he shall tear the infected portion of the item]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 13:56 (#2)

אַחֲרֵי֙ הֻכַּבַּ֣ס אֹתָ֔וֹ

“after it was washed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [after the owner of the item washed it]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 13:57 (#5)

אֵ֚ת אֲשֶׁר־בּ֣וֹ הַנָּ֔גַע

“that which {has} the infection on it”

Alternate translation: [whichever item has the mold or mildew on it]

Leviticus 13:57 (#3)

בָּאֵשׁ תִּשָּׂרֵפֶנּוּ

“You shall burn it with fire”

Here, **You** is singular and refers to the owner of the infected item, so use the singular form in your translation if you choose to use the second person form and if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 13:57 (#4)

בָּאֵשׁ תִּשָּׂרֵפֶנּוּ

“You shall burn it with fire”

This expression contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. See how you handled the similar expression in 7:17. Alternate translation: [You should completely burn it]

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

Leviticus 13:57 (#1)

פֹּרַרַ֖ת הִוא֑

“it is breaking out”

Alternate translation: [it is a sign that the infectious mold or mildew has spread over the entire item such that it cannot be washed and made clean]

Leviticus 13:57 (#2)

בָּאֵ֖שׁ תִּשְׂרְפֶ֣נּוּ

“You shall burn it with fire”

As the Introduction to this chapter discusses, here the author of Leviticus switches to a second-person address. If the sudden switch to the second person would not be natural in your language, consider continuing to use the third person in your translation. Alternate translation: [The owner should burn it with fire]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Leviticus 13:58 (#1)

אֲשֶׁ֤ר תְּכַבֶּ֙ס֙

“that you washed”

As the Introduction to this chapter discusses, here the author of Leviticus switches to a second-person address. If the switch would not be natural in your language, consider continuing to use the third person in your translation. Alternate translation: [that the owner of the item has washed]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Leviticus 13:58 (#3)

וְסָ֥ר מֵהֶ֖ם הַנֶּ֑גַע

“and the infection turned aside from them”

This expression is an idiom. For the **infection** to have **turned aside from** the item means for it to have been removed through the process of washing. If your language has a similar expression, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [and the infection was successfully removed from them]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 13:58 (#2)

אֲשֶׁ֤ר תְּכַבֶּ֙ס֙

“that you washed”

Here, **you** is singular. It refers to the owner of the infected item, so use the singular form in your translation if you choose to use the second person form and if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 13:58 (#4)

שֵׁנִ֔ית

“a second {time”

The word **second** is the ordinal form of the number two. Alternate translation: [again]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Leviticus 13:59 (#1)

זֹ֣את תּוֹרַ֗ת נֶ֚גַע־צָרַ֣עַת

“This {is} the law of the infection of disease of”

This expression uses the possessive form to describe the **law** that is characterized by its referring to **the infection of disease** that might occur in a variety of textiles and materials. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [This is the law that has to do with the infection of disease] or [This is the law that pertains to the infection of disease]

See: Possession

Leviticus 13:59 (#3)

א֣וֹ הַשְּׁתִ֔י א֖וֹ הָעֵֽרֶב

“or warp or woof”

See how you translated these words in 13:48.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 13:59 (#4)

לְטַהֲרוֹ֙ א֣וֹ לְטַמְּא֔וֹ

“to pronounce it clean or to pronounce it unclean”

Here, **to** marks pronouncing the item to be clean or unclean as the goal or purpose of **the instruction**. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Leviticus 13:59 (#2)

נֶ֚גַע־צָרַ֣עַת בֶּ֔גֶד הַצֶּ֖מֶר ׀ א֣וֹ הַפִּשְׁתִּ֑ים א֣וֹ הַשְּׁתִ֔י א֖וֹ הָעֵֽרֶב א֥וֹ כָל־כְּלִי־עֹ֖ור

“the infection of disease of clothing of wool or linen or warp or woof or any article of leather”

This expression uses a prolonged possessive form to describe an **infection** that is actually the symptom of an infectious **disease** that can occur on a variety of textiles and household materials. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [an infection that is the symptom of an infectious disease that might occur on clothing of wool or linen or on the warp or woof or on any article of leather]

See: Possession

Leviticus - Chapter 14 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter is a continuation of the material in the previous chapter.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Skin disease and mildew

This chapter addresses the ways a priest was to decide if a person had a skin disease which would make a person unclean. This was important because these diseases could have easily spread by contact among the people in the ancient Near East. This was also true for the things which could have touched a person's skin. This chapter explains how the priest was to treat the person suffering with a skin disease. (See: priest, priesthood)

Leviticus 14:1 (#1)

לֵאמֹֽר

"saying"

The word translated as **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, consider ways in which you might introduce this quotation naturally in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Leviticus 14:2 (#3)

וְהוּבָ֖א אֶל־הַכֹּהֵֽן

"And he shall be brought to the priest"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And someone should bring him to the priest] or [He must go to the priest]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 14:2 (#1)

תּוֹרַ֣ת הַמְּצֹרָ֑ע

"the law of the person with a skin disease"

This expression uses the possessive form to describe the **law** that is characterized by its referring to the process of cleansing for any **person with a skin disease** who has been pronounced clean by the priest. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [This is the law for a person who previously had a skin disease] or [This is the law that pertains to the person who previously had a skin disease]

See: Possession

Leviticus 14:2 (#2)

בְּי֖וֹם טָהֳרָתֽוֹ

"on the day of his cleansing"

Here, the expression **on the day of his cleansing** is uses the possessive form to describe a **day** that is characterized by **his cleansing**. This expression refers to the **day** on which the priest declares the person to be ritually clean. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could state the meaning generically. Alternate translation: [on the day on which he is to be made clean]

See: Possession

Leviticus 14:3 (#1)

וְהִנֵּ֣ה נִרְפָּ֔א נֶ֖גַע־הַצָּרַ֥עַת מִן־הַצָּרֽוּעַ

"And behold, the infection of the skin disease was healed from the person with the skin disease"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And behold, the infection of the skin disease has completely healed from the person with the skin disease]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 14:3 (#2)

נֶ֖גַע־הַצָּרַ֥עַת

"the infection of the skin disease"

See how you translated these words in 13:2.

See: Possession

Leviticus 14:4 (#1)

וְצִוָּה֙ הַכֹּהֵ֔ן

"Then the priest shall command"

This expression leaves out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. Here, the **priest** is telling the infected person how to prepare for his cleansing. You could supply words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And the priest shall command the people what they must do]

See: Ellipsis

Leviticus 14:4 (#3)

לַמִּטַּהֵֽר

“for the person who is being cleansed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [for the person whom the priest is cleansing]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 14:4 (#4)

וּשְׁנִ֥י תוֹלַ֖עַת

“and scarlet of worm”

By using the expression **scarlet of worm**, the author is referring to fabric or twine by association with its color. The dye for this scarlet color was likely the byproduct of crushing the eggs of a certain insect, here referred to as a **worm**. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers, either in a footnote or in the text of your translation. Alternate translation: [and thread that has been naturally dyed bright red]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 14:4 (#2)

וְלָקַ֣ח לַמִּטַּהֵ֔ר

“and he shall take for the person who is being cleansed”

This expression contains the context of what the priest is commanding. Here, **he** refers to anyone in general. Alternate translation: [and someone shall take for the one being cleansed]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 14:4 (#5)

וְאֵזֹ֖ב

“and hyssop”

This **hyssop** was a leafy plant, an herb that was common in Israel. Its large and numerous leaves made it ideal for use in sprinkling, especially in ceremonial or ritual contexts, as described in the present chapter. If your language does not have a word for this plant, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [and some leafy branches]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 14:5 (#2)

וְשָׁחַ֛ט אֶת־הַצִּפּ֥וֹר הָאֶחָ֖ת

“and he shall slaughter one bird”

Here, **he** refers to the person who is to be cleansed. This expression contains the context of what the priest is commanding. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and the person who is to be cleansed shall slaughter one bird]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 14:5 (#1)

וְצִוָּ֤ה הַכֹּהֵן֙

“And the priest shall command”

This expression again omits out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. Here, the **priest** is telling the infected person how to proceed with the ritual cleansing. You could supply some words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And the priest shall command the person what he must do]

See: Ellipsis

Leviticus 14:5 (#3)

כְּלִי־חֶ֖רֶשׂ

“a container of clay”

The expression **container of clay** refers to a vessel made from **clay** or earthenware, likely resembling modern kitchen pots or perhaps clay pots that could hold water. If your language has a specific word for a pot made from this material, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [a clay vessel]

See: Possession

Leviticus 14:5 (#4)

חֶ֖רֶשׂ

“clay”

The **container** is described as being made of **clay**, which refers to a material similar to earthenware, out of which a pot-shaped vessel could be shaped. Then it could be baked in a kiln until hardened. If your language has a specific word for this material, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [earthenware]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 14:5 (#5)

מַ֖יִם חַיִּ֑ים

“living water”

Here, **living water** is an idiom that refers to flowing **water**. The water in the container of clay needed to be taken from a flowing source such as a river or a well rather than from a cistern. If your language has a similar expression, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [freshwater taken from a flowing source]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 14:7 (#3)

עַל־פְּנֵ֥י הַשָּׂדֶ֖ה

“over the face of the field”

Here, the expression **the face of the field** refers to an open field. If your language has a similar expression, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [toward an open field]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 14:7 (#1)

וְהִזָּ֡ה עַל֩ הַמִּטַּהֵ֨ר מִן־הַצָּרַ֜עַת שֶׁ֣בַע פְּעָמִ֗ים

“And he shall sprinkle on the person who is being cleansed from the skin disease seven times”

This is a ritual action by which cedar wood, hyssop, and a living bird are used to sprinkle the person with the **skin disease** with both blood and clean water. This action ritually purifies and cleanses the individual from any impurity that they acquired through their skin disease. It may be helpful to explain this to your readers in a footnote or in the text of your translation. See how you handled the idea of ritual sprinkling in 1:5 and elsewhere.

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 14:7 (#4)

הַשָּׂדֶ֖ה

“the field”

Here, the expression **the field** does not refer to a specific field but to any field near the place where the Israelites are living. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [any nearby field]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 14:7 (#2)

עַ֚ל הַמִּטַּהֵ֔ר מִן־הַצָּרַ֖עַת

“on the person who is being cleansed from the skin disease”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [on the person he is cleansing]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 14:8 (#1)

וְכִבֶּ֣סׄ הַמִּטַּהֵ֗ר אֶת־בְּגָדָ֤יו וְגִלַּח֙ אֶת־כָּל־שְׂעָר֔וֹ וְרָחַ֥ץ בַּמַּ֖יִם

“And the person who is being cleansed shall wash his clothes, and he shall shave all his hair, and he shall bathe in the water”

These are ritual actions designed to show the people and the individual who is being cleansed that he is now ritually and ceremonially clean. If your language has expressions for these kinds of ritual actions, especially in religious contexts, consider using them here. If not, consider explaining the significance of these actions in a footnote or in the text of your translation.

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 14:8 (#2)

הַמִּטַּהֵֽר

“the person who is being cleansed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the person whom the priest is cleansing]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 14:8 (#3)

וְרָחַ֥ץ בַּמַּ֖יִם

“and he shall bathe in the water”

It might seem that the expression **and he shall bathe in the water** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in your language. If so, you could use an equivalent expression. See how you translated this expression in 1:9. Alternate translation: [And he shall wash his body thoroughly]

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

Leviticus 14:9 (#2)

יְגַלַּח אֶת־כָּל־שְׂעָרוֹ אֶת־רֹאשׁוֹ וְאֶת־זְקָנוֹ וְאֵת גַּבֹּת עֵינָיו וְאֶת־כָּל־שְׂעָרוֹ יְגַלֵּחַ

“he shall shave all his hair. His head and his beard and the brows of his eyes, and all his hair he shall shave”

These expressions mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word that shows that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [he shall shave all his hair, including his head and his beard and the brows of his eyes—all his hair]

See: Parallelism

Leviticus 14:9 (#1)

בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי

“on the seventh day”

The word **seventh** is the ordinal form of the number seven. If your language does not use ordinal numbers, you could use a cardinal number here or an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [on the last day of that week-long period]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Leviticus 14:9 (#3)

וְרָחַץ אֶת־בְּשָׂרוֹ בַּמָּיִם

“and he shall bathe his flesh in the water”

See how you translated this expression in the previous verse and in 1:9.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

Leviticus 14:9 (#4)

אֶת־בְּשָׂרוֹ

“his flesh”

Alternate translation: [his whole body]

Leviticus 14:10 (#1)

וּבַיּוֹם הַשְּׁמִינִי

“And on the eighth day”

The word **eighth** is the ordinal form of the number eight. If your language does not use ordinal numbers, you could use a cardinal number here or an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [And on the next day]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Leviticus 14:10 (#4)

וּשְׁלֹשָׁה עֶשְׂרֹנִים סֹלֶת

“and three tenth parts of flour”

Although the measurement is not explicitly listed here, the **flour** is likely to be measured in ephahs. One ephah was about 23 liters, so **three tenth parts** of an ephah would amount to almost seven liters of flour. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the equivalent modern measurement in your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [and about seven liters of flour]

See: Biblical Volume

Leviticus 14:10 (#2)

יִקַּח

“he shall take”

Alternate translation: [the person who is being cleansed shall take]

Leviticus 14:10 (#3)

וְכַבְשָׂה אַחַת בַּת־שְׁנָתָהּ תְּמִימָה

“and one {female} lamb, a perfect daughter of her year”

The expression **a daughter of her year** is an idiom that refers to an animal that is a year old. If your language has a similar idiom, consider using it here. If not, state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar expression in 9:3. Alternate translation: [and an unblemished female lamb that is a year old] or [and a perfect female lamb that is twelve months of age]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 14:10 (#5)

וּשְׁלֹשָׁה עֶשְׂרֹנִים

“and three tenth parts of”

The word **tenth** means one part out of ten equal parts, so **three tenth parts** would equal three parts out of ten parts. Alternate translation: [and about seven quarts of]

See: Fractions

Leviticus 14:10 (#6)

מִנְחָתוֹ בְּלוּלָה בַשָּׁמֶן

“a grain offering mixed with oil”

Alternate translation: [an offering of grain to which oil has been mixed in]

Leviticus 14:10 (#7)

וְלֹג אֶחָד שָׁמֶן

“and one log of oil”

One **log** was about half of a liter. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the equivalent modern measurement in your translation or a footnote. Alternate translation: [and one half of a liter of oil]

See: Biblical Volume

Leviticus 14:11 (#3)

אֵת הָאִישׁ הַמִּטַּהֵר

“the man, the one being cleansed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the person whom the priest is cleansing]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 14:11 (#5)

לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated this expression in 1:9. Alternate translation: [in Yahweh’s presence in the sacred precincts of the tent of meeting, where Yahweh lives among the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 14:11 (#4)

וְאֹתָם

“and them”

Here, **them** refers to the three lambs, the flour, and the oil that, in the previous verse, the individual was told to bring. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and the three lambs, the flour, and the oil that he has brought]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 14:11 (#1)

וְהֶעֱמִיד הַכֹּהֵן הַמְטַהֵר אֵת הָאִישׁ הַמִּטַּהֵר וְאֹתָם

“And the priest, the one pronouncing clean, shall make the man, the one being cleansed, and them stand”

This expression implies positioning the man and his sacrificial items in such a way that they face the inner tent of the tent of meeting, in which the Holy of Holies was housed. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And the priest, the one pronouncing clean, shall position the man, the person being cleansed, and the sacrifice he offers, in such a way that they stand]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 14:11 (#2)

אֵת הָאִישׁ הַמִּטַּהֵר

“the man, the one being cleansed”

Even though the word **man** is masculine, it is being used in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [the person who is being cleansed]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Leviticus 14:12 (#5)

תְּנוּפָה

“as} a raised offering”

See how you translated this sacrifice in 7:30.

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 14:12 (#1)

וְהִקְרִיב אֹתָם

“and he shall present it”

See how you handled this ritual action in 1:2.

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 14:12 (#3)

וְאֶת־לֹג הַשָּׁמֶן

“and the log of oil”

One **log** was about one-sixth of a liter (or 0.167 liters). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the equivalent modern measurement in your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [and the one-sixth of a liter of oil]

See: Biblical Volume

Leviticus 14:12 (#4)

וְהֵנִיף אֹתָם תְּנוּפָה לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“And he shall raise them {as} a raised offering to the face of Yahweh”

It is highly unlikely that the living **lamb** was physically waved in Yahweh’s presence before it was killed. Instead, this expression may refer to some physical motion to show that the lamb (and the oil) were the kind of sacrifice that qualified as a **wave offering**. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers in a footnote or in the text of your translation. Alternate translation: [And he shall present them as a wave offering to the face of Yahweh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 14:12 (#2)

לְאָשָׁם

“as a guilt offering”

See the discussion about the guilt offering in the Introduction to Chapter 5. See how you translated this sacrifice in 5:16.

Leviticus 14:13 (#2)

בְּבִמְקוֹם אֲשֶׁר יִשְׁחַט אֶת־הַחַטָּאת וְאֶת־הָעֹלָה

“in the place where one slaughters the sin offering and the burnt offering”

Here, the author of Leviticus uses the present tense to describe a habitual action, something that is done regularly. Also, **he** here refers to anyone who does this action. Alternate translation: [in the same place where sin offerings and burnt offerings are slaughtered] or [in the same place where they slaughter sin offerings and burnt offerings]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Leviticus 14:13 (#4)

כְּקֹדֶשׁ קָדָשִׁים הוּא

“It {is} a holy thing of holy things”

See how you handled the similar expression in 2:3.

See: Possession

Leviticus 14:13 (#1)

וְשָׁחַט אֶת־הַכֶּבֶשׂ

“And he shall slaughter the lamb”

Here, **he** refers either to: (1) the priest, who was the subject in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [And the priest shall slaughter the lamb] or (2) the person who is to be cleansed. Alternate translation: [And the person who is to be cleansed shall slaughter the lamb]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 14:13 (#3)

כִּי כַּחַטָּאת הָאָשָׁם

“for the guilt offering {is} like the sin offering”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation, with a period before: [This is because the guilt offering is like the sin offering]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 14:14 (#2)

הַמִּטַּהֵר

“the person who is being cleansed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the person whom the priest is cleansing]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 14:14 (#3)

וְנָתַן הַכֹּהֵן

“and the priest shall put {it”

See how you handled this idiom in 1:7. Alternate translation: [and the priest should spread some of the blood of the sacrificed animal]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 14:14 (#1)

וְנָתַן הַכֹּהֵן עַל־תְּנוּךְ אֹזֶן הַמִּטַּהֵר הַיְמָנִית וְעַל־בֹּהֶן יָדוֹ הַיְמָנִית וְעַל־בֹּהֶן רַגְלוֹ הַיְמָנִית

“and the priest shall put {it} on the lobe of the right ear of the person who is being cleansed and on the thumb of his right hand and on the big toe of his right foot”

See how you translated the similar ritual action in 8:23–24.

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 14:17 (#2)

הַמִּטַּהֵרֹ

“the person being cleansed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the person whom the priest is cleansing]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 14:17 (#1)

וּמִיֶּתֶר הַשֶּׁמֶן אֲשֶׁר עַל־כַּפּוֹ יִתֵּן הַכֹּהֵן עַל־תְּנוּךְ אֹזֶן הַמִּטַּהֵרֹ הַיְמָנִית וְעַל־בֹּהֶן יָדוֹ הַיְמָנִית וְעַל־בֹּהֶן רַגְלוֹ הַיְמָנִית עַל דַּם הָאָשָׁם

“And the priest shall put some of the remainder of the oil that {is} on his palm on the lobe of the right ear of the person being cleansed and on the thumb of his right hand and on the big toe of his right foot, on the blood of the guilt offering”

See how you translated the similar ritual action in 8:23–24.

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 14:18 (#2)

וְכִפֶּר עָלָיו הַכֹּהֵן לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“And the priest shall make atonement for him to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated the abstract noun **atonement** in 1:4. However, here and throughout this chapter, make sure that your translation makes it clear that the person is not being atoned for because of any sin on his or her part. In this case, **atonement** removes impurity that is not caused by sin, but by infection and uncleanness. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers in a footnote or in the text of your translation.

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 14:18 (#1)

עַל־רֹאשׁ הַמִּטַּהֵר

“on the head of the person being cleansed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [on the head of the person whom the priest is cleansing]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 14:19 (#1)

הַמִּטַּהֵר

“the person being cleansed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the person whom the priest is cleansing]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 14:19 (#2)

מִטֻּמְאָתוֹ

“from his uncleanness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **uncleanness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [from that which has made him unclean]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 14:20 (#1)

וְהֶעֱלָה הַכֹּהֵן אֶת־הָעֹלָה וְאֶת־הַמִּנְחָה הַמִּזְבֵּחָה

“And the priest shall make the burnt offering and the grain offering go up on the altar”

The expression **go up on the altar** is an idiom. It depicts the act of burning the **burnt offering** and the **grain offering** on the altar as converting the offering into smoke that goes **up** from the altar to God in heaven. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And the priest shall burn the burnt offering and the grain offering on the altar in such a way that they go up to Yahweh in smoke]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 14:21 (#1)

וְאֵין יָדוֹ מַשֶּׂגֶת

“and his hand is not reaching”

The expression **his hand is not reaching** is an idiom that refers to being unable to afford to provide or purchase the three lambs required for the ritual cleansing. If your language has a similar idiomatic expression, consider using it here. Otherwise, if it would be helpful in your language, consider stating the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar expression in 5:11. Alternate translation: [and he cannot afford to offer the three lambs]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 14:21 (#3)

וְעִשָּׂרוֹן סֹלֶת אֶחָד

“and one tenth of flour”

The word “tenth” means one part out of ten equal parts, so **one tenth** would equal one part out of ten parts. Alternate translation: [and about two quarts of fine flour]

See: Fractions

Leviticus 14:21 (#4)

וְעִשָּׂרוֹן סֹלֶת אֶחָד

“and one tenth of flour”

Although it is not explicit, it is likely that **one tenth** refers to a tenth of an ephah of flour. See how you translated this measurement in 14:10.

See: Biblical Volume

Leviticus 14:21 (#5)

וְלֹג שָׁמֶן

“and a log of oil”

See how you translated this measurement in 14:10.

See: Biblical Volume

Leviticus 14:21 (#2)

לְהִנּוֹפֵף כַּפֵּר עָלָיו

“to raise, to make atonement for him”

Here, **to** marks waving and making **atonement** as the goal or purpose of bringing the **lamb**, **flour**, and birds to the priest. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Leviticus 14:22 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר תַּשִּׂיג יָדוֹ

“that his hand reaches”

This expression is an idiom that refers to being able to afford to purchase an animal. In other words, that which **his hand reaches** refers to whatever bird the individual is able to afford. If your language has a similar idiomatic expression, consider using it here. Otherwise, if it would be helpful in your language, consider stating the meaning plainly. See the discussion of Sacrifices for the poor in the Introduction to Chapter 5 and see how you translated the similar expression in 5:7 and 5:11. Alternate translation: [that he can afford]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 14:22 (#1)

בְּנֵי יוֹנָה

“sons of a pigeon”

See how you translated this expression in 1:14.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 14:23 (#5)

לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated this expression in 1:3–5.

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 14:23 (#1)

וְהֵבִיא אֹתָם בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁמִינִי

“And on the eighth day, he shall bring them”

Here, **he** refers to the person who is to be cleansed, and **them** refers to the lamb, portions of flour, and birds that the ritual cleansing requires. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And on the eighth day, the person who is to be cleansed should bring the lamb, portions of flour, oil, and the birds]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 14:23 (#3)

לְטָהֳרָתוֹ

“for his cleansing”

Here, **for** marks **cleansing** as the goal or purpose of bringing all of the required items and animals. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Leviticus 14:23 (#4)

אֶל־הַכֹּהֵן אֶל־פֶּתַח אֹהֶל־מוֹעֵד לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“to the priest, to the entrance of the tent of meeting, to the face of Yahweh”

These three phrases mean basically the same thing. The second and third emphasize the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could

connect the phrases with a word that shows that the second and third phrases are repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [to the priest who is at the entrance of the tent of meeting, that is, to the face of Yahweh]

See: Parallelism

Leviticus 14:23 (#2)

בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁמִינִי

“on the eighth day”

The word **eighth** is the ordinal form of the number eight. If your language does not use ordinal numbers, you could use a cardinal number here or an equivalent expression. The **eighth day** refers to the day after the week-long period of purification mentioned in 14:8 during with the person dwells outside of the camp. If this would not be clear to your readers, consider stating the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [on the day after the week-long period during which he lived outside of the camp]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Leviticus 14:24 (#1)

אֶת־כֶּבֶשׂ הָאָשָׁם

“the lamb of the guilt offering”

This expression uses the possessive form to describe a **lamb** that is characterized by the fact that it has been selected to become a **guilt offering**. If your language would not use the possessive form to express this, use a construction that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the lamb which someone has selected to offer as a guilt offering]

See: Possession

Leviticus 14:24 (#2)

וְהֵנִיף אֹתָם הַכֹּהֵן תְּנוּפָה לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“And the priest shall raise them {as} a raised offering to the face of Yahweh”

Again, it is highly unlikely that the living **lamb of the guilt offering** was physically waved in Yahweh’s presence. Instead, this expression may refer to making some physical motion that would show that it (along with the measure of oil) was the kind of sacrifice that qualified as a wave offering. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers in a footnote or in the text of your translation. Alternate translation: [And the priest shall present them as a wave offering to the face of Yahweh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 14:25 (#3)

הַמִּטַּהֵר

“the person being cleansed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the person whom the priest is cleansing]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 14:25 (#1)

וְשָׁחַט אֶת־כֶּבֶשׂ הָאָשָׁם

“And he shall slaughter the lamb of the guilt offering”

Here, **he** refers to the person who is to be cleansed. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the person who is to be cleansed shall slaughter the lamb of the guilt offering]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 14:25 (#2)

וְנָתַן עַל־תְּנוּךְ אֹזֶן־הַמִּטַּהֵר הַיְמָנִית וְעַל־בֹּהֶן יָדוֹ הַיְמָנִית וְעַל־בֹּהֶן רַגְלוֹ הַיְמָנִית

“and he shall put {it} on the lobe of the right ear of the person being cleansed and on the thumb of his right hand and on the big toe of his right foot”

See how you translated the similar ritual action in 8:23–24.

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 14:27 (#1)

לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated this expression in 1:9.

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 14:28 (#1)

הַמִּטַּהֵר

“the person being cleansed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the person whom the priest is cleansing]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 14:29 (#1)

לְכַפֵּ֥ר עָלָ֖יו

“to make atonement for him”

Here, **to** marks making **atonement** as the goal or purpose of putting the **oil** on the head of **the person being cleansed**. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Leviticus 14:29 (#2)

לִפְנֵ֥י יְהוָֽה

“to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated this expression in 1:9.

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 14:31 (#3)

לִפְנֵ֥י יְהוָֽה

“to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated this expression in 1:3–5.

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 14:31 (#1)

אֵ֚את אֲשֶׁר־תַּשִּׂ֣יג יָדֹ֔ו

“whatever his hand reaches”

Alternate translation: [whatever he can afford]

Leviticus 14:31 (#2)

הַמִּטַּהֵֽר

“the person being cleansed”

Alternate translation: [the person whom the priest is cleansing]

Leviticus 14:32 (#1)

זֹ֣את תּוֹרַ֔ת אֲשֶׁר־בּ֖וֹ נֶ֣גַע צָרָ֑עַת

“This {is} the law of whoever {has} on him an infection of skin disease”

This expression uses the possessive form to describe the **law** that is characterized by referring to any person who has **an infection of a skin disease** and who cannot afford the three lambs normally required for the ritual cleansing. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [This is the law for whoever has an infection of a skin disease] or [This is the law that pertains to whoever has an infection of a skin disease]

See: Possession

Leviticus 14:32 (#2)

נֶ֣גַע צָרָ֑עַת

“an infection of skin disease”

See how you translated these words in 13:2.

See: Possession

Leviticus 14:32 (#4)

אֲשֶׁ֥ר לֹא־תַשִּׂ֖יג יָדֹ֥ו בְּטָהֳרָתֹֽו

“whose hand does not reach his cleansing”

Like the similar expression in 5:7, the phrase **whose his hand does not reach** is an idiom that refers to someone being unable to afford to purchase the usual animal for the sacrifice. If your language has a similar idiomatic expression, consider using it here. Otherwise, if it would be helpful in your language, consider stating the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who is unable to afford the usual sacrifice required for cleansing]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 14:32 (#6)

בְּטָהֳרָתֹֽו

“his cleansing”

Alternate translation: [the means by which he can become clean] or [the means by which he can be cleansed]

Leviticus 14:32 (#3)

אֲשֶׁ֥ר לֹא־תַשִּׂ֖יג יָדֹ֥ו בְּטָהֳרָתֹֽו

“whose hand does not reach his cleansing”

This expression **whose hand does not reach his cleansing** is an idiom that refers to being unable to afford to purchase the three lambs required for the ritual cleansing. If your language has a similar idiomatic expression, consider using it here. Otherwise, if it would be helpful in your language, consider stating the meaning plainly. See the discussion of Sacrifices for the poor in the Introduction to Chapter 5 and see how you translated the similar expression in 5:11. Alternate translation: [who cannot afford the three lambs required for his cleansing]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 14:32 (#5)

אֲשֶׁ֥ר לֹא־תַשִּׂ֛יג יָדֹ֖ו בְּטָהֳרָתֹֽו

“whose hand does not reach his cleansing”

The clause **whose hand does not reach his cleansing** does not describe every person who has a skin disease. It describes only those who are not able to afford the usual offering of three lambs. Alternate translation: [who is not able to provide the required offering for cleansing]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

Leviticus 14:34 (#1)

תָּבֹ֔אוּ & לָכֶ֖ם & אֲחֻזַּתְכֶֽם

“you enter & to you & your possession”

Here, **you** and **your** are plural. They refer to the people of Israel, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 14:34 (#2)

נֶ֣גַע צָרַ֑עַת

“an infection of a disease”

Here, the expression **an infection of a disease**, while the same expression that was used above for infectious skin diseases, likely refers to an infectious household mold or fungus. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers in a footnote or in the text of your translation. Alternate translation: [an infection of mold or mildew]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 14:34 (#3)

נֶ֣גַע צָרַ֑עַת

“an infection of a disease”

This expression uses the possessive form to describe an **infection** that is characterized by the fact that it is the symptom of a **disease**, likely referring to a mold or mildew. If your language would not use the possessive form to express this, use a construction that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [an infectious disease] or [an infectious mold or mildew]

See: Possession

Leviticus 14:34 (#4)

בְּבֵ֖ית אֶ֥רֶץ אֲחֻזַּתְכֶֽם

“in a house of the land of your possession”

This expression uses the possessive form to describe a **house** that is in the **land** that the Israelites will come to possess, that is, the land of Canaan. If your language would not use the possessive form to express this, use a construction that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [in a house that is in the land that you will possess]

See: Possession

Leviticus 14:34 (#5)

אֶ֥רֶץ אֲחֻזַּתְכֶֽם

“the land of your possession”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **possession**, you can express the same idea with a verbal form. Alternate translation: [in the land that you will possess]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 14:35 (#1)

וּבָ֣א אֲשֶׁר־לֹ֔ו הַבָּ֖יִת

“then he who the house {is} to him shall come”

Alternate translation: [then he who owns the house shall come]

Leviticus 14:35 (#2)

וְהִגִּ֥יד לַכֹּהֵ֖ן לֵאמֹ֑ר כְּנֶ֣גַע נִרְאָ֤ה לִי֙ בַּבָּ֔יִת

“and he shall inform the priest, saying, ‘{Something} like an infection has appeared to me in the house”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [and he shall inform the priest that something like an infection has appeared to him in the house]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Leviticus 14:36 (#1)

וְצִוָּ֣ה הַכֹּהֵ֔ן

“The priest shall command”

This expression leaves out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. Here, the **priest** is telling the people what to do about the house that is infected with mold or mildew. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language.

Alternate translation: [The priest shall command the people what they must do]

See: Ellipsis

Leviticus 14:36 (#3)

וּפִנּוּ אֶת־הַבַּיִת

“and they shall empty the house”

Here, **they** refers to the residents of the house. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and the people in the house shall open the house]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 14:36 (#2)

וּפִנּוּ אֶת־הַבַּיִת בְּטֶרֶם יָבֹא הַכֹּהֵן לִרְאֹות אֶת־הַנֶּגַע וְלֹא יִטְמָא כָּל־אֲשֶׁר בַּבָּיִת

“and they shall empty the house before the priest comes to see the infection, and everything that {is} in the house will not be pronounced unclean”

The implication is that unless the owners and residents of the house totally empty the house in preparation for the priest to arrive to inspect the household mold, the priest will declare the house and everything (and, likely, everyone) in it to be unclean. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers in a footnote or in the text of your translation. Alternate translation: [and they shall prepare the house by opening windows and emptying the house of its contents before the priest comes to inspect regarding the infection. If they do not do this, the priest will declare everything that is in the house to be unclean]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 14:36 (#4)

וְלֹא יִטְמָא כָּל־אֲשֶׁר בַּבָּיִת

“and everything that {is} in the house will not be pronounced unclean”

Once the priest declared **the house** to be unclean, everything in the house became **unclean** too. If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [so that the priest does not need to declare the things and people in the house to be unclean]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 14:37 (#2)

וּמַרְאֵיהֶנָּן שָׁפָל מִן־הַקִּיר

“and their appearance {is} deeper than the wall”

The expression **their appearance is deeper than the wall** implies that the priest is to determine whether mold or mildew has gone **deeper** into the construction material than just the surface of the wall. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and they look as though they are deeper than the surface of the wall]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 14:37 (#1)

שְׁקַעֲרוּרֹת יְרַקְרַקֹּת אוֹ אֲדַמְדַּמֹּת

“{is} greenish or reddish eruptions”

The word **eruptions** likely refers to spots on the wall where the mold or mildew has aggressively spread and changed colors. If your language has a word for this kind of spreading mold or mildew, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [is spots of mold or mildew that are green or red in color]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 14:38 (#1)

וְהִסְגִּיר אֶת־הַבַּיִת שִׁבְעַת יָמִים

“and he shall shut up the house {for} seven days”

As was the case with the person who had the potential symptom of an infectious skin disease, this expression refers to quarantining the house for a period of time in order to allow the mold to naturally progress and for a diagnosis to be more easily made in one direction or another. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and he shall shut up the house for seven days so that no one can come in or out]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 14:39 (#1)

בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי

“on the seventh day”

The word **seventh** is the ordinal form of the number seven. If your language does not use ordinal numbers, you could use a cardinal number here or an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [on the last day of that week-long period]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Leviticus 14:40 (#5)

לָעִֽיר

“of the city”

Here, **the city** does not refer to a specific city but to any city in which an Israelite may someday live. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [of any city in which you will someday live]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 14:40 (#2)

וְחִלְּצוּ֙ & וְהִשְׁלִ֔יכוּ

“and they shall pull out & and they shall cast”

Here, **they** refers to the residents or owners of the house. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the residents of the house shall pull out ... and they shall cast]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 14:40 (#3)

אֶל־מִחֻ֥ץ לָעִ֖יר אֶל־מָקֹ֥ום טָמֵֽא

“to {a place} on the outside of the city, to an unclean place”

Alternate translation: [to the unclean place on the outside of the city where people dispose of unclean things]

Leviticus 14:40 (#4)

אֶל־מִחֻ֥ץ לָעִ֖יר

“to {a place} on the outside of the city”

Here, and as 14:34 also suggests, the inclusion of the word **city** implies that Yahweh is speaking of a future time when the people of Israel will be living in cities rather than in the wilderness, as they were when Yahweh spoke these words to Moses. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers in a footnote or in the text of your translation. Alternate translation: [to a place on the outside of the city in which you will one day live]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 14:40 (#1)

וְצִוָּה֙ הַכֹּהֵ֔ן

“And the priest shall command”

This expression leaves out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. Here, the **priest** is telling the people what to do with the house that is infected with mold or mildew. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And the priest shall command the people what they must do]

See: Ellipsis

Leviticus 14:41 (#2)

וְאֶת־הַבַּ֖יִת יַקְצִ֑עַ

“And he shall have the house scraped”

Here, **he** refers to the priest, although the priest is not the one who will scrape the house. The rest of the verse suggests that the residents of the house will scrape the walls. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the priest shall command that the owner must scrape the house]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 14:41 (#1)

וְאֶת־הַבַּ֖יִת יַקְצִ֣עַ מִבַּ֑יִת סָבִ֖יב

“And he shall have the house scraped, inside the house all around”

Alternate translation: [And he should scrape away and remove all the material which held the stones together to form the interior walls of his house]

Leviticus 14:41 (#3)

וְשָׁפְכ֗וּ אֶת־הֶֽעָפָר֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר הִקְצֹ֔וּ

“And they shall pour out the mortar that they scrape”

Here, **they** refers to the residents of the house. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the residents of the house shall pour out the plaster that they scrape off]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 14:41 (#4)

אֶת־הֶֽעָפָר֙

“the mortar”

This **mortar** likely refers to an earthen, plaster-like material that would be used to cover the walls of a house. If your language has a word for this kind of building material, consider using it here. If not,

consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [the wall plaster]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 14:42 (#1)

וְלָקְחוּ & וְהֵבִיאוּ

“And they shall take & and they shall bring {them”

Here, the pronoun **they** refers to the owner and residents of the house or someone they have hired. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the workers shall take ... and they shall bring them]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 14:42 (#2)

אֲבָנִים אֲחֵרוֹת וְהֵבִיאוּ & אַחֵר

“other stones and they shall bring {them & other {mortar”

Alternate translation: [new, clean stones ... fresh material for plastering,]

Leviticus 14:42 (#3)

וְהֵבִיאוּ אֶל־תַּתַּחַת הָאֲבָנִים

“and they shall bring {them} in the place of the stones”

Alternate translation: [and they shall insert them wherever the infected stones were removed from the wall]

Leviticus 14:44 (#1)

צָרַעַת מַמְאֶרֶת הִוא בַּבַּיִת

“it {is} a malignant infection in the house”

See how you translated the similar expression in 13:51. Alternate translation: [the infection is actually a sign that the house has an infectious and potentially deadly mold or mildew on it]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 14:45 (#1)

וְנָתַץ אֶת־הַבַּיִת

“Then he shall tear down the house”

Here, **he** refers either to: (1) the owner of the house. Alternate translation: [Then the owner of the house shall tear down the house] or (2) the priest. Alternate translation: [Then the priest shall tear down the house]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 14:45 (#2)

וְהוֹצִיא

“And he shall take {them} out”

Here, **them** refers to all the parts of the house that were previously mentioned in this verse, including the **stones**, **wood**, and **dirt** of the house. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And he shall take out the stones, wood, and dirt of the house]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 14:46 (#1)

וְהַבָּא אֶל־הַבַּיִת

“And the person entering into the house”

This expression represents any person who enters the house in general, not one particular individual. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [And any person who enters into the house]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 14:46 (#2)

כָּל־יְמֵי הִסְגִּיר אֹתָוֹ

“all of the days of {the priest’s} shutting it up”

Alternate translation: [during the time when the priest has shut up the house]

Leviticus 14:47 (#1)

וְהַשֹּׁכֵב בַּבַּיִת

“And the person dwelling in the house”

This expression represents any person who dwells in the quarantined house in general, not one particular individual. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [And any person who dwells in the house]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 14:47 (#2)

וְהָאֹכֵל בַּבַּיִת

“And the person eating in the house”

This expression represents any person who eats in the house in general, not one particular individual. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use

a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [And any person who eats in the house]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 14:48 (#2)

כִּֽי־נִרְפָּ֥א הַנָּ֖גַע

“because the infection was healed”

The word translated as **because** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation, with a period before: [The house should be pronounced clean. since the infection was healed]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 14:48 (#3)

נִרְפָּ֥א הַנָּ֖גַע

“the infection was healed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the owner has successfully removed the infection from the house]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 14:48 (#1)

וְאִם־בֹּ֣א יָבֹ֔א הַכֹּהֵ֖ן

“But if, coming, the priest comes”

This expression repeats the verb **coming** in order to intensify the idea that it expresses. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [But if the priest ever comes] or [But when the priest comes]

See: Reduplication

Leviticus 14:49 (#1)

וְלָקַ֗ח

“And he shall take”

Here, **he** refers to the priest. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the priest shall take]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 14:49 (#2)

וְעֵ֣ץ אֶ֔רֶז וּשְׁנִ֖י תוֹלַ֣עַת וְאֵזֹֽב

“and wood of cedar and scarlet of worm and hyssop”

See how you translated these words in 14:4.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 14:49 (#3)

לְחַטֵּ֖א אֶת־הַבָּֽיִת

“to cleanse the house”

Here, **to** marks cleansing **the house** as the goal or purpose of the priests’ using these items. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Leviticus 14:51 (#2)

בְּדַ֣ם ׀ הַצִּפֹּ֣ר הַשְּׁחוּטָ֗ה

“in the blood of the bird, the one that was slaughtered”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [in the blood of the bird that the owner of the house slaughtered]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 14:51 (#3)

וּבַמַּ֣יִם הַחַיִּ֔ים

“and in the living water”

See how you translated this expression in 14:5.

See: Idiom

Leviticus 14:51 (#1)

וְלָקַ֗ח

“And he shall take”

Here, **he** refers to the priest and not to the owner of the house that is being cleansed. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the priest shall take]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 14:52 (#1)

וּבַמַּ֣יִם הַחַיִּ֔ים

“and with the living water”

See how you translated this expression in 14:5.

See: Idiom

Leviticus 14:52 (#2)

וּבַצִּפֹּר הַחַיָּה וּבְעֵץ הָאֶרֶז וּבָאֵזֹב וּבִשְׁנִי הַתּוֹלָעַת

“and with the live bird and with the wood of cedar and with the hyssop and with the scarlet of worm”

See how you translated these words in 14:4.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 14:53 (#2)

אֶל־פְּנֵי הַשָּׂדֶה

“to the face of the field”

See how you translated the similar expression in 14:7.

See: Idiom

Leviticus 14:53 (#3)

וְכִפֶּר עַל־הַבַּיִת

“And he shall make atonement for the house”

See how you translated the abstract noun **atonement** in 1:4. Here, however, make sure your translation makes it clear that the house is not being atoned for because of any sin on the part of anyone who lived in it. In this case, **atonement** removes impurity that is not caused by sin but by infection and uncleanness. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers in a footnote or in the text of your translation.

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 14:53 (#1)

וְשִׁלַּח אֶת־הַצִּפֹּר הַחַיָּה

“And he shall send the live bird”

Here, **he** refers to the priest and not to the owner of the house that is being cleansed. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the priest shall send the live bird]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 14:54 (#2)

וְלַנָּתֶק

“and of the scall”

See how you translated this skin condition in 13:30.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 14:54 (#1)

זֹאת הַתּוֹרָה לְכֹל־נֶגַע הַצָּרַעַת

“This {is} the law of every infection of the skin disease”

This expression uses the possessive form to describe the **law** that is characterized by referring to the process of cleansing for any of the scenarios described in 14:54–57. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [This is the law that has to do with every infection of the skin disease] or [This is the law that pertains to every infection of the skin disease]

See: Possession

Leviticus 14:56 (#1)

וְלַשְּׂאֵת

“and of the swelling”

See how you translated this skin condition in 13:2.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 14:56 (#2)

וְלַסַּפַּחַת

“and of the rash”

See how you translated this skin condition in 13:6.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 14:57 (#4)

זֹאת תּוֹרַת הַצָּרָעַת

“This {is} the law of the skin disease”

This expression uses the possessive form to describe the **law** that is characterized by referring to the wide variety of skin diseases described in 14:54–57. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [This is the law that has to do with skin diseases] or [This is the law that pertains to skin diseases]

See: Possession

Leviticus 14:57 (#1)

לְהוֹרֹת

“in order to teach”

Here, the expression **in order to** marks teaching how to identify **uncleanness** and **cleanness** as the goal or

purpose of the **law**. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Leviticus 14:57 (#2)

בְּיוֹם הַטָּמֵא וּבְיוֹם הַטָּהֳרֹ

"on the day of uncleanness or on the day of cleanness"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the words **uncleanness** and **cleanness**, you can express the same idea with a verbal form. Alternate translation: [when a person is unclean or when a person is clean]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 14:57 (#3)

בְּיוֹם הַטָּמֵא וּבְיוֹם הַטָּהֳרֹ

"on the day of uncleanness or on the day of cleanness"

Here the term **day** refers to the time at which something might be considered to become unclean or clean. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [at the time when someone or something becomes unclean or becomes clean]

See: Idiom

Leviticus - Chapter 15 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter contains Yahweh's laws concerning bodily discharges that make a person unclean, as well as the process for their purification. The structure of this chapter is as follows:

1. Laws about male discharges (15:1–18)
2. Abnormal discharges (15:1–15)
3. Normal discharges (15:16–18)
4. Laws about female discharges (15:19–30)
5. Normal menstruation (15:19–24)
6. Abnormal bleeding (15:25–30)
7. Summary and purpose (15:31–33)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Bodily discharges

This chapter talks about different kinds of bodily fluids that made a person ritually unclean. When translating this chapter, remember that these conditions:

1. Were not considered sinful
2. Were natural body processes
3. Made people unclean because they were connected to life and death
4. Required cleansing rituals before people could worship again

Cleanliness and separation

The laws about bodily discharges had two main purposes:

1. To protect people's health by keeping them apart when diseases might spread
2. To keep Israel pure as Yahweh's special people

Atonement without sin

When translating about the offerings in this chapter:

1. Do not use words that suggest the person did something wrong
2. Make it clear these offerings were for becoming clean again, not for forgiveness
3. Use words that show this was about ritual purity, not moral purity

(See: atonement, atone, atoned)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Euphemisms and polite language

This chapter frequently uses the word "flesh" as a polite way to refer to sexual organs. Your language may have its own polite ways to refer to these body parts. You should use terms that your community would consider respectful and appropriate for public reading.

Repeated words and phrases

The chapter often repeats words like "flow" or "discharge" for emphasis (for example, "when a flow flows"). If your language uses different methods to show emphasis, you can use those instead. You may not need to repeat the exact words.

Possessive expressions

The text frequently uses possessive phrases like "days of her purification" or "bed of her menstruation." These describe things characterized by or associated with a condition. Your language might express these

relationships differently. For example, “days of her purification” could be “the days when she waits to be pure.”

Quotes within quotes
At the beginning of the chapter, there are several layers of quotations (God speaking to Moses, who speaks to the people). If it would be helpful in your language, you can break these into separate sentences or use your language’s way of showing different speakers.

Leviticus 15:1 (#1)

לֵאמֹֽר

“saying”

The word translated as **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, consider ways in which you might introduce this quotation naturally in your language. Alternate translation: [and he told them]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Leviticus 15:1–2 (#1)

לֵאמֹר: דַּבְּרוּ֩ אֶל־בְּנֵ֨י יִשְׂרָאֵ֜ל וַאֲמַרְתֶּ֣ם אֲלֵהֶ֗ם

“saying, “Speak to the sons of Israel, and you shall say to them”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation, with a period before: [He told Moses and Aaron to speak to the sons of Israel and to say to them]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Leviticus 15:2 (#3)

וַאֲמַרְתֶּ֣ם

“and you shall say”

The word **you** here is plural. The word refers to Moses and Aaron. Use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 15:2 (#5)

מִבְּשָׂרֹ֑ו

“from his flesh”

Here and throughout this chapter, the word **flesh** is a polite way of referring to a man’s genitals. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [from his sexual organ]

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 15:2 (#1)

דַּבְּרוּ֩ אֶל־בְּנֵ֨י יִשְׂרָאֵ֜ל וַאֲמַרְתֶּ֣ם אֲלֵהֶ֗ם

“Speak to the sons of Israel, and you shall say to them”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The repetition emphasizes that Moses and Aaron are to deliver the following speech to the people of Israel. If your language does not use repetition for emphasis, you could use a single phrase and convey the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [Make sure you say to the sons of Israel]

See: Parallelism

Leviticus 15:2 (#2)

בְּנֵ֨י יִשְׂרָאֵ֜ל

“the sons of Israel”

See how you translated this metaphor in 1:2.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 15:2 (#4)

אִ֣ישׁ אִ֣ישׁ

“A man, a man”

Words are being repeated for emphasis. Specifically, here **man** is repeated to refer to any male. If your language can repeat words in a similar way, consider doing so here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [Any man]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 15:3 (#1)

וְזֹ֣את תִּהְיֶ֤ה טֻמְאָתֹו֙ & טֻמְאָתֹ֔ו הֽוּא

“And this is his uncleanness & it {is} his uncleanness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **uncleanness**, you can express the same idea with a verbal form. Alternate translation: [This is what makes him unclean ... it makes him unclean]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 15:3 (#3)

אֽוֹ־הֶחְתִּ֥ים בְּשָׂרֹ֖ו מִזּוֹבֹ֑ו

“or his flesh blocks his flow”

Alternate translation: [or the discharge is stopped up in the man’s flesh]

Leviticus 15:3 (#2)

רָרָר בְּשָׂרוֹ אֶת־זוֹבֹו

“whether} his flesh secretes his flow”

Alternate translation: [whether the discharge drips from his flesh]

Leviticus 15:4 (#1)

הַזָּב

“the {one} flowing”

Alternate translation: [the man with the flux] or [the man with the flow]

Leviticus 15:5 (#1)

וְאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר יִגַּע בְּמִשְׁכָּבוֹ יְכַבֵּס בְּגָדָיו

“And a man who touches his bed shall wash his clothes”

See how you handled this ritual action in 14:8.

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 15:5 (#2)

וְאִישׁ

“And a man”

Although the word **man** is masculine, here is it being used in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [And any person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Leviticus 15:5 (#3)

וְרָחַץ בַּמַּיִם

“And he shall bathe with water”

It might seem that the expression **he shall bathe with water** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in your language. If so, you could use an equivalent expression. See how you translated this expression in 1:9. Alternate translation: [And he shall wash thoroughly]

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

Leviticus 15:6 (#1)

וְהַיֹּשֵׁב עַל־הַכְּלִי

“And the person who sits on the furniture”

This expression represents any person who **sits** on any **furniture** on which the man with the discharge has sat, not one particular individual. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [And any person who sits on the furniture]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 15:6 (#2)

וְרָחַץ בַּמַּיִם

“and he shall bathe with water”

See how you translated this expression in 1:9.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

Leviticus 15:7 (#1)

וְהַנֹּגֵעַ בִּבְשַׂר הַזָּב

“And the person who touches the flesh of the {one} flowing”

Here, **flesh** likely does not represent the genitals specifically, but the body of the person with the discharge as a whole. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And the person who touches any part of the body of the flowing man]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 15:7 (#2)

וְהַנֹּגֵעַ בִּבְשַׂר

“And the person who touches the flesh of”

This expression represents any person who **touches** the **flesh** of the man with the discharge, not one particular individual. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [And any person who touches the flesh]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 15:7 (#3)

וְרָחַץ בַּמַּיִם

“And he shall bathe with water”

See how you translated this expression in 1:9.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

Leviticus 15:8 (#1)

וְרָחַץ בַּמַּיִם

“and he shall bathe with water”

See how you translated this expression in 1:9.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

Leviticus 15:9 (#1)

וְכָל־הַמֶּרְכָּב אֲשֶׁר יִרְכַּב עָלָיו הַזָּב

“And any means of riding on which the flowing {man} rides”

Words are being repeated for emphasis. Specifically, the expression **means of riding** translates a noun that is related to the verb **rides**. If your language can repeat words in a similar way, consider doing so here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [And any chariot or riding seat on which the man with the flux has ridden]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 15:9 (#2)

וְכָל־הַמֶּרְכָּב

“And any means of riding”

The expression **any means of riding** would imply anything that is placed on the back of a horse or donkey on which a person would ride. This includes objects like saddles, clothes, blankets, and the like. It could also include a chariot or riding seat. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And anything that could be used to ride an animal or travel in a vehicle]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 15:10 (#2)

וְהַנּוֹשֵׂא אוֹתָם

“And the one who lifts them”

This expression represents any person who **lifts** anything on which the man with the discharge sat while riding; it does not refer to one particular individual. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [And whoever lifts them]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 15:10 (#1)

בְּכֹל אֲשֶׁר יִהְיֶה תַּחְתָּיו

“anything that was under him”

This expression refers to the “means of riding” that was described in the previous verse. So the word **him** in this expression refers to the man who has the discharge. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [anything that the man with the discharge sat upon to ride an animal or a vehicle]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 15:11 (#1)

וְכֹל אֲשֶׁר יִגַּע־בּוֹ הַזָּב

“And anyone whom the {one} flowing touches”

Alternate translation: [And whomever the person with the infected flow touches]

Leviticus 15:12 (#4)

וְכָל־כְּלִי־עֵץ יִשָּׁטֵף בַּמָּיִם

“and every vessel of wood shall be rinsed with water”

This expression contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. See how you handled the similar expression in 7:17. Alternate translation: [and whoever owns a vessel of wood shall rinse it thoroughly]

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

Leviticus 15:12 (#1)

וּכְלִי־חֶרֶשׂ אֲשֶׁר־יִגַּע־בּוֹ הַזָּב יִשָּׁבֵר

“And a vessel of clay that the {one} flowing touches shall be broken”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And whoever owns the vessel of clay that the flowing man touches shall break it]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 15:12 (#2)

וּכְלִי־חֶרֶשׂ

“And a vessel of clay”

The expression **vessel of clay** uses the possessive form to describe a container that is characterized by

being made of **clay**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use an adjective to show that one noun describes the other. Alternate translation: [And a clay container]

See: Possession

Leviticus 15:12 (#3)

וְכָל־כְּלִי־עֵ֗ץ יִשָּׁטֵ֥ף בַּמָּֽיִם

“and every vessel of wood shall be rinsed with water”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and someone must rinse every wooden container with water]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 15:12 (#5)

וְכָל־כְּלִי־עֵ֗ץ

“and every vessel of wood”

The expression **a vessel of wood** is likely an implement rather than a **container**. Additionally, the expression here refers to any wooden implement that **the {one} flowing touches**. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of tool, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [and every wooden implement that the man who has a flux touches]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 15:13 (#4)

בְּשָׂרֹ֑ו

“his flesh”

See how you handled this euphemism in 15:2.

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 15:13 (#3)

לְטָהֳרָתֹֽו

“for his cleansing”

Here, **for** marks **cleansing** as the goal or purpose of counting out **seven days**. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Leviticus 15:13 (#5)

בְּמַ֥יִם חַיִּ֖ים

“in living water”

See how you translated this idiom in 14:5.

See: Idiom

Leviticus 15:13 (#2)

וְסָ֥פַר לֹ֛ו שִׁבְעַ֥ת יָמִ֖ים

“then he shall count for himself seven days”

Alternate translation: [then he shall determine a seven-day period]

Leviticus 15:13 (#1)

וְכִֽי־יִטְהַ֥ר הַזָּ֖ב מִזּוֹבֹ֑ו

“And when the {one} flowing cleanses from his flow”

Alternate translation: [And when the man who was flowing recovers from his flow and is no longer infected]

Leviticus 15:14 (#1)

וּבַיּ֣וֹם הַשְּׁמִינִ֗י

“And on the eighth day”

The word **eighth** is the ordinal form of the number eight. If your language does not use ordinal numbers, you could use a cardinal number here or an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [And on the next day]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Leviticus 15:14 (#2)

שְׁנֵ֤י בְנֵי־יֹונָה֙

“two sons of a pigeon”

See how you translated this expression in 1:14.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 15:14 (#3)

לִפְנֵ֖י יְהוָֽה

“to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated this expression in 1:9.

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 15:15 (#1)

וְעָשָׂה אֹתָם֙ הַכֹּהֵ֔ן

“And the priest shall make them”

Alternate translation: [And the priest shall get them ready]

Leviticus 15:15 (#2)

וְעָשָׂה אֹתָם֙ הַכֹּהֵ֔ן

“And the priest shall make them”

Here, **them** refers to the two birds that are described in the previous verse. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the priest shall make ready the two birds]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 15:15 (#3)

וְכִפֶּ֥ר עָלָ֛יו הַכֹּהֵ֖ן

“And the priest shall make atonement for him”

See how you translated the abstract noun **atonement** in 1:4. However, here and throughout this chapter, make sure that your translation makes it clear that the man is not being atoned for because of any sin on his or her part. In this case, **atonement** removes impurity that is not caused by sin but by infection and uncleanness. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers in a footnote or in the text of your translation.

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 15:15 (#4)

לִפְנֵ֥י יְהוָ֖ה

“to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated this expression in 1:9.

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 15:16 (#2)

כִּֽי־תֵצֵ֥א מִמֶּ֖נּוּ שִׁכְבַת־זָ֑רַע

“when a lying of seed goes out from him”

Alternate translation: [when he experiences an ejaculation]

Leviticus 15:16 (#3)

אֶת־כָּל־בְּשָׂר֔וֹ

“all his flesh”

Whereas elsewhere, the word **flesh** usually refers specifically to a person’s genitals, here the expression **all his flesh** refers to a man’s entire body. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [his whole body]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 15:16 (#1)

וְאִ֣ישׁ כִּ֔י

“And a man, when”

See how you translated this expression in 13:2. See also the discussion of this phrase in the Introduction to Leviticus.

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Leviticus 15:17 (#1)

וְכֻבַּ֥ס בַּמַּ֖יִם

“and it shall be washed in water”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and the owner of the item shall wash it with water] or [and someone shall wash it with water]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 15:18 (#2)

שִׁכְבַת־זָ֑רַע

“a lying down of seed”

Alternate translation: [and the man ejaculates]

Leviticus 15:18 (#3)

וְרָחֲצ֥וּ בַמַּ֖יִם

“then they shall bathe with water”

See how you translated this expression in 1:9.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

Leviticus 15:18 (#1)

וְאִשָּׁ֕ה אֲשֶׁר֩ יִשְׁכַּ֨ב אִ֜ישׁ אֹתָ֗הּ

“And a woman, when a man lies with her”

This expression refers in a polite way to sexual relations between a man and a woman. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [And if a man and woman have sexual relations]

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 15:19 (#2)

שִׁבְעַ֣ת יָמִ֗ים תִּהְיֶ֙ה בְּנִדָּתָ֔הּ

“for} seven days, she will be in her menstruation”

This expression implies that when a woman begins menstruating, she will be considered unclean for seven days. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [she will be unclean because of her menstruation]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 15:19 (#3)

תִּהְיֶ֙ה בְּנִדָּתָ֔הּ

“she will be in her menstruation”

The word **menstruation** refers to the time when blood discharges from a woman’s uterine lining. If your readers would not be familiar with this term, you could use the term or euphemism used in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [she is in the way of women] or [it is her monthly period]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 15:19 (#1)

בִּבְשָׂרָ֖הּ

“in her flesh”

Here, the word **flesh** is a polite way of referring to a woman’s genitals. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [in her genitals]

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 15:23 (#1)

וְאִ֣ם עַל־הַמִּשְׁכָּ֗ב הֽוּא־אֹו֙ עַל־הַכְּלִ֣י אֲשֶׁר־הִ֔וא יֹשֶׁ֥בֶת־עָלָ֖יו

“But if it {is} on the bed or on furniture on which she is sitting”

Here, **it** refers to anything that might be placed on a **bed** or a piece of **furniture** on which the menstruating woman has sat or on which she has lain. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [But if an item should happen to be placed on the bed or on furniture on which she is sitting]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 15:24 (#2)

וְאִ֥ם שָׁכֹ֛בֹ יִשְׁכַּ֥ב אִ֖ישׁ אֹתָ֑הּ

“And if, lying, a man lies with her”

This expression repeats the verb **lying** in order to intensify the idea that it expresses. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [And certainly, if a man lies with her]

See: Reduplication

Leviticus 15:24 (#3)

וּתְהִ֥י נִדָּתָ֖הּ עָלָ֑יו

“and her menstruation is on him”

Here, the expression **her menstruation** represents a woman’s menstrual blood. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and her menstrual flow is on him]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 15:24 (#1)

וְאִ֥ם שָׁכֹ֛בֹ יִשְׁכַּ֥ב אִ֖ישׁ אֹתָ֑הּ

“And if, lying, a man lies with her”

This expression is a polite way to refer to sexual relations between a man and a woman while she is menstruating. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a polite reference to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [And if a man has sexual relations with her]

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 15:25 (#1)

כִּֽי־יָזוּב֩ זוֹב֙ דָּמָ֜הּ

“when a flow of her blood flows”

Words are being repeated for emphasis. Specifically, the word **flow** translates a noun that is related to the verb **flows**. If your language can repeat words in a similar way, consider doing so here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [when her blood certainly flows]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 15:25 (#2)

כִּֽי־תָזוֹב֙ עַל־נִדָּתָ֔הּ

“when she flows beyond her menstruation”

Alternate translation: [when she continues to bleed from her genitals longer than the expected length of time]

Leviticus 15:25 (#3)

כָּל־יְמֵ֣י זוֹב֮ טֻמְאָתָהּ֒

“all the days of the flow of her uncleanness”

Here, **days of the flow** uses the possessive form to describe **days** that are characterized by the presence of the woman’s unclean **flow**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [as long as she is bleeding and is unclean, it]

See: Possession

Leviticus 15:25 (#4)

כִּימֵ֣י נִדָּתָ֔הּ

“like the days of her menstruation”

This expression uses the possessive form to describe **days** that are characterized by the presence of the woman’s **menstruation**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [like the period when she normally menstruates]

See: Possession

Leviticus 15:26 (#4)

כְּטֻמְאַ֥ת נִדָּתָ֖הּ

“like the uncleanness of her menstruation”

This expression uses the possessive form to describe **uncleanness** that comes from the woman’s **menstruation**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [like the uncleanness that she acquires because of her menstruation]

See: Possession

Leviticus 15:26 (#3)

כְּמִשְׁכַּ֥ב נִדָּתָ֖הּ

“like the bed of her menstruation”

This expression uses the possessive form to describe a **bed** that is characterized by its use during the woman’s **menstruation**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [like the bed on which she lays when she is normally menstruating]

See: Possession

Leviticus 15:26 (#1)

כָּל־הַמִּשְׁכָּ֞ב אֲשֶׁר־תִּשְׁכַּ֣ב עָלָ֗יו כָּל־יְמֵי֙ זוֹבָ֔הּ כְּמִשְׁכַּ֥ב נִדָּתָ֖הּ יִהְיֶה־לָּ֑הּ

“Every bed on which she lies all the days of her flow shall be to her like the bed of her menstruation”

Alternate translation: [Every bed on which she lies all the days of her flow should be considered to be unclean, just like the bed of her menstruation]

Leviticus 15:26 (#2)

כָּל־יְמֵ֣י זוֹבָ֔הּ

“all the days of her flow”

This expression uses the possessive form to describe **days** that are characterized by the presence of the woman’s unclean **flow**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [when she is experiencing unusual genital bleeding]

See: Possession

Leviticus 15:28 (#2)

וְסָפְרָ֥ה לָ֖הּ שִׁבְעַ֣ת יָמִ֑ים

“then she shall count for herself seven days”

Alternate translation: [then she shall determine a seven-day period]

Leviticus 15:28 (#1)

וְאִם־טָהֲרָ֥ה מִזּוֹבָ֖הּ

“But if she becomes clean from her flow”

The author is presenting this as a hypothetical condition and describing what should happen if this condition, that **she becomes clean from her flow**, should occur. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a situation that could happen. Alternate translation: [Suppose the woman who was experiencing unusual genital bleeding becomes clean from the flow of her blood]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Leviticus 15:29 (#1)

וּבַיּ֣וֹם הַשְּׁמִינִ֗י

“And on the eighth day”

The word **eighth** is the ordinal form of the number eight. If your language does not use ordinal numbers,

you could use a cardinal number here or an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [And on the next day]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Leviticus 15:29 (#2)

בְּנֵי יוֹנָֽה

“sons of a pigeon”

See how you translated this expression in 1:14.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 15:30 (#1)

וְכִפֶּ֤ר עָלֶ֙יהָ֙ הַכֹּהֵ֔ן

“And the priest shall make atonement for her”

See how you handled the abstract noun **atonement** in 1:4. However, in your translation, be careful not to convey the idea that the woman has sinned and so is in need of atonement. Here, atonement removes from the woman the impurity that she acquired from the blood that she has bled. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers in a footnote or in the text of your translation. Alternate translation: [And the priest shall present these offerings for her purification]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 15:30 (#3)

מִזֹּ֖וב טֻמְאָתָֽהּ

“from the flow of her uncleanness”

Alternate translation: [from her flow of blood that made her unclean]

Leviticus 15:30 (#2)

לִפְנֵ֥י יְהוָ֖ה

“to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated this expression in 1:9.

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 15:31 (#1)

וְהִזַּרְתֶּ֣ם

“And you shall hold back”

Here, **you** is plural. It refers to Aaron and Moses, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 15:31 (#5)

אֶת־מִשְׁכָּנִ֖י אֲשֶׁ֣ר בְּתוֹכָֽם

“my Dwelling, which {is} in their midst”

Yahweh is not distinguishing this Dwelling in the midst of the Israelites from another Dwelling that in not in their midst. Yahweh is reminding them about the location of his Dwelling with them. Be sure that this is clear in your translation. Alternate translation: [my Dwelling. After all, it is in their midst]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

Leviticus 15:31 (#3)

מִטֻּמְאָתָ֑ם & בְּטֻמְאָתָ֥ם בְּטַמְּאָ֖ם

“from their uncleanness & by their uncleanness, by their defiling”

Words are being repeated for emphasis. Specifically, the word **uncleanness** comes from a noun that is related to the verb **defiling**. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 15:31 (#2)

אֶת־בְּנֵ֥י יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל

“the sons of Israel”

See how you handled this way of referring to the people of Israel in 1:2.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 15:31 (#4)

מִטֻּמְאָתָֽם

“from their uncleanness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **uncleanness**, you can express the same idea with “unclean.” Alternate translation: [from becoming unclean]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 15:32 (#1)

זֹ֣את תּוֹרַ֣ת הַזָּ֔ב

“This {is} the law of the flowing {person”

This expression uses the possessive form to describe the **law** that is characterized by its referring to the wide variety of bodily discharges listed in 15:32–33.

If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [This is the law that has to do with people who have discharges] or [This is the law that pertains to people who have discharges]

See: Possession

Leviticus 15:32 (#3)

לְטָמְאָה־בָהּ

"to become unclean by it"

Alternate translation: [and he becomes unclean by it]

Leviticus 15:32 (#2)

שִׁכְבַת־זֶרַע

"a layer of seed"

See how you handled this expression in 15:16.

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 15:33 (#2)

וְהַזָּבָ֖ה אֶת־זוֹבֹ֑ו

"and of the flowing of his flow"

Although the word **his** is masculine, here is it being used in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [and of the flowing of any person's flow]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Leviticus 15:33 (#3)

וְהַזָּבָ֖ה אֶת־זוֹבֹ֑ו

"and of the flowing of his flow"

Words are being repeated for emphasis. Specifically, the word **flow** translates a noun that is related to the verb **flowing**. If your language can repeat words in a similar way, consider doing so here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [and of his flowing discharge]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 15:33 (#4)

וּלְאִ֣ישׁ אֲשֶׁ֣ר יִשְׁכַּ֣ב עִם־טְמֵאָ֔ה

"and of the man who lies with an unclean {woman"

This expression refers in a polite way to sexual relations between a man and a woman. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [and of the man who has sexual relations with an unclean woman]

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 15:33 (#1)

וְהַדָּוָה֙ בְּנִדָּתָ֔הּ

"and of {the woman} who is sick in her menstruation"

This expression does not imply physical sickness but, rather, a woman's general experience of menstruation. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and of the woman who experiences menstruation]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus - Chapter 16 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter explains the rules for the Day of Atonement, the most important holy day for Israel. The structure of this chapter is as follows:

1. Introduction and basic requirements (16:1–5)
2. The sacrifices and rituals (16:6–28)
3. The sin offering for Aaron (16:6–14)
4. The sin offering for the people (16:15–19)
5. The scapegoat ritual (16:20–28)
6. Rules for observing the Day of Atonement (16:29–34)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The Day of Atonement

This was the most important holy day for Israel because:

- It happened only once a year.
- Only the high priest could perform the rituals.
- It was when sins were dealt with for the whole nation.
- Special rules had to be followed exactly.

Symbolic Actions

The chapter includes actions that had special meaning:

- Putting hands on the goat's head showed the transfer of sin.
- Sprinkling blood showed cleansing.

- Sending away the scapegoat showed removing sin from the people.

Holy Places and Things
The chapter talks about different sacred areas:

- the most holy place (where only the high priest could go)
- the holy place (where regular priests could go)
- the altar in the courtyard
- special clothes for the high priest

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Special terms for clothing and objects
This chapter uses several special terms that might be hard to translate:

- Undergarments are clothes worn under other clothes.
- A sash is a long piece of cloth worn around the waist.
- A turban is a cloth wrapped around the head.
- A censor is a special container for carrying fire and incense.
- T horns of the altar are the corners of the altar that stick out like animal horns.

Metaphors about cleanness
The chapter uses many word pictures about being clean or unclean:

- Sin is described as if it were dirt that makes things physically unclean.
- Making things acceptable to God is described as "cleansing" them.
- Setting things apart for God is described as "separating" them from uncleanness.

Time references
The chapter mentions specific times using the Hebrew calendar:

- "Seventh month" and "tenth day" are ordinal numbers.
- These dates match with late September in our calendar.
- You could explain this in a note if it would be helpful to your readers.

(See: holy, holiness, unholy, sacred; high priest, chief priest; atonement, atone, atoned; and sin, sinful, sinner, sinning)

Leviticus 16:1 (#1)

שְׁנֵי בְּנֵי אַהֲרֹן

"the two sons of Aaron"

The phrase **the two sons of Aaron** refers to Nadab and Abihu, who died because they brought fire to Yahweh that he did not approve (Leviticus 10:1–2).

Leviticus 16:4 (#1)

וּמִכְנְסֵי־בַד

"and the undergarments of linen"

These **undergarments** were clothing worn next to the skin under the outer clothes.

Leviticus 16:4 (#2)

וּבָאַבְנֵט בַּד

"and & the linen sash"

A **sash** is a piece of cloth that ties around the waist or chest.

Leviticus 16:4 (#3)

וּבְמִצְנֶפֶת בַּד

"and & the linen turban"

A **turban** is a head covering made from wrapped strips of cloth.

Leviticus 16:6 (#1)

הַחַטָּאת אֲשֶׁר־לֹו

"the sin offering, which {is} for himself"

Alternate translation: [as the sin offering for himself]

Leviticus 16:8 (#1)

לַעֲזָאזֵל

"for the scapegoat"

Aaron was to have someone set the goat free in the wilderness. Alternate translation: [for the goat that is sent away]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 16:9 (#1)

אֲשֶׁר עָלָה עָלָיו הַגּוֹרָל

"on which the lot & went up"

Alternate translation: [which the lot designated]

Leviticus 16:10 (#1)

וְהַשָּׂעִיר & יָעֳמַד־חַי

“But the goat & shall be made to stand, living”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [But Aaron must bring the goat ... still living]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 16:12 (#1)

מְלֹא־הַמַּחְתָּה

“the fullness of a censer”

A **censer** is a container for fire and incense, used by the priests.

Leviticus 16:14 (#1)

מִדַּם הַפָּר

“some of the blood of the bull”

This is the **blood** Aaron caught with a bowl in Leviticus 16:11.

Leviticus 16:14 (#3)

וְלִפְנֵי הַכַּפֹּרֶת

“And to the face of the atonement lid”

This could mean: (1) “And below the atonement lid onto the chest” or (2) “And onto the ground in front of the atonement lid.”

Leviticus 16:14 (#2)

עַל־פְּנֵי הַכַּפֹּרֶת

“on the face of the atonement lid”

He put the blood on the top part of the **lid** that was toward him as he entered the most holy place.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 16:15 (#1)

וְהִזָּה אֹתוֹ עַל־הַכַּפֹּרֶת וְלִפְנֵי הַכַּפֹּרֶת

“And he shall sprinkle it on the atonement lid and to the face of the atonement lid”

Aaron sprinkled the blood in the same manner that he did with the bull’s blood. See how you translated the previous instructions in Leviticus 16:14.

Leviticus 16:16 (#1)

וְכִפֶּר עַל־הַקֹּדֶשׁ מִטֻּמְאֹת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“And he shall make atonement for the Holy Place from the uncleanness of the sons of Israel”

The sins of the people of **Israel** made the **Holy Place** unclean.

Leviticus 16:16 (#2)

מִטֻּמְאֹת & וּמִפִּשְׁעֵיהֶם & חַטֹּאתָם

“from the uncleanness of & and from their rebellion & their sins”

The words **uncleanness**, **rebellion**, and **sins** mean basically the same thing. They emphasize that the people have committed all kinds of sins.

Leviticus 16:16 (#3)

מִטֻּמְאֹת

“from the uncleanness of”

Sinful actions which make people unacceptable to Yahweh are spoken of as if they were physically unclean.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 16:16 (#4)

בְּתוֹךְ טֻמְאֹתָם

“in the midst of their uncleanness”

The phrase **their uncleanness** represents the people who commit sinful actions. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in the presence of people who commit sinful actions]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 16:18 (#2)

קַרְנוֹת הַמִּזְבֵּחַ

“the horns of the altar”

The **horns of the altar** refers to the corners of the altar. They are shaped like the horns of an ox. See how you translated this in Leviticus 4:7. Alternate translation: [the projections at the corners of the altar]

Leviticus 16:18 (#3)

וְכִפֶּר עָלָיו

“and he shall make atonement for it”

Like the holy place and tent of meeting, the altar is unclean because of the sins of the people.

Leviticus 16:18 (#1)

וְיָצָא אֶל־הַמִּזְבֵּחַ אֲשֶׁר לִפְנֵי־יְהוָה

“And he shall go out to the altar that {is} to the face of Yahweh”

This is the **altar** of sacrifice just inside the courtyard of the tabernacle.

Leviticus 16:19 (#1)

וְטִהֲרוֹ

“And he shall cleanse it”

Making the altar fit to be used for God’s purposes is spoken of as if the priest were physically cleansing it.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 16:19 (#3)

מִטֻּמְאֹת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“from the uncleanness of the sons of Israel”

Sinful actions which make people unacceptable to Yahweh are spoken of as if they were physical **uncleanness**.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 16:19 (#2)

וְקִדְּשׁוֹ מִטֻּמְאֹת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“and make it holy from the uncleanness of the sons of Israel”

The altar being dedicated to Yahweh is spoken of as if it were being physically separated from the sins of the people.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 16:20 (#1)

וְהִקְרִיב אֶת־הַשָּׂעִיר הֶחָי

“and he shall present the living goat”

This **goat** is called the scapegoat in verse Leviticus 16:10.

Leviticus 16:21 (#1)

וְהִתְוַדָּה עָלָיו

“and he shall confess over it”

Alternate translation: [and confess over the goat]

Leviticus 16:21 (#2)

עֲוֹנֹת & פִּשְׁעֵיהֶם & חַטֹּאתָם

“the iniquity of & their rebellion & their sins”

The words **iniquity**, **rebellion**, and **sins** mean basically the same thing. Aaron is confessing every kind of sin that the people committed.

Leviticus 16:21 (#3)

וְנָתַן אֹתָם עַל־רֹאשׁ הַשָּׂעִיר

“And he shall put them on the head of the goat”

Aaron’s actions here were a symbolic transfer of the peoples’ sin to the **goat** as a sign that the goat would bear the punishment for their guilt. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text or in a footnote.

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 16:23 (#1)

וּפָשַׁט אֶת־בִּגְדֵי הַבָּד

“and he shall remove the linen clothing”

This was the special **linen clothing** Aaron wore only when he entered the most holy place.

Leviticus 16:24 (#2)

וְלָבַשׁ אֶת־בְּגָדָיו

“and he shall wear his clothes”

These **clothes** were the garments that Aaron wore for his ordinary duties.

Leviticus 16:24 (#1)

וְרָחַץ אֶת־בְּשָׂרוֹ בַמַּיִם בְּמָקוֹם קָדוֹשׁ

“And he shall bathe his flesh in the water in a holy place”

Here, **holy place** does not refer to the tent of meeting. This was a different place set aside for him to **bathe** himself.

Leviticus 16:25 (#1)

יַקְטִיר

“he shall cause to become smoke”

Alternate translation: [Aaron must burn]

Leviticus 16:26 (#1)

וְהַמְשַׁלֵּחַ אֶת־הַשָּׂעִיר לַעֲזָאזֵל יְכַבֵּס בְּגָדָיו וְרָחַץ אֶת־בְּשָׂרוֹ בַּמָּיִם

“And the person sending away the goat as scapegoat shall wash his clothes, and he shall bathe his flesh in the water”

The man was unclean because of his contact with the scapegoat, which carried the sin of the people.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 16:26 (#2)

לָעֲזָאזֵֽל

“as scapegoat”

See how you translated this in Leviticus 16:8. Alternate translation: [that bears the sin of the people]

Leviticus 16:27 (#1)

אֲשֶׁ֨ר הוּבָ֤א אֶת־דָּמָם֙

“whose blood was brought”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [whose blood Aaron brought in]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 16:27 (#2)

יוֹצִ֔יא

“shall be brought out”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [someone must carry]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 16:27 (#3)

אֶת־עֹרֹתָ֥ם

“their skins”

Here, **their** refers to the bull and the goat. Alternate translation: [the skins of the bull and the goat]

Leviticus 16:29 (#1)

לָכֶ֑ם

“for you”

The word **you** is plural and refers to the people of Israel, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 16:29 (#2)

בַּחֹ֣דֶשׁ הַֽשְּׁבִיעִ֗י בֶּֽעָשׂ֤וֹר לַחֹ֙דֶשׁ֙

“in the seventh month on the tenth day of the month”

The **seventh month** and the **tenth day** of the Hebrew calendar is near the end of September on the western calendar. You could convert the Hebrew day and month into an approximate date on the calendar that your culture uses. However, the Jews used a lunar calendar, so if you use a solar calendar, the date will be different every year, and the translation will not be entirely accurate. So you may just want to give the number of the day and the name of the month on the Hebrew calendar and say in a footnote approximately what time of year that is on your calendar.

See: Hebrew Months

Leviticus 16:29 (#3)

בַּחֹ֣דֶשׁ הַֽשְּׁבִיעִ֗י בֶּֽעָשׂ֤וֹר לַחֹ֙דֶשׁ֙

“in the seventh month on the tenth day of the month”

The words **seventh** and **tenth** are the ordinal forms of “seven” and “ten.” If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **in the seventh month**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [in month seven on day ten of the month]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Leviticus 16:30 (#1)

יְכַפֵּ֥ר עֲלֵיכֶ֖ם

“he will make atonement for you”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Aaron will make atonement for you]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 16:30 (#2)

לְטַהֵ֥ר אֶתְכֶ֖ם & תִּטְהָֽרוּ

“to cleanse you & you will be clean”

Here, people who are acceptable for God’s purposes are spoken of as if they were physically made **clean**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to purify you ... you will be pure]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 16:31 (#1)

שַׁבַּ֣ת שַׁבָּתוֹן֮ הִיא֣ לָכֶם֒

“It {is} a sabbath of sabbaths for you”

This is not the same as the Sabbath they observed every week on the seventh day. This was a special Sabbath on the Day of Atonement.

Leviticus 16:32 (#1)

תַּחַת֙ אָבִ֔יו

“under his father”

When the high priest died, one of his sons would replace him.

Leviticus 16:32 (#2)

בִּגְדֵ֥י הַקֹּֽדֶשׁ

“the clothes of holiness”

These **clothes of holiness** were special clothes the high priest must wear when he enters the most holy place.

Leviticus 16:33 (#1)

כָּל־עַ֣ם הַקָּהָ֔ל

“all the people of the assembly”

Alternate translation: [all the people of Israel]

Leviticus - Chapter 17 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter contains Yahweh’s laws about proper sacrifice and handling of blood. The structure of this chapter is as follows:

1. Laws about where to sacrifice (17:1–9)
2. Sacrifices must be brought to the tabernacle (17:1–7)
3. Punishment for sacrificing elsewhere (17:8–9)
4. Laws about blood (17:10–16)
5. Prohibition against eating blood (17:10–12)
6. Proper handling of blood from hunted animals (17:13–14)
7. Rules about eating animals found dead (17:15–16)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The Day of Atonement

This was the most important holy day for Israel because:

- It happened only once a year.
- Only the high priest could perform the rituals.
- It was when sins were dealt with for the whole nation.
- Special rules had to be followed exactly.

Symbolic Actions

The chapter includes actions that had special meaning:

- Putting hands on the goat’s head showed the transfer of sin.
- Sprinkling blood showed cleansing.
- Sending away the scapegoat showed removing sin from the people.

Holy Places and Things

The chapter talks about different sacred areas:

- the most holy place (where only the high priest could go)
- the holy place (where regular priests could go)
- the altar in the courtyard
- special clothes for the high priest

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Metaphors about being “cut off”

The chapter often uses the phrase “cut off from his people” as a picture of punishment. This means the person:

- Cannot live with their community anymore
- Is separated like a branch cut from a tree
- Must leave their people

Your language might need a different way to express this idea of being forced to leave the community.

Idioms and figures of speech

The chapter uses several word pictures that might be hard to translate:

- “Set my face against” means “firmly decide to oppose”
- “Prostituting themselves” means “being unfaithful to Yahweh”

- "Carry his iniquity" means "be responsible for his sin"

Important terms about blood
The chapter talks about blood in special ways:

- "The life is in the blood" means blood keeps creatures alive
- "Blood makes atonement" means God uses blood to forgive sins
- "Eat blood" means eat meat that still has blood in it

(See: holy, holiness, unholy, sacred; high priest, chief priest; atonement, atone, atoned; and sin, sinful, sinner, sinning)

Leviticus 17:4 (#1)

לִפְנֵי֙ מִשְׁכַּ֣ן יְהוָ֔ה

"to the face of the Dwelling of Yahweh"

Alternate translation: [before Yahweh's tabernacle]

Leviticus 17:4 (#2)

וְנִכְרַ֗ת הָאִישׁ֙ הַה֣וּא מִקֶּ֔רֶב עַמּ֖וֹ

"and that man shall be cut off from the midst of his people"

A person being excluded from his community is spoken of as if he had been **cut off** from his people, as one would cut a piece of cloth or cut a branch from a tree. See how you translated this in Leviticus 7:20. Alternate translation: [that person must be cut off from among his people as a branch is cut from a tree]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 17:4 (#3)

וְנִכְרַ֗ת הָאִישׁ֙ הַה֣וּא מִקֶּ֔רֶב עַמּ֖וֹ

"and that man shall be cut off from the midst of his people"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that person may no longer live among his people] or [you must separate that person from his people]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 17:7 (#2)

חֻקַּ֤ת עוֹלָם֙ תִּֽהְיֶ֣ה־זֹּ֔את לָהֶ֖ם לְדֹרֹתָֽם

"This will be an enduring statute for them for their generations"

See how you translated this phrase in Leviticus 3:17.

Leviticus 17:7 (#1)

אֲשֶׁ֥ר הֵ֛ם זֹנִ֥ים אַחֲרֵיהֶ֖ם

"after whom they are prostituting themselves"

The people being unfaithful to Yahweh by worshiping false gods is spoken of as if they were prostitutes who sold their bodies for money. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [for which they are unfaithful to Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 17:9 (#1)

וְנִכְרַ֗ת הָאִישׁ֙ הַה֣וּא מֵעַמָּ֔יו

"then that man shall be cut off from his people"

A person being excluded from his community is spoken of as if he had been **cut off from his people**, as one would cut a piece of cloth or cut a branch from a tree. See how you translated this in Leviticus 7:20. Alternate translation: [that person must be cut off from among his people like a branch is cut from a tree]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 17:9 (#2)

וְנִכְרַ֗ת הָאִישׁ֙ הַה֣וּא מֵעַמָּ֔יו

"then that man shall be cut off from his people"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that person may no longer live among his people] or [you must separate that person from his people]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 17:10 (#1)

וְנָתַתִּ֤י פָנַי֙ בַּנֶּ֣פֶשׁ

"then I will set my face against the person"

Here, **set my face against** is a common expression that means he "firmly decided to oppose." If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I have made up my mind to oppose that person]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 17:10 (#2)

וְהִכְרַתִּי֙ אֹתָ֣הּ מִקֶּ֔רֶב עַמָּ֑הּ

“and I will cut him off from the midst of his people”

A person being excluded from his community is spoken of as if he had been **cut off** from **his people**, as one would cut a piece of cloth or a branch from a tree. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will not permit that person to live among his people any longer] or [I will separate that person from his people]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 17:11 (#1)

כִּֽי־נֶ֣פֶשׁ הַבָּשָׂ֣ר בַּדָּ֣ם הִוא֮ & כִּֽי־הַדָּם֒ הוּא֙ בַּנֶּ֔פֶשׁ יְכַפֵּֽר

“For the life of the flesh, it is in the blood & For the blood, it makes atonement with the life”

This means God uses the **blood** to atone for the sins of the people because the blood is **life**. The people should not consume the blood because it has this special purpose.

Leviticus 17:12 (#1)

אָמַ֥רְתִּי

“I said”

Here, **I** refers to Yahweh.

Leviticus 17:12 (#2)

כָּל־נֶ֥פֶשׁ מִכֶּ֖ם לֹא־תֹאכַ֣ל דָּ֑ם

“Every person among you shall not eat blood”

Alternate translation: [no one among you may eat meat with blood in it]

Leviticus 17:13 (#1)

אֲשֶׁ֥ר יֵאָכֵֽל

“that will be eaten”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that I have said they may eat]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 17:14 (#1)

נֶ֣פֶשׁ כָּל־בָּשָׂ֣ר דָּמ֔וֹ

“the life of all flesh, its blood”

The implication is that the **blood** enables the creature to live. The full meaning of this statement can be made clear. Alternate translation: [each creature is able to live because of its blood]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 17:14 (#2)

כָּל־אֹכְלָ֖יו יִכָּרֵֽת

“All who eat it shall be cut off”

A person being excluded from his community is spoken of as if he had been **cut off** from his people, as one would cut a piece of cloth or a branch from a tree. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Whoever eats blood may no longer live among his people] or [Anyone who eats blood must be cut off from his people, as if he were a branch cut from a tree]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 17:14 (#3)

כָּל־אֹכְלָ֖יו יִכָּרֵֽת

“All who eat it shall be cut off”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Whoever eats blood may no longer live among his people] or [You must separate from his people anyone who eats blood]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 17:15 (#2)

בָּאֶזְרָ֖ח

“among the native-born”

Alternate translation: [among the Israelites]

Leviticus 17:15 (#4)

עַד־הָעֶ֑רֶב

“until the evening”

Alternate translation: [until sunset]

Leviticus 17:15 (#1)

וּטְרֵפָ֔ה

“or a torn animal”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way

that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [or one that wild animals have killed]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 17:15 (#3)

וְטָמֵא & וְטָהֵר

“and he will be unclean & Then he will be clean”

The person whom other people may not touch is spoken of as if he were physically **unclean** and the person whom other people may touch is spoken of as if he were physically **clean**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state these meanings plainly.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 17:16 (#2)

וְנָשָׂא עֲוֹנוֹ

“then he shall bear his iniquity”

Here the word **iniquity** represents the punishment for that iniquity. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [then he is responsible for his own iniquity] or [then I will punish him for his sin]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 17:16 (#1)

וְנָשָׂא עֲוֹנוֹ

“then he shall bear his iniquity”

Here a person’s **iniquity** is spoken of as if it were a physical object that the person carries.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus - Chapter 18 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter contains Yahweh’s laws about forbidden sexual relationships. The structure of this chapter is as follows:

1. Introduction: Following Yahweh’s laws (18:1–5)
2. Laws about forbidden sexual relationships (18:6–23)
3. Relationships with close relatives (18:6–18)
4. Other forbidden sexual acts (18:19–23)
5. Warning about these sins (18:24–30)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Sexual purity
This chapter teaches that:

- Sexual relationships must only be between a husband and wife
- Certain relatives cannot marry or have sexual relations
- These rules were different from other nations’ practices
- Breaking these rules made people and the land unclean

Punishment for disobedience
The chapter warns about serious consequences:

- People who break these rules must leave the community
- The land itself will reject people who do these things
- God removed previous nations for these practices
- Israel must be different from other nations

Clean and unclean
The chapter talks about:

- Actions that make people unclean
- How these sins affect the whole land
- Why God’s people must stay pure
- The difference between God’s people and other nations

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Euphemisms for sexual relations
This chapter uses polite ways to talk about sexual matters:

- “Uncover nakedness” means “have sexual relations with”
- “Approach a woman” means “have sexual relations with her”
- “Lie with” means “have sexual relations with”

Your language may have its own polite ways to talk about these things. Use words that your community would consider respectful and appropriate for public reading.

Family relationship terms
The chapter uses many words for family relationships that might need explanation:

- “Father’s wife” could mean a stepmother

- "Sister" could mean a half-sister or stepsister
- "Daughter-in-law" means your son's wife
- "Your brother's wife" means your sister-in-law

Metaphors and figures of speech
The chapter uses several word pictures that might be hard to translate:

- "Walk in their statutes" means "follow their rules"
- "The land vomited out its inhabitants" means "God forced the people to leave the land"
- "Cut off from their people" means "removed from the community"

(See: pure, purify, purification)

Leviticus 18:4 (#1)

אֶת־מִשְׁפָּטַי תַּעֲשׂוּ וְאֶת־חֻקֹּתַי תִּשְׁמְרוּ

"My customs you shall do, and my statutes you shall keep"

These two phrases mean basically the same thing and emphasize that the people must obey everything that Yahweh has commanded them to do. You can translate this parallelism into one statement that conveys the requirement to keep all of Yahweh's commands. Alternate translation: [You must obey all of my laws and commandments]

See: Parallelism

Leviticus 18:4 (#2)

לָלֶכֶת בָּהֶם

"to walk in them"

Obeying Yahweh's commandments is spoken of as if they were a way or path that a person walks along. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [so that you conduct your behavior according to them]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 18:6 (#1)

לְגַלּוֹת עֶרְוָה

"to uncover nakedness"

The phrase **to uncover nakedness** is a polite way of referring to sexual activity. Depending on what is helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [to have sexual relations]

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 18:7 (#2)

לֹא תְגַלֵּה עֶרְוָתָהּ

"you shall not uncover her nakedness"

This is a polite way of referring to sexual activity. Alternate translation: [you must not have sexual relations with her]

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 18:7 (#1)

עֶרְוַת אָבִיךָ וְעֶרְוַת אִמְּךָ לֹא תְגַלֵּה

"The nakedness of your father and the nakedness of your mother you shall not uncover"

This is a polite way of referring to sexual activity. Depending on what is helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not have sexual relations with your father or your mother]

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 18:8 (#2)

עֶרְוַת אָבִיךָ הִוא

"It {is} the nakedness of your father"

Alternate translation: [You would dishonor your father]

Leviticus 18:8 (#1)

אֵשֶׁת־אָבִיךָ

"the wife of your father"

Sometimes men had more than one wife. God did not allow a son to have sexual intercourse with any woman married to his father, even if she was not his mother.

Leviticus 18:9 (#1)

עֶרְוַת אֲחוֹתְךָ בַת־אָבִיךָ אוֹ בַת־אִמֶּךָ מוֹלֶדֶת בַּבַּיִת אוֹ מוֹלֶדֶת חוּץ לֹא תְגַלֶּה עֶרְוָתָן

"The nakedness of your sister, the daughter of your father or the daughter of your mother, born of {the same} house or born outside {it}, you shall not uncover their nakedness"

This is a polite way of referring to sexual activity. See how this is translated in Leviticus 18:7. Alternate translation: [Do not have sexual relations with your

sister, the daughter of your father or the daughter of your mother, born at home or born outside]

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 18:9 (#2)

בַּת־אָבִיךָ אוֹ בַת־אִמֶּךָ

“the daughter of your father or the daughter of your mother”

This means a man cannot have sexual intercourse with his sister even if she has a different mother or father.

Leviticus 18:10 (#1)

כִּכְּי עֶרְוָתְךָ הֵנָּה

“for they {are} your nakedness”

Alternate translation: [for you will dishonor yourself as well as them]

Leviticus 18:11 (#1)

בַּת־אֵשֶׁת אָבִיךָ

“the daughter of the wife of your father”

This could mean: (1) “your half-sister” or (2) “your stepsister.” Here the man does not have the same father or mother as the woman. They became brother and sister when their parents married.

Leviticus 18:12 (#1)

עֶרְוַת אֲחוֹת־אָבִיךָ לֹא תְגַלֶּה

“The nakedness of the sister of your father, you shall not uncover”

This is a polite way of referring to sexual activity. See how this is translated in Leviticus 18:7. Alternate translation: [Do not have sexual relations with your father’s sister]

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 18:14 (#1)

אֶל־אִשְׁתּוֹ לֹא תִקְרָב

“to his wife you shall not draw near”

You may have to make explicit the purpose of the approach. Alternate translation: [do not go to his wife in order to have sexual relations with her]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 18:15 (#2)

לֹא תְגַלֶּה עֶרְוָתָהּ

“You shall not uncover her nakedness”

This is a polite way of referring to sexual activity. Alternate translation: [You must not have sexual relations with her]

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 18:15 (#1)

עֶרְוַת כַּלָּתְךָ לֹא תְגַלֶּה

“The nakedness of your daughter-in-law, you shall not uncover”

This is a polite way of referring to sexual activity. See how this is translated in Leviticus 18:7. Alternate translation: [Do not have sexual relations with your daughter-in-law]

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 18:16 (#1)

עֶרְוַת אָחִיךָ הִוא

“She is the nakedness of your brother”

Alternate translation: [If you do that, you will dishonor your brother]

Leviticus 18:17 (#2)

לְגַלְּלוֹת עֶרְוָתָהּ

“to uncover her nakedness”

Alternate translation: [to have sexual relations with her]

Leviticus 18:17 (#1)

עֶרְוַת אִשָּׁה וּבִתָּהּ לֹא תְגַלֶּה

“The nakedness of a woman and her daughter, you shall not uncover”

This is a polite way of referring to sexual activity. See how this is translated in Leviticus 18:7. Alternate translation: [Do not have sexual relations with a woman and her daughter]

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 18:19 (#2)

לְגַלְּלוֹת עֶרְוָתָהּ

“to uncover her nakedness”

Alternate translation: [to have sexual relations with her]

Leviticus 18:19 (#1)

בְּנִדַּ֣ת טֻמְאָתָ֑הּ

“in the menstruation of her uncleanness”

This refers to the time every month when a woman bleeds from her womb.

Leviticus 18:21 (#2)

וְלֹ֥א תְחַלֵּ֛ל אֶת־שֵׁ֥ם אֱלֹהֶ֖יךָ

“And you shall not profane the name of your God”

Here the word **name** represents God himself, and the word **profane** means “to dishonor.” Alternate translation: [And you must not dishonor your God]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 18:21 (#1)

וּמִזַּרְעֲךָ֣ לֹא־תִתֵּ֔ן לְהַעֲבִ֖יר לַמֹּלֶ֑ךְ

“And from your seed, you shall not give {them} to cause {them} to pass over to Molech”

The phrase **to pass over to Molech** refers to burning a child in the fire as a sacrifice to the idol Molech. Alternate translation: [You must not burn your children alive for Molech]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 18:22 (#1)

וְאֶת & לֹ֥א תִשְׁכַּ֖ב

“And you shall not lie with”

This is a polite way of speaking of sexual relations. Use a polite way of referring to this in your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not have sexual relations with]

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 18:22 (#2)

תּוֹעֵבָ֥ה הִ֖וא

“It is an abomination”

Here, **an abomination** refers to a violation of the natural order of things as Yahweh intended them to be.

Leviticus 18:23 (#1)

לִרְבָעָ֣ה

“to mate with it”

This is a polite way of referring to sexual activity. Alternate translation: [to have sexual relations with it]

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 18:24 (#1)

נִטְמְא֖וּ הַגּוֹיִ֑ם

“the nations & make themselves unclean”

Here, **the nations** refers to the people groups already living in Canaan. Translate this so the term **nations** is clarified as people. Alternate translation: [the people of the nations ... have defiled themselves]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 18:25 (#2)

וַתָּקֵ֥א הָאָ֖רֶץ אֶת־יֹשְׁבֶ֑יהָ

“And the land vomited out the ones dwelling {in} it”

Yahweh forcibly removing the people from the land is spoken of as if **the land vomited out the ones dwelling in it**. Alternate translation: [I forcibly removed the people from the land]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 18:25 (#1)

וַתִּטְמָ֥א הָאָ֖רֶץ

“And the land became unclean”

Alternate translation: [And the people defiled the land]

Leviticus 18:25 (#3)

וַתָּקֵ֥א הָאָ֖רֶץ אֶת־יֹשְׁבֶ֑יהָ

“And the land vomited out the ones dwelling {in} it”

The **land** is spoken of as if it were a living thing that could vomit.

See: Personification

Leviticus 18:26 (#1)

מִכֹּ֣ל הַתּוֹעֵבֹ֗ת הָאֵ֫לֶּ֥ה

“any of these abominations”

Alternate translation: [any of these disgusting things]

Leviticus 18:28 (#1)

וְלֹא־תָקִ֥יא הָאָ֛רֶץ אֶתְכֶ֖ם & קָאָ֑תָהּ

“And the land will not vomit you out & it vomited out”

Yahweh forcibly removing the people from the land is spoken of as if the land **vomited** the people out. See how you translated this metaphor in Leviticus 18:25.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 18:28 (#2)

וְלֹא־תָקִיא הָאָרֶץ אֶתְכֶם & קָאָה

“And the land will not vomit you out & it vomited out”

The land is spoken of as if it were a living thing that could **vomit**. See how you translated these phrases in Leviticus 18:25.

See: Personification

Leviticus 18:29 (#2)

וְנִכְרְתוּ הַנְּפָשׁוֹת הָעֹשֹׂת מִקֶּרֶב עַמָּם

“the people who do will be cut off from the midst of their people”

If your language does not use the passive form, you could express this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [you must separate those who do such things from their people]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 18:29 (#1)

וְנִכְרְתוּ הַנְּפָשׁוֹת הָעֹשֹׂת מִקֶּרֶב עַמָּם

“the people who do will be cut off from the midst of their people”

People who are excluded from the community are spoken of as if they had been **cut off** from their people, as one would cut a branch from a tree. Alternate translation: [the people who do these things must be separated from their people as a branch is cut from a tree]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 18:30 (#1)

אֲשֶׁר נַעֲשׂוּ לִפְנֵיכֶם

“that are done to your faces”

If your language does not use the passive form, you could express this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [which the people did here before you came]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 18:30 (#2)

בָּהֶם

“by them”

Here, **them** refers to the abominations and detestable customs.

Leviticus - Chapter 19 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter contains various laws about how to live a holy life. The structure of this chapter is as follows:

1. Basic rules about holiness (19:1–8)
2. Laws about treating others fairly (19:9–18)
3. Various other laws (19:19–37)
4. Laws about mixing things (19:19)
5. Laws about sexual purity (19:20–22)
6. Laws about food and worship (19:23–31)
7. Laws about respecting others (19:32–37)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Holiness in daily life

This chapter shows that being holy means:

- Being fair in business
- Helping poor people
- Respecting parents and elderly people
- Being honest in court
- Using correct measurements
- Not spreading rumors

Treatment of others

The chapter gives rules about:

- Leaving food for poor people to gather
- Paying workers on time
- Being fair to everyone in court
- Not hating others secretly
- Loving neighbors
- Respecting the elderly

Proper worship

The chapter includes rules about:

- Keeping the Sabbath
- Not worshiping idols
- Proper sacrifices

- Not consulting fortune-tellers
- Not following pagan practices

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Metaphors and figures of speech
The chapter uses several word pictures that might be hard to translate:

- "Turn to idols" means "start worshiping idols"
- "Hate in your heart" means "continue to hate"
- "The land will practice prostitution" means "the people will become unfaithful"
- "Carry his iniquity" means "be responsible for his sin"

Special terms for measurements
The chapter mentions specific measurements that might need explanation:

- "Ephah", a measurement for dry things like grain
- "Hin", a measurement for liquids

Your language might need to use general terms like "measure" or explain these in a note.

Double negatives and emphasis
Some commands use special ways to make them stronger:

- "Not do injustice" means "always judge fairly"
- "Keep and do" means the same thing, repeated for emphasis
- "Poor and great" means "anyone, regardless of wealth"

(See: holy, holiness, unholy, sacred; righteous, righteousness, unrighteous, unrighteousness, upright, uprightness; and just, justice, unjust, injustice, justify, justification)

Leviticus 19:3 (#1)

וְאֶת־שַׁבְּתֹתַ֖י תִּשְׁמֹ֑רוּ

"and my sabbaths you shall keep"

Alternate translation: [and you must observe my sabbaths] or [and you must respect my day of rest]

Leviticus 19:4 (#1)

אַל־תִּפְנוּ֙ אֶל־הָאֱלִילִ֔ים

"You shall not turn to idols"

The worshiping of **idols** is spoken of as if the people would physically turn toward them. Alternate translation: [Do not begin to worship worthless idols]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 19:5 (#1)

לִרְצֹנְכֶ֖ם תִּזְבָּחֻֽהוּ

"you shall sacrifice it for your acceptance"

This could mean: (1) Yahweh will accept the person offering the sacrifice. Alternate translation: [you must offer it properly so that I will accept you] or (2) Yahweh will accept the sacrifice from the person. Alternate translation: [you must offer it properly so that I will accept your sacrifice]

Leviticus 19:6 (#2)

וְהַנּוֹתָ֣רׇ עַד־יוֹם֮ הַשְּׁלִישִׁי֒ בָּאֵ֣שׁ יִשָּׂרֵֽף

"And the remainder until the third day shall be burned with fire"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [you must burn up in the fire what is left until the third day]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 19:6 (#1)

יֵאָכֵ֔ל

"it shall be eaten"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [you must eat it]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 19:7 (#2)

לֹ֥א יֵרָצֶֽה

"It will not be accepted"

To eat the offering after the designated time is against God and increases the guilt the offering was to cover. If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God will not accept it]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 19:7 (#1)

וְאִאָם הֵאָכֹל יֵאָכֵל

“But if, eating, it is eaten”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And if you eat any of it]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 19:8 (#2)

וְאֹכְלָיו עֲוֹנוֹ יִשָּׂא

“And the person eating it shall bear his iniquity”

Here the word **iniquity** represents the punishment for that sin. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your own language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And everyone who eats the sacrifice is responsible for his own sin] or [Yahweh will punish the sin of him who eats the sacrifice]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 19:8 (#1)

וְאֹכְלָיו עֲוֹנוֹ יִשָּׂא

“And the person eating it shall bear his iniquity”

A person’s **iniquity** is spoken of as if it were a physical object that the person can lift. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And the person eating it will be guilty]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 19:8 (#4)

וְנִכְרְתָה הַנֶּפֶשׁ הַהִוא מֵעַמֶּיהָ

“And that person shall be cut off from his people”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [That person may no longer live among his people] or [You must separate that person from his people]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 19:8 (#3)

וְנִכְרְתָה הַנֶּפֶשׁ הַהִוא מֵעַמֶּיהָ

“And that person shall be cut off from his people”

A person being excluded from his community is spoken of as if he had been cut off from his people, as one would cut a piece of cloth or cut a branch from a tree. See how you translated this in Leviticus 7:20. Alternate translation: [And that person must be cut off from among his people as a branch is cut from a tree]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 19:9 (#2)

וְלֶקֶט קְצִירְךָ לֹא תְלַקֵּט

“and the gleaning of your harvest you shall not glean”

This refers to the practice of going back over the fields a second time to gather any produce that remained after the first time. The full meaning of this statement can be made explicit. Alternate translation: [and do not go back and pick up all that you left behind]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 19:9 (#1)

וּבְקֻצְרְכֶם אֶת־קְצִיר אַרְצְכֶם לֹא תְכַלֶּה פְּאַאת שָׂדְךָ

“And in your harvesting the harvest of your land, you shall not complete the edge of your field”

Alternate translation: [And when you gather your crops, do not gather all the way to the edges of your fields]

Leviticus 19:12 (#1)

וְלֹא־תִשָּׁבְעוּ בִשְׁמִי לַשָּׁקֶר

“And you shall not swear by my name to a lie”

Alternate translation: [And do not use my name to swear about something that is not true]

Leviticus 19:13 (#1)

לֹא־תַעֲשֹׁק אֶת־רֵעֲךָ וְלֹא תִגְזֹל

“You shall not extort your neighbor, and you shall not rob”

Here, **neighbor** means “anyone.” The meaning of this can be made explicit. Alternate translation: [Do not hurt or rob anyone]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 19:13 (#2)

לֹא־תָלִין פְּעֻלַּת שָׂכִיר אִתְּךָ עַד־בֹּקֶר

“You shall not retain the wages of a hired {person} with you until morning”

Yahweh commands the employer to pay his servant promptly when his work is done that day. The full meaning of this statement can be made clear.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 19:15 (#3)

בְּצֶדֶק תִּשְׁפֹּט עֲמִיתֶךָ

“In righteousness, you shall judge your fellow citizen”

Alternate translation: [Judge everyone according to what is right]

Leviticus 19:15 (#1)

לֹא־תַעֲשׂוּ עָוֶל בַּמִּשְׁפָּט

“You shall not do injustice with judgment”

The double negative **not … injustice** is used for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [Always judge rightly]

See: Litotes

Leviticus 19:15 (#2)

לֹא־תִשָּׂא פְנֵי־דָל וְלֹא תֶהְדַּר פְּנֵי גָדוֹל

“You shall not lift the face of an insignificant {person}, and you shall not honor the face of a great {person”

The words **insignificant person** and **great person** are two extremes, which together mean “anyone.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [You must not show favoritism to anyone based on how much money they have]

See: Merism

Leviticus 19:16 (#1)

רָכִיל

“as} a slanderer”

A **slanderer** is someone who says untrue and hurtful things about other people.

Leviticus 19:17 (#1)

לֹא־תִשְׂנָא אֶת־אָחִיךָ בִּלְבָבֶךָ

“You shall not hate your brother with your heart”

Continually hating a person is spoken of as if it were hating a person in the **heart**. Alternate translation: [Do not continually hate your brother]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 19:17 (#2)

הוֹכֵחַ תּוֹכִיחַ אֶת־עֲמִיתֶךָ

“Reproving, you shall reprove your fellow citizen”

Alternate translation: [You must correct your fellow Israelite who is sinning]

Leviticus 19:20 (#1)

יִשְׁכַּב אֶת

“he lies with”

This is a polite way of referring to sexual activity. Alternate translation: [he has sexual relations with]

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 19:20 (#3)

וְהָפְדֵּהוּ לֹא נִפְדָּתָה אוֹ חֻפְשָׁה לֹא נִתַּן־לָהּ

“but, being redeemed, she has not been redeemed or freedom has not been given to her”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [but whom her future husband has not ransomed or given her freedom]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 19:20 (#4)

לֹא יוּמָתוּ

“They shall not be executed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [You must not kill them]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 19:20 (#2)

נֶחֱרֶפֶת לְאִישׁ

“a {woman} being assigned to a man”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [whom someone promised to give to a man as his wife]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 19:21 (#1)

וְהֵבִיא אֶת־אֲשָׁמוֹ לַיהוָה אֶל־פֶּתַח אֹהֶל מוֹעֵד אַיִל אָשָׁם

“And he shall bring his guilt to Yahweh, to the entrance of the tent of meeting—a ram of a guilt offering”

Alternate translation: [And a man must bring a ram as a guilt offering to Yahweh to the entrance of the tent of meeting]

Leviticus 19:22 (#1)

וְנִסְלַח לוֹ מֵחַטָּאתוֹ אֲשֶׁר חָטָא

“And it will be forgiven to him from his sin that he sinned”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will forgive the sin which he has committed]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 19:23 (#1)

וַעֲרַלְתֶּם עָרְלָתוֹ אֶת־פִּרְיוֹ שָׁלֹשׁ שָׁנִים יִהְיֶה לָכֶם עֲרֵלִים לֹא יֵאָכֵל

“then you shall leave uncircumcised {as} its foreskin its fruit. Three years it shall be uncircumcised to you. It shall not be eaten”

Yahweh repeats the prohibition in order to emphasize it and to clarify that it is in force for the first three years that the tree bears fruit. Translate this to clarify the period of time the trees must be left alone. Alternate translation: [then you must consider the fruit of the trees to be unclean for the first three years and not eat any of it until after that]

See: Parallelism

Leviticus 19:23 (#2)

לֹא יֵאָכֵל

“It shall not be eaten”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [You must not eat it]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 19:29 (#1)

וְלֹא־תִזְנֶה הָאָרֶץ וּמָלְאָה הָאָרֶץ זִמָּה

“and the land shall not practice prostitution, or the land will fill {itself with} depravity”

Here both occurrences of the word **land** represent the people who live there. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [or the people will begin to practice prostitution and many wicked things]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 19:29 (#2)

וְלֹא־תִזְנֶה הָאָרֶץ וּמָלְאָה הָאָרֶץ זִמָּה

“and the land shall not practice prostitution, or the land will fill {itself with} depravity”

Many people practicing **prostitution** and other **depravity** is spoken of as if the land has become full of those things. Alternate translation: [lest the people begin to practice prostitution and many wicked things]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 19:31 (#1)

הָאֹבֹת וְאֶל־הַיִּדְּעֹנִים

“the mediums, and to the spiritists”

The **mediums** were people who claimed to speak with dead people. The **spiritists** claimed to be able to predict what would happen in the future. The Israelites were not allowed to have anything to do with these people.

Leviticus 19:31 (#2)

אַל־תִּבָּקְשׁוּ לְטָמְאָה בָהֶם

“you shall not seek to become unclean by them”

Alternate translation: [do not seek those people out. If you do, they will defile you]

Leviticus 19:32 (#2)

שֵׂיבָה

“gray hair”

A face of **gray-hair** refers to a person whose hair has turned gray from age, or “an old person.”

Leviticus 19:32 (#1)

תָּקוּם

“you shall rise”

Here, **you shall rise** is a symbolic action that is meant to show respect. Standing up in front of someone is a sign of respect in some cultures. If this would not be clear to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text or in a footnote. AT: [you must act respectfully toward them]

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 19:35 (#1)

לֹא־תַעֲשׂוּ עָוֶל בַּמִּשְׁפָּט בַּמִּדָּה בַּמִּשְׁקָל וּבַמְּשׂוּרָה

“You shall not do injustice with judgment, in measure, in weight, or in volume”

This prohibits the practice of intentionally using instruments that give inaccurate readings when measuring things.

Leviticus 19:36 (#1)

אֵיפַת צֶדֶק

“an ephah of righteousness”

An **ephah** was a measurement for grain.

See: Biblical Volume

Leviticus 19:36 (#2)

וְהִין צֶדֶק

“and a hin of righteousness”

A **hin** was a measurement for liquids.

See: Biblical Volume

Leviticus 19:37 (#1)

וְשָׁמַרְתֶּם & וַעֲשִׂיתֶם

“And you shall keep & and you shall do”

These phrases mean the same thing and emphasize the command for obedience.

See: Doublet

Leviticus - Chapter 20 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter lists punishments for various sins. The structure is:

1. Punishments for worshiping Molech (20:1–5)
2. Punishments for consulting spirits (20:6–8)
3. Punishments for cursing parents (20:9)
4. Punishments for sexual sins (20:10–21)
5. Call to holiness (20:22–27)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Capital punishment
The chapter prescribes death for many offenses. This shows:

- The community was responsible for carrying out punishment
- Public execution by stoning was the common method
- Both parties in sexual sins usually received the same punishment

Family honor
The chapter treats family relationships as sacred:

- Sexual relations between close relatives were forbidden
- Dishonoring parents was a serious offense
- Marriage boundaries protected family structures

Childlessness as punishment
Being “childless” or “dying without children” was seen as:

- A divine punishment
- The end of one’s family line
- A serious consequence for sexual sins

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Quotes within quotes
The chapter has many places where someone quotes what another person said. Your language may need different ways to show:

- When Yahweh speaks to Moses
- When Moses speaks to the people
- When they quote laws or commands

Euphemisms for sexual relations
The chapter uses several polite expressions for sexual activity:

- “Lie with” means “have sexual relations with”
- “Take a wife” can mean either “marry” or “have relations with”
- “Uncover nakedness” means “have sexual relations with”
- “See nakedness” means “have sexual relations with”

Metaphors and idioms
The chapter uses several expressions that need careful translation:

- "His blood is on him" means "he is responsible for his own death"
- "Cut off from among their people" means "removed from the community"
- "The land will vomit you out" means "God will force you to leave the land"
- "Walk in their statutes" means "follow their customs"

Repeated words for emphasis
Some phrases repeat words to show importance:

- "Man man" means "any person"
- "Dying he shall die" means "he must certainly be executed"
- "Stranger who sojourns" means "any foreigner living among you"

Leviticus 20:1 (#1)

לֵאמֹֽר

"saying"

The word translated **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Leviticus 20:1–2 (#1)

לֵאמֹר׃ וְאֶל־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל֮ תֹּאמַר֒

"saying, "And to the sons of Israel, you shall say"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation (with a period before): [He told Moses to speak to the sons of Israel and say that]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Leviticus 20:2 (#10)

יִרְגְּמֻ֥הוּ בָאָֽבֶן

"shall stone him with the rock"

The expression **the rock** represents "rocks" in general and not a specific rock. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an expression that is more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [shall stone him with rocks]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 20:2 (#4)

מִזַּרְעוֹ֙

"from his seed"

This expression uses a metaphor to relate the word **seed** to one's children. Whether semen was thought of to resemble plant seed is unclear, although the same word is used to refer to both. (See 11:37 and 15:16 for reference.) If your language uses a similar metaphor, consider using it here. If not consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [from his children]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 20:2 (#8)

עַ֣ם הָאָ֔רֶץ יִרְגְּמֻ֥הוּ בָאָֽבֶן

"The people of the land shall stone him with the rock"

This expression refers to a method of public execution by which members of the community throw stones at a person convicted of wrongdoing until the individual dies. As such, the person's death is public and slow. If your language has a word or phrase for this sort of public execution, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [The people of the land shall put him to death publicly]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 20:2 (#9)

עַ֣ם הָאָ֔רֶץ

"The people of the land"

The expression **the people of the land** uses the possessive form to describe people who live in the land of Israel, whether foreigner or native-born. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [Whoever lives in the land of Israel] or [Everybody]

See: Possession

Leviticus 20:2 (#1)

בְּנֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֗ל & מִבְּנֵי֙ יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

"the sons of Israel & from the sons of Israel"

See how you translated this metaphor in 1:2.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 20:2 (#3)

אֲשֶׁשֶׁר יִתֵּתֵן מִזַּרְעֵוֹ לַמֹּלֶךְ

“who gives from his seed to Molech”

This expression is an idiom that means to offer one’s children to **Molech** in a sacrifice. Those who worshiped **Molech** often sacrificed their children to him by means of fire. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who kills any of his children as a sacrifice to Molech]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 20:2 (#6)

מָוֹת יוּמָֽת

“dying, he shall be executed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [dying, the people of Israel shall execute him]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 20:2 (#7)

מָוֹת יוּמָֽת

“dying, he shall be executed”

This expression repeats the verb **dying** in order to intensify the idea that it expresses. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [the person shall certainly be executed] or, to avoid the passive construction, [the people of Israel shall certainly execute him]

See: Reduplication

Leviticus 20:2 (#2)

אִ֣ישׁ אִ֔ישׁ

“A man, a man”

Here the masculine term **A man, a man** has a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. For more information, please see the Leviticus 20 Chapter Introduction on repeating words for emphasis. Alternate translation: [Any person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Leviticus 20:2 (#5)

לַמֹּלֶךְ

“to Molech”

Molech is a word borrowed from Hebrew. You will need to decide if you will also borrow this word into your language. If you borrow the word, you could spell it the way it sounds in your language and then put the translation in a footnote. If you choose to translate the term, consider using a generic expression. See how you translated the name of this deity in 18:21. Alternate translation: [to a false god] or [to an idol]

See: Copy or Borrow Words

Leviticus 20:3 (#1)

וַאֲנִ֖י אֶתֵּ֣ן אֶת־פָּנַ֑י

“And I myself will set my face”

Here, the words **I** and **my** refer to Yahweh, the one speaking to Moses. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [And I, Yahweh, will set my face]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 20:3 (#6)

לְמַמְּעַן טַמֵּא֙ אֶת־מִקְדָּשִׁ֔י

“to make my Holy Place unclean”

This expression implies that child sacrifice performed in the worship of Molech makes Yahweh’s **Holy Place** unclean, that is, unfit for hosting the holy presence of Yahweh or the worship of him. You could include this information if it would be helpful to your readers. It may be helpful to consult how you handled the idea of something becoming **unclean** in 5:3.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 20:3 (#3)

וְהִכְרַתִּ֥י אֹתָ֛וֹ מִקֶּ֥רֶב עַמָּֽוֹ

“and I will cut him off from among his people”

The punishment for sacrificing one’s children to worship Molech is spoken of as if Yahweh were literally cutting off the individual from his people. It may be helpful to refer to how you handled the similar expression in 7:20.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 20:3 (#4)

כִּֽי מִזַּרְעוֹ֙ נָתַ֔ן לַמֹּלֶךְ

“for he gave his seed to Molech”

See how you translated the similar phrase in 20:2. Alternate translation: [because he has sacrificed his child to Molech]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 20:3 (#2)

בָּאִ֣ישׁ הַה֔וּא

“against that man”

Here, the expression **that man** refers to the individual who sacrifices his children to worship Molech. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making the referent explicit. Alternate translation: [against the person who sacrifices his children to worship Molech]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 20:3 (#5)

כִּֽי

“for”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation (with a period before): [I will do this because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 20:3 (#8)

וּלְחַלֵּ֖ל אֶת־שֵׁ֥שֵׁם קָדְשִֽׁי

“and to profane my holy name”

Here, **name** represents Yahweh and, by extension, Yahweh’s reputation for holiness. So, to **profane** this **name** is to associate Yahweh with that which is not holy, but rather, abominable and detestable, like child sacrifice. If your language has a similar expression, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [and to publicly defame me] or [and to openly denigrate my reputation]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 20:3 (#7)

לְמַ֣עַן

“to”

The word translated as **to** indicate that what follows is a result for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation (with a period before): [He did this in order to]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 20:4 (#3)

הָאִ֣ישׁ הַה֗וּא

“that man”

Here, the expression **that man** refers to the individual who sacrifices his children to worship Molech. You could make this explicit to your readers if it would be helpful in your language. Alternate translation: [the person who sacrifices his children to worship Molech]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 20:4 (#1)

הַעְלֵ֤ם יַעְלִימוּ֙ עַ֣ם הָאָ֔רֶץ אֶת־עֵינֵיהֶ֖ם מִן־הָאִ֣ישׁ הַה֑וּא

“hiding, the people of the land hide their eyes from that man”

Here, the **eyes** of a person represents their attention and focus, and the phrase **hiding, the people of the land hide their eyes** is an expression that refers to disregarding or ignoring something. It means that the **people of the land** disregard or ignore what **that man** does. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the people of the land disregard that man] or [the people of the land ignore what that man does]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 20:4 (#4)

בְּתִתּ֥וֹ מִזַּרְעוֹ֖ לַמֹּלֶךְ

“when he gives his seed to Molech”

See how you translated the similar phrase in 20:2. Alternate translation: [when he sacrifices his child to Molech]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 20:4 (#2)

הַעְלֵ֤ם יַעְלִימוּ֙ עַ֣ם הָאָ֔רֶץ אֶת־עֵינֵיהֶ֖ם

“hiding, the people of the land hide their eyes”

This expression repeats the verb **hiding** in order to intensify the idea that it expresses. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [the people of the land ever hide their eyes]

See: Reduplication

Leviticus 20:4 (#5)

לְבִלְתִּ֥י הָמְמִ֖ית אֹתֽוֹ

“so as not to execute him”

The words translated as **so as not to** indicate that what follows is a result of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [and, as a result, the man is not executed] or, to avoid the passive: [meaning, they do not execute him]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 20:5 (#3)

וְהִכְרַתִּ֥י אֹת֛וֹ וְאֵ֥ת ׀ כָּל־הַזֹּנִ֖ים אַחֲרָ֑יו לִזְנ֞וֹת אַחֲרֵ֣י הַמֹּלֶךְ֮ מִקֶּ֣רֶב עַמָּֽם

“And I will cut him off and all the people who practice prostitution after him, by prostituting after Molech, from the midst of their people”

The punishment for sacrificing one’s children to worship Molech is spoken of as if Yahweh were literally cutting off the individual from his people. It may be helpful to refer to how you handled the similar expression in 7:20.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 20:5 (#2)

וְשַׂמְתִּ֤י אֲנִי֙ אֶת־פָּנַ֔י בָּאִ֖ישׁ הַה֑וּא

“then I myself will set my face against that man”

Like the expression “I will put my face against that man” in 20:3, this expression is an idiom that refers to a decision to oppose someone. Here, the word **face** represents the entire person by metonymy. If your language has a similar idiom, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [And I will personally oppose that man] or [And I will make myself the enemy of that man]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 20:5 (#1)

וְשַׂמְתִּ֤י אֲנִי֙ אֶת־פָּנַ֔י בָּאִ֖ישׁ הַה֑וּא

“then I myself will set my face against that man”

The words **I**, **myself**, and **my** refer to Yahweh, while the words **that man** refer to the individual who has sacrificed his children to the false god Molech. If this would be helpful in your language, consider making these referents explicit. Alternate translation: [then I, Yahweh, will put my face against the individual who has sacrificed his children to Molech]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Leviticus 20:5 (#4)

וְאֵ֥ת ׀ כָּל־הַזֹּנִ֖ים אַחֲרָ֑יו לִזְנ֞וֹת אַחֲרֵ֣י הַמֹּלֶךְ֮

“and all the people who practice prostitution after him, by prostituting after Molech”

Here Yahweh is speaking of those who are unfaithful to him and worship other gods as if they were **people who practice prostitution**. This implies a marriage between Yahweh and the people of Israel, such that Yahweh is like a husband and the people of Israel are like a wife. If your language has a similar metaphor to describe being religiously unfaithful in worship, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [and all the people who are unfaithful to Yahweh by choosing to worship Molech]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 20:6 (#1)

וְהַנֶּ֙פֶשׁ֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר תִּפְנֶ֔ה אֶל־הָאֹבֹ֖ת וְאֶל־הַיִּדְּעֹנִ֑ים

“And the person who turns to the mediums or to the spiritists”

This expression uses the idiom of turning to **mediums** and **spiritists** to refer to a person who decides to disregard Yahweh and his commandments and consult these means of talking to the dead instead. If your language has a similar idiom for religious disobedience, consider using it here. If not, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And the person who is unfaithful to Yahweh by consulting mediums or spiritists]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 20:6 (#2)

הָאֹבֹ֖ת & הַיִּדְּעֹנִ֑ים

“the mediums & the spiritists”

See how you how translated these terms in 19:31.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 20:6 (#3)

לִזְנוֹת אַחֲרֵיהֶם

“to practice prostitution after them”

Here those who are unfaithful to Yahweh and instead worship other gods are compared to prostitutes. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar expression in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [by choosing to worship Molech instead]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 20:6 (#4)

וְהִכְרַתִּי אֹתוֹ מִקֶּרֶב עַמּוֹ

“And I will cut him off from among his people”

The punishment for these behaviors is spoken of as if Yahweh were literally cutting off the individual from his people. It may be helpful to refer to how you handled the similar expression in 7:20.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 20:7 (#1)

כִּי֙ אֲנִ֣י יְהוָ֔ה אֱלֹהֵיכֶֽם

“because I {am} Yahweh your God”

The word translated as **because** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation (with a period before): [You should do this because I am Yahweh your God]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 20:8 (#2)

וּשְׁמַרְתֶּם֙ אֶת־חֻקֹּתַ֔י וַעֲשִׂיתֶ֖ם אֹתָ֑ם

“And you shall keep my statutes, and you shall do them”

The phrases **you shall keep my statutes** and **you shall do them** mean basically the same thing. They are used together in order to emphasize that the people must obey God. Alternate translation: [You must keep my statutes; indeed, you must do them diligently]

See: Parallelism

Leviticus 20:8 (#1)

וּשְׁמַרְתֶּם֙ אֶת־חֻקֹּתַ֔י וַעֲשִׂיתֶ֖ם & מְקַדִּשְׁכֶֽם

“And you shall keep my statutes, and you shall do & the one making you holy”

Here, **you** is plural. They refer to the people of Israel, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 20:9 (#1)

אִ֣ישׁ אִ֔ישׁ

“a man, a man”

Words are being repeated for emphasis. Specifically, **man** is repeated to refer to any person. Additionally, even though **man** is masculine, it is being used in a generic way that refers to both men and women. If your language can repeat words in a similar way, consider doing so here. If not, consider using a generic expression. See how you translated this repetition in 20:2. Alternate translation: [any person]

See: Reduplication

Leviticus 20:9 (#4)

דָּמָ֥יו בּ֖וֹ

“his blood {is} on him”

The phrase **his blood** represents the individual’s guilt for the bloodshed or death of the individual’s parents that his curse brings about. Additionally, this guilt is spoken of as being **on** the individual as if it were a burden that he must carry. If your language has a comparable expression that is used to speak of the legal requirement for an individual to be held responsible for their actions, consider using it here. If not, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he must be held responsible] or, to avoid the passive, [he must bear the bloodguilt he has acquired by his actions]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 20:9 (#3)

מָ֣וֹת יוּמָ֔ת

“dying—he shall be executed”

See how you handled this expression in 20:2.

See: Reduplication

Leviticus 20:9 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר יְקַלֵּל אֶת־אָבִיו וְאֶת־אִמּוֹ & אָבִיו וְאִמּוֹ קִלֵּל

“who curses his father or his mother & His father and his mother he has cursed”

Here the act of cursing one’s father or mother refers to speaking dishonorable and harmful words against one’s parents or to uttering a formalized sequence of words intended to bring about harm to one’s parents. Cursing one’s parents enacts a desire to see them harmed instead of a desire to care for them and honor them. (See 19:3) If your language has a word for this kind of harmful speech, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [who wishes harm on his father or his mother and so speaks dishonorably toward them … He has spoken harm toward his father and his mother]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 20:10 (#2)

מוֹת־יוּמַת

“dying & shall be executed”

See how you handled this expression in 20:2.

See: Reduplication

Leviticus 20:10 (#3)

הַנֹּאֵף וְהַנֹּאָפֶת

“the adulterer and the adulteress”

The words **adulterer** and **adulteress** refer to the man and woman who have committed adultery, respectively. You could state this explicitly in your translation if it would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the man and the woman who have committed adultery]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 20:10 (#1)

וְאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר יִנְאַף אֶת־אֵשֶׁת אִישׁ אֲשֶׁר יִנְאַף אֶת־אֵשֶׁת רֵעֵהוּ

“And a man who commits adultery {with} the wife of a man, who commits adultery {with} the wife of his neighbor”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing and emphasize that the man has committed **adultery** with another man’s **wife**. You can translate this parallelism into one statement that conveys the seriousness of these actions. Alternate translation: [And who ever commits adultery with another man’s wife, indeed, his neighbor’s wife]

See: Parallelism

Leviticus 20:11 (#3)

מוֹת־יוּמְתוּ שְׁנֵיהֶם

“Dying, both of them shall be executed”

See how you handled the similar expression in 20:2. Alternate translation: [Both of them shall certainly be executed] or, to avoid the passive construction [The people of Israel shall certainly execute both of them]

See: Reduplication

Leviticus 20:11 (#1)

וְאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר יִשְׁכַּב אֶת־אֵשֶׁת & אָבִיו

“And a man who lies with the wife of his father”

This is a polite way of speaking of sexual relations. Depending on what is helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And a man who sleeps with the wife of his father] or [And a man who has sexual relations with the wife of his father]

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 20:11 (#2)

עֶרְוַת אָבִיו גִּלָּה

“his father—he has uncovered the nakedness of”

See how you handled the similar expression in 18:6.

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 20:11 (#4)

דְּמֵיהֶם בָּם

“their blood {is} on them”

See how you handled the similar expression in 20:9.

See: Idiom

Leviticus 20:12 (#1)

וְאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר יִשְׁכַּב אֶת־כַּלָּתוֹ

“And a man who lies with his daughter-in-law”

This is a polite way of speaking of sexual relations. See how you handled the similar expression in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [And a man who sleeps with his daughter-in-law] or [And a man who has sexual relations with his daughter-in-law]

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 20:12 (#3)

מָמֹות יוּמָתוּ שְׁנֵיהֶם

“dying, both of them shall be executed”

See how you translated this exact phrase in 20:11.

See: Reduplication

Leviticus 20:12 (#4)

תֵּבֶל עָשׂוּ

“They have done perversion”

Here the abstract noun **perversion** refers to a behavior that is considered to be far outside the bounds of what Yahweh intends for people to do. If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **perversion**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [The thing they have done is perverted and disgusting] or [Such behavior is forbidden because it is so disgusting and perverse]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 20:12 (#2)

אֶת־כַּלָּתוֹ

“with his daughter-in-law”

A **daughter-in-law** is the wife of one’s son. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could include this information. Alternate translation: [with his son’s wife]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 20:12 (#5)

דְּמֵיהֶם בָּם

“their blood {is} on them”

See how you handled the similar expression in 20:9.

See: Idiom

Leviticus 20:13 (#1)

וְאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר יִשְׁכַּב אֶת־זָכָר מִשְׁכְּבֵי אִשָּׁה

“And a man who lies with a male, lying as a woman”

The expression **lying as a woman** represents sexual activity. In particular, it refers to a man having sexual relations with another man in the same manner in which he would have sexual relations with a woman. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state this in plain language. Alternate translation: [And a man who lies with a man as he would with a woman]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 20:13 (#3)

תּוֹעֵבָה עָשׂוּ שְׁנֵיהֶם

“both of them have done an abomination”

Here, the abstract noun **abomination** refers to a violation of the way that Yahweh intended his creation to be ordered. If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **abomination**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what both of them have done does not respect the way that God intends his creation to be ordered]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 20:13 (#2)

וְאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר יִשְׁכַּב אֶת־זָכָר

“And a man who lies with a male”

See how you handled this euphemism in 20:11.

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 20:13 (#4)

מָמֹות יוּמָתוּ

“Dying, they shall be executed”

See how you handled the similar expression in 20:2.

See: Reduplication

Leviticus 20:13 (#5)

דְּמֵיהֶם בָּם

“their blood {is} on them”

See how you handled the similar expression in 20:9.

See: Idiom

Leviticus 20:14 (#2)

זִמָּה הִוא & וְלֹא־תִהְיֶה זִמָּה בְּתוֹכְכֶם

“this {is} depravity & and depravity will not be in your midst”

The word **depravity** refers to behavior that flagrantly violates the way God has intended family units to function and family members to relate to one another. If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **depravity**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [such behavior is surely depraved ... and such depraved behavior will not be in your midst] or [such behavior does not reflect the way God wants family members to relate to one another ... and such despicable behavior will not be in your midst]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 20:14 (#1)

וְאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר יִקַּח אֶת־אִשָּׁה וְאֶת־אִמָּהּ

“And a man who takes a wife and her mother”

The expression **takes a wife and her mother** is either an idiom that refers to a man marrying both a woman and her mother or a euphemism that refers to a man having sexual relations with a woman and her mother. If possible, consider a translation that will allow for both possibilities. Alternate translation: [And a man who marries a woman and her mother] or [And a man who has sexual relations with both a woman and her mother]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 20:14 (#3)

בָּאֵשׁ יִשְׂרְפוּ אֹתוֹ וְאֶתְהֶן

“They shall burn him and them with fire”

Here the word **They** refers to the people of Israel, while the word **them** refers to the woman and her mother who have had sexual relations with the same man. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [The people of Israel shall burn the man and both women with fire]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 20:14 (#4)

בְּתוֹכְכֶם

“in your midst”

Here, **your** is plural. It refers to the people of Israel, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 20:15 (#1)

וְאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר יִתֵּתֶן שְׁכָבְתּוֹ בִּבְהֵמָה

“And a man who gives his layer in a livestock”

This is a euphemism for sexual activity. See how you translated the similar expressions in 18:20 and 18:23. Alternate translation: [And a man who has sexual relations with a livestock so that he ejaculates]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 20:15 (#2)

מוֹת יוּמָת

“dying, he shall be executed”

See how you handled the similar expression in 20:2.

See: Reduplication

Leviticus 20:15 (#3)

וְאֶת־הַבְּהֵמָה תַּהַרְגוּ

“and you shall kill the livestock”

Here, **you** is plural. It refers to the people of Israel, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 20:16 (#1)

וְאִשָּׁה אֲשֶׁר תִּקְרַב אֶל־כָּל־בְּהֵמָה לִרְבָעָה אֹתָהּ

“And a woman who draws near to any livestock to mate with it”

This is a polite but technical way of speaking of sexual activity between two animals. See how you translated a similar expression in 18:23. Alternate translation: [And a woman who draws near to any livestock to copulate with it] or [And a woman who draws near to any livestock to have sexual relations with it]

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 20:16 (#2)

וְהָרַגְתָּ אֶת־הָאִשָּׁה וְאֶת־הַבְּהֵמָה מוֹת יוּמָתוּ

“then you shall kill the woman and the livestock. Dying, they must be executed”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing and emphasize that people of Israel are to execute the woman and kill the animal who engages in this behavior. The first phrase states the idea more explicitly while the second phrase uses a generic expression. You can translate the phrases into one statement that conveys the seriousness of these actions. Alternate translation: [then you must execute the woman, yes, and even execute the livestock]

See: Parallelism

Leviticus 20:16 (#3)

מוֹת יוּמָתוּ

“Dying, they must be executed”

See how you handled the similar expression in 20:2.

See: Reduplication

Leviticus 20:16 (#4)

דְּמֵיהֶם בָּם

“their blood {is} on them”

See how you handled the similar expression in 20:9.

See: Idiom

Leviticus 20:17 (#4)

חֶסֶד הוּא

“it {is} a disgrace”

The word **disgrace** refers to behavior that flagrantly violates the way God has intended family units to function and family members to relate to one another. If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **disgrace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [such behavior is surely disgraceful] or [such behavior does not reflect the way God wants family members to relate to one another]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 20:17 (#6)

בְּנֵי עַמָּם

“the sons of their people”

Here the masculine term **sons** has a generic sense that includes all descendants, male and female. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language that is clearly inclusive of both sons and daughters. Alternate translation: [the children of their people]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Leviticus 20:17 (#2)

בַּת־אָבִיו אוֹ בַת־אִמּוֹ

“the daughter of his father or the daughter of his mother”

The implication is that a person cannot have sexual intercourse with his sister even if she has a different mother or father. You could include this information if it would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [your stepsister]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 20:17 (#5)

וְנִכְרְתוּ לְעֵינֵי בְּנֵי עַמָּם

“And they shall be cut off in the eyes of the sons of their people”

See how you translated the similar expression in 7:20. This expression uses the word **eyes** to refer to one’s attention and sight. If your language has a similar expression, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [And they should be excommunicated in the sight of the sons of their people] or, to avoid the passive form, [And the sons of the people should publicly remove them from their sight and refuse to have contact with them]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 20:17 (#7)

עֶרְוַת אֲחֹתוֹ גִּלָּה

“The nakedness of his sister he has uncovered”

See how you handled the similar expression in 18:6.

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 20:17 (#8)

עֲוֹנוֹ יִשָּׂא

“he shall bear his iniquity”

See how you handled the similar expression in 5:1.

See: Idiom

Leviticus 20:17 (#3)

וְרָאָה אֶת־עֶרְוָתָהּ וְהִיא־תִרְאֶה אֶת־עֶרְוָתוֹ

“and he sees her nakedness, and she herself sees his nakedness”

To **see** a person’s **nakedness** expresses a similar idea to uncovering one’s **nakedness**. It is implied that seeing another person’s nakedness disgraces and brings shame on both individuals. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they see one another naked and so bring shame on one another]

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 20:17 (#1)

וְאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר־יִקַּח אֶת־אֲחֹתוֹ

“And a man who takes his sister”

The expression **takes his sister** is either an idiom that refers to a man marrying his sister or a euphemism that refers to a man having sexual relations with his sister. If possible, consider a translation that will allow for both possibilities. Alternate translation: [And a man who marries his sister] or [And a man who has sexual relations with his sister]

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 20:18 (#5)

וְנִכְרְתוּ שְׁנֵיהֶם מִקֶּרֶב עַמָּם

“And {the} two of them shall be cut off from among their people”

See how you translated the similar expression in 7:20.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 20:18 (#1)

וְאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר־יִשְׁכַּב אֶת־אִשָּׁה דָּוָה

“And a man who lies with a sick woman”

See how you handled this euphemism in 20:11.

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 20:18 (#2)

אִשָּׁה דָּוָה

“a sick woman”

This expression does not refer to physical sickness but rather to a woman’s experience of normal menstruation. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could include this information. See how you translated the similar expression in 15:33. Alternate translation: [a woman who is experiencing her normal menstruation]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 20:18 (#3)

וְגִלְּלָה אֶת־עֶרְוָתָהּ

“and he has uncovered her nakedness”

See how you handled the similar expression in 18:6.

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 20:18 (#4)

אֶת־מְקֹרָהּ הֶעֱרָה וְהִוא גִּלְּתָה אֶת־מְקוֹר דָּמֶיהָ

“he has exposed her flow, and she herself has uncovered the flow of her blood”

The expressions **her flow** and the **the flow of her blood** refer to a woman’s genitals during her normal menstruation. Similar to the euphemism “to uncover one’s nakedness,” uncovering a woman’s genitals during menstruation is thought to bring shame on both her and the man involved. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could indicate this explicitly in your translation. Alternate translation: [he has exposed her genitals during her normal menstruation and so shamed her, and she has uncovered the source of her genital bleeding and so brought shame on herself]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 20:19 (#2)

כִּי אֶת־שְׁאֵרוֹ הֶעֱרָה

“because he would expose his body”

The word translated as **because** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation (with a period before): [He should not do this because he would expose his relative]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 20:19 (#3)

עֲוֹנָם יִשָּׂאוּ

“They shall carry their iniquity”

See how you handled the similar expression in 5:1.

See: Idiom

Leviticus 20:19 (#4)

עֲוֹנָם יִשָּׂאוּ

“They shall carry their iniquity”

See how you handled the similar expression in 5:1.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 20:19 (#1)

וְעֶרְוַת אֲחוֹת אִמְּךָ וַאֲחוֹת אָבִיךָ לֹא תְגַלֶּה

“And the nakedness of the sister of your mother or the sister of your father, you shall not uncover”

See how you handled the similar euphemism in 18:6.

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 20:20 (#1)

וְאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר יִשְׁכַּב אֶת־דֹּדָתוֹ

“And a man who lies with his aunt”

See how you handled this euphemism in 20:11.

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 20:20 (#2)

עֶרְוַת דֹּדוֹ גִּלָּה

“he has uncovered the nakedness of his uncle”

See how you handled the similar expression in 18:6.

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 20:20 (#3)

חֶטְאָם֙ יִשָּׂ֔אוּ

“They will bear their sin”

Similar to the expression “to bear one’s iniquity,” this expression speaks of carrying one’s **sin** as if it were a burden to carry. This means being held responsible for one’s wrongdoing. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [They shall be held responsible for their sin] or [They shall bear the guilt of their sin]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 20:21 (#3)

עֲרִירִ֖ים יִהְיוּ

“they will be childless”

Unlike the previous verse, in which a man who has sexual relations with his aunt is said to “die childless,” here both the man and the wife of his brother will **be childless**. These two expressions likely have the same meaning: both couples will die before they produce any children together. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if it would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [They shall die and not have any children]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 20:21 (#2)

עֶרְוַ֥ת אָחִ֛יו גִּלָּ֖ה

“He has uncovered the nakedness of his brother”

See how you handled the similar expression in 18:6.

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 20:21 (#1)

וְאִ֣ישׁ אֲשֶׁ֣ר יִקַּ֔ח אֶת־אֵ֖שֶׁת אָחִ֑יו

“And a man who takes the wife of his brother”

See how you translated the similar expression in 20:14.

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 20:22 (#2)

וְלֹא־תָקִ֥יא אֶתְכֶ֖ם הָאָֽרֶץ

“and the land & will not vomit you out”

Yahweh forcibly removing the people from **the land** is spoken of as if the land itself **vomited** the people out. If your language has a similar metaphor, consider using it here. If not, you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated this personification of the land in 18:25. Alternate translation: [and from the land … I will not forcibly remove you]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 20:22 (#3)

וְלֹא־תָקִ֥יא אֶתְכֶ֖ם הָאָ֑רֶץ אֲשֶׁ֨ר אֲנִ֤י מֵבִיא֙ אֶתְכֶ֣ם שָׁ֔מָּה לָשֶׁ֖בֶת בָּֽהּ

“and the land that I am bringing you there to dwell in it will not vomit you out”

Here, **the land** is described as if it were a living thing that could **vomit**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the land to which I am bringing you will not reject you]

See: Personification

Leviticus 20:22 (#1)

וּשְׁמַרְתֶּ֣ם & וַעֲשִׂיתֶ֣ם & אֶתְכֶ֖ם & אֶתְכֶֽם

“And you shall keep & And you shall do & you & you”

Here, **you** is plural. It refers to the people of Israel, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 20:23 (#3)

אֲשֶׁר־אֲנִ֥י מְשַׁלֵּ֖חַ מִפְּנֵיכֶ֑ם

“that I am sending out from before your face”

Here, **face** represents the presence of a person. In this expression, Yahweh is removing **the nation** that currently lives in the land from before Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that I am sending away from your presence] or [that I am sending from before you]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 20:23 (#1)

תֵּלְכ֖וּ & מִפְּנֵיכֶֽם

“you shall & walk & from before your face”

Here and throughout this chapter, the words **you** and **your** are plural. They refer to the people of Israel, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of 'You' — Singular

Leviticus 20:23 (#2)

וְלֹ֣א תֵלְכ֔וּ בְּחֻקַּ֖ת הַגּ֑וֹי

"And you shall not walk in the statutes of the nation"

Here, the word **walk** is used to describe a habitual lifestyle. In context, to **walk in the statutes of the nation** describes a practice of living that models itself after the practices of the people of the nations who live around Israel. If your language has a similar metaphor, consider using it here. If not, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And you shall not follow the statutes of the nation] or [And you shall not make a practice of living according to the statutes of the nation]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 20:24 (#3)

אֶ֣רֶץ זָבַ֤ת חָלָב֙ וּדְבָ֔שׁ

"a land flowing {with} milk and honey"

The phrase **a land flowing with milk and honey** is a common expression in that culture that means "a land with productive, fertile soil that produces good and abundant food." If this expression does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a very productive land] or [a land that produces abundant food]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 20:24 (#1)

וָאֹמַ֥ר לָכֶ֖ם אַתֶּ֣ם תִּירְשׁ֣וּ אֶת־אַדְמָתָ֑ם

"And I said to you, 'You yourselves will inherit their land"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation (with a period before): [And I told you that you yourselves will inherit their land]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Leviticus 20:24 (#2)

אַתֶּ֣ם תִּירְשׁ֣וּ אֶת־אַדְמָתָ֑ם

"You yourselves will inherit their land"

This expression uses the words **yourselves** to emphasize how significant it was that Israel would inherit the promised land. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this significance. Alternate translation: [Even you will inherit their land] or [It is you who will inherit their land]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Leviticus 20:25 (#1)

הַבְּהֵמָ֣ה הַטְּהֹרָה֮ & לַטָּהֹר֒

"the clean animal & and the clean"

See the chapter introduction for guidance on how to translate the word **clean** in this context.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 20:25 (#3)

וְלֹֽא־תְשַׁקְּצ֣וּ אֶת־נַפְשֹׁתֵיכֶ֗ם

"And you shall not make your lives detestable"

See how you translated the similar expression in 11:43.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 20:25 (#4)

וּבְכֹ֖ל אֲשֶׁ֣ר תִּרְמֹ֣שׂ הָאֲדָמָ֑ה

"or with anything that crawls on the ground"

See how you translated the similar expression in 11:44. Alternate translation: [or with any animals that crawl on the ground]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 20:25 (#2)

לַטָּמֵ֔א & הָע֖וֹף הַטָּמֵ֑א

"and the unclean & the unclean bird"

See the chapter introduction for guidance on how to translate the expressions **the unclean** and **the unclean bird** in this context.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 20:26 (#1)

כִּֽי־קָד֣וֹשׁ אֲנִ֔י יְהוָ֑ה

"because I Yahweh am holy"

The word translated as **because** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [for I Yahweh am holy]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 20:27 (#1)

אוֹב

“a medium”

See how you translated the words **medium** and **spiritist** in 19:31.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 20:27 (#2)

מוֹת יוּמָתוּ

“dying, they shall be executed”

See how you handled the similar expression in 20:2.

See: Reduplication

Leviticus 20:27 (#4)

דְּמֵיהֶם בָּם

“Their blood {is} on them”

See how you handled the similar expression in 20:9.

See: Idiom

Leviticus 20:27 (#3)

בָּאֶבֶן יִרְגְּמוּ אֹתָם

“They must stone them with stones”

Here, the word **They** refers to the people of Israel, while the word **them** refers to the people who consult a **medium** or **spiritist**. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [The people of Israel shall stone the people who consult mediums or spiritists with stones]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus - Chapter 21 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter gives special rules for priests. The structure is:

1. Rules for regular priests (21:1–9)
2. Contact with dead bodies (21:1–4)
3. Mourning practices (21:5–6)
4. Marriage rules (21:7–9)
5. Special rules for the high priest (21:10–15)
6. Physical requirements for priests (21:16–24)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Priestly purity
The chapter emphasizes keeping priests holy:

- They had stricter rules than ordinary people
- Their marriages affected their holiness
- Their physical appearance represented God’s perfection
- Even their family members’ behavior affected their status

Mourning restrictions
The chapter limits how priests could mourn:

- They could not touch dead bodies (except close relatives)
- They could not show typical signs of grief
- The high priest could not mourn even for parents

These rules kept priests ready for service.

Physical requirements
Physical perfection was required because:

- Priests represented God to the people
- Their appearance symbolized holiness
- Physical blemishes were seen as making someone unfit
- This did not affect their right to eat holy food

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Quotes within quotes
The chapter contains multiple levels of speech:

- Yahweh speaking to Moses
- Moses telling Aaron
- Instructions for future generations

Your language may need different ways to show these levels.

Metaphors and idioms
The chapter uses several expressions that need careful translation:

- “Fill his hand” means “give him authority as priest”
- “Profane the name” means “damage God’s reputation”

- "His seed" means "his descendants"
- "The bread of God" means "food offerings to God"

Body-related terms
The chapter mentions various physical conditions that may need explanation:

- "Hunchback" and "dwarf" may be unknown in your language
- "Blemish" refers to any physical condition making someone unfit for priesthood

(See: holy, holiness, unholy, sacred; priest, priesthood; and high priest, chief priest)

Leviticus 21:1 (#2)

אֱמֹ֗ר אֶל־הַכֹּהֲנִים֙ בְּנֵ֣י אַהֲרֹ֔ן וְאָמַרְתָּ֖ אֲלֵהֶ֑ם

"Say to the priests, the sons of Aaron, and you shall say to them"

The expressions **Say to the priests** and **you shall say to them** mean similar things. These two phrases are used together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [Tell the priests, the sons of Aaron]

See: Doublet

Leviticus 21:1 (#1)

וַיֹּ֤אמֶר יְהוָה֙ אֶל־מֹשֶׁ֔ה אֱמֹ֗ר אֶל־הַכֹּהֲנִים֙ בְּנֵ֣י אַהֲרֹ֔ן וְאָמַרְתָּ֖ אֲלֵהֶ֑ם

"And Yahweh said to Moses, "Say to the priests, the sons of Aaron, and you shall say to them"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [Yahweh told Moses to speak to the priests, the sons of Aaron, and to say to them that]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Leviticus 21:1 (#3)

לֹֽא־יִטַּמָּ֖א בְּעַמָּֽיו

"he shall not make himself unclean among his people"

Here the words **he** and **himself** and **his** refer to any priest. If it would be helpful in your language, you may clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [No priest should make himself unclean among his people]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 21:2 (#1)

לִשְׁאֵרֹ֑ו

"for his flesh"

Here, the word **his flesh** is being used to refer to someone who shares the same bloodline as someone else. In other words, **his flesh** refers to a close family member. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [for his close family member]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 21:3 (#1)

וְלַאֲחֹתֹ֥ו הַבְּתוּלָ֖ה

"or for his virgin sister"

The word translated as **virgin** refers to a young woman of marriageable age who has not yet had sexual relations. If your language has a specific word for a woman of this social group, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [or for his unmarried sister]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 21:4 (#1)

לְהֵחָלֹֽו

"to profane himself"

The words translated as **to** indicate that what follows is a result of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a result of what came before. Alternate translation: [with the result that he profanes himself]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 21:5 (#1)

לֹֽא־יקרחה קָרְחָ֣ה בְרֹאשָׁ֗ם וּפְאַ֤ת זְקָנָם֙ לֹ֣א יְגַלֵּ֔חוּ וּבִבְשָׂרָ֖ם לֹ֣א יִשְׂרְטָ֑טוּ שָׂרָטֶֽת

"They shall not bald a bald patch on their heads, and the edges of their beard they shall not shave, and they shall not cut a cut in their flesh"

Here and in the next verse, the words **they** and **their** refer to all the priests of Israel. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [The priests of Israel shall not bald a bald patch on their heads, and the edges of their beard they shall not shave, and they shall not cut a cut in their flesh]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 21:5 (#3)

לֹא־יקרחה קָרְחָהּ בְּרֹאשָׁם

“They shall not bald a bald patch on their heads”

Words are being repeated for emphasis. Specifically, the noun **bald patch** comes from the same root as the verb **bald**. If your language can repeat words in a similar way, consider doing so here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [They shall not shave the crown of their heads]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 21:5 (#2)

לֹא־יקרחה קָרְחָהּ בְּרֹאשָׁם וּפְאַת זְקָנָם לֹא יְגַלֵּחוּ

“They shall not bald a bald patch on their heads, and the edges of their beard they shall not shave”

These expressions describe the mourning rituals practiced by the people of the nations who surrounded Israel. Because of their role as priests to Yahweh, the priests of Israel were not to mourn like the priests of other nations. Doing so would associate Yahweh’s holy space with the idolatry of the other nations and profane it (as the next verse indicates). If it would be helpful in your language, consider supplying this information in a footnote or in the text of your translation, as the UST models.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 21:5 (#4)

וּבִבְשָׂרָם לֹא יִשְׂרְטוּ שָׂרָטֶת

“and they shall not cut a cut in their flesh”

Words are being repeated for emphasis. Specifically, the noun **cut** comes from the same root as the verb **cut**. If your language can repeat words in a similar way, consider doing so here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [They shall not cut themselves]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 21:6 (#1)

וְלֹא יְחַלְּלוּ שֵׁשֵׁם אֱלֹהֵיהֶם

“and they shall not profane the name of their God”

This word **name** is used to represent Yahweh’s character. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and they must not disgrace God’s reputation] or [and they must not disgrace their God]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 21:6 (#4)

לֶחֶם אֱלֹהֵיהֶם

“the bread of their God”

This expression uses one kind of food, **bread**, to represent food in general. Furthermore, this expression uses the possessive form to describe bread (that is, food) that is characterized by the fact that it is offered to God. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the gifts of food that people offer to their God]

See: Synecdoche

Leviticus 21:6 (#2)

כִּי

“for”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation (with a period before): [This is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 21:6 (#3)

אֶת־אִשֵּׁי יְהוָה לֶחֶם אֱלֹהֵיהֶם הֵם מַקְרִיבִם

“they are presenting gifts of Yahweh, the bread of their God”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The phrase **the bread of their God** clarifies the meaning of the phrase **gifts of Yahweh**. You can translate this parallelism into one statement that conveys this relationship. Alternate translation: [they are presenting the gifts of Yahweh, that is, the bread of their God] or [they are presenting the food gifts offered to Yahweh, their God]

See: Parallelism

Leviticus 21:6 (#5)

וְהָיוּ קְדֹשׁ

“and they shall be holy”

Alternate translation: [and so they must be holy]

Leviticus 21:7 (#2)

לֹא יִקָּחוּ & לֹא יִקָּחוּ

“He shall not take & he shall not take”

The phrase **He shall not take** is a polite way of referring to sexual relations with a woman, but it is also a common expression that means “to marry.” If this phrase does not have this meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [He shall not marry ... nor shall he marry] or [He shall not have sexual relations with ... nor shall he have sexual relations with]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 21:7 (#1)

לֹא יִקָּ֔חוּ & לֹ֣א יִקְח֔וּ כִּי־קָד֥וֹשׁ הוּא֙ לֵאלֹהָ֔יו

“He shall not take & he shall not take & for he {is} holy to his God”

Here and throughout the next few verses, the words **he** and **his** refer to any priest in Israel. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [No priest shall take ... nor shall he take ... for that priest is holy to his God]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 21:7 (#3)

כִּ֣י

“for”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation (with a period before): [This is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 21:8 (#2)

אֶת־לֶ֥חֶם אֱלֹהֶ֖יךָ

“the bread of your God”

See how you translated this expression in 21:6.

See: Synecdoche

Leviticus 21:8 (#4)

כִּֽי־

“because”

The word translated as **because** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation (with a period before): [This is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 21:8 (#1)

וְקִדַּשְׁתּ֖וֹ כִּי־אֶת־לֶ֣חֶם אֱלֹהֶ֗יךָ הֽוּא֙ מַקְרִ֔יב קָד֥וֹשׁ יִהְיֶה־לָּ֖ךְ

“And you shall make him holy, for he is the one presenting the bread of your God. He shall be holy for you”

Here, **you** is singular and refers to Moses, the one to whom Yahweh is speaking. The words **he** and **him** refer to a priest. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And you, Moses, shall make the priest holy, for he is the one presenting the bread of your God. That priest shall be holy for you, Moses]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 21:8 (#3)

כִּֽי־קָד֣וֹשׁ אֲנִ֔י יְהוָ֖ה מְקַדִּשְׁכֶֽם

“because holy {am} I, Yahweh, the one making you holy”

The word **you** here is plural and refers either to the priests or to the people of Israel. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [because holy am I, Yahweh, the one making the priests holy] or [because holy am I, Yahweh, the one making the people of Israel holy]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 21:9 (#1)

וּבַ֣ת אִ֔ישׁ כֹּהֵ֖ן

“And a daughter of a man, a priest”

Alternate translation: [And a priests’s daughter]

Leviticus 21:9 (#3)

בָּאֵ֥שׁ תִּשָּׂרֵ֖ף

“She must be burned with fire”

This expression indicates a form of capital punishment whereby an individual is executed by being publicly burned alive. Additionally, it may be helpful to see how you handled the extra information in this expression in 6:30. Furthermore, if your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [The people of Israel shall publicly burn her to death]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 21:9 (#2)

כִּֽי־תֵחֵ֥ל לִזְנ֖וֹת

“when she is profaned by prostituting”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [when she profanes herself by prostituting herself]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 21:10 (#4)

וּמְלֵ֣א אֶת־יָד֔וֹ

“and whose hand is filled”

The phrase **whose hand is filled** is a common expression that means to induct someone into the ministry and responsibilities of the priesthood. According to this verse, God has given the high priest the responsibilities of serving and worshiping him. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and to whom I, Yahweh, have given the responsibilities of the priesthood]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 21:10 (#1)

אֲשֶׁר־יוּצַ֤ק עַל־רֹאשׁוֹ֙ ׀ שֶׁ֣מֶן הַמִּשְׁחָ֔ה

“on whose head the oil of anointing was poured”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [on whose head the priests poured anointing oil]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 21:10 (#2)

שֶׁ֣מֶן הַמִּשְׁחָ֔ה

“the oil of anointing”

See how you translated this expression in 8:2.

See: Possession

Leviticus 21:10 (#3)

וּמִלֵּ֣א אֶת־יָד֔וֹ לִלְבֹּ֖שׁ אֶת־הַבְּגָדִֽים

“and whose hand is filled to wear the clothing”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [whose hand God filled to wear the clothes]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 21:10 (#5)

אֶת־רֹאשׁוֹ֙ לֹ֣א יִפְרָ֔ע וּבְגָדָ֖יו לֹ֣א יִפְרֹֽם

“his head he shall not let be unbound, and his clothes he shall not tear”

Loose hair and torn **clothes** were signs of mourning. The high priests of Yahweh were not to mourn for their dead relatives in any way that would disrupt their duties of offering Israel’s sacrifices. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly in a footnote or in the text of your translation. Alternate translation: [he must not allow himself to be distracted from his priestly duties by mourning for his dead relatives]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 21:10 (#6)

אֶת־רֹאשׁוֹ֙ לֹ֣א יִפְרָ֔ע

“his head he shall not let be unbound”

Here, **head** represents the hair on the head. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his hair he shall not let be unbound] or [he shall not let his hair be disheveled]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 21:11 (#1)

וְעַ֖ל כָּל־נַפְשֹׁ֣ת מֵתֶ֑ת לֹ֥א יָבֹ֖א לְאָבִ֥יו וּלְאִמּ֖וֹ לֹ֥א יִטַּמָּֽא

“And near any dead person, he shall not go, for his father or for his mother. He shall not make himself unclean”

Here and throughout the next verses, the words **he** and **his** refer to the high priest. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And near any dead person, the high priest shall not go—for his father or for his mother. The high priest shall not make himself unclean]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 21:12 (#3)

שֶׁ֣מֶן מִשְׁחַ֣ת

“the oil of the anointing of”

See how you translated this expression in 8:2.

See: Possession

Leviticus 21:12 (#1)

כִּֽי

“for”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation (with a period before): [This is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 21:12 (#2)

נֵ֣זֶר שֶׁ֣מֶן מִשְׁחַ֣ת אֱלֹהָ֔יו עָלָ֖יו

“the crown of the oil of the anointing of his God {is} on him”

This expression uses the image of a **crown** to describe the **oil of the anointing of his God** that was poured on the high priest’s head to appoint him as the high priest. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [on his head is the oil of anointing that God used to appoint him, which he should consider to be like a crown]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 21:13 (#1)

בִּבְתוּלֶ֖יהָ

“in her virginity”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **virginity**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [while she is still a virgin] or [when she has not yet had sexual relations]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 21:15 (#2)

כִּֽי

“For”

The word translated as **For** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [This is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 21:15 (#1)

וְלֹא־יְחַלֵּ֥ל זַרְע֖וֹ בְּעַמָּ֑יו

“And he shall not profane his seed among his people”

Here the word **seed** is a reference to one’s children. Whether semen was thought of to resemble plant seed is unclear, although the same word is used to refer to both (see 11:37 and 15:16 for reference). This expression implies that by marrying an unholy or ungodly woman, the priest would have children unworthy to be a priest. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And he shall not profane his children among his people]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 21:16 (#1)

לֵאמֹֽר

“saying”

The word translated as **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, consider ways in which you might introduce this quotation naturally in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Leviticus 21:16–17 (#1)

לֵאמֹ֕ר: דַּבֵּ֖ר אֶל־אַהֲרֹ֣ן לֵאמֹ֑ר

“saying, “Speak to Aaron, saying”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation (with a period before): [He told Moses to tell Aaron that]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Leviticus 21:17 (#1)

אִ֣ישׁ מִזַּרְעֲךָ֔

“A man from your seed”

Here the word **seed** is a reference to one’s children. Whether semen was thought of to resemble plant seed is unclear, although the same word is used to refer to both. (See 11:37 and 15:16 for reference.) If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [A man from your children] or [One of your male children]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 21:17 (#3)

לֹ֣א יִקְרַ֔ב לְהַקְרִ֖יב

“shall not draw near to present”

Here the verb **present** comes from the same root as the verb **draw near**. This construction is used for emphasis. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing emphasis. Alternate translation: [shall not ever draw near to present] or [should never approach the altar in order to present]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 21:17 (#2)

לְדֹרֹתָ֑ם

“to their generations”

The phrase **to their generations** refers to the descendants of Aaron who will be priests. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [throughout the generations of the descendants of Aaron who will be priests]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 21:17 (#4)

לֶ֖חֶם אֱלֹהָ֥יו

“the bread of his God”

See how you translated the similar expression in 21:6.

See: Synecdoche

Leviticus 21:18 (#3)

שָׂר֥וּעַ

“extended”

This expression likely refers to a person who is born with a defect in which one leg is longer than another. If it would be helpful for your readers, you could include this information. Alternate translation: [with an extended leg] or [who has one leg that is longer than the other]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 21:18 (#1)

כִּ֣י

“For”

The word translated as **For** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [This is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 21:18 (#2)

לֹ֣א יִקְרָ֔ב

“shall not draw near”

This expression leaves out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [shall not draw near to the altar to offer a sacrifice]

See: Ellipsis

Leviticus 21:20 (#1)

גִּבֵּ֖ן

“a hunchback”

The word **hunchback** refers to a person whose spine is misshapen and so possesses a hunched or bent back. If your language has a specific term for this form of disability, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [a person whose spine is misshapen] or [a person born with a bent back]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 21:20 (#2)

דַּ֥ק

“a dwarf”

The word **dwarf** here refers to a person who is born with a genetic defect that causes them to be considerably shorter than what is considered normal height. This disability can also sometimes cause other health issues. If your language has a specific word for this form of disability, consider using it here. If not, consider using a generic expression. Alternate translation: [a person who is considerably shorter than normal] or [an unusually short person]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 21:21 (#1)

מִזֶּ֣רַע אַהֲרֹ֔ן

“from the seed of Aaron”

See how you translated the word **seed** in 21:15. Alternate translation: [from the children of Aaron] or [from the descendants of Aaron]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 21:21 (#2)

אֶת־אִשֵּׁי יְהוָה

“the gift of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:2.

See: Possession

Leviticus 21:21 (#3)

אֵאֵת לֶ֣חֶם אֱלֹהָ֔יו

“the bread of his God”

See how you translated the similar expression in 21:6.

See: Synecdoche

Leviticus 21:22 (#3)

יֹאכֵל

“he may eat”

Here the word **he** refers to the priest with the bodily blemish. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the priest with a blemish may eat]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 21:22 (#2)

מִקָּדְשֵׁי הַקָּדָשִׁים וּמִן־הַקֳּדָשִׁים

“from the holy things of the holy things and from the holy things”

Different offering and sacrifices were designated as food for the priests. These portions of food were called **the holy things of the holy things** and **the holy things**. It may be helpful to see how you translated the similar expression in 6:17. Alternate translation: [from the most holy portions of food or from the holy portions of food]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 21:22 (#1)

לֶ֣חֶם אֱלֹהָ֔יו

“The bread of his God”

See how you translated the similar expression in 21:6.

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 21:23 (#1)

אֶל־הַפָּרֹכֶת לֹ֥א יָבֹ֖א

“he shall not enter into the curtain”

To **enter into the curtain** means to pass through the curtain dividing the holy place from the most holy place in the sanctuary. No priest with a blemish was permitted to approach God in the most holy place. You could include this information if it would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [he shall not pass through the curtain into the holy of holies]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 21:23 (#2)

כִּי & כִּֽי־

“for & for”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation (with a period before): [This is because ... This is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 21:23 (#3)

מְקַדְּשָׁם

“the one making them holy”

Here the word **them** refers to the priests who have blemishes and so cannot approach Yahweh’s altar to offer sacrifices. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the one making holy even the priests who have blemishes]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 21:24 (#2)

וְאֶל־כָּל־בְּנֵ֥י יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“and to all the sons of Israel”

See how you translated this expression in 4:2.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 21:24 (#1)

וְאֶל־בָּנָ֖יו

“and to his sons”

The word **his** refers to Aaron and not to Moses. If it would be helpful for your readers, consider using

Aaron's name here. Alternate translation: [and to Aaron's sons]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus - Chapter 22 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter gives rules about who can eat holy food and what animals can be offered. The structure is:

(1) Rules about eating holy food (22:1–16)

1. Unclean priests (22:1–9)
2. Non-priests (22:10–16)

(2) Rules about acceptable sacrifices (22:17–33)

1. Animals without defects (22:17–25)
2. Age and timing rules (22:26–33)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Holy food
The chapter has strict rules about holy food:

- Only priests and their households could eat it
- Unclean priests could not eat it until they became clean again
- Daughters who married non-priests could no longer eat it
- Accidentally eating it required payment plus 20%

Acceptable sacrifices
The chapter defines what makes an animal acceptable:

- Must be physically perfect
- Must be at least 8 days old
- Cannot be castrated
- Cannot be from foreigners

These rules showed respect for God's holiness.

Household membership
The chapter shows how household status affected rights:

- Priests' slaves could eat holy food
- Hired workers could not
- Daughters' rights changed with marriage

This reflected the importance of family structure.

(See: holy, holiness, unholy, sacred)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Quotes within quotes
The chapter contains multiple levels of speech:

- Yahweh speaking to Moses
- Moses telling Aaron and his sons
- Instructions for all Israelites

Your language may need different ways to show these levels.

Metaphors and idioms
The chapter uses several expressions that need careful translation:

- "The bread of God" means "food offerings to God"
- "From the hand of a foreigner" means "from a foreigner"
- "Under its mother" means "with its nursing mother"
- "His seed" means "his descendants"

Body and family terms
The chapter uses terms that may need explanation:

- "Body" often means the whole person
- "Flesh" refers to the physical body
- "House" means family or household
- "Sojourner" means temporary resident

Leviticus 22:1 (#1)

לֵאמֹֽר

"saying"

The word translated as **saying** introduces a direct quotation. Consider natural ways of introducing direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Leviticus 22:2 (#1)

מִקָּדְשֵׁי֙ בְּנֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

"from the holy things of the sons of Israel"

This expression uses the possessive form to describe **holy things** (sacrificial food offerings) that the **sons of Israel** offer to Yahweh as sacrifices. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [the holy things that the sons of Israel offer to Yahweh]

See: Possession

Leviticus 22:2 (#4)

אֶת־שֵׁשֵׁם קָדְשִׁשֵׁי

“the name of my holiness”

This expression uses the possessive form to describe Yahweh’s **name** (his reputation as God) that is characterized by **holiness**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [my holy name] or [my sacred reputation]

See: Possession

Leviticus 22:2 (#2)

בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the sons of Israel”

See how you handled this metaphor for the people of Israel in 1:2.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 22:2 (#3)

וְלֹא יְחַלְּלוּ אֶת־שֵׁשֵׁם קָדְשִׁשֵׁי

“and they shall not profane the name of my holiness”

Here, the word **name** represents Yahweh’s reputation and, by extension, Yahweh himself. So to **profane** this **name** is to associate Yahweh who is holy with that which is not only not holy, but abominable and detestable, like child sacrifice. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. See how you translated this expression in 20:3. Alternate translation: [and they shall not publicly defame me] or [and they shall not openly denigrate my reputation]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 22:3 (#6)

וְטֻמְאָתוֹ עָלָיו

“and his uncleanness {is} on him”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **uncleanness**, you could express the same idea in another way. It may be helpful to see how you translated this abstract noun in 5:3. Alternate translation: [while he is unclean] or [and he is unclean]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 22:3 (#7)

וְנִכְרְתָה הַנֶּפֶשׁ הַהִוא מִלְּפָנַי

“that person shall be cut off from before my face”

See how you translated the similar expression in 7:20.

See: Idiom

Leviticus 22:3 (#4)

מִכָּל־זַרְעֲכֶם

“from all your seed”

This expression uses the word **seed** to refer to one’s children. Whether semen was thought of to resemble plant seed is unclear, although the same word is used to refer to both (see 11:37 and 15:16 for reference). If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated this metaphor in 20:2. Alternate translation: [from all your children] or [from all your descendants]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 22:3 (#2)

לְדֹרֹתֵיכֶם & מִכָּל־זַרְעֲכֶם

“To your generations & from all your seed”

Here, the word **your** is plural and refers to the Israelite priests, the male descendants of Aaron. If you chose to make this verse indirect speech (as the previous note suggested), it may be helpful to change the second-person pronouns to the third person. Alternate translation: [to their generations … from all their seed]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Leviticus 22:3 (#3)

כָּל־אִישׁ

“any man”

Here the word **man** refers to any male descendant of Aaron who serves as a priest. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [any priest]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 22:3 (#5)

אֶל־הַקֳּדָשִׁים אֲשֶׁר יַקְדִּישׁוּ בְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל לַיהוָה

“to the holy things that the sons of Israel have made holy to Yahweh”

Here a verb and its object come from the same root. The phrase **have made holy** translates a verb that is related to the noun translated as **holy things**. The repetition of related words adds emphasis to the statement. You may be able to use the same construc-

tion in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing emphasis. Alternate translation: [to the holy things that the sons of Israel are presenting to Yahweh as holy offerings]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 22:3 (#1)

אֱמֹ֣ר אֲלֵהֶ֗ם לְדֹרֹֽתֵיכֶם֮

“Say to them, ‘To your generations”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Tell them that to their generations]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Leviticus 22:3 (#8)

מִלְּפָנַ֔י

“from before my face”

Here, **face** represents the presence of a person. In this expression, the priest who offers sacrifices while he is unclean must be removed from Yahweh’s presence —that is, he must be exiled. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from my presence] or [from the place where I live among the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 22:4 (#1)

אִ֣ישׁ אִ֣ישׁ

“A man, a man”

Here the word **man** refers to any priest. See how you handled the repetition of the word **man** in 15:2. Alternate translation: [Any priest]

See: Reduplication

Leviticus 22:4 (#6)

אִ֣ישׁ אֲשֶׁר־תֵּצֵ֗א מִמֶּ֙נּוּ֙ שִׁכְבַ֣ת־זָ֔רַע

“a man who has go out from him a lying of seed”

See how you translated the similar expression in 15:16.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 22:4 (#2)

מִזֶּ֖רַע אַהֲרֹ֑ן

“from the seed of Aaron”

See how you handled this metaphor for descendants in 20:2. Alternate translation: [from the children of Aaron] or [from Aaron’s descendants]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 22:4 (#3)

וְהוּא֙ צָרוּעַ֙ א֣וֹ זָ֔ב

“and he {is} skin diseased or flowing”

The terms **skin diseased** and **flowing** refer to various kinds of visible, infectious skin diseases. See how you translated the expression **skin diseased** in 13:44. Similarly, see how you translated the word **flowing** in 15:2.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 22:4 (#4)

וְהַנֹּגֵ֥עַ בְּכָל־טְמֵ֖א

“And the one touching anything unclean of”

This expression refers generally to any priest who touches something **unclean**, not to a specific priest. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [And any priest who touches anything unclean]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 22:4 (#5)

בְּכָל־טְמֵא־נָ֔פֶשׁ

“anything unclean of a person”

This expression uses the possessive form to describe **anything unclean** that has a human source, whether an unclean person or a discharge or blood that has come from a person. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [anything unclean that has come from a person] or [any unclean person]

See: Possession

Leviticus 22:5 (#2)

לְכֹל֙ טֻמְאָת֔וֹ

“whatever his uncleanness”

Here the word **his** refers to the unclean person whom the priest touches. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [whatever that person’s uncleanness]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 22:5 (#1)

אוֹ בְאָדָם אֲשֶׁר יִטְמָא־לוֹ

“or a person who makes him unclean”

The expression **or a person who makes him unclean** leaves out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [or a man who touches a person who makes him unclean] or [or a priest who touches a person who makes him unclean]

See: Ellipsis

Leviticus 22:5 (#3)

לְכֹל טֻמְאָתוֹ

“whatever his uncleanness”

See how you handled the abstract noun **uncleanness** in 5:3.

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 22:6 (#1)

בּוֹ

“it”

Here the word **it** refers to any of the previously listed unclean things that a priest might touch and become unclean. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [any of these unclean things]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 22:6 (#2)

רָחַץ בְּשָׂרוֹ בַּמָּיִם

“he washes his body with the water”

Here the word **flesh** refers to a person’s body. Additionally, see how you handled the extra information in the similar expression in 1:9. Alternate translation: [he washes himself]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 22:7 (#2)

כִּי

“because”

The word translated as **because** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation (with a period before): [This is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 22:7 (#1)

וּבָא הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ

“And the sun will go”

This is a common expression that refers to the **sun** setting at the end of the day. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And when the sun sets]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 22:9 (#3)

וְלֹא־יִשְׂאוּ עָלָיו חֵטְא וּמֵתוּ בּוֹ כִּי יְחַלְּלֻהוּ

“and they shall not bear sin with regard to it and die by it, because they profaned it”

Here the word **it** refers to the **watch** of Yahweh, that is, Yahweh’s commands to avoid contact with unclean things while performing sacrificial duties. If it would be helpful to your readers, consider stating this plainly. Alternate translation: [and the priests shall not carry sin with regard to what I have told them to avoid and therefore die because they did what I told them to avoid, thus profaning my commands to them]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 22:9 (#4)

וְלֹא־יִשְׂאוּ עָלָיו חֵטְא

“and they shall not bear sin with regard to it”

Here, **they shall not bear sin** is a common expression that refers to a priest being held responsible for their sin or wrongdoing. If that phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they shall not sin with regard to it]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 22:9 (#5)

כִּי

“because”

The word translated as **because** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what

follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation (with a period before): [They would die because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 22:9 (#1)

וְשָׁמְרוּ & וְלֹא־יִשְׂאוּ & יְחַלְּלֻהוּ & מְקַדְּשָׁם

“And they shall keep & and they shall not bear & they profaned it & the one making them holy”

Here the book of Leviticus switches from describing one hypothetical priest to describing the priesthood as a whole. As such, the words **they** and **them** refer to the Israelite priests. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [And the priests shall keep … and the priests shall not carry … they profaned it … the one making the priests holy]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 22:9 (#2)

וְשָׁמְרוּ אֶת־מִשְׁמַרְתִּתִי

“And they shall keep my watch”

See how you translated this expression in 8:35 and 18:30.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 22:10 (#2)

תּוֹשַׁב כֹּהֵן

“A dweller of the priest”

This expression uses the possessive form to describe a **dweller** (that is, a traveling guest) that is characterized by their receiving the hospitality of **the priest**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a generic expression. Alternate translation: [A traveling guest of the priest] or [A traveler who is staying at the priest’s home]

See: Possession

Leviticus 22:10 (#1)

קֹדֶשׁ & קֹדֶשׁ

“the holy thing & the holy thing”

Here, the expression **the holy thing** refers to any gift of food that the Israelites have sacrificed and offered to Yahweh, not to a specific food gift. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [any holy thing … any holy thing]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 22:11 (#1)

כִּי־יִקְנֶה נֶקֶשׁ קִנְיַן כַּסְפּוֹ

“when he buys a person, the property of his silver”

This expression uses the possessive form to describe a slave who is **property** characterized by their having been bought by the priest’s **silver**, that is, his money. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a generic expression. Additionally, here, **silver** represents any money or currency by which a priest would purchase a slave. If it would be helpful in your language, consider stating the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when he buys a person and they become his property that he purchased with his money] or [when he buys a person with his own money and they become his property]

See: Possession

Leviticus 22:11 (#4)

וְיִלְיַד בֵּיתוֹ הֵם יֹאכְלוּ בַלַּחְמוֹ

“And one born of his house, they themselves may eat his bread”

Here, the word **his** refers to a priest, while the phrase **the one born of his house** refers to a child who is born from a slave residing in the priest’s household. This expression uses the plural **they** to refer to this slave, perhaps including the mother who gave birth to him or her. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making these explicit. Alternate translation: [And a slave who is born into a priest’s household—he and his parents may eat the priest’s bread]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 22:11 (#5)

בַּלַּחְמוֹ

“his bread”

Here, **bread** represents the sacred portions of food that the priests received from the food gifts that the people of Israel offered to Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his food]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 22:11 (#2)

הוּא יֹאכַל & הֵם יֹאכְלוּ

“he himself may eat & they themselves may eat”

These expressions use the words **himself** and **themselves** to emphasize how significant it was that these slaves are permitted to eat the priest's holy food. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this significance. Alternate translation: [even he may eat ... they also may eat]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Leviticus 22:11 (#3)

הוּא יֹאכַל

"he himself may eat"

Here, the word **he** refers to the slave that the priest purchased, not to the priest. If it would be helpful for your readers, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [that slave may eat]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 22:12 (#1)

הִוא בִּתְרוּמַת הַקֳּדָשִׁים לֹא תֹאכֵל

"she herself may not eat the contribution of the holy things"

This expression uses the word **herself** to emphasize how significant it was that the daughter of a priest is not permitted to eat her father's holy food after her marriage. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this significance. Alternate translation: [not even she may eat the contribution of the holy things]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Leviticus 22:12 (#2)

בִּתְרוּמַת הַקֳּדָשִׁים

"the contribution of the holy things"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **contribution**, you can express the same idea another way. Alternate translation: [the holy things that the people of Israel have contributed]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 22:13 (#1)

וְזֶרַע אֵין לָהּ

"and there is no seed for her"

See how you handled this metaphor for descendants in 20:2. Alternate translation: [and she has no children]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 22:13 (#2)

מִלֶּחֶם אָבִיהָ

"from the bread of her father"

Here, **bread** represents the sacred portions of food that the priests received from the food gifts that the people of Israel offered to Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from her father's food]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 22:13 (#3)

וְכָל־זָר לֹא־יֹאכַל בּוֹ

"And any stranger may not eat it"

Alternate translation: [And no stranger may eat it]

Leviticus 22:14 (#4)

חֲמִשִּׁיתוֹ

"its fifth"

The term **its fifth** refers to one part out of five equal parts.

See: Fractions

Leviticus 22:14 (#3)

וְיָסַף חֲמִשִּׁיתוֹ עָלָיו

"then he shall add its fifth on it"

Here, **shall add its fifth on it** is a common expression that refers to adding one-fifth of the monetary value of a sacred food item to its total value. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [then he shall take the total monetary value of the food item plus one–fifth]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 22:14 (#2)

וְיָסַף חֲמִשִּׁיתוֹ עָלָיו וְנָתַתָּן לַכֹּהֵן אֶת־הַקֹּדֶשׁ

"then he shall add its fifth on it, and he shall give the holy thing to the priest"

This could mean: (1) that the person had to replace the food that he had eaten with the same kind of food or (2) that the person had to pay money to the priest for the food that he had eaten.

Leviticus 22:14 (#1)

וְאִ֣ישׁ

“And a man”

Although the term **man** is masculine, here it is used in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [And a person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Leviticus 22:15 (#1)

וְלֹ֣א יְחַלְּל֗וּ & אֵ֚את אֲשֶׁר־יָרִ֣ימוּ

“And they shall not profane & that which they raise”

Here, the pronoun **they** refers to the people of Israel. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the people of Israel shall not profane ... that which the people of Israel raise]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 22:15 (#2)

אֶת־קָדְשֵׁ֣י בְנֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

“the holy things of the sons of Israel”

See how you translated this expression in 22:2.

See: Possession

Leviticus 22:15 (#3)

בְּנֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

“the sons of Israel”

See how you handled this metaphor for the people of Israel in 1:2.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 22:15 (#4)

אֵ֚את אֲשֶׁר־יָרִ֣ימוּ

“that which they raise”

Here, the word **raise** refers to the ritual gesture of lifting up an offering to Yahweh. If your language has a word for this kind of ritual gesture, consider using it here. You could also explain the significance of this action in the text or a footnote. Alternate translation: [that which they present] or [that which they offer]

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 22:15 (#5)

לַֽיהוָ֑ה

“to Yahweh”

Yahweh is speaking about himself in the third person. If this would not be natural in your language, you could use the first-person form. Alternate translation: [to me, Yahweh]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Leviticus 22:16 (#1)

וְהִשְּׂא֥וּ אוֹתָ֖ם עֲוֹ֣ן אַשְׁמָ֑ה

“or they shall cause themselves to bear the iniquity of guilt”

Here, **to bear the iniquity of guilt** is a common expression that refers to guilt as a physical object that needs to be carried. Because **guilt** in Leviticus can refer to both the legal status of needing to provide restitution for wrongdoing or the punishment by which restitution is provided, this expression could mean: (1) the people of Israel would become guilty and so responsible for their sin. Alternate translation: [or they shall be guilty of the sin that they committed] or (2) the word **guilt** is a metonym for punishment for the sin that they committed. Alternate translation: [or they shall receive the punishment that they deserve when they committed wrongdoing]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 22:16 (#2)

בְּאָכְלָ֖ם אֶת־קָדְשֵׁיהֶ֑ם

“by their eating their holy things”

Alternate translation: [when they ate their holy things]

Leviticus 22:16 (#3)

כִּֽי־

“For”

The word translated as **For** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [This is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 22:17–18 (#1)

לֵּאמֹ֥ר׃ דַּבֵּ֛ר אֶל־אַהֲרֹ֥ן וְאֶל־בָּנָ֖יו וְאֶל֣ כָּל־בְּנֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל וְאָמַרְתָּ֣ אֲלֵהֶ֔ם

“saying, “Speak to Aaron and to his sons and to all the sons of Israel, and you shall say to them”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [Speak to Aaron and to his sons and to all the sons of Israel, and tell them that]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Leviticus 22:18 (#5)

אֲשֶׁ֣ר יַקְרִ֣יב קָרְבָּנ֔וֹ

“who presents his offering”

See how you handled these repeated words in 1:2.

See: Poetry

Leviticus 22:18 (#1)

דַּבֵּ֞ר אֶל־אַהֲרֹ֣ן וְאֶל־בָּנָ֗יו וְאֶל֙ כָּל־בְּנֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל וְאָמַרְתָּ֖ אֲלֵהֶ֑ם

“Speak to Aaron and to his sons and to all the sons of Israel, and you shall say to them”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing but serve different functions. While the first phrase is a command, the second phrase introduces what Moses is to say to Aaron, the priests, and the people of Israel. You can translate this parallelism into one statement that conveys this relationship. Alternate translation: [Tell Aaron and his sons and all the sons of Israel] or [Speak to Aaron and to his sons and to all the sons of Israel, telling them]

See: Parallelism

Leviticus 22:18 (#2)

וְאֶל֙ כָּל־בְּנֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

“and to all the sons of Israel”

See how you handled this metaphor for the people of Israel in 1:2.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 22:18 (#3)

מִבֵּ֣ית יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

“from the house of Israel”

This expression uses **house** to represent the people of Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from the people of Israel]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 22:18 (#4)

אִ֣ישׁ אִ֣ישׁ

“A man, a man”

Here, the word **man** refers generally to any Israelite in general and not to men specifically. See how you handled the repetition of the word **man** in 15:2. Alternate translation: [Any person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 22:18 (#6)

לַיהוָ֔ה

“to Yahweh”

Yahweh is speaking about himself in the third person. If this would not be natural in your language, you could use the first-person form. Alternate translation: [to me, Yahweh]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Leviticus 22:19 (#1)

לִרְצֹנְכֶ֑ם תָּמִ֣ים זָכָ֔ר בַּבָּקָ֖ר בַּכְּשָׂבִ֥ים וּבָעִֽזִּים

“for your acceptance, a perfect male among the cattle, among the sheep, or among the goats”

This expression leaves out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [for your acceptance, you shall present a perfect male among the cattle, among the sheep, or among the goats]

See: Ellipsis

Leviticus 22:19 (#2)

לִרְצֹנְכֶ֑ם

“for your acceptance”

Here and throughout the rest of this chapter, the word “you” is plural and refers to the people of Israel as a whole and to the priests specifically. If the switch from third-person forms to second-person plural forms would not be natural in your language, consider continuing to use third-person forms. Alternate translation: [for their acceptance]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Leviticus 22:19 (#3)

בַּבָּקָ֖ר בַּכְּשָׂבִ֥ים וּבָעִֽזִּים

“among the cattle, among the sheep, or among the goats”

The expressions **the cattle**, **the sheep**, and **the goats** do not refer to specific groups of animals. They describe any groups of animals that an Israelite might own. Express this in the way that would be most natural in your language. Alternate translation: [among your cattle, your sheep, or your goats that you own or purchase] or, in the third person, [among any of the cattle, sheep, or goats that he owns or purchases]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 22:20 (#1)

כֹּ֚ל אֲשֶׁר־בּ֣וֹ מ֔וּם

“Anything on which {is} a blemish”

Alternate translation: [Any animal on which is a blemish]

Leviticus 22:20 (#2)

כִּ֥י

“because”

The word translated as **because** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation (with a period before): [This is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 22:21 (#4)

כָּל־מ֥וּם לֹ֖א יִהְיֶ֥ה־בּֽוֹ

“Any blemish shall not be on it”

Alternate translation: [No blemish shall be on it]

Leviticus 22:21 (#2)

לַיהוָֹֽה

“to Yahweh”

Yahweh is speaking about himself in the third person. If this would not be natural in your language, you could use the first-person form. Alternate translation: [to me, Yahweh]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Leviticus 22:21 (#3)

בַּבָּקָ֖ר א֣וֹ בַצֹּ֑אן

“among the cattle or among the flock”

The expressions **the cattle** and **the flock** do not refer to specific groups of animals. They describe any groups of animals that an Israelite might own. Express this in the way that would be most natural in your language. Alternate translation: [among your cattle or your flock animals that you own or purchase] or, in the third person, [among his cattle or flock animals that he owns or purchases]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 22:21 (#1)

וְאִ֣ישׁ

“And a man”

Although the term **man** is masculine, here it is used in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [And a person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Leviticus 22:22 (#2)

לֹא־תִתְּנ֥וּ מֵהֶ֛ם עַל־הַמִּזְבֵּ֖חַ

“you shall not give from them on the altar”

See how you handled the similar idiom in 4:7.

See: Idiom

Leviticus 22:22 (#1)

לַיהוָ֔ה & לַיהוָֹֽה

“to Yahweh & to Yahweh”

Yahweh is speaking about himself in the third person. If this would not be natural in your language, you could use the first-person form. Alternate translation: [to me, Yahweh ... to me]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Leviticus 22:23 (#1)

לֹ֣א יֵרָצֶ֔ה

“it will not be accepted”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [I will not accept it]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 22:24 (#1)

וּמָעֽוּךְ֙ וְכָת֣וּת֔ וְנָת֥וּק וְכָר֖וּת לֹ֣א תַקְרִ֑יבוּ לַיהוָ֔ה

“But bruised or crushed or torn or cut you shall not present to Yahweh”

The words **bruised**, **crushed**, **torn** and **cut** refer to ways in which the owner of a bovine might castrate that animal to remove its testicles. This was a common practice in the ancient world that was believed to increase the quality of the animal’s meat. Such practices are forbidden for animals that will be sacrificed as it introduces a blemish to an animal that Yahweh requires to be whole and perfect. If it would be helpful in your language, consider supplying this information in a footnote or in the text of your translation. Alternate translation: [But you shall not present to Yahweh any animal whose testicles have been bruised or crushed or torn or cut] or [But you shall not present to Yahweh any animal whose owner has bruised or crushed or torn or cut the animal’s testicles]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 22:25 (#4)

מִכָּל־אֵאֵלֶּה & בָּהֶם & בָּבֶם

“from any of these & is on them & is on them”

Here, the words **these** and **them** refer to the disabled or deformed animals, not to the **foreigner**. If it would be helpful in your language, consider making this explicit. Alternate translation: [from any of these blemished animals … is on these animals … is on them]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 22:25 (#3)

לֹא תַקְרִיבוּ אֶת־לֶחֶם אֱלֹהֵיכֶם

“you shall not present the bread of your God”

Here, **bread** represents food in general. Furthermore, this expression uses the possessive form to describe **bread** (that is, food) which is characterized by the fact that it is offered to **God**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you shall not present any food as a gift to your God]

See: Possession

Leviticus 22:25 (#5)

כִּי

“because”

The word translated as **because** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation (with a period before): [This is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 22:25 (#6)

מָשְׁחָתָם בָּהֶם

“their being ruined is on them”

Alternate translation: [their ruin is on them] or [their deformity is on them]

Leviticus 22:25 (#7)

לֹא יֵרָצוּ לָכֶם

“They will not be accepted for you”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will not accept them from you]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 22:25 (#1)

וּמִיַּד בֶּן־נֵכָר לֹא תַקְרִיבוּ אֶת־לֶחֶם אֱלֹהֵיכֶם מִכָּל־אֵאֵלֶּה

“And from the hand of a son of a foreigner, you shall not present the bread of your God from any of these”

Here the word **hand** represents the whole person. In context, this expression refers to purchasing an animal from another, specifically a **foreigner**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And you shall not present the bread of your God that you acquired from the son of a foreigner]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 22:25 (#2)

בֶּן־נֵכָר

“a son of a foreigner”

Here, the word **son** refers generically to descendants and not just to male progeny. If your language has a generic word for children, consider using it here. Alternate translation: [a foreigner] or [someone who you consider to be a foreigner]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 22:27 (#2)

תַּתַּ֖חַת אִמָּ֑ו

“under its mother”

Here, **under its mother** is a common expression that describes a young animal as being with its mother. The use of the word **under** likely describes the mother feeding the young animal. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with its mother] or [feeding from its mother]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 22:27 (#3)

וּמִיּ֣וֹם הַשְּׁמִינִ֔י וָהָ֖לְאָה

“And from the eighth day and beyond”

If your language does not use this type of number, you could use a different type of number here or an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [And after seven days]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Leviticus 22:27 (#4)

יֵרָצֶֽה

“it may be accepted”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [I will accept it]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 22:27 (#1)

כִּֽי־יִוָּלֵ֥ד

“when it is born”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [when its mother gives birth to it]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 22:27 (#5)

לַֽיהוָֹה

“to Yahweh”

Yahweh is speaking about himself in the third person. If this would not be natural in your language, you could use the first-person form. Alternate translation: [to me, Yahweh]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Leviticus 22:28 (#1)

אֹתָ֥ו וְאֶת־בְּנֹ֖ו

“it and its son”

Although the term **son** is masculine, here it is used in a generic sense that includes both male and female animals. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [it and its young] or [it and its offspring]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Leviticus 22:29 (#1)

וְכִֽי־תִזְבְּח֥וּ זֶֽבַח־תֹּודָ֖ה

“And when you sacrifice a sacrifice of thanks”

Here, **when you sacrifice a sacrifice** is an emphatic construction that uses a verb and its object that come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [And whenever you present an animal as a sacrifice of thanks]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 22:30 (#1)

בַּיֹּ֥ום הַה֖וּא יֵאָכֵ֑ל

“On that day, it shall be eaten”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [On that day, you shall eat it] or [On that day, the people of Israel shall eat it]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 22:31 (#1)

וּשְׁמַרְתֶּ֥ם מִצְוֹתַ֖י וַעֲשִׂיתֶ֣ם אֹתָ֑ם

“And you shall keep my commandments, and you shall do them”

Here, the words **keep** and **do** mean similar things. They both emphasize that the people must practice a habitual lifestyle of obeying God’s commands. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express

the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [And you shall obey my commandments] or [And you shall keep my commandments so that you do them]

See: Doublet

Leviticus 22:32 (#1)

אֶת־שֵׁשֵׁם קָדְשִׁשְׁי

“the name of my holiness”

See how you translated this expression in 22:2.

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 22:32 (#2)

וְנִנְקַדַּשְׁתִּתִּי

“but I will show myself to be holy”

Alternate translation: [but I shall be treated as holy]

Leviticus 22:32 (#3)

בְּנֵנִי יִשְׂרָאֵאֵל

“the sons of Israel”

See how you handled this metaphor for the people of Israel in 1:2.

See: Metaphor

Leviticus - Chapter 23 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter describes Israel’s religious festivals and holy days. The structure is:

1. Introduction (23:1–2)
2. The Sabbath (23:3)
3. The Passover and Festival of Unleavened Bread (23:4–8)
4. The Offering of Firstfruits (23:9–14)
5. The Festival of Weeks (Pentecost) (23:15–22)
6. The Festival of Trumpets (23:23–25)
7. The Day of Atonement (23:26–32)
8. The Festival of Shelters (23:33–43)
9. Conclusion (23:44)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Festival timing
Each festival had specific timing rules:

- Some lasted one day
- Others lasted seven days
- Some required counting days between events
- Some were tied to harvest times

Holy gatherings
The festivals involved special meetings:

- People stopped regular work
- They gathered to worship
- They made specific offerings
- Some required fasting or special housing

Symbolic actions
Many festival activities had deeper meaning:

- Living in shelters reminded of wilderness years
- First harvest offerings showed gratitude
- Trumpet blasts called people to worship
- Consider explaining these meanings in footnotes

Agricultural connections
Many festivals linked to farming:

- Firstfruits at beginning of harvest
- Weeks festival at end of grain harvest
- Rules about leaving harvest edges for the poor
- Shows connection between worship and daily life

Special Translation Issues in This Chapter

Calendar terms
The chapter uses Hebrew calendar terms that need careful translation:

- “First month” is March-April
- “Seventh month” is September-October
- Consider adding brief explanations in footnotes

Numbers and measurements
The chapter uses several numbers and measures:

- “Two-tenths” of an ephah (about 4.4 liters)
- “One-fourth” of a hin (about 1 liter)
- “Seven sabbaths” means seven weeks
- Consider using local measurements if helpful

Repeated phrases
Several phrases appear multiple times:

- “To the face of Yahweh” means “in Yahweh’s presence”

- "A pleasing aroma" means "an acceptable offering"
- "A permanent law" means "a rule that continues forever"
- Use consistent translations for these phrases

(See: Sabbath; and holy, holiness, unholy, sacred)

Leviticus 23:2 (#1)

דַּבֵּ֣ר אֶל־בְּנֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵל֮ וְאָמַרְתָּ֣ אֲלֵהֶם֒

"Speak to the sons of Israel, and you shall say to them"

See how you handled the beginning of the quote within a quote in 1:2 and throughout the book.

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Leviticus 23:2 (#2)

מוֹעֲדַ֣י יְהוָ֔ה אֲשֶׁר־תִּקְרְא֥וּ אֹתָ֖ם מִקְרָאֵ֑י קֹ֖דֶשׁ אֵ֣לֶּה הֵ֔ם מוֹעֲדָֽי

"The appointed times of Yahweh, which you shall proclaim them {as} assemblies of holiness, these {are} them, my appointed times"

This verse repeats the phrase **appointed times** for emphasis. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine the phrases and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [These are the special times that Yahweh has set, which you must announce as holy gatherings] or [These are the times that Yahweh has chosen which you must announce for people to gather and worship him]

See: Parallelism

Leviticus 23:2 (#3)

מִקְרָאֵ֣י קֹ֑דֶשׁ

"as} assemblies of holiness"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **holiness**, you could express the same idea with an adjective. See how you translated this abstract noun in 8:9. Alternate translation: [as sacred assemblies] or [as holy gatherings]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 23:2 (#4)

אֵ֣לֶּה הֵ֔ם מוֹעֲדָֽי

"these {are} them, my appointed times"

Here, **my** refers to Yahweh. Make sure this is clear in your translation. Alternate translation: [these are Yahweh's appointed times]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 23:3 (#1)

שֵׁ֣שֶׁת יָמִים֮ תֵּעָשֶׂ֣ה מְלָאכָה֒

"Six days work shall be done"

If your language does not use a passive form like **shall be done**, you could express this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [You may work for six days] or [People may work for six days]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 23:3 (#2)

שַׁבַּ֣ת שַׁבָּתוֹן֮

"is} a sabbath of sabbaths"

Here, **sabbath of sabbaths** is a common expression emphasizing that this is a very important sabbath. Alternate translation: [is a special sabbath] or [is an especially important sabbath of complete rest]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 23:3 (#3)

בְּכֹ֖ל מוֹשְׁבֹתֵיכֶ֑ם

"in all your dwellings"

This phrase refers to everywhere people live, including their homes and the surrounding areas. If your language has a way to express this concept of "everywhere," consider using it here. Alternate translation: [everywhere you live] or [in all your towns and homes]

See: Merism

Leviticus 23:4 (#1)

אֵ֣לֶּה מוֹעֲדֵ֣י יְהוָ֔ה מִקְרָאֵ֖י קֹ֑דֶשׁ אֲשֶׁר־תִּקְרְא֥וּ אֹתָ֖ם בְּמוֹעֲדָֽם

"These {are} the appointed times of Yahweh, assemblies of holiness which you shall proclaim them in their appointed times"

This verse repeats the phrase **appointed times** for emphasis. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine the phrases and express the emphasis in another way. See how you handled this repetition in 23:2.

See: Parallelism

Leviticus 23:5 (#1)

בַּחֹ֣דֶשׁ הָרִאשׁ֔וֹן

"In the first month"

This refers to the first month of the Hebrew calendar, which occurs in March-April on modern calendars. If it would be helpful in your language, you could include this information. Alternate translation: [In the first month of the year, which is in early spring]

See: Hebrew Months

Leviticus 23:5 (#3)

בֵּ֣ין הָעַרְבָּיִם

“between the evenings”

The phrase **between the evenings** was a common expression of the culture that meant “at twilight,” which is the time period between sundown and darkness. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [as the sun goes down] or [at dusk]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 23:5 (#2)

בְּאַרְבָּעָ֥ה עָשָׂ֖ר

“on {day} 14 of”

Here, **fourteen** is a cardinal number used where many languages would use an ordinal number. If your language would not use a cardinal number in this context, use an ordinal number instead. Alternate translation: [on the fourteenth day of]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Leviticus 23:6 (#1)

וּבַחֲמִשָּׁ֨ה עָשָׂ֜ר י֣וֹם ׀ לַחֹ֣דֶשׁ הַזֶּ֗ה

“And on day 15 of this month”

Here, **day 15** is a cardinal number used where many languages would use an ordinal number. If your language would not use a cardinal number in this context, use an ordinal number instead. Alternate translation: [And on the fifteenth day of this month]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Leviticus 23:7 (#1)

מְלֶ֥אכֶת עֲבֹדָ֖ה

“work of labor”

These two words **work** and **labor** express a single idea and are used together to emphasize that no work should be done. If your language has a way to emphasize the prohibition of work, you could use it here. Alternate translation: [kind of work] or [work of any kind]

See: Hendiadys

Leviticus 23:8 (#1)

שִׁבְעַ֥ת יָמִ֖ים

“for} seven days”

This phrase means to do something every day for a week. Alternate translation: [each day for seven days] or [every day for a week]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 23:10 (#1)

אֶת־עֹ֣מֶר

“a sheaf of”

A **sheaf** is a bundle of grain stalks tied together after being cut. If your language does not have a word for this, you could use a descriptive phrase. Alternate translation: [a bundle of harvested grain stalks from] or [a handful of]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 23:11 (#1)

לִפְנֵ֥י יְהוָ֖ה

“to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated this expression in 1:5. Alternate translation: [before Yahweh] or [in Yahweh’s presence]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 23:11 (#2)

לְרִצֹנְכֶ֑ם

“for your acceptance”

See how you translated this abstract noun in 1:3. Alternate translation: [so that Yahweh will accept you] or [so that Yahweh will accept your offering]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 23:12 (#1)

בֶּן־שְׁנָתוֹ֙

“a son of its year”

See how you translated this idiom in 9:3. Alternate translation: [one year old] or [that is a year old]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 23:13 (#1)

אִשֶּׁה לַיהוָה רֵיַח נִיחֹחַ

“a gift to Yahweh, a scent of pleasing”

See how you translated this idiom in 1:9. Alternate translation: [an offering that pleases Yahweh] or [a sacrifice that is acceptable to Yahweh]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 23:13 (#2)

שְׁנֵי עֶשְׂרֹנִים

“two-tenths {of an ephah} of”

The fraction **two-tenths** means two parts out of ten equal parts. Languages handle fractions in different ways. Consider how your language expresses fractions and translate accordingly. Alternate translation: [two parts out of ten of an ephah of] or [one-fifth of an ephah of]

See: Fractions

Leviticus 23:13 (#3)

שְׁנֵי עֶשְׂרֹנִים

“two-tenths {of an ephah} of”

The text only says **two-tenths** but implies that the measurement is in ephahs, which was the standard measure for flour. If your language requires the unit to be stated explicitly, you can include it. Alternate translation: [two-tenths of an ephah of]

See: Ellipsis

Leviticus 23:13 (#4)

שְׁנֵי עֶשְׂרֹנִים

“two-tenths {of an ephah} of”

An ephah is a Hebrew unit of dry measure, about 22 liters or 20 quarts. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a modern equivalent. Alternate translation: [about 4.4 liters of] or [about 4 quarts of]

See: Biblical Volume

Leviticus 23:13 (#5)

רְבִיעִת הַהִין

“a fourth of a hin”

The fraction **a fourth of** means one part out of four equal parts. Languages handle fractions in different ways. Consider how your language expresses fractions and translate accordingly. Alternate translation: [one part out of four of a hin] or [a quarter of a hin]

See: Fractions

Leviticus 23:13 (#6)

רְבִיעִת הַהִין

“a fourth of a hin”

A hin is a Hebrew unit of liquid measure, about 3.8 liters or 1 gallon. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a modern equivalent. Alternate translation: [about 1 liter] or [about 1 quart]

See: Biblical Volume

Leviticus 23:14 (#1)

אֶת־קָרְבַּן אֱלֹהֵיכֶם

“the offering of your God”

This phrase uses possession to describe an offering that belongs to God because it is given to him. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the offering that you give to your God] or [the offering that belongs to your God]

See: Possession

Leviticus 23:14 (#2)

חֻקַּת עוֹלָם לְדֹרֹתֵיכֶם

“It is} a statute of eternity for your generations”

See how you translated this phrase in 3:17. Alternate translation: [It is a rule that will continue forever for all your descendants] or [It is a permanent law that all future generations must obey]

Leviticus 23:15 (#1)

שֶׁבַע שַׁבָּתֹת

“seven sabbaths”

Here, **seven sabbaths** refers to seven weeks, as the sabbath marks the end of each week. Alternate translation: [seven weeks] or [forty-nine days]

Leviticus 23:16 (#1)

עַד מִמָּחֳרַת הַשַּׁבָּת הַשְּׁבִיעִת תִּסְפְּרוּ חֲמִשִּׁים יוֹם

“Until the day after the seventh sabbath you shall count 50 days”

This verse clarifies that the fifty days include the seven Sabbaths mentioned in the previous verse. You could say that explicitly if it would be helpful to your read-

ers. Alternate translation: [Count fifty days, ending on the day after the seventh Sabbath]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 23:17 (#1)

מִמּוֹשְׁבֹתֵיכֶם

“From your dwellings”

Here, **dwellings** refers specifically to the homes where people live, not the broader meaning used earlier in the chapter. Alternate translation: [From your homes] or [From each household]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 23:17 (#2)

שְׁנֶיׁם & עֶשְׂרֹנִים

“two {loaves} of & tenths {of an ephah & of”

See how you translated this measurement in 23:13.

See: Fractions

Leviticus 23:18 (#1)

בְּנֵי שָׁנָה

“sons of a year”

See how you translated this common expression in 9:3. Alternate translation: [one-year olds] or [that are a year old]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 23:18 (#2)

וּפַר בֶּן־בָּקָר אֶחָד

“and one bull, a son of cattle”

This phrase may contain extra information that would be unnatural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. See how you translated this expression in 4:3. Alternate translation: [and one young bull]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Leviticus 23:18 (#3)

רֵיחַ־נִיחֹחַ

“a scent of pleasing”

See how you translated this common expression in 23:13.

See: Idiom

Leviticus 23:19 (#1)

בְּנֵי שָׁנָה

“sons of a year”

See how you translated this common expression in 23:18.

See: Idiom

Leviticus 23:20 (#1)

לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“to the face of Yahweh”

Here, **to the face of Yahweh** means to present something directly to Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [before Yahweh] or [in Yahweh’s presence]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 23:21 (#1)

מְלֶאכֶת עֲבֹדָה

“work of labor”

See how you translated this phrase in 23:7.

See: Hendiadys

Leviticus 23:21 (#2)

חֻקַּת עוֹלָם & לְדֹרֹתֵיכֶם

“It is} a statute of eternity & for your generations”

See how you translated this phrase in 23:14.

See: Possession

Leviticus 23:22 (#1)

לֹא־תְכַלֶּה פְּאַת שָׂדְךָ בְּקֻצְרֶךָ וְלֶקֶט קְצִירְךָ לֹא תְלַקֵּט

“you shall not finish the edge of your field in your harvesting, and you shall not glean the gleaning of your harvest”

This instruction refers to specific harvesting laws. If it would be helpful in your translation, you could add a footnote explaining the purpose of these practices and referring readers to where it was commanded. See Leviticus 19:9–10 for the full explanation of this law and its purpose. Alternate translation: [do not harvest all the way to the edges of your field, and do not pick up the grain that falls on the ground]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 23:24 (#1)

בַּחֹ֨דֶשׁ הַשְּׁבִיעִ֜י

“In the seventh month”

This refers to the seventh month of the Hebrew calendar, which occurs in September-October on modern calendars. If it would be helpful in your language, you could include this information. Alternate translation: [In the seventh month of the year, which is in early autumn]

See: Hebrew Months

Leviticus 23:24 (#2)

בְּאֶחָ֤ד לַחֹ֙דֶשׁ֙

“on {day} one of the month”

If your language would not use a number in a form such as **day one**, you could represent this number in a form your language would use. Alternate translation: [on the first day of the month]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Leviticus 23:24 (#3)

שַׁבָּתוֹן֙ זִכְרוֹן֙ תְּרוּעָ֔ה מִקְרָא־קֹ֖דֶשׁ

“a rest, a memorial of a loud blast, an assembly of holiness”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for these concepts, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [a day when you rest from work, shout to remember important events, and gather together to worship in a special way] or [a time for you to stop working, to call out loudly as you recall significant moments, and to come together for a sacred meeting]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 23:25 (#1)

מְלֶ֣אכֶת עֲבֹדָ֔ה

“work of labor”

See how you translated this phrase in 23:7.

See: Hendiadys

Leviticus 23:27 (#1)

קִקְדֶּשׁ֣

“holiness”

See how you translated this abstract noun in 8:9.

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 23:27 (#2)

וְעִנִּיתֶ֥ם אֶת־נַפְשֹׁתֵיכֶ֖ם

“and you shall humble your souls”

See how you translated this expression in 16:29. Alternate translation: [and you shall deny yourselves] or [and you shall fast and pray to show your sadness for your sins]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 23:28 (#1)

לִפְנֵ֖י יְהוָ֥ה אֱלֹהֵיכֶֽם

“to the face of Yahweh your God”

See how you translated this expression in 1:5. Alternate translation: [before Yahweh your God] or [in the presence of Yahweh your God]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 23:29 (#1)

וְנִכְרְתָ֖ה מֵעַמֶּֽיהָ

“shall be cut off from his people”

See the Introduction to chapter 7 for more information and see how you translated this in 7:20.

See: Idiom

Leviticus 23:31 (#1)

חֻקַּ֥ת עוֹלָ֖ם לְדֹרֹתֵיכֶֽם

“It is} a statute of eternity for your generations”

See how you translated this phrase in 23:14 and 23:21. This phrase emphasizes the enduring nature of the law. Alternate translation: [It is a rule that will continue forever for all your descendants] or [It is a permanent law that all future generations must obey]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 23:32 (#1)

שַׁבַּ֤ת שַׁבָּתוֹן֙

“is} a sabbath of sabbaths”

This is an idiom emphasizing that this is a very important sabbath. Alternate translation: [is a special sabbath] or [is an especially important day of rest]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 23:34 (#1)

בַּחֲמִשָּׁ֣ה עָשָׂ֔ר י֥וֹם לַחֹ֖דֶשׁ הַשְּׁבִיעִ֑י הַזֶּ֔ה

“On day 15 of this seventh month”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **day 15**, you could represent this number in a form your language would use. Alternate translation: [On the fifteenth day of this seventh month]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Leviticus 23:35 (#1)

See how you translated 23:7.

Leviticus 23:36 (#1)

שִׁבְעַ֥ת יָמִ֖ים

“For} seven days”

This phrase means to do something every day for a week. See how you translated this in 23:8. Alternate translation: [Each day for seven days] or [Every day for a week]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 23:36 (#3)

מְלֶ֣אכֶת עֲבֹדָ֔ה

“work of labor”

See how you translated this phrase in 23:7.

See: Hendiadys

Leviticus 23:36 (#2)

מִקְרָא־קֹ֖דֶשׁ

“an assembly of holiness”

See how you translated this phrase in 23:2.

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 23:37 (#1)

דְּבַר־י֥וֹם בְּיוֹמ֖וֹ

“the thing of a day on its day”

This is a common expression that means to do what is required each day. Alternate translation: [as each day requires] or [what needs to be done on each specific day]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 23:38 (#1)

מִלְּבַד֙ שַׁבְּתֹ֣ת יְהוָ֔ה וּמִלְּבַד֙ מַתְּנֹתֵיכֶ֔ם וּמִלְּבַד֙ כָּל־נִדְרֵיכֶ֔ם וּמִלְּבַד֙ כָּל־נִדְבֹתֵיכֶ֔ם

“besides the sabbaths of Yahweh and besides your gifts and besides all your vows and besides all your freewill offerings”

This verse lists several types of offerings that are in addition to the regular festival offerings. If your language has a way to express items in a list that are additional to something else, you could use it here. Alternate translation: [in addition to your regular Sabbath offerings, your other gifts, your vows, and your freewill offerings]

See: Ellipsis

Leviticus 23:39 (#1)

בַּחֲמִשָּׁ֥ה עָשָׂ֛ר י֖וֹם לַחֹ֣דֶשׁ הַשְּׁבִיעִ֑י

“on day 15 of the seventh month”

If your language would not represent a number using the form **day 15**, you could represent this number in a form your language would use. Alternate translation: [on the fifteenth day of the seventh month]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Leviticus 23:40 (#2)

שִׁבְעַ֥ת יָמִ֖ים

“for} seven days”

See how you translated this phrase in 23:8. Alternate translation: [each day for seven days] or [every day for a week]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 23:40 (#1)

לִפְנֵ֖י יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֵיכֶֽם

“to the face of Yahweh your God”

See how you translated this expression in 1:5.

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 23:41 (#1)

חֻקַּ֥ת עוֹלָ֖ם לְדֹרֹתֵיכֶ֑ם

“It is} a statute of eternity for your generations”

See how you translated this phrase in 23:14.

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 23:43 (#2)

לְמַ֣עַן֮ יֵדְע֣וּ דֹרֹתֵיכֶם֒

“so that your generations may know”

This verse explains why God commanded the people to live in booths during the festival. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this connection more explicit. Alternate translation: [I commanded this so that all your descendants would remember]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 23:43 (#1)

אֶת־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the sons of Israel”

Here, **sons of Israel** refers to the Israelite people who came out of Egypt. This represents all the Israelite people by referring to them as sons. Alternate translation: [the Israelite people] or [the people of Israel]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus - Chapter 24 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter has two main sections:

1. Instructions about the lampstand and bread (24:1–9)
2. A case of blasphemy and its punishment (24:10–23)

- General instructions about blasphemy (24:15–16)
- Laws about personal injury (24:17–22)
- The punishment carried out (24:23)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Holy bread and lampstand
The chapter gives rules about sacred items:

- The bread represented God’s presence.
- The lampstand needed to burn continuously.
- Only priests could eat the holy bread.
- These items required special care and respect.

Blasphemy
The chapter records the first case of blasphemy:

- Speaking disrespectfully about God was serious.
- The punishment was death by stoning.
- The whole community participated.
- This case set the standard for future situations.

Symbolic actions
Several actions had special meaning:

- Witnesses placed hands on guilty person’s head.
- The community participated in punishment.
- Regular bread arrangement showed God’s presence.
- Consider explaining these meanings in footnotes.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Euphemisms
The chapter uses respectful ways to refer to God:

- “The Name” means “Yahweh.”
- Consider how your language shows respect when referring to God.
- Be consistent in how you translate these terms.

Generic terms
The chapter uses general terms that include everyone:

- “A man” often means “any person.”
- “The one who” includes both men and women.
- “Fellow citizen” means “fellow Israelite.”

Repeated phrases
Several phrases appear multiple times:

- “Before Yahweh” means “in Yahweh’s presence.”
- “Permanent law” means “rule that continues forever.”
- “Most holy” emphasizes extreme holiness.
- Use consistent translations for these phrases.

(See: blasphemy, blaspheme, blasphemous; holy, holiness, unholy, sacred; and curse, cursed, cursing)

Leviticus 24:2 (#1)

אֶת־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וְיִקְחוּ אֵלֶיךָ

“the sons of Israel, and they shall bring to you”

The text reports indirectly what the sons of Israel should do. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as a direct quotation. Alternate translation: [the sons of Israel, ‘Bring to me]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Leviticus 24:2 (#2)

לְהַעֲלֹת נֵר

“to make a lamp go up”

Here, **to make a lamp go up** is a common expression that means to keep it burning. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to keep the lamp burning]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 24:2–3 (#1)

If you have translated Exodus, see how you translated these same instructions in Exodus 27:20–21.

Leviticus 24:3 (#1)

מִחוּץ

“From outside”

In some languages, the word **from** is redundant here. Express this in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Outside]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Leviticus 24:3 (#2)

לִפְנֵי

“to the face of”

See how you translated this expression in 23:40. Alternate translation: [in the presence of]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 24:3 (#3)

חֻקַּת עוֹלָם

“It is} a statute of eternity”

See how you translated this expression in 23:41. Alternate translation: [It is a permanent law]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 24:4 (#1)

לִפְנֵי

“to the face of”

See how you translated this expression in 24:3. Alternate translation: [in the presence of]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 24:4 (#2)

יַעֲרֹךְ

“he shall arrange”

The word **he** refers to Aaron. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Aaron shall arrange]

See: Pronouns

Leviticus 24:5 (#1)

שְׁנֵי עֶשְׂרֹנִים

“Two-tenths {of an ephah”

See how you translated this expression in 23:13.

See: Fractions

Leviticus 24:5–7 (#1)

וְלָקַחְתָּ & וְשַׂמְתָּ & וְנָתַתָּ

“And you shall take & And you shall place & And you shall put”

The word **you** could refer to Moses (because Yahweh is talking directly to him) or Aaron (because starting in verse 8 the instructions are to Aaron and verses 5–7 seem to go with verses 8–9). Some think it refers to Moses initially and then to Aaron and his sons later. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers so you may have to decide to specify who **you** refers to.

See: Pronouns

Leviticus 24:6 (#1)

לִפְנֵי

“to the face of”

See how you translated this expression in 24:3. Alternate translation: [in the presence of]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 24:7 (#1)

עַל־הַמַּעֲרֶכֶת

“on the row”

Here, **on the row** means “on each row.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this clear for your readers. Alternate translation: [on each row]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 24:8 (#3)

מֵאֵת בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“from the sons of Israel”

The text does not specify what comes **from the sons of Israel**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could be more explicit. Alternate translation: [, this bread that is from the sons of Israel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 24:8 (#4)

בְּרִית עוֹלָם

“a covenant of eternity”

If possible, translate this similar to how you translated “statute of eternity” in 24:3. Alternate translation: [a permanent covenant]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 24:8 (#1)

בְּיוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת בְּיוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת

“On the day of the sabbath, on the day of the sabbath”

This repetition means “on each sabbath.” If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this in a different way. Alternate translation: [Every sabbath day]

See: Parallelism

Leviticus 24:8 (#2)

לִפְנֵי

“to the face of”

See how you translated this expression in 24:3. Alternate translation: [in the presence of]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 24:9 (#3)

חָק־עוֹלָם

“a statute of eternity”

See how you translated this expression in 24:3. Alternate translation: [a permanent law]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 24:9 (#2)

קֹדֶשׁ קָדָשִׁים

“is} a holy of holies”

Here, **a holy of holies** is a common expression meaning something that is extremely holy. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is most holy] or [is extremely sacred]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 24:9 (#1)

וְהָיְתָה לְאַהֲרֹן וּלְבָנָיו

“And it shall be for Aaron and for his sons”

The text does not specify what is **for Aaron and his sons**. If it would be helpful for your readers, you could make this explicit. Alternate translation: [And this bread shall be for Aaron and for his sons]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 24:10 (#1)

וַיֵּצֵא

“And & went out”

A specific event occurs here which interrupts Yahweh’s giving instructions to Moses about the special feast and sabbaths. However, it also provides some of Israel’s important case law. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Leviticus 24:11 (#2)

וַיָּבִיאוּ

“And they brought”

The word **they** refers to the sons of Israel. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the Israelites brought]

See: Pronouns

Leviticus 24:11 (#1)

אֶת־הַשֵּׁם

“the Name”

Here, **the Name** is a polite and respectful way of referring to Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to Yahweh, or you could state this directly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh]

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 24:11 (#3)

דִּבְרִי

“Dibri”

This is the name of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

Leviticus 24:12 (#1)

לִפְרֹשׁ לָהֶם עַל־פִּי יְהוָה

“to declare to them according to the mouth of Yahweh”

Alternate translation: [until Yahweh would declare to them what he wanted them to do with the man who blasphemed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 24:12 (#2)

עַל־פִּי יְהוָה

“according to the mouth of Yahweh”

Here, **according to the mouth of Yahweh** is a common expression meaning “according to Yahweh’s instructions.” If this phrase would not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [according to what Yahweh would command]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 24:14 (#1)

אֶת־הַמְקַלֵּל

“the curser”

Here, **the curser** refers to the man who cursed Yahweh. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could include this information. Alternate translation: [the one who cursed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 24:14 (#2)

הַשֹּׁמְעִים

“the hearers”

Here, **hearers** refers to those who heard the man curse. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could include this information. Alternate translation: [those who heard him curse]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 24:14 (#3)

וְסָמְכוּ & אֶת־יְדֵיהֶם עַל־רֹאשׁוֹ

“and & shall lay their hands on his head”

Here, laying **their hands on his head** was a symbolic action to show that they were witnesses to the fact that the man was guilty. If it would not be clear to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [and ... shall place their hands on his head to show that they witnessed his guilty action]

See: Symbolic Action

Leviticus 24:15 (#1)

תְּדַבֵּר לֵאמֹר אִישׁ אִישׁ כִּי־יְקַלֵּל

“you shall speak, saying, ‘A man, a man if he curses”

The word **saying** marks the beginning of a quotation within a quotation. If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [say that if a man, a man curses]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Leviticus 24:15 (#4)

אִישׁ אִישׁ כִּי־יְקַלֵּל אֱלֹהָיו

“A man, a man if he curses his God”

This presents a hypothetical situation. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a situation that could happen. Alternate translation: [Whoever curses his God]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Leviticus 24:15 (#2)

אִישׁ אִישׁ

“A man, a man”

Here, **a man** is used to mean any person and not one particular person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [Any person] or [Anyone]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 24:15 (#3)

אִישׁ אִישׁ

“A man, a man”

Here the masculine term **man** has a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [Any person] or [Anyone]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Leviticus 24:16 (#2)

יוּמָ֥ת & יוּמָֽת

“he shall be executed & he shall be executed”

If your language does not use a passive form like **he shall be executed**, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [you must put him to death]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 24:16 (#4)

כַּגֵּר֙ כָּאֶזְרָ֔ח

“As {for} the sojourner, as {for} the native-born”

Here, **as for the sojourner, as for the native-born** means the same penalty applies to everyone regardless of their status. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this meaning clear. Alternate translation: [Whether the person is a foreigner or native-born]

See: Merism

Leviticus 24:16 (#5)

שֵׁ֥שֵׁם

“the Name”

Here, **the Name** is a polite way of referring to Yahweh. See how you translated this in 24:11. Alternate translation: [Yahweh]

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 24:16 (#3)

רָגְמ֤וּ יִרְגְּמוּ־בוֹ֙ כָּל־הָעֵדָ֔ה

“Stoning, all the congregation shall stone him”

This repetition emphasizes that this must certainly happen. If it would be more natural in your language, you could combine the phrases and express this emphasis differently. Alternate translation: [The congregation must certainly stone him to death]

See: Parallelism

Leviticus 24:16 (#6)

וְנֹקֵ֖ב

“And the blasphemer {of”

Here, **the blasphemer** is used in a generic sense to mean anyone who blasphemes. Use a natural way in your language of expressing that this applies to anyone who commits this act. Alternate translation: [Whoever blasphemes]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 24:16 (#1)

מ֣וֹת יוּמָ֑ת

“dying, he shall be executed”

This repetition emphasizes that this must certainly happen. If it would be more natural in your language, you could combine the phrases and express this emphasis differently. Alternate translation: [he must certainly be put to death]

See: Parallelism

Leviticus 24:17 (#2)

וְאִ֣ישׁ & אָדָ֔ם

“And a man & a man”

Here the masculine term **man** has a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [And any person] or [anyone]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Leviticus 24:17 (#6)

יוּמָֽת

“he shall be executed”

If your language does not use a passive form like **he shall be executed**, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [you must put him to death]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 24:17 (#1)

וְאִ֣ישׁ & אָדָ֔ם

“And a man & a man”

Here, **a man** is used in a generic sense to mean any person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [And anyone ... anyone else]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 24:17 (#3)

כִּֽי־יַכֶּ֥ה כָל־נֶ֖פֶשׁ אָדָ֑ם

“when he strikes any life of a man”

This presents a hypothetical situation. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a situation that could happen. Alternate translation: [whoever kills anyone]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Leviticus 24:17 (#4)

כִּֽי־יַכֶּה כָּל־נֶ֥פֶשׁ אָדָ֖ם

“when he strikes any life of a man”

Here, **strikes any life of a man** is a common expression meaning to kill someone. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when he kills anyone]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 24:17 (#5)

מָמֹ֥ות יוּמָֽת

“dying, he shall be executed”

See how you translated this expression in 24:16. Alternate translation: [he must certainly be put to death]

See: Parallelism

Leviticus 24:18 (#2)

וּמַכֵּ֥ה

“And a striker of”

Here **a striker** is used in a generic sense to mean anyone who kills. If it would be helpful, you could use a natural way in your language to express this. Alternate translation: [anyone who kills]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 24:18 (#3)

וּמַכֵּ֥ה נֶ֖פֶשׁ־בְּהֵמָ֑ה

“And a striker of the life of a livestock”

Here, **a striker of the life of a livestock** is a common expression meaning to kill an animal. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Anyone who kills an animal]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 24:18 (#1)

וּמַכֵּ֥ה נֶ֖פֶשׁ־בְּהֵמָ֑ה

“And a striker of the life of a livestock”

This presents a hypothetical situation. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a situation that could happen. Alternate translation: [If anyone kills an animal]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Leviticus 24:18 (#4)

נֶ֖פֶשׁ תַּ֥חַת נָֽפֶשׁ

“a life for a life”

Here, **a life for a life** is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and must give a living animal to replace the one that was killed]

See: Ellipsis

Leviticus 24:19 (#4)

בַּעֲמִיתֹֽו

“to his fellow citizen”

Here **fellow citizen** refers to Israelites in general, not one particular person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [to fellow Israelite] or [to another member of Israel]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 24:19 (#1)

וְאִ֣ישׁ

“And a man”

Here **a man** is used in a generic sense to mean any person. Use a natural way in your language of expressing that this law applies to anyone. Alternate translation: [Any person] or [Anyone]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 24:19 (#2)

וְאִ֣ישׁ

“And a man”

Here the masculine term **man** has a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in

your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [Any person] or [Anyone]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Leviticus 24:19 (#3)

כִּי־יִתֵּ֥ן מוּם֙ בַּעֲמִית֔וֹ

“when he gives a blemish to his fellow citizen”

This presents a hypothetical situation. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a situation that could happen. Alternate translation: [whoever injures another person]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Leviticus 24:20 (#1)

שֶׁ֚בֶר תַּ֣חַת שֶׁ֔בֶר עַ֥יִן תַּ֖חַת עַ֑יִן שֵׁ֚ן תַּ֣חַת שֵׁ֔ן שֵׁ֖ן

“fracture for fracture, eye for eye, tooth for tooth”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [If he breaks someone’s bones, his bones shall be broken. If he pokes out someone’s eye, his eye shall be poked out. If he breaks someone’s tooth, his tooth shall be broken]

See: Ellipsis

Leviticus 24:21 (#2)

יוּמָֽת

“shall be executed”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this actively. Alternate translation: [you must put him to death]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 24:21 (#1)

וּמַכֵּ֥ה & וּמַכֵּ֖ה

“And a striker of & but a striker of”

Here, **striker** is used in a generic sense to mean anyone who kills. Use a natural way in your language to make it clear that this applies to anyone who commits this act. Alternate translation: [Anyone who strikes … but anyone who strikes]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 24:22 (#1)

כַּגֵּ֥ר כָּאֶזְרָ֖ח

“As {for} the sojourner, as {for} the native-born”

See how you translated this expression in 24:16. Alternate translation: [Whoever the person is]

See: Merism

Leviticus 24:23 (#1)

אֶת־הַמְקַלֵּ֑ל

“the curser”

See how you translated this expression in 24:14. Alternate translation: [the man who had cursed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus - Chapter 25 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter describes two special types of years and property rights:

1. The Sabbath Year (25:1–7)
2. The Year of Jubilee (25:8–22)
3. Laws about property redemption (25:23–34)
4. Laws about helping the poor (25:35–46)
5. Laws about Israelite slaves (25:47–55)

Special Translation Issues in This Chapter

Personification

The chapter often speaks of land as if it were a person:

- “The land shall rest”
- “The land shall give”
- Consider how your language expresses these concepts naturally

Idioms

The chapter uses several idioms that need careful translation:

- “His hand reaches” means “he becomes prosperous”
- “His hand wavers” means “he becomes poor”
- “To the mouth of” means “according to” or “based on”
- Use natural expressions in your language to convey the meaning

Generic terms

The chapter uses general terms that include everyone:

- “Brother” means “fellow Israelite”
- “A man” means “any person”

• "Sons" can include both men and women

(See: Sabbath; and redeem, redeemer, redemption)

Leviticus 25:2 (#2)

לָכֶם

"to you"

Here, **you** is plural and refers to all the Israelites. Use the plural form of "you" in your translation if your language marks that distinction. Alternate translation: [to all of you Israelites]

See: Forms of 'You' — Singular

Leviticus 25:2 (#1)

דַּבֵּר אֶל־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וְאָמַרְתָּ אֲלֵהֶם

"Speak to the sons of Israel, and you shall say to them"

The passage that begins here and ends at 26:35 is a quotation of what Moses is told to speak to the Israelites, creating a quote within a quote. If it would be helpful in your language, you could indicate this with quotation marks or with whatever other punctuation or convention your language uses to indicate an embedded quotation. Alternate translation: [Tell the Israelites this message]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Leviticus 25:2 (#3)

וְשָׁבְתָה הָאָרֶץ

"then the land shall rest"

Here, **the land** is spoken of as if it were a person who could rest. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a natural way in your language to express that the land should not be farmed. Alternate translation: [you must not farm the land] or [let the soil recover]

See: Personification

Leviticus 25:4 (#1)

שַׁבַּתּוֹן

"a sabbath of sabbaths"

See how you translated this expression in 23:3. Alternate translation: [a complete rest]

Leviticus 25:5 (#2)

נְזִירֶךָ

"your untrimmed {vines"

The phrase **your untrimmed vines** refers to grapevines that are normally pruned to increase their yield but will still produce some grapes even without pruning. If your readers would not be familiar with this concept, you could use a more general expression. Alternate translation: [your unpruned grapevines] or [your naturally growing grape plants]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 25:5 (#1)

אֵת סְפִיחַ קְצִירְךָ

"The self-grown {produce} of your harvest"

The **self-grown produce of your harvest** refers to whatever grows back naturally from the roots of previously harvested plants or from seeds that fell during the previous harvest. If your readers would not be familiar with this concept, you could use a more general expression. Alternate translation: [The grain that grows by itself] or [The crops that sprout without being planted]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 25:6 (#2)

לָכֶם & לְךָ וּלְעַבְדְּךָ וְלַאֲמָתֶךָ וְלִשְׂכִירְךָ וּלְתוֹשָׁבְךָ הַגָּרִים עִמָּךְ

"for you: for you, and for your male servant, and for your female servant, and for your hired worker, and for your temporary resident who sojourns with you"

These terms refer to different categories of people. Use natural terms in your language for these different types of workers and residents. Alternate translation: [for everyone–you, your workers, both permanent and temporary, and the foreigners living among you]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 25:6 (#1)

לָכֶם

"for you"

Here, **you** is plural and refers to all the Israelites. Use the plural form of "you" in your language if your language marks that distinction. Alternate translation: [for all of you]

See: Forms of 'You' — Singular

Leviticus 25:7 (#1)

וְלִלְבֶהֱמְתְּךָ וְלַחַיָּה

“and for your cattle, and for the animals”

These terms refer to different categories of animals. Use natural terms in your language for domesticated and wild animals. Alternate translation: [and for both your farm animals and the wild animals]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 25:9 (#1)

שׁוֹפַר תְּרוּעָה

“a horn of loud blast”

A horn of loud blast refers to a trumpet or horn that is blown very loudly. Alternate translation: [a loudly blowing horn] or [a trumpet that makes a loud sound]

Leviticus 25:10 (#1)

וְקִדַּשְׁתֶּם

“And you shall consecrate”

Here and throughout this verse, **you** is plural and refers to all the Israelites. Use the plural form of “you” in your language if your language marks that distinction. Alternate translation: [And all of you shall consecrate]

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 25:10 (#2)

וְשַׁבְתֶּם אִישׁ אֶל־אֲחֻזָּתוֹ

“and you shall return, each to his possession”

When Israel entered and conquered the promised land Yahweh gave certain parts of it to each tribe and family. These parts were always to stay in that family. Sometimes families had to sell parts of that land because of debt or other poverty. But, except for certain circumstances, that land always had to go back to the original family in the 50th year. Because this is all discussed later in the chapter, there is no need to include this extra information here.

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 25:11 (#1)

אֶת־סְפִיחֶיהָ & אֶת־נְזִרֶיהָ

“its self-grown {produce & from its untrimmed {vines”

See how you translated these terms in 25:5. Alternate translation: [the grain that grows by itself ... from the unpruned grapevines]

Leviticus 25:11 (#2)

לָכֶם

“for you”

Here and throughout this verse, **you** is plural and refers to all the Israelites. Use the plural form of “you” in your translation if your language marks that distinction. Alternate translation: [for all of you]

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 25:12 (#1)

לָכֶם

“to you”

Here and throughout this verse, **you** is plural and refers to all the Israelites. Use the plural form of “you” in your translation if your language marks that distinction. Alternate translation: [to all of you]

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 25:13 (#1)

תָּשֻׁבוּ

“you shall return”

Here and throughout this verse, **you** is plural and refers to all the Israelites. Use the plural form of “you” in your translation if your language marks that distinction. Alternate translation: [all of you shall return]

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 25:14 (#1)

תִּמְכְּרוּ

“you sell”

Here and throughout this verse, **you** is plural and refers to all the Israelites. Use the plural form of “you” in your translation if your language marks that distinction. Alternate translation: [all of you sell]

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 25:16 (#1)

לְפִי

“To the mouth of”

See the Leviticus 25 Chapter Introduction for an explanation of this common expression. Alternate translation: [According to] or [Based on]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 25:17 (#1)

וְלֹ֥א תוֹנ֖וּ

“And you shall not oppress”

Here, **you** is plural and refers to all the Israelites. Use the plural form of “you” in your translation if your language marks that distinction. Alternate translation: [None of you should oppress]

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 25:18 (#1)

וַעֲשִׂיתֶ֣ם

“And you shall do”

Here and throughout this verse, **you** is plural and refers to all the Israelites. Use the plural form of “you” in your translation if your language marks that distinction. Alternate translation: [All of you shall do]

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 25:19 (#2)

וַאֲכַלְתֶּ֥ם

“and you shall eat”

Here and throughout this verse, **you** is plural and refers to all the Israelites. Use the plural form of “you” in your translation if your language marks that distinction. Alternate translation: [and all of you shall eat]

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 25:19 (#1)

וְנָתְנָ֣ה הָאָ֔רֶץ

“And the land shall give”

Here, **the land** is spoken of as if it were a person who could give something. Use a natural way in your language to express that crops will grow in the land. Alternate translation: [Crops will grow in the land and yield] or [The soil will produce]

See: Personification

Leviticus 25:20 (#2)

וְכִֽי תֹאמְר֔וּ

“And if you say”

This introduces a quotation within the larger passage. If your language has a natural way to express this kind of embedded quotation, use it. Alternate translation: [If you ask this question]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Leviticus 25:20 (#1)

וְכִֽי תֹאמְר֔וּ

“And if you say”

This introduces a hypothetical situation. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a situation that could happen. Alternate translation: [Suppose you say] or [You might ask]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Leviticus 25:20 (#3)

תֹאמְר֔וּ

“you say”

Here, **you** is plural and refers to all the Israelites. Use the plural form of “you” in your language if your language marks that distinction. Alternate translation: [all of you say]

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 25:21 (#3)

וְעָשָׂ֥תָה

“and it shall make”

Here, **it** refers to the land. Alternate translation: [and the land shall make]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 25:21 (#1)

וְצִוִּ֤יתִי

“And I will command”

This connection marks God’s answer to the question in the previous verse. Use a connecting word that indicates a response or promise in your language. Alternate translation: [This is my answer: I will command] or [Here is what I promise: I will command]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Leviticus 25:21 (#2)

לָכֶ֖ם

“to you”

Here, **you** is plural and refers to all the Israelites. Use the plural form of “you” in your translation if your language marks that distinction. Alternate translation: [to all of you]

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 25:22 (#1)

וּזְרַעְתֶּם

“And you shall sow”

Here and throughout this verse, **you** is plural and refers to all the Israelites. Use the plural form of “you” in your translation if your language marks that distinction. Alternate translation: [And all of you shall sow]

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 25:22 (#2)

בּוֹאוֹ

“comes in”

Here, **comes in** is a common expression referring to crops growing and producing food. Use a natural expression in your language for crops becoming ready for harvest. Alternate translation: [is ready to harvest] or [has grown]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 25:22 (#3)

תֹּאכְלוּ יָשָׁן

“you shall eat the old”

The word **produce** or “crops” is left out of this phrase but is understood. You could include it if it would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [you shall eat the old produce] or [you shall eat the old crops]

See: Ellipsis

Leviticus 25:23 (#2)

אַתֶּם

“you {are”

Here, **you** is plural and refers to all the Israelites. Use the plural form of “you” in your translation if your language marks that distinction. Alternate translation: [all of you are]

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 25:23 (#1)

וְהָאָרֶץ לֹא תִמָּכֵר

“And the land shall not be sold”

If your language does not use a passive form like **the land shall not be sold**, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [You must not sell the land] or [No one may sell the land]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 25:24 (#1)

אֲחֻזַּתְכֶם & תִּתְּנוּ

“your possession, you shall give”

Here and throughout this verse, **you** and **your** are plural and refer to all the Israelites. Use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction. Alternate translation: [your inheritance, all of you shall give] and [of that which belongs to all of you, you shall give]

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 25:24 (#2)

גְּאֻלָּה תִּתְּנוּ לָאָרֶץ

“you shall give redemption for the land”

This means to allow an original owner to buy back their land. Use a natural expression in your language for allowing someone to repurchase property. Alternate translation: [you must allow people to buy back their land] or [you must permit the repurchase of land]

Leviticus 25:25 (#1)

כִּי־יָמוּךְ אָחִיךָ וּמָכַר מֵאֲחֻזָּתוֹ

“If your brother becomes poor and sells some of his possession”

This introduces a hypothetical situation. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a situation that could happen. Alternate translation: [Suppose one of your fellow Israelites becomes poor and has to sell some of his property]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Leviticus 25:26 (#2)

וְאִישׁ

“And a man”

This refers to any person in this situation, not to a specific man. Use a natural expression in your language. Alternate translation: [If someone] or [When anyone]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 25:26 (#1)

This verse continues with another hypothetical situation. Use a natural way in your language to introduce a situation that could happen.

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Leviticus 25:26 (#3)

וְהִשִּׂיגָה יָדוֹ

“but his hand reaches”

Here, **his hand reaches** is a common expression meaning that someone prospers or becomes financially able. Use a natural expression in your language that communicates this meaning. Alternate translation: [but he becomes prosperous] or [but he earns enough money]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 25:26 (#4)

וּמָצְאָ֣ה כְדֵ֔י גְּאֻלָּתֽוֹ

“and he finds enough {for} his redemption”

The word “money” is left out but understood. You could supply this word if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and he finds enough money to buy back his property]

See: Ellipsis

Leviticus 25:27 (#1)

אֶת־שְׁנֵ֣י מִמְכָּר֗וֹ

“the years of its sale”

This refers to the number of years remaining until the next Year of Jubilee, which determines the value of the land based on expected crops. Alternate translation: [the number of years left until the Year of Jubilee] or [how many growing seasons remain]

Leviticus 25:27 (#2)

וְשָׁ֖ב לַאֲחֻזָּתֽוֹ

“and he shall return to his possession”

This means he will return to his family land. Alternate translation: [and he will get his family property back] or [and his land will be returned to him]

Leviticus 25:28 (#3)

וְיָצָא֙

“And it shall go out”

Here, the land is spoken of as if it were a person who could **go out**. Use a natural way in your language to express that the land will return to its original owner. Alternate translation: [The land will be returned] or [The ownership of the land will revert]

See: Personification

Leviticus 25:28 (#1)

וְאִם־לֹ֣א מָצְאָ֔ה יָדוֹ֙ דֵּי֔

“But if his hand does not find enough”

See how you translated this in 25:26. Alternate translation: [But if he cannot earn enough money]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Leviticus 25:28 (#4)

אֹתֹ֑ו

“it”

Here, **it** refers to the land. Alternate translation: [the land]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 25:28 (#2)

וְאִם־לֹ֣א מָצְאָ֔ה יָדוֹ֙ דֵּי֔ הָשִׁ֥יב לוֹ֖

“But if his hand does not find enough to return to him”

The words “money” and “land” are left out but understood. You could supply these words in your translation if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [But if he cannot find enough money to buy back his land]

See: Ellipsis

Leviticus 25:29 (#2)

בֵּ֣ית־מוֹשַׁ֔בֹ

“a house of dwelling”

In some languages, **house** and **dwelling** may be redundant. If your language would not use a phrase like this, you could simplify it. Alternate translation: [a house] or [a home]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Leviticus 25:29 (#1)

וְאִ֣ישׁ

“And a man”

This refers to any person in this situation, not a specific man. Use a natural way to express this in your language. Alternate translation: [And someone] or [And anyone]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 25:29 (#3)

יָמִים תִּהְיֶה גְאֻלָּתוֹ

“Days shall be its redemption”

Here, **days shall be its redemption** means that there is a specific time period for redeeming the property. Use a natural way in your language to express this time limit. Alternate translation: [The owner has only one year to buy it back] or [It can be redeemed only during the first year after it is sold]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 25:30 (#1)

וְאִם לֹא־יִגָּאֵל

“And if it is not redeemed”

If your language does not use a passive form like **it is not redeemed**, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [If the owner does not buy it back] or [If no one redeems it]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 25:30 (#3)

לַצְמִיתֻת & לְדֹרֹתָיו

“shall be & in perpetuity, to his generations”

See how you translated similar phrases in 25:23.

Leviticus 25:30 (#2)

יִגָּאֵל

“it is & redeemed”

Here, **it** refers to the house. Alternate translation: [the house is ... redeemed]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 25:30 (#4)

לֹא יֵצֵא

“It shall not go out”

See how you translated this expression in 25:28. Alternate translation: [It will not be returned]

See: Personification

Leviticus 25:31 (#2)

הַחֲצֵרִים אֲשֶׁר אֵין־לָהֶם חוֹמָה סָבִיב

“the villages which there {is} not a surrounding wall to them”

This describes villages without protective walls around them. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express this more simply. Alternate translation: [unwalled villages] or [villages without walls]

Leviticus 25:31 (#6)

לוֹ & יֵצֵא

“to it & it shall go out”

Here these words are singular but refer to multiple houses. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use plural forms in your translation. Alternate translation: [to them] and [they shall go out]

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Leviticus 25:31 (#1)

וּבָתֵּי

“But houses of”

This refers to **houses** in general that are not in walled cities, not a specific house. Use a natural way in your language to express this general category. Alternate translation: [But any house of] or [All houses in]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 25:31 (#3)

עַל־שְׂדֵה

“on the field of”

This means these houses are considered part of the agricultural land. Alternate translation: [as part of the fields of]

Leviticus 25:31 (#4)

גְּאֻלָּה תִּהְיֶה־לּוֹ

“Redemption shall be to it”

This means these properties can be bought back. Alternate translation: [These houses can be redeemed] or [People can buy back these houses]

Leviticus 25:31 (#5)

יֵצֵא

“it shall go out”

See how you translated this expression in 25:28. Alternate translation: [it must be returned]

See: Personification

Leviticus 25:32 (#1)

וְעָרֵי

“And the cities of”

This word introduces a new topic about the Levites special rights. Use a natural way in your language to introduce a new but related topic. Alternate translation: [As for the cities of] or [Regarding the cities of]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Leviticus 25:32 (#2)

גְּאֻלַּת עוֹלָם תִּהְיֶה לַלְוִיִּם

“a redemption of perpetuity shall be for the Levites”

This means the Levites always have the right to buy back their houses. Alternate translation: [the Levites may always redeem] or [the Levites have a permanent right to buy back]

Leviticus 25:33 (#3)

וְיָצָא

“and it shall go out”

See how you translated this expression in 25:28. Alternate translation: [it must be returned to its original owner]

See: Personification

Leviticus 25:33 (#4)

מִמְכַּר־בַּיִת וְעִיר

“the sale of house and city of”

This could mean: (1) “the sale of a house in a city” or (2) “the sale of a house and a city.” You should follow how your local major language translations understand this phrase. Alternate translation: [the sale of a house in a city]

Leviticus 25:33 (#1)

וַאֲשֶׁר יִגְאַל מִן־הַלְוִיִּם

“And whatever one from the Levites may redeem”

This refers to property that a Levite might buy back. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Any property a Levite could buy back]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 25:33 (#5)

כִּי בָתֵּי עָרֵי הַלְוִיִּם הִוא אֲחֻזָּתָם

“for the houses of the cities of the Levites, it {is} their possession”

Here **it** is singular but refers to multiple houses. See how you translated this in 25:31. Alternate translation: [for the houses of the cities of the Levites, they are their possessions]

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Leviticus 25:33 (#2)

וַאֲשֶׁר יִגְאַל מִן־הַלְוִיִּם וְיָצָא

“And whatever one from the Levites may redeem, and it shall go out”

In many languages it might be more natural to drop the second **and**. Use a natural way in your language to connect these two statements. Alternate translation: [Any property a Levite could buy back, it will return to its original owner]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Leviticus 25:34 (#1)

אֲחֻזַּת עוֹלָם

“is} a possession of perpetuity”

See how you translated similar phrases in 25:30 or 25:32. Alternate translation: [is a permanent possession]

Leviticus 25:35 (#4)

וּמָטָה יָדוֹ

“and his hand wavers”

Here, **his hand wavers** is a common expression that means he becomes poor or struggles financially. If this phrase does not mean this in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he becomes unable to support himself] or [and he falls into financial difficulty]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 25:35 (#5)

וְהֶחֱזַקְתָּ בּוֹ

“then you shall strengthen him”

Here, **then you shall strengthen** refers specifically to providing financial or material support. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [help him by providing what he needs] or [support him financially]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 25:35 (#2)

אָחִ֔יךָ

“your brother”

Here, **your brother** refers to any fellow Israelite, not only literal brothers. Use a natural way in your language to express this relationship. Alternate translation: [your fellow Israelite] or [your countryman]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 25:35 (#1)

וְכִֽי

“And if”

This introduces a hypothetical situation. Use a natural way in your language to introduce a situation that could happen. Alternate translation: [Suppose] or [When]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Leviticus 25:35 (#3)

אָחִ֔יךָ

“your brother”

Here, **brother** refers to any Israelite, whether male or female. Use a word in your language that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [your fellow Israelite] or [any countryman or countrywoman]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Leviticus 25:36 (#1)

אַל־תִּקַּ֤ח מֵאִתּוֹ֙ נֶ֣שֶׁךְ וְתַרְבִּ֔ית וְיָרֵ֖אתָ מֵֽאֱלֹהֶ֑יךָ וְחַ֥י אָחִ֖יךָ עִמָּֽךְ

“You shall not take from him interest or profit, but you shall fear from your God, and your brother shall live with you”

Here, fearing God is given as the reason for not charging interest and letting your brother live with you. If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Because you must fear your God, you shall not take interest or profit from him, and your brother shall live with you] or [Since you must honor your God, do not charge him interest or profit, and let your brother live with you]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 25:37 (#1)

אֶת־כַּסְפְּךָ֥ לֹא־תִתֵּ֛ן לוֹ֖ בְּנֶ֑שֶׁךְ וּבְמַרְבִּ֕ית לֹא־תִתֵּ֥ן אָכְלֶֽךָ

“Your silver you shall not give to him with interest, and for profit you shall not give your food”

Here the verse expresses a single idea by repeating it in a way that the middle parts match (**interest** and **profit**) and the outside parts (**silver** and **food**) match. The two parts emphasize that you should not profit from lending anything to a poor person. If your language has a natural way to express this kind of emphasis through repetition, you could use it. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine the ideas and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [Do not charge interest when you lend money or food to him] or [You must not make any profit when you lend either silver or food to him]

See: Parallelism

Leviticus 25:38 (#1)

אֶתְכֶ֔ם & לָכֶ֖ם & לָכֶ֑ם

“you & to you & to you”

Throughout this verse, **you** is plural and refers to all the Israelites. Use the plural form of “you” in your translation if your language marks that distinction. Alternate translation: [all of you ... to all of you ... to all of you]

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Leviticus 25:39 (#1)

וְכִֽי

“And if”

See how you translated this conditional phrase in 25:35. Alternate translation: [Suppose]

Leviticus 25:39 (#3)

וְנִמְכַּר־לָ֖ךְ

“and sells himself to you”

The words **sells himself** indicates someone taking action on themselves. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate that the same person is both the subject and the object of the action. Alternate translation: [and becomes your slave] or [and sells himself into your service]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Leviticus 25:39 (#2)

אָחִיךָ

“your brother”

See how you translated this term in 25:35. Alternate translation: [your fellow Israelite]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 25:42 (#1)

The word translated as **For** indicates that what is follows is the reason for the instructions in verses 39–43. Use a natural way in your language to make this clear.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 25:43 (#2)

וְיָרֵאתָ מֵאֱלֹהֶיךָ

“but you shall fear from your God”

See how you translated this phrase in 25:36. Alternate translation: [but you shall honor your God]

Leviticus 25:43 (#1)

בְּפָרֶךְ

“with harshness”

Here, **harshness** is an abstract noun that refers to cruel or severe treatment. If your language does not use abstract nouns for the idea of **harshness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [or treat him harshly] or [or act cruelly toward him]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 25:44 (#2)

וְעַבְדְּךָ וַאֲמָתְךָ & עֶבֶד וְאָמָה

“And your male slave and your female slave & a male slave and a female slave”

These are generic nouns referring to any slaves in these categories. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And any of your male slaves or your female slaves ... male slaves or female slaves]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 25:44 (#1)

וְעַבְדְּךָ

“And your male slave”

This introduces a new, but related, topic. If the connection between this statement and the previous one is not clear, you may want to use a different connecting word to show how this statement relates to what comes before it. Alternate translation: [As for your male slave]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Leviticus 25:46 (#1)

בְּפָרֶךְ

“with harshness”

See how you translated this phrase in 25:43. Alternate translation: [harshly]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 25:47 (#2)

This entire verse is a hypothetical situation. Express this possible condition in a way that would be natural in your language.

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Leviticus 25:47 (#4)

וְנִמְכַּר

“and sells himself”

The words **sells himself** describes someone taking action on themselves. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate that the same person is both the subject and the object of the action. Alternate translation: [and becomes a slave] or [and sells himself into slavery]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Leviticus 25:47 (#1)

As you are translating verses 47–55 keep in mind that the situation described is that of an Israelite who has become a slave to a foreigner.

Leviticus 25:47 (#3)

תַּשִּׂיג יַד גֵּר וְתוֹשָׁב עִמָּךְ

“the hand of a sojourner or temporary resident with you reaches”

See how you translated this common expression in 25:26. Alternate translation: [a foreigner living among you becomes wealthy]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 25:48 (#1)

גְּאֻלָּה תִּהְיֶה־לּוֹ

“redemption may be to him”

This means he can be freed by someone paying a price. Alternate translation: [he can be redeemed] or [someone can buy back his freedom]

Leviticus 25:49 (#1)

יָדוֹ

“his hand reaches”

See how you translated this idiom in 25:26. Alternate translation: [he becomes prosperous]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 25:49 (#2)

וְנִגְאַל

“then he may redeem himself”

This phrase describes someone taking action on themselves. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate that the same person is both the subject and the object of the action. Alternate translation: [then he may buy back his own freedom]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Leviticus 25:50 (#3)

וְהָיָה כֶּסֶף מִמְכָּרוֹ בְּמִסְפַּר שָׁנִים

“and the silver of his sale shall be by the number of years”

Here, **the silver of his sale** refers to the price that he needs to pay to buy back his freedom. This price should be calculated based on the number of years remaining until the Year of Jubilee. You could include this information if it would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and the price that he needs to pay to buy back his freedom should be calculated by the number of years until the Year of Jubilee]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 25:50 (#2)

לוֹ

“to him”

Here, **to him** refers to the buyer. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [to the buyer]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 25:50 (#4)

כִּימֵי שָׂכִיר יִהְיֶה עִמּוֹ

“Like the days of a hired worker he shall be with him”

This compares the way to calculate the redemption price to how a hired worker is paid. Just as a hired worker is paid for the days he works, the redemption price should be based on the years of service remaining. Alternate translation: [The price should be calculated as if he were a hired worker being paid for those years]

See: Simile

Leviticus 25:50 (#1)

הִמָּמָּכְרוֹ

“his selling himself”

This phrase describes someone taking action on themselves. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate that the same person is both the subject and the object of the action. Alternate translation: [his becoming a slave]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Leviticus 25:51 (#1)

יָשִׁיב גְּאֻלָּתוֹ מִכֶּסֶף מִקְנָתוֹ

“he shall pay back his redemption from the silver of his purchase”

Here, this describes how to calculate the price of freedom. The person must pay back part of the original purchase price, based on how many years are left until the Year of Jubilee. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [he must pay back the portion of the original purchase price that matches the remaining years of service] or [he must repay part of what the buyer paid for him, calculated according to the remaining years]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 25:51 (#4)

יָשִׁיב גְּאֻלָּתוֹ מִכֶּסֶף מִקְנָתוֹ

“he shall pay back his redemption from the silver of his purchase”

Here, this describes how to calculate the price of freedom. The person must pay back part of the original purchase price, based on how many years are left until the Year of Jubilee. You could include this information if it would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [he must pay back the portion of the original purchase price that matches the remaining years of service] or [he must repay part of what the buyer paid for him, calculated according to the remaining years]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 25:51 (#2)

רַבִּבוֹת בַּשָּׁנִים

“many in the years”

This refers to having many years remaining until the Year of Jubilee. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express this explicitly. Alternate translation: [many years remaining] or [many years left]

Leviticus 25:51 (#3)

לְפִיהֶן

“to their mouth”

See how you translated this common expression in 25:16. This expression means “according to” or “in proportion to.” Use a natural expression in your language that communicates this meaning. Alternate translation: [according to the number of years] or [based on the remaining years]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 25:52 (#1)

כְּפִי שָׁנָיו

“According to the mouth of his years”

See how you translated this common expression in 25:51. Alternate translation: [According to the number of years remaining]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 25:53 (#2)

לְעֵינֶיךָ

“before your eyes”

Here, **before your eyes** means that the other Israelites are to watch how Israelite slaves are treated by their masters. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [under your supervision] or [while you watch]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 25:53 (#1)

יִהְיֶה עִמּוֹ לֹא־יִרְדֶּנּוּ

“he shall be with him. He shall not rule over him”

In the first sentence, **he** refers to the slave and **him** refers to the foreign buyer. In the second sentence, **He** refers to the foreign buyer and **him** refers to the slave. Alternate translation: [the slave shall be with the owner. The owner shall not rule over the slave]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 25:54 (#1)

וּבָנָיו

“and his sons”

Here, **sons** refers to children of both genders. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both male and female children. Alternate translation: [and his children]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Leviticus 25:55 (#1)

אוֹתָם

“them”

Here, **them** refers to the sons of Israel. In some languages, this pronoun may be redundant and can be omitted. Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Leviticus - Chapter 26 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter presents blessings and curses based on obedience:

1. Blessings for obedience (26:1–13)
- Agricultural prosperity
- Military victory
- God’s presence

1. Curses for disobedience (26:14–39)
- Progressive punishments
- Natural disasters

- Military defeats

1. Hope for restoration (26:40–46)

- Confession and repentance
- God's faithfulness to covenant

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Covenant faithfulness
The chapter emphasizes the relationship between obedience and blessing:

- Obedience brings prosperity
- Disobedience brings punishment
- God remains faithful to His covenant
- Shows God's justice and mercy

Progressive discipline
Punishments increase in severity:

- Starts with mild consequences
- Becomes more severe with continued disobedience
- Each stage gives opportunity for repentance
- Shows God's patience and justice

Divine presence
God's presence is central to the promises:

- His presence brings blessing
- His opposition brings curse
- He can be reconciled through repentance
- Shows importance of relationship with God

National consequences
Actions affect the whole community:

- Blessings benefit everyone
- Curses impact everyone
- Individual choices have communal effects
- Shows corporate responsibility

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Metaphors and personification
The chapter uses many metaphors that need careful translation:

- "Walk in my statutes" means "obey my laws"
- "Break the pride of your strength" means "destroy what makes you proud"
- "Set my face against you" means "oppose you"
- Consider how your language expresses these concepts naturally

Idioms
The chapter uses several idioms that need careful translation:

- "Break the staff of bread" means "cause famine"
- "Fall by the sword" means "die in battle"
- "Turn to you" means "show favor"
- Use natural expressions in your language

Repeated phrases
Several phrases appear multiple times for emphasis:

- "I am Yahweh"
- "Seven times"
- "Walk in hostility"
- Maintain the emphasis while using natural expressions

(See: law, law of Moses, law of Yahweh, law of God; repent, repentance; and promise, promised)

Leviticus 26:1 (#1)

כִּֽי־אֲנִ֥י יְהוָ֖ה אֱלֹהֵיכֶֽם

"for I {am} Yahweh your God"

Here, **for I am Yahweh your God** gives the reason for the commands that precede it. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases. Alternate translation: [because I am Yahweh your God] or [Obey these commands because I am Yahweh your God]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 26:2 (#1)

אֲנִ֥י יְהוָֽה

"I {am} Yahweh"

See how you translated this in 26:1. Here, **I am Yahweh** gives the reason for the command. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a connecting word to make this relationship clear. Alternate translation: [because I am Yahweh]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 26:2 (#2)

This verse is identical to 19:30. See how you translated it there.

Leviticus 26:3 (#1)

בְּחֻקֹּתַי תֵּלֵכוּ

“you walk in my statutes”

Here, **walk in my statutes** represents living according to God’s laws. Use a natural way in your language to express following or obeying laws. Alternate translation: [you live according to my laws]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 26:3 (#2)

בְּחֻקֹּתַי תֵּלֵכוּ וְאֶת־מִצְוֹתַי תִּשְׁמְרוּ וַעֲשִׂיתֶם אֹתָם

“you walk in my statutes and keep my commandments and do them”

These three phrases mean basically the same thing. The second and third phrases emphasize the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could combine these phrases and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [you completely and faithfully follow my rules]

See: Parallelism

Leviticus 26:4 (#2)

וְנָתְנָה הָאָרֶץ יְבוּלָהּ וְעֵץ הַשָּׂדֶה יִתֵּן פִּרְיוֹ

“and the land will give its produce, and the tree of the field will give its fruit”

Here, **the land** and **trees** are spoken of as if they were people who could give gifts. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and crops will grow in the land, and trees in the fields will produce fruit]

See: Personification

Leviticus 26:4 (#3)

וְעֵץ הַשָּׂדֶה יִתֵּן פִּרְיוֹ

“and the tree of the field will give its fruit”

Here, **tree of the field** refers to any fruit-bearing tree and not a specific tree. Use a natural expression in your language that includes all such trees. Alternate translation: [and fruit trees will give their fruit] or [and trees that grow in your fields will give their fruit]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 26:4 (#1)

וְנָתַתִּי גִשְׁמֵיכֶם בְּעִתָּם וְנָתְנָה הָאָרֶץ יְבוּלָהּ וְעֵץ הַשָּׂדֶה יִתֵּן פִּרְיוֹ

“then I will give your rains in their time, and the land will give its produce, and the tree of the field will give its fruit”

Here, **I will give** leaves out “to you” which is understood. If your language requires this information to be stated explicitly, include it. Alternate translation: [then I will give to you your rains in their time, and the land will give its produce to you, and the tree of the field will give its fruit to you]

See: Ellipsis

Leviticus 26:5 (#2)

אֶת־זָרַע

“seed”

Here, **seed** represents the activity of planting. Use a phrase that clearly refers to the planting season. Alternate translation: [planting time] or [the time to plant]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 26:5 (#3)

לִשְׂבְעָה וִישַׁבְתֶּם לָבֶטַח

“to satisfaction, and you will dwell in security”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **satisfaction** and **security**, you could express these ideas in a natural way in your language. Alternate translation: [until you are satisfied, and you will live safely]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 26:5 (#1)

וְהִשִּׂיג לָכֶם דַּיִשׁ אֶת־בָּצִיר וּבָצִיר יַשִּׂיג אֶת־זָרַע

“And threshing will reach grape harvest for you, and grape harvest will reach seed”

Here, **threshing will reach** means the harvests will be so abundant that one crop’s processing will overlap with the next harvest. Express this abundance clearly in your language. Alternate translation: [And you will have such abundant harvests that you will still be threshing grain when it is time to harvest grapes, and still be harvesting grapes when it is time to plant seeds]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 26:6 (#2)

וְחֶרֶב לֹא־תַעֲבֹר בְּאַרְצְכֶם

“and a sword will not pass through in your land”

Here, **sword** represents war or armed conflict. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and there will be no war in your land] or [and no army will attack your land]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 26:6 (#1)

וְנָתַתִּי שָׁלוֹם

“And I will give peace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express this in a natural way in your language. Alternate translation: [I will make things peaceful] or [I will cause you to live peacefully]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 26:7 (#1)

לִפְנֵיכֶם לָחָרֶב

“to your faces to the sword”

Here, **to your faces** means “before you” or “in front of you” in battle. Use an equivalent expression in your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when you attack them] or [before your attack]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 26:7 (#2)

וְנָפְלוּ לִפְנֵיכֶם לָחָרֶב

“and they will fall to your faces to the sword”

Here, **fall ... to the sword** is a common expression meaning to die in battle. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, use a comparable expression in your translation that does have that meaning, or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they will die in battle before you] or [and they will be killed to your faces]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 26:8 (#1)

וְרָדְפוּ מִכֶּם חֲמִשָּׁה מֵאָה וּמֵאָה מִכֶּם רְבָבָה יִרְדֹּפוּ

“And five from you will pursue a hundred, and a hundred from you will pursue ten thousand”

These parallel statements are expressed in a poetic, proverbial way to emphasize how God will empower a small number to defeat many enemies. If your language has poetic or proverbial ways to express this kind of dramatic contrast, use them. Alternate translation: [Five will chase a hundred, a hundred will chase ten thousand] or express it as a proverb like [Your fives will scatter hundreds, your hundreds will scatter thousands]

See: Parallelism

Leviticus 26:8 (#2)

וְנָפְלוּ אֹיְבֵיכֶם לִפְנֵיכֶם לָחָרֶב

“and your enemies will fall to your faces to the sword”

See how you translated this in 26:7. Here, **fall to your faces to the sword** means to die in battle.

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 26:9 (#2)

וְהִפְרֵיתִי אֶתְכֶם וְהִרְבֵּיתִי אֶתְכֶם

“and make you fruitful and multiply you”

See how you translated this in Genesis 1:28. Here, **make you fruitful and multiply you** means to cause the people to have many children and descendants. Alternate translation: [and cause you to have many children and descendants]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 26:9 (#1)

וּפָנִיתִי אֲלֵיכֶם

“And I will turn to you”

Here, **I will turn to you** is a common expression meaning to show favor. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will favor you] or [I will bless you]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 26:10 (#2)

מִפְּנֵי חָדָשׁ

“from the face of the new”

Here, **from the face of** is a common expression meaning to make room for something. Use a natural way in your language to express making space available. Alternate translation: [to make room for the new grain] or [because you need space for the new crop]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 26:10 (#1)

וַאֲכַלְתֶּם יָשָׁן נוֹשָׁן וְיָשָׁן מִפְּנֵי חָדָשׁ תּוֹצִיאוּ

“And you will eat old {grain that is} getting old, and you will bring out the old from the face of the new”

Here, **old** is repeated three times to emphasize abundance, not staleness. Express this emphasis on abundance in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [You will still have plenty of last year’s grain when the new harvest comes]

See: Parallelism

Leviticus 26:10 (#3)

יָשָׁן & וְיָשָׁן & חָדָשׁ

“old {grain & and & the old & the new”

Here, **old** and **new** leave out the word “grain” or “crop” which is understood. If your language requires this to be stated explicitly, include it. Alternate translation: [old grain ... and ... the old grain ... the new grain] or [old crop ... and ... the old crop ... the new crop]

See: Ellipsis

Leviticus 26:11 (#1)

נַפְשִׁי

“my soul”

Here, **my soul** represents all of God. Use a natural way in your language to refer to the whole person. Alternate translation: [I] or [I, myself]

See: Synecdoche

Leviticus 26:12 (#1)

וְהָיִיתִי לָכֶם לֵאלֹהִים וְאַתֶּם תִּהְיוּ־לִי לְעָם

“and be God to you, and you will be a people to me”

Here, this means “I will be your God and you will be my people.” If your language requires the relationship to be stated more explicitly, you can do so. Alternate translation: [I will be your God and you will be my people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 26:12 (#2)

וְהִתְהַלַּכְתִּי בְתוֹכְכֶם

“And I will walk in your midst”

Here God is described as walking among his people like a person would. Use a natural way in your language to express God’s presence among people. Alternate translation: [I will live among you] or [I will be present with you]

See: Personification

Leviticus 26:13 (#1)

וָאֶשְׁבֹּר מֹטֹת עֻלְּכֶם

“and I broke the bars of your yoke”

Here, **bars of your yoke** represents slavery. Use a natural way in your language to express freedom from slavery. Alternate translation: [I freed you from slavery] or [I released you from bondage]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 26:13 (#2)

וָאוֹלֵךְ אֶתְכֶם קוֹמְמִיּוּת

“and made you walk upright”

Here, **walk upright** represents freedom and dignity. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and made you free people] or [and gave you dignity]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 26:14 (#1)

וְאִם

“But if”

Here, **But if** introduces a contrast between verses 3 and 4. Use a natural way in your language to show this contrast. Alternate translation: [However, if]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Leviticus 26:14 (#2)

לֹא תִשְׁמְעוּ לִי

“you will not listen to me”

Here, **listen to** represents obedience. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression in your translation or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you will not obey me] or [you refuse to do what I say]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 26:15 (#2)

בְּחֻקֹּתַי & אֶת־מִשְׁפָּטַי & מִצְוֹתַי & אֶת־בְּרִיתִי

“my statutes & my judgments & my commandments & my covenant”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for these ideas, you could express the same ideas in other ways.

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 26:15 (#1)

תִּגְעַ֣ל נַפְשְׁכֶ֔ם

“your soul detests”

Here, **your soul** represents the whole person. If it would be helpful to your readers, use a natural way in your language to refer to the whole person. Alternate translation: [you detest] or [you hate]

See: Synecdoche

Leviticus 26:16 (#2)

בֶּ֣הָלָ֔ה

“terror”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **terror**, you could express this idea with a verb or adjective. Use a natural way in your language to express extreme fear. Alternate translation: [things that terrify you] or [frightening things]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 26:16 (#3)

וּזְרַעְתֶּ֥ם לָרִיק֖ זַרְעֲכֶ֑ם וַאֲכָלֻ֖הוּ אֹיְבֵיכֶֽם

“And you shall sow your seed {in} vain, and your enemies shall eat it”

Here the second phrase gives the reason for the first. Use a connecting word that makes it clear that what follows is the reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [You will plant your seed uselessly because your enemies will eat what grows]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 26:16 (#4)

וְהִפְקַדְתִּ֤י

“And I will appoint”

Here this begins a section describing the results of disobedience. Use a natural way in your language to show this is the consequence of their actions. Alternate translation: [As a result, I will send] or [Because of this, I will bring]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 26:16 (#1)

אַף־אֲנִ֣י אֶֽעֱשֶׂה

“then} I also, I will do”

Here the repetition of **I** emphasizes that God will certainly act. Use a way in your language to show emphasis on God’s certain action. Alternate translation: [then I will certainly do]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 26:17 (#1)

וְנָתַתִּ֥י פָנַ֖י בָּכֶ֑ם

“And I will set my face against you”

Here, **set my face against** represents anger and opposition. Use a natural way in your language to express divine anger. Alternate translation: [I will oppose you] or [I will show my anger against you]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 26:17 (#2)

וְנִגַּפְתֶּ֣ם

“and you shall be struck down”

Here, **struck down** represents being killed. Use an equivalent expression for death or plain language in your translation. Alternate translation: [and you will be killed] or [and you will die]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 26:17 (#4)

This verse describes the opposite situation from verses 7–8, where God’s people were victorious. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could make this contrast clear.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 26:17 (#3)

לִפְנֵ֥י אֹיְבֵיכֶ֖ם

“to the face of your enemies”

Here, **to the face of** means “before” or “by” in battle. Use an equivalent expression or plain language to express being defeated by enemies. Alternate translation: [by your enemies] or [when your enemies attack you]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 26:18 (#3)

חַטֹּאתֵיכֶֽם

“your sins”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **sins**, you could express this as an action. Use a natural way in your language to express wrongdoing. Alternate translation: [your wrongdoing] or [your evil actions]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 26:18 (#4)

לֹ֣א תִשְׁמְע֣וּ לִ֑לָי

“you will not listen to me”

See how you translated this in 26:14. Here, **listen to** represents obedience. Use a natural way in your language to express disobedience. Alternate translation: [you will not obey me] or [you refuse to do what I say]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 26:18 (#1)

וְאִ֨ם־עַד־אֵ֜לֶּה

“And if up to these {things”

This means “if you still do not obey after all this discipline.” Express this clearly in your language. Alternate translation: [If you still do not obey me after all this punishment and] or [If you continue to disobey despite this discipline and]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 26:18 (#2)

שֶׁ֖שַׁע

“seven {times”

Here, **seven times** could mean either complete punishment or greatly increased punishment. If you need to express the meaning of this expression in your language, consider following the interpretation of an accepted regional translation. Alternate translation: [completely] or [much more severely]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 26:19 (#3)

אֶת־שְׁמֵיכֶ֗ם כַּבַּרְזֶ֔ל וְאֶת־אַרְצְכֶ֖ם כַּנְּחֹשֶֽׁת

“your heavens like iron and your land like bronze”

These phrases **like iron** and **like bronze** compare the sky to iron and the land to bronze to show there will be no rain and the ground will be hard. Use natural comparisons in your language to express severe drought. Alternate translation: [the sky smooth as metal with no cloud blemishes and the ground as impenetrable to plant roots as metal]

See: Simile

Leviticus 26:19 (#4)

אֶת־גְּא֣וֹן עֻזְּכֶ֑ם

“the pride of your strength”

This could mean either that they are very proud or that they are proud of their strength. Choose the interpretation that best fits your context. Alternate translation: [your strong pride] or [your pride in your power]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 26:19 (#1)

וְשָׁבַרְתִּ֣י אֶת־גְּא֣וֹן עֻזְּכֶ֑ם

“Then I will break the pride of your strength”

Here, **Then I will break the pride of your strength** introduces God’s goal for the discipline described in the rest of this verse and the next verse. He will make the heavens like iron and the land like bronze to humble the people. Express this purpose clearly in your language. Alternate translation: [And so I will make you humble] or [Because of this, I will destroy what makes you proud]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Leviticus 26:19 (#2)

וְשָׁבַרְתִּ֣י אֶת־גְּא֣וֹן עֻזְּכֶ֑ם

“Then I will break the pride of your strength”

Here, **break** compares pride to something physical that can be broken, like a stick or rod. This represents how God will destroy their arrogance. Use a natural way in your language to express humbling someone. Alternate translation: [Then I will destroy your arrogance] or [Then I will take away what makes you proud]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 26:20 (#1)

וְתַ֥ם לָרִ֖יק כֹּחֲכֶ֑ם

“And your strength shall be exhausted {in} vain”

This tells what will happen if the people continue to disobey. Use a natural way in your language to express this hypothetical situation. Alternate translation: [If you continue to disobey, then your strength will be used up for nothing] or [Then all your hard work will accomplish nothing]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Leviticus 26:20 (#2)

לָרִיק

“in} vain”

The abstract concept **in vain** can be expressed as an action that produces no results. Use a natural way in your language to express futile effort. Alternate translation: [uselessly] or [without any result]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 26:20 (#3)

וְלֹא־תִתֵּ֥ן אַרְצָכֶם֙ אֶת־יְבוּלָ֔הּ וְעֵ֥ץ הָאָ֖רֶץ לֹ֣א יִתֵּ֑ן פִּרְיֽוֹ

“and your land shall not give its produce, and the tree of the land shall not give its fruit”

Here the **land** and **tree** are spoken of as if they were people who could give things. Use a natural way in your language to express failed crops. Alternate translation: [and nothing will grow in your land, and your trees will not produce any fruit] or [and nothing will grow in your land and on your trees]

See: Personification

Leviticus 26:21 (#3)

וְלֹ֥א תֹאבֶ֖ו לִשְׁמֹ֥עַ לִֽי

“and are not willing to listen to me”

See how you translated this in 26:14. Here, **listen to** represents obedience. Use a natural way in your language to express disobedience. Alternate translation: [and are not willing to obey me] or [and refuse to do what I say]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 26:21 (#1)

וְאִם־תֵּלְכ֥וּ עִמִּ֖י קֶ֑רִי וְלֹ֥א תֹאבֶ֖ו לִשְׁמֹ֥עַ לִ֛י וְיָסַפְתִּ֥י עֲלֵיכֶ֖ם מַכָּ֥ה שֶׁ֛בַע כְּחַטֹּאתֵיכֶֽם

“And if you walk with me {in} hostility and are not willing to listen to me, then I will add on you a plague seven {times} according to your sins”

Many parts of this verse are similar to verse 18. See how you translated those parts in 26:18.

Leviticus 26:21 (#4)

שֶׁ֛בַע

“seven {times”

See how you translated this in 26:18. Alternate translation: [much more severe]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 26:21 (#5)

כְּחַטֹּאתֵיכֶֽם

“according to your sins”

See how you translated this in 26:18. If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **sins**, it can be expressed as an action. Or you could use another way that is natural in your language to express wrongdoing. Alternate translation: [for your wrongdoing] or [for your evil actions]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 26:21 (#2)

תֵּלְכ֥וּ עִמִּ֖י קֶ֑רִי

“you walk with me {in} hostility”

Here, **walk with me in hostility** is speaking of how a person lives as if it were a way or path that a person was walking along. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you continue to oppose me] or [you persist in being hostile to me]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 26:22 (#2)

וְשִׁכְּלָ֥ה אֶתְכֶ֖ם

“and it will bereave you”

Here, **and it will bereave you** is a polite way of saying “they will kill your children.” Use a direct term for killing to avoid ambiguity. Alternate translation: [and it will kill your children] or [and it will wipe out your children]

See: Euphemism

Leviticus 26:22 (#1)

אֶת־חַיַּ֣ת הַשָּׂדֶ֔ה

“the animal of the field”

Here, **animal of the field** is not referring to a specific animal. It means animals in general. If it would be helpful for your readers, use a general term for wild animals or specify if your language has different terms for various wild animals. Alternate translation: [wild animals] or [the animals of the field]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 26:23 (#1)

וְאִם־בְּאֵ֣לֶּה

“And if by these {things”

And if by these things introduces a condition that could happen similar to verse 18. Use a connecting structure that clearly indicates this condition. Alternate translation: [If by these things] or [And if these things happen and]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Leviticus 26:23 (#2)

וַהֲלַכְתֶּ֥ם עִמִּ֖י קֶֽרִי

“but walk with me {in} hostility”

Here, **walk with me in hostility** is a metaphor for living in opposition to Yahweh. Use a natural expression in your language to convey ongoing opposition or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but continue to oppose me] or [but live in opposition to me]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 26:23 (#4)

קֶֽרִי

“in} hostility”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **hostility**, use an appropriate term in your language that conveys the concept of opposition or enmity. Alternate translation: [in opposition] or [in enmity]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 26:23 (#3)

לִ֑לְי

“my discipline”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **discipline**, use an appropriate term in your language that conveys the concept of punishment or correction. Alternate translation: [my punishment] or [my correction]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 26:24 (#4)

וְהִכֵּיתִ֥י אֶתְכֶ֛ם גַּם־אָ֖נִי שֶׁ֣שַׁע עַל־חַטֹּאתֵיכֶֽם

“and I myself will also strike you seven {times} for your sins”

The phrase **strike you seven times** is a common expression indicating either greatly increased punishment or complete punishment. Choose the interpretation that fits your context. Alternate translation: [and I will strike you completely for your sins] or [and I will punish you sevenfold for your sins]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 26:24 (#5)

עַל־חַטֹּאתֵיכֶֽם

“for your sins”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **sins**, you could express this idea in another way that conveys wrongdoing. Alternate translation: [because you sinned]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 26:24 (#1)

וְהָלַכְתִּ֥י אַף־אֲנִ֖י & וְהִכֵּיתִ֥י & גַּם־אָֽנִי

“then I myself will also walk & and I myself will also strike”

The intensive pronoun **myself** represents the pronoun “I” that God uses in the original even though the verbs translated as **walk** and **strike** already include this meaning. Doing this adds emphasis to what he is saying. If your language uses explicit pronouns for emphasis, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of bringing out this emphasis. Alternate translation: [then I will also walk ... and I will also punish] or [then I myself will walk ... and I will personally strike]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Leviticus 26:24 (#2)

וְהָלַכְתִּ֥י אַף־אֲנִ֛י עִמָּכֶ֖ם בְּקֶֽרִי

“then I myself will also walk with you in hostility”

Here, **walk with you in hostility** is a common expression that means “living in opposition.” Use a comparable expression in your language to convey ongoing opposition or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will continue to oppose you] or [I will persist in being hostile towards you]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 26:24 (#3)

וְהָלַכְתִּ֥י אַף־אֲנִ֛י עִמָּכֶ֖ם בְּקֶֽרִי

“then I myself will also walk with you in hostility”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **hostility**, you could express the same idea in another way to convey the concept of opposition or enmity. Alternate translation: [then I, I also will walk hostilely with you]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 26:25 (#2)

חֶ֖רֶב נֹקֶ֣מֶת

“a sword avenging”

Here, **a sword** is spoken of as if it were a living thing that could be an agent of vengeance. Use a natural expression in your language that conveys the idea or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the avenging sword of] or [the sword which acts in avenging]

See: Personification

Leviticus 26:25 (#9)

וְנִתַּתֶּ֖ם בְּיַד־אוֹיֵֽב

“and you will be given into the hand of an enemy”

The expression **you will be given into the hand of an enemy** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, the context indicates that it is God. Alternate translation: [and I will give you into the hand of an enemy]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 26:25 (#3)

נֹקֶ֣מֶת נְקַם־בְּרִ֑ית

“avenging the vengeance of the covenant”

Here, **avenging the vengeance of the covenant** uses parallelism for emphasis. Use a similar parallel structure if it would be helpful to your readers, or express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [punishing according to the covenant’s vengeance]

See: Parallelism

Leviticus 26:25 (#4)

נְקַם־בְּרִ֑ית

“the vengeance of the covenant”

Here, **the vengeance of the covenant** refers to the curses associated with violating the covenant. Use your language’s term for these consequences. Alternate translation: [the covenant’s curses] or [the curses of the covenant]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Leviticus 26:25 (#5)

נְקַם

“the vengeance of”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **vengeance**, you could express the same idea in a way that conveys punishment in your language. Alternate translation: [the punishments of] or [the retributions of]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 26:25 (#6)

וְנֶאֱסַפְתֶּ֖ם אֶל־עָרֵיכֶ֑ם

“and you will be gathered into your cities”

If your language does not use a passive form like **and you will be gathered into your cities**, you could express the same idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and you will gather to hide in your cities]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 26:25 (#7)

וְנֶאֱסַפְתֶּ֖ם אֶל־עָרֵיכֶ֑ם

“and you will be gathered into your cities”

Here, **and you will be gathered into your cities** means that people will flee to their cities for safety. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if it would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and you will flee to your cities to seek safety] or [and you will gather in your cities for protection]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 26:25 (#8)

וְשִׁלַּ֥חְתִּי דֶ֖בֶר

“And I will send pestilence”

Here, **And I will send pestilence** connects to the previous clause to show continued discipline. Use a connecting word to show how this statement relates to what comes before it. Alternate translation: [Furthermore, I will send pestilence] or [Moreover, I will send pestilence]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Leviticus 26:25 (#10)

וְנִתַּתֶּם בְּיַד־אוֹיֵב

“and you will be given into the hand of an enemy”

Here, **the hand of an enemy** represents being captured or killed by the enemy. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you will be captured by the enemy] or [and you will be killed by the enemy]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 26:25 (#11)

אוֹיֵב

“an enemy”

Here, **an enemy** is not referring to a specific enemy but enemies in general. Use a general term for enemies.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 26:25 (#1)

וְהֵבֵאתִי עֲלֵיכֶם חֶרֶב

“And I will bring upon you a sword”

Here, **a sword** represents “war.” Use an equivalent expression or plain language that appropriately conveys war. Alternate translation: [I will bring war upon you] or [I will wage war against you]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 26:26 (#1)

בְּשִׁבְרִי לָכֶם מַטֵּה־לֶחֶם

“When I break to you the staff of bread”

Here, **the staff of bread** is a common expression meaning “famine.” Use a comparable expression from your language that conveys the same meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [When I cause famine] or [When I bring famine upon you]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 26:26 (#2)

וְאָפוּ עֶשֶׂר נָשִׁים לַחְמְכֶם בְּתַנּוּר אֶחָד

“then ten women will bake your bread in one oven”

Here, **then ten women will bake your bread in one oven** implies severe food scarcity. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if it would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [then ten women will bake your bread in one oven due to scarcity] or [then ten women will bake your bread in a single oven because of famine]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 26:26 (#3)

וְהֵשִׁיבוּ לַחְמְכֶם בַּמִּשְׁקָל

“and they will return your bread by weight”

Here, **and they will return your bread by weight** means that bread will be distributed carefully to families. Use an expression that conveys precise distribution. Alternate translation: [and they will carefully measure and distribute your bread to their families] or [and they will return your bread in measured portions to their families]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 26:26 (#4)

וְלֹא תִשְׂבָּעוּ

“but not be satisfied”

Here, **but not be satisfied** shows a contrast between expectation and reality, indicating that people will not be content despite receiving some bread. In your translation, indicate this contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [but you will not be satisfied] or [yet you will not be content]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Leviticus 26:27 (#1)

בְּקֶרִי

“in hostility”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **hostility**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [as my enemy] or [by rebelling against me]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 26:28 (#2)

קֶרִי

“hostility”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **hostility**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [opposition] or [enmity]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 26:28 (#3)

וְיִסַּרְתִּתִי אֶתְכֶם֙ אַף־אֲנִ֣י שֶׁ֔בַע

“and I myself will also discipline you seven {times”

The intensive pronoun **myself** represents the pronoun “I” that God uses in the original even though the verb translated as **discipline** already includes this meaning. Doing this adds emphasis to what he is saying. If your language uses explicit pronouns for emphasis, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of bringing out this emphasis. Alternate translation: [and I will personally discipline you seven times]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Leviticus 26:28 (#1)

בַּחֲמַת־קֶ֖רִי

“in the heat of hostility”

Here, **in the heat of hostility** is an expression comparing strong feelings of hostility to the intensity of a fire. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [amid strong hostility] or [in the midst of fierce opposition]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 26:29 (#1)

וַאֲכַלְתֶּ֣ם בְּשַׂ֣ר בְּנֵיכֶ֔ם וּבְשַׂ֥ר בְּנֹתֵיכֶ֖ם תֹּאכֵֽלוּ׃

“And you will eat the flesh of your sons, and the flesh of your daughters you will eat”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [And you will eat the flesh of your sons and daughters]

See: Poetry

Leviticus 26:30 (#1)

וְגָעֲלָ֥ה נַפְשִׁ֖י אֶתְכֶֽם

“and my soul will detest you”

Here, **my soul** represents the speaker (Yahweh). Use a natural expression in your language that maintains the emphasis on personal detestation. Alternate translation: [and my soul will hate you] or [and I will deeply despise you]

See: Synecdoche

Leviticus 26:31 (#1)

בְּרֵ֣יחַ נִיחֹחֲכֶֽם

“your pleasing aromas”

Here, **pleasing aromas** represents sacrifices, as God often refers to the pleasant smells of burnt offerings and incense. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the pleasant scents of your sacrifices] or [the delightful aromas of your offerings]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 26:32 (#1)

וַהֲשִׁמֹתִ֣י אֲנִ֔י אֶת־הָאָ֖רֶץ

“And I, I will make the land desolate”

See how you translated this in 26:16. Alternate translation: [I will also make the land desolate] or [I, myself, will make the land desolate]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 26:32 (#2)

וְשָׁמְמ֥וּ עָלֶ֖יהָ אֹיְבֵיכֶ֑ם הַיֹּשְׁבִ֖ים בָּֽהּ׃

“and your enemies, the dwellers in it, will be appalled at it”

Here, the connector **and** implies that the reason that the enemies will be appalled is because the land is so desolate. If the connection between this statement and the previous one is not clear, you may want to use a different connecting word to show how this statement relates to what comes before it. Alternate translation: [furthermore, your enemies who dwell in it will be appalled] or [additionally, your enemies residing there will be appalled]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Leviticus 26:33 (#1)

וַהֲרִיקֹתִ֣י אַחֲרֵיכֶ֔ם חָ֖רֶב

“and I will draw out a sword after you”

Here, **a sword** represents war. Use a term that appropriately conveys war or conflict in your language. Alternate translation: [and I will wage war against you] or [and I will bring war upon you]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 26:34 (#1)

תִּרְצֶ֣ה הָאָ֔רֶץ אֶת־שַׁבְּתֹתֶ֖יהָ & תִּשְׁבַּ֣ת הָאָ֑רֶץ וְהִרְצָ֖ת אֶת־שַׁבְּתֹתֶֽיהָ

“the land will enjoy its sabbaths & the land will rest and enjoy its sabbaths”

Here, **the land** is spoken of as if it were a living thing that could rest and enjoy its sabbaths. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the land will observe its sabbaths and rest ... the land will honor its sabbaths by resting]

See: Personification

Leviticus 26:35 (#1)

אֵ֣ת אֲשֶׁ֣ר לֹא־שָׁבְתָ֗ה בְּשַׁבְּתֹתֵיכֶ֛ם בְּשִׁבְתְּכֶ֥ם עָלֶֽיהָ

“what it did not rest in your sabbaths, when you dwelt on it”

Here, **what it did not rest in your sabbaths** means that the land will rest in compensation for the sabbaths the Israelites did not observe. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [what it did not rest during your sabbaths] or [the land will rest for the sabbaths you neglected]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 26:36 (#2)

מֵמֹרַ֥ךְ בִּלְבָבָ֖ם

“faintness into their heart”

Here, **their heart** represents where a person’s thoughts, feelings, and fears exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [fearfulness into their hearts] or [deep anxiety within them]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 26:36 (#4)

וְרָדַ֤ף אוֹתָם֙ קֹ֣ול עָלֶ֣ה נִדָּ֔ף

“And the sound of a driven leaf will chase them”

Here, **the sound of a driven leaf** is spoken of as a living thing actively chasing people. If it would be helpful in your translation, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The sound of a blowing leaf will pursue them] or [The noise of a driven leaf will chase after them]

See: Personification

Leviticus 26:36 (#5)

עָלֶ֣ה נִדָּ֔ף

“a driven leaf”

The expression **a driven leaf** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use this form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [a leaf that the wind drives] or [a leaf that the wind blows]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 26:36 (#1)

וְהַנִּשְׁאָרִ֖ים בָּכֶ֑ם וְהֵבֵ֤אתִי

“And the remaining in you, and I will bring”

This indicates that as for those who survive, Yahweh will bring additional discipline. Use a grammatical structure that clearly connects the survival of some people with the forthcoming actions. Alternate translation: [As for those of you who survive, I will bring] or [And for the remaining among you, I will bring]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Leviticus 26:36 (#6)

חֶ֣רֶב

“a sword”

Here, **a sword** represents a person who is going to harm them. If it would be helpful in your translation, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [a warrior] or [an aggressor]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 26:36 (#3)

בִּלְבָבָ֖ם

“into their heart”

Here, **their heart** shifts Yahweh’s perspective from addressing the survivors directly to speaking about them in the third person. Follow a clear and natural use of pronouns in your language. Alternate translation: [within their hearts] or [inside their hearts]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 26:37 (#4)

תְּקוּמָ֔ה

“power to stand”

Here, **power to stand** means to successfully resist or fight back against enemies. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if it would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [strength to resist] or [ability to defend yourselves]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 26:37 (#5)

לִפְנֵי אֹיְבֵיכֶם

“to the face of your enemies”

See how you translated this expression earlier in this verse. Here it means “before” or “against.” Alternate translation: [against your enemies] or [when your enemies attack]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 26:37 (#1)

וְכָשְׁלוּ אִישׁ־בְּאָחִיו

“And they will stumble, one on his brother”

This is a common expression in the writer’s culture that describes people falling over each other in panic while trying to flee. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [They will fall over each other while running away] or [They will trip over one another as they flee]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 26:37 (#2)

כְּמִפְנֵי־חָרֶב

“as from the face of a sword”

Here, **from the face of** is a common expression of the culture meaning “before” or “in front of.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [as from before a sword] or [as from someone threatening them with a sword]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 26:37 (#3)

כְּמִפְנֵי־חָרֶב

“as from the face of a sword”

The point of this comparison is that just as people flee from an armed enemy, so will these people flee even though no one is actually pursuing them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [as if someone were chasing them with a sword] or [like people running from an armed enemy]

See: Simile

Leviticus 26:37 (#6)

וְכָשְׁלוּ & תִּהְיֶה לָכֶם

“And they will stumble & to you there will be”

The text shifts from talking about the people in the third person (**they**) to addressing them directly (**you**). If it would be helpful for your readers, you could use the same pronoun throughout. Alternate translation: [And you will stumble ... you will have] or [And they will stumble ... they will have]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 26:38 (#1)

וְאָכְלָה אֶתְכֶם אֶרֶץ אֹיְבֵיכֶם

“and the land of your enemies will consume you”

This talks about **the land of your enemies** as if it were a living thing that could consume people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the land of your enemies will devour you]

See: Personification

Leviticus 26:39 (#3)

אֲבֹתָם

“their fathers”

Here, **fathers** represents ancestors. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [their ancestors] or [their forefathers]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 26:39 (#1)

יִמַּקּוּ & יִמָּקּוּ

“will rot away & they will rot away”

This could mean: (1) they will not prosper spiritually, (2) they will not prosper materially, and (3) they will literally die, and their bodies will rot away. Try to use a term broad enough to cover all three meanings in your language. Alternate translation: [will perish ... they will perish] or [will decay ... they will decay]

Leviticus 26:39 (#2)

בַּעֲוֹנָ֖ם & בַּעֲוֹנֹ֥ת

“in their iniquity & in the iniquities of”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **iniquity** or **iniquities**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [in their sins ... in the sins of] or [in their wrongdoings ... in the wrongdoings of]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 26:40 (#1)

וְהִתְוַדּ֔וּ

“And they confess”

Here, **And they confess** introduces a strong contrast. In your translation, indicate this contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [But if they confess] or [However, if they confess]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Leviticus 26:40 (#3)

אֲבֹתָ֑ם

“their fathers”

Here, **fathers** represents ancestors. See how you translated this in 26:39. Alternate translation: [their ancestors] or [their forefathers]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 26:40 (#2)

אֶת־עֲוֹנָ֣ם וְאֶת־עֲוֹן֮ אֲבֹתָם֒ בְּמַעְלָ֣ם אֲשֶׁ֣ר מָעֲל֣וּ־בִ֔י & בְּקֶ֖רִי

“their iniquity and the iniquity of their fathers in their unfaithfulness which they were unfaithful to me & in hostility”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **iniquity**, **unfaithfulness**, and **hostility**, you could express those same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [the ways they sinned and the ways their ancestors sinned and did not faithfully obey me ... hostilely]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 26:40 (#4)

הָלְכ֥וּ עִמִּ֖י בְּקֶֽרִי

“they walked with me in hostility”

See how you translated this in 26:21. Alternate translation: [they lived in hostility]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 26:41 (#1)

אַף־אֲנִ֖י אֵלֵ֣ךְ

“I also, I walked”

See how you translated this repetition in 26:16. Alternate translation: [I, too, walked]

Leviticus 26:41 (#2)

אֵלֵ֥ךְ עִמָּ֛ם בְּקֶ֖רִי

“I walked with them in hostility”

See how you translated this in 26:24. Alternate translation: [I walked with hostility toward them]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 26:41 (#3)

יִכָּנַ֥ע לְבָבָ֛ם הֶֽעָרֵ֖ל

“their uncircumcised heart is humbled”

The expression **their uncircumcised heart is humbled** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [they humble their uncircumcised hearts]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 26:41 (#4)

לְבָבָ֛ם הֶֽעָרֵ֖ל

“their uncircumcised heart”

Here, **heart** represents where a person’s emotions, feelings, and desires exist, and the **uncircumcised heart** represents people who are unwilling to obey God. Since physical circumcision was a sign of being in covenant with God, an uncircumcised heart represents resistance to God’s covenant. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [their stubborn inner nature] or [their rebellious attitude]

See: Metaphor

Leviticus 26:41 (#5)

יִרְצ֖וּ אֶת־עֲוֹנָֽם

“they accept their iniquity”

This could mean either: (1) they accept the punishment that their wrongdoing deserves, or (2) they acknowledge and admit their guilt. If you can translate this in

a way that can capture both meanings do that, otherwise you could follow how your local major language translations understand this phrase. Alternate translation: [they accept their punishment] or [they admit their guilt]

Leviticus 26:43 (#2)

מֵהֶ֑ם

“by them”

The pronoun **them** refers to the Israelites who will be taken away from the land. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [by the Israelites] or [by those people]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 26:43 (#1)

וְהָאָ֖רֶץ תֵּעָזֵ֣ב מֵהֶ֑ם וְתִתְרַ֖ץ

“And the land will be deserted by them and will enjoy”

The expression **And the land will be deserted by them** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And they will desert the land, and the land will enjoy] or [And they will leave the land deserted, and it will enjoy]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 26:43 (#3)

בְּהִשַּׁמָּ֣הּ מֵהֶ֔ם

“in its desolation from them”

Here, **in its desolation from them** implies that the land is empty without them. You could include this information if it would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [while it is empty without them] or [as it becomes desolate without them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 26:43 (#4)

וְהֵ֗ם יִרְצ֛וּ

“And they, they will accept”

Here, the repetition of **they** shifts focus from the land to the people. Use a way that is natural in your language to make this clear. Alternate translation: [And they will accept] or [They, they will accept]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Leviticus 26:43 (#5)

יִרְצ֛וּ אֶת־עֲוֹנָ֖ם

“they will accept their iniquity”

See how you translated this in 26:41. Here it seems more clear that they are accepting the punishment for their wrongdoing. Alternate translation: [they accept their punishment]

Leviticus 26:43 (#6)

יַ֗עַן וּבְיַ֤עַן

“because, even because”

Here, **because, even because** emphatically marks the reason for the result that came before. If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [because] or [even because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 26:44 (#1)

כִּֽי־אֲנִ֣י יְהוָ֔ה אֱלֹהֵיהֶ֑ם

“for I {am} Yahweh their God”

Here, **for I am Yahweh their God** provides a reason for the result. If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of this phrase to appear at the beginning of the sentence. Alternate translation: [because I am Yahweh their God] or [since I am Yahweh their God]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Leviticus 26:45 (#1)

בְּרִ֣ית רִאשֹׁנִ֔ים

“the covenant of the first”

Here, **the covenant of the first** refers to “the first covenant” or “the covenant with the first generation of Israelites”. You could use a comparable expression that accurately reflects this meaning in your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the first covenant with them] or [the covenant with the first generation of Israelites]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 26:45 (#3)

לִֽהְיֹ֥ת לָהֶ֖ם לֵֽאלֹהִ֑ים

“to be God to them”

Here, **to be God to them** represents the goal or purpose of bringing them out of Egypt. Use an expression in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. Alternate translation: [to serve as their God] or [to be their God]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Leviticus 26:45 (#2)

לְעֵינֵי הַגּוֹיִם

“to the eyes of the nations”

Here, the phrase **to the eyes of the nations** represents the people that observed God’s actions. If it would be helpful in your translation, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in the sight of the nations] or [before the nations]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 26:46 (#3)

בֵּינֹו֙ וּבֵ֣ין בְּנֵ֔י יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל בְּהַ֣ר סִינַ֑י בְּיַד־מֹשֶׁ֔ה

“between him and between the sons of Israel on Mount Sinai by the hand of Moses”

Here, **between him and between the sons of Israel on Mount Sinai by the hand of Moses** means that this covenant agreement, which consisted of the statutes, judgments, and laws, was made between Yahweh and the Israelites on Mount Sinai with Moses as mediator and scribe. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to the Israelites at Mount Sinai, which Moses wrote down as their mediator]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 26:46 (#2)

הַחֻקִּ֣ים וְהַמִּשְׁפָּטִ֔ים וְהַתֹּורֹ֖ת

“the statutes and the judgments and the laws”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **the statutes and the judgments and the laws**, you could express the same ideas in different ways. Alternate translation: [the commands, rules, and instructions] or [all that God commanded and instructed]

See: Abstract Nouns

Leviticus 26:46 (#1)

This verse provides a closing summary of at least chapters 17–26, if not an initial closing for the entire book. Use the natural form in your language for expressing the conclusion to the previous section.

See: End of Story

Leviticus 26:46 (#4)

בְּיַד־מֹשֶׁה

“by the hand of Moses”

Here, **by the hand of Moses** represents Moses acting as a mediator and scribe. If it would be helpful in your translation, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [through Moses as mediator] or [with Moses serving as mediator and writing these things down]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus - Chapter 27 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter explains rules about vows and dedications to Yahweh:

1. Valuation of people dedicated to God (27:1–8)
2. Valuation of animals (27:9–13)
3. Valuation of houses and land (27:14–25)
4. Special cases and exceptions (27:26–34)

- Firstborn animals
- Devoted things
- Tithes

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Vows and dedication

The chapter explains different types of dedication:

- Voluntary vows to God
- Dedication of property
- Permanent vs. redeemable gifts

Value assessment

The priest plays an important role in valuation. These show fairness and mercy:

- Set standard values for people
- Adjusted for poor people
- Evaluated property condition

Property rights

There are different rules for different properties. These show the importance of family inheritance:

- Inherited land had special status

- Purchased land treated differently
- Some dedications were permanent

Sacred ownership
Some things automatically belonged to God. This shows God's ultimate ownership:

- Firstborn animals
- Devoted things
- Tithes of crops and animals

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Numbers and measurements
The chapter uses several specific values. Consider using local measurements if helpful:

- Ages: "from one month to five years," "from five to twenty years"
- Money: "shekels of the holy place"
- Volume: "homer of barley"

Repeated phrases
Several phrases appear multiple times. Use consistent translations for these phrases:

- "Your valuation" (refers to priest's assessment)
- "Redeeming he will redeem" (emphasizes certainty)
- "According to your valuation"

Technical terms
The chapter uses specialized religious terms. Consider explaining these terms in footnotes:

- "Devoted thing" means permanently dedicated
- "Field of possession" means inherited land
- "Field of purchase" means bought land

(See: consecrate, consecrated, consecration)

Leviticus 27:2 (#4)

יַפְלִ֣א נֶ֔דֶר

"he makes extraordinary a vow"

This is a common expression meaning to make a special kind of vow. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he makes a special vow] or [he makes a solemn promise]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 27:2 (#1)

דַּבֵּ֤ר אֶל־בְּנֵי֙ יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל וְאָמַרְתָּ֖ אֲלֵהֶ֑ם

"Speak to the sons of Israel and say to them"

In Hebrew, they introduced speech by using two similar phrases. If this kind of repetition would not be natural in your language, you could combine them. Alternate translation: [Say to the sons of Israel]

See: Reduplication

Leviticus 27:2 (#3)

אִ֖ישׁ

"A man"

Here, **a man** refers to any person, not a specific man. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Anyone] or [Any person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 27:2 (#5)

בְּעֶרְכְּךָ֣ נְפָשֹׁ֔ת לַיהוָֽה

"by your valuation of persons to Yahweh"

The phrase **your valuation** occurs 19 times in the chapter. For people, the valuation is set here by Yahweh. For more information see the introduction to chapter 5 and how you translated this in 5:15. Alternate translation: [by the valuation of persons that I, Yahweh, give you]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 27:2 (#2)

בְּנֵ֥י יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל

"the sons of Israel"

Here, **sons of Israel** refers to the entire Israelite people, not just the male descendants or the original 12 sons of Jacob. Alternate translation: [the people of Israel] or [the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 27:3 (#1)

מִבֶּ֣ן עֶשְׂרִ֔ים שָׁנָ֖ה וְעַד־בֶּן־שִׁשִּׁ֣ים שָׁנָ֑ה

"from a son of 20 years and until a son of 60 years"

Here, **son of** is a common expression in the culture which refers to a person who has some characteristic. In this instance, it is referring to males who have age ranges from 20–59. If this would be helpful to your

readers, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from age twenty to age fifty-nine]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 27:3 (#2)

בְּשֶׁשֶׁקֶל הַקֹּדֶשׁ

“by the shekel of the holy place”

In ancient times the silver **shekel of the holy place** was the standard weight kept by the priests in the Dwelling and later the temple. Alternate translation: [according to the standard shekel kept at the holy place]

See: Biblical Money

Leviticus 27:4 (#1)

וְאִם־נְקֵבָה הִוא

“And if {it is} a female”

The ages from verse 3, (twenty to fifty-nine years) carry over to this verse. You could include this information if it would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And if it is a female between twenty and fifty-nine years old]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 27:5 (#1)

מִבֶּן־חָמֵשׁ שָׁנִים וְעַד בֶּן־עֶשְׂרִים שָׁנָה

“from a son of five years and until a son of 20 years”

This is a common expression referring to ages 5–19. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from age five to age nineteen]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 27:6 (#1)

מִבֶּן־חֹדֶשׁ וְעַד בֶּן־חָמֵשׁ שָׁנִים

“from a son of a month and until a son of five years”

This is a common expression referring to ages one month to four years. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from one month old to four years old]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 27:7 (#1)

מִבֶּן־שִׁשִּׁים שָׁנָה וָמַעְלָה

“from a son of 60 years and upward”

This is a common expression referring to ages sixty and older. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [sixty years old and older]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 27:8 (#3)

לִפְנֵי הַכֹּהֵן

“before the face of the priest”

Here, **before the face of the priest** represents being in front of the priest. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in front of the priest] or [in the priest’s presence]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 27:8 (#4)

עַל־פִּי אֲשֶׁר תַּשִּׂיגַ יַד הַנֹּדֵר

“Upon the mouth of what the hand of the one vowing can reach”

This is a common expression meaning according to what someone can pay. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Based on how much the one making the vow can afford]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 27:8 (#1)

וְאִם־מָמֵךְ הוּא מֵעֶרְכֶּךָ

“And if he is too poor from your valuation”

Here **too poor from your valuation** means unable to pay the standard amount. You could make this explicit in your translation if it would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And if he is too poor to pay the standard valuation]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 27:8 (#2)

וְהֶעֱמִידוֹ

“then he shall stand him”

Here, **he** refers to the person making the vow (who is poor), and **him** refers to the person that has been promised to Yahweh that the vower is trying to redeem. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [then the person making the vow shall present the one promised to Yahweh]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 27:9 (#1)

וְאִם־בְּהֵמָה אֲשֶׁר יַקְרִיבוּ מִמֶּנָּה קָרְבָּן לַיהוָה

“And if {it is} an animal which they will present from it an offering to Yahweh”

The meaning of this verse may be unclear due to its complex structure. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation, if it would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And if someone is presenting a portion of an animal as an offering to Yahweh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 27:10 (#1)

לֹא יַחֲלִיפֶנּוּ וְלֹא־יָמִיר אֹתָהּ

“He shall not exchange it and he shall not substitute it”

The words **exchange** and **substitute** mean very similar things and are used together for emphasis. If your language would not use two similar words this way, you could combine them into a single clear expression. Alternate translation: [He must not trade it for another animal]

See: Doublet

Leviticus 27:10 (#2)

טֹוב בְּרָע אוֹ־רַע בְּטֹוב

“good with bad or bad with good”

Some words are left out that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [not a good animal for a worse one or a bad animal for a better one]

See: Ellipsis

Leviticus 27:10 (#3)

וְאִם־הָמֵר יָמִיר

“And if substituting, he substitutes”

This Hebrew expression uses repetition of the verb “substitute” to intensify the idea. If your language does not repeat words for intensification, you could have another way of expressing the same idea. Alternate translation: [And if indeed he substitutes]

See: Reduplication

Leviticus 27:11 (#1)

לִפְנֵי הַכֹּהֵן

“to the face of the priest”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in front of the person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in front of the priest] or [in the priest’s presence]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 27:12 (#1)

כְּעֶרְכְּךָ

“According to your valuation”

Here, **your valuation** refers to the value that the priest determines for the poor person’s offering. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if it would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [The value that you, the priest, determine]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 27:13 (#1)

גָּאֹל יִגְאָלֶנָּה

“redeeming he will redeem it”

This Hebrew expression **redeeming he will redeem it** uses repetition to intensify expression of the idea. If your language does not repeat words for intensification, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [indeed he redeems it]

See: Reduplication

Leviticus 27:13 (#2)

חֲמִישִׁתְךָ

“its fifth”

See how you translated this in 5:16.

See: Fractions

Leviticus 27:14 (#2)

בֵּין טֹוב וּבֵין רָע

“between good and between bad”

The phrase **between good and between bad** means the priest will assess the condition of the house to determine its value. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if it would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [according to the condition of the house]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 27:14 (#1)

וְאִ֣ישׁ

“And a man”

Here, **a man** refers to any person, not a specific man. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Anyone] or [Any person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Leviticus 27:15 (#2)

חֲמִישִׁ֣ית

“a fifth of”

See how you translated this in 27:13.

See: Fractions

Leviticus 27:15 (#3)

וְהָיָ֥ה לֽוֹ

“and it will be to him”

Here, **and it will be to him** is a common expression meaning that ownership will be transferred to him. You could use a comparable expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and it will belong to him]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 27:15 (#1)

הַמַּקְדִּ֖ישׁ

“the one consecrating”

In the phrase **the one consecrating**, the words “his house” are left out but understood from the previous verse. You could supply these words if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [the one consecrating his house]

See: Ellipsis

Leviticus 27:15 (#4)

עֶֽרְכְּךָ֔

“your valuation”

Here, **your valuation** refers to the value that the priest determined based on the condition of the house. You could say that explicitly if it would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the value you determined]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 27:16 (#1)

מִשְּׂדֵ֥ה אֲחֻזָּתֽוֹ

“from the field of his possession”

The phrase **field of his possession** refers to inherited property that was originally given to Israelite families when they entered Canaan. This property generally returned to the family every 49 years at Jubilee. Alternate translation: [from his inherited field]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 27:16 (#3)

חֹ֣מֶר

“a homer of”

A **homer** was a unit of volume that may have been about 220 liters. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this in terms of modern measurement. Alternate translation: [about 220 liters of]

See: Biblical Volume

Leviticus 27:16 (#2)

לְפִ֥י זַרְעֹ֖ו זֶ֣רַע

“to the mouth of its seed, seed of”

This means the amount of seed. It could mean either (1) the amount of seed needed to plant the field or (2) the amount of seed the field produces. Alternate translation: [according to how much seed it takes to plant] or [according to how much seed to produce]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 27:18 (#1)

עַל־פִּ֥י הַשָּׁנִ֖ים

“upon the mouth of the years”

The phrase **upon the mouth of the years** is a common expression meaning based on the number of years. You could use a comparable expression from your language that has the same meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [according to the number of years]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 27:19 (#2)

חֲמִשִּׁשִׁית

“a fifth of”

See how you translated this in 27:13.

See: Fractions

Leviticus 27:19 (#1)

גָּאֹל יִגְאַל

“redeeming he will redeem”

The phrase **redeeming he will redeem** uses repetition to intensify the idea. If your language does not use repetition for intensification, you could use another way that is natural in your language to convey this meaning. Alternate translation: [if indeed he redeems]

See: Reduplication

Leviticus 27:19 (#3)

וְקָם לוֹ

“and it will stand to him”

The phrase **it will stand to him** is a common expression meaning ownership will revert to him. You could use a comparable expression from your language that has the same meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and it will belong to him again]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 27:20 (#1)

לֹא יִגָּאֵל עוֹד

“it shall not be redeemed again”

This verse presents a case where someone tries to profit twice from the same field by dedicating it and then selling it. As a result, they lose the right to the field permanently. You could say this explicitly if it would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [he will permanently lose the right to redeem it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 27:20 (#2)

לֹא יִגָּאֵל עוֹד

“it shall not be redeemed again”

The expression **it shall not be redeemed again** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [no one will be able to redeem it again]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 27:21 (#2)

כִּשְׂדֵה הַחֵרֶם

“as a field of devotion”

A **field of devotion** refers to land that is completely and permanently dedicated to Yahweh. This is a stronger term than “consecrated.” You could use a term in your language that communicates this permanent, irrevocable dedication. Alternate translation: [as a field permanently and completely given to Yahweh]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 27:21 (#1)

בְּצֵאתוֹ בַיֹּבֵל

“in its going out in the Jubilee”

This is a common expression referring to when property ownership changes at the Year of Jubilee. You could use a natural expression in your language that has the same meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when ownership transfers in the Year of Jubilee]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 27:22 (#1)

אֶת־שְׂדֵה מִקְנָתוֹ

“a field of his purchase”

The phrase **a field of his purchase** refers to a field someone has bought rather than inherited. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if it would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [a field that he has purchased]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 27:22 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר לֹא מִשְּׂדֵה אֲחֻזָּתוֹ

“which {is} not from the field of his possession”

A **field of possession** refers to inherited land that was originally given to Israelite families. You could state this explicitly if it would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [which is not part of his inherited family land]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 27:24 (#1)

לַאֲשֶׁר קָנָהוּ מֵאִתּוֹ לַאֲשֶׁר־לוֹ

“to him from whom he bought it, to whom to him”

Here both instances of **him** refer to the original owner who has inheritance rights, while **he** refers to the person who bought and then dedicated the field. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [to the original owner from whom the buyer bought it, to whom]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Leviticus 27:24 (#2)

לַאֲשֶׁר־לוֹ אֲחֻזַּת הָאָרֶץ

“to whom to him {is} the possession of the land”

This refers to the person who permanently owns the land through inheritance rights. You could say this explicitly, if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to the one who permanently owns the land by inheritance]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 27:25 (#1)

בְּשֶׁקֶל הַקֹּדֶשׁ

“by the shekel of the holy place”

See how you translated this in 27:3.

See: Biblical Money

Leviticus 27:25 (#2)

גֵּרָה

“gerahs”

A **gerah** was a unit of weight equal to about one-half gram. You could use a known unit of weight in your language. Alternate translation: [units each equal to about one-half gram]

See: Biblical Weight

Leviticus 27:26 (#1)

בְּכוֹר אֲשֶׁר־יִבָּכֵר לַיהוָה בִּבְהֵמָה לֹא־יַקְדִּישׁ אִישׁ אֹתָהּ אִם־שׁוֹר אִם־שֶׂה לַיהוָה הוּא

“a firstborn (which firstborn {belongs} to Yahweh) among animals, a man shall not consecrate it, whether ox or sheep, it {belongs} to Yahweh”

The assumption is that readers will know that Yahweh automatically owns all firstborn animals from the time of the Passover, so no one can consecrate them. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [no one may consecrate a firstborn animal to Yahweh, whether ox or sheep, because all firstborn animals already belong to Yahweh]

See: Information Structure

Leviticus 27:27 (#1)

חֲמִשְׁתּוֹ

“its fifth”

See how you translated this in 27:13

See: Fractions

Leviticus 27:27 (#2)

וְאִם־לֹא יִגָּאֵל וְנִמְכַּר בְּעֶרְכֶּךָ

“And if it is not redeemed, then it shall be sold at your valuation”

The phrase **if it is not redeemed, then it shall be sold** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And if no one redeems it, then you must sell it at the value you determined]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 27:28 (#1)

חֵרֶם

“devoted thing”

A **devoted thing** refers to something that is completely and permanently dedicated to Yahweh. This is a stronger term than “consecrated.” See how you translated this in 27:21. Alternate translation: [thing permanently and completely given to Yahweh]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 27:28 (#2)

מֵאָדָם וּבְהֵמָה וּמִשְּׂדֵה אֲחֻזָּתוֹ

“from man and animal and from field of his possession”

This refers to anything someone might own that could be devoted to Yahweh. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [whether a person, an animal, or an inherited field]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Leviticus 27:28 (#3)

קֹ֥דֶשׁ־קָדָ֖שִׁים

“a holy thing of holy things”

See how you translated this in 2:3.

Leviticus 27:29 (#1)

הַחֵ֔רֶם אֲשֶׁ֥ר יָחֳרַ֖ם

“devoted ones who are devoted to destruction”

All **devoted ones** refers to someone who is completely and permanently dedicated to Yahweh. When someone is **devoted to destruction**, it means they must be executed because they are enemies of Israel or have severely broken Yahweh’s covenant. Alternate translation: [people who must be executed because they are permanently condemned]

See: Translate Unknowns

Leviticus 27:29 (#3)

לֹ֥א יִפָּדֶ֖ה

“shall not be ransomed”

The expression **shall not be ransomed** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use this form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [no one may pay to save their lives]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 27:29 (#4)

מ֥וֹת יוּמָֽת

“dying he shall be put to death”

The expression **he shall be put to death** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [you must certainly execute them]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 27:29 (#2)

כָּל־חֵ֔רֶם אֲשֶׁ֥ר יָחֳרַ֖ם

“All devoted ones who are devoted to destruction”

If your language does not use a passive verbal form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [All those whom Yahweh has condemned to death]

See: Active or Passive

Leviticus 27:30 (#1)

מִזֶּ֣רַע הָאָ֔רֶץ

“from the seed of the land”

Here, **seed** represents all food crops that grow from seeds. If it would be helpful in your translation, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from the crops of the land] or [from what grows in the fields]

See: Metonymy

Leviticus 27:31 (#1)

גָּאֹ֥ל יִגְאַ֖ל אִ֣ישׁ מִמַּעַשְׂרֵֽהוּ

“redeeming, a man will redeem from his tithe”

See how you translated a similar phrase about redeeming property in 27:19. Alternate translation: [indeed someone redeems part of his tithe]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 27:32 (#1)

כֹּ֚ל אֲשֶׁר־יַעֲבֹ֣ר תַּ֔חַת הַשָּׁ֖בֶט

“all which passes under the rod”

This is a common expression that refers to how shepherds would count their animals by making them pass under a rod one by one. You could use a comparable expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all that is counted in the flock]

See: Idiom

Leviticus 27:33 (#1)

לֹ֤א יְבַקֵּר֙ בֵּין־ט֣וֹב לָרָ֔ע וְלֹ֥א יְמִירֶ֖נּוּ

“He shall not examine between good to bad, and he shall not substitute it”

See how you translated this in 27:10. Alternate translation: [He must not inspect them to trade a good one for a bad one]

See: Doublet

Leviticus 27:33 (#2)

לֹ֥א יִגָּאֵֽל

“It shall not be redeemed”

Leviticus 27:33 (#2)

The phrase **It shall not be redeemed** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use this form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [No one may redeem it]

See: Active or Passive